Wesgro
cape town & western cape
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FINAL RESEARCH REPORT

Unlocking Tourism Growth

An Action Plan for the Western Cape to 2035

Letsema in partnership with Skift Advisory

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Foreword

[Foreword by the Chief Executive Officer of Wesgro, one page. To be drafted by Wesgro or ghost-written by Letsema for sign-off, SLA Annexure B clause 1.1.14.5.]

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Abbreviations

Abbreviation	Meaning
ACSA	Airports Company South Africa
CAGR	Compound annual growth rate
CTAA	Cape Town Air Access
CTIA	Cape Town International Airport
CTICC	Cape Town International Convention Centre
CTT	Cape Town Tourism
DEDAT	Department of Economic Development and Tourism, Western Cape Government
DMO	Destination marketing organisation
FTE	Full-time equivalent
FY	Financial year (April to March)
G4J	Growth for Jobs Strategy, Western Cape Government, 2023
GCC	Gulf Cooperation Council
GDPR	Gross domestic product by region
GVA	Gross value added
ICCA	International Congress and Convention Association
LTO	Local tourism organisation
M&E	Monitoring and evaluation
Mero	Municipal Economic Review and Outlook
MICE	Meetings, incentives, conferences and exhibitions
OAG	Official Airline Guide (schedules and capacity data)
OSM	OpenStreetMap
OTA	Online travel agency
Pero	Provincial Economic Review and Outlook
RACI	Responsible, accountable, consulted, informed
SAT	South African Tourism
SLA	Service level agreement
SMME	Small, medium and micro enterprise
Stats SA	Statistics South Africa
TSA	Tourism Satellite Account
UIA	Union of International Associations
VFR	Visiting friends and relatives
WTTC	World Travel and Tourism Council

Executive summary

A record 1.57 million international passengers arrived at Cape Town International in FY25/26, against 1.16 million in FY19/20, before the pandemic.[1] Its load factor of 79% across all its seats in 2025 was the joint highest of South Africa's five largest airports, with Lanseria.[2] Between 2015 and 2025 the airport added 17 mainline international routes, more than any of eight peer airports.[3] On the airport count, the recovery is complete. The next stage is harder, because the system that delivered it is now full at the peak.

Interest is not what holds the province back. About 97 million high-value travellers in 34 markets are interested in South Africa, yet only about one in seventy of them, some 1.4 million, turns that interest into a trip.[4] Seats and bookings stand in the way. Eleven of 27 international routes run above 80% load across the year, and at the summer peak one runway caps movements at about 30 an hour.[5] In winter, carriers pull seats: June holds 6.4% of the year's international capacity, against 10.8% in December.[6] Beyond the Metro, most rural properties are missing from the online travel agents where visitors book.[7]

On the growth model's count, arrivals can grow from about 1.5 million in 2025 to 2.5 million by 2035, if the province wins the seats.[8] That makes the action plan a supply programme before it is a marketing programme.

The province earns a premium from a narrow base

The Western Cape earns more per visitor than the rest of South Africa. The province takes about a quarter of national foreign spend from about a seventh of the arrivals. Its foreign visitors spend roughly 1.6 times the national average.[9] That is about US$890 per arrival, against US$500 for the rest of South Africa.[10] Foreign direct spend rose 14% in a year, from R22.7bn in FY2024 to R25.9bn in FY2025.[11]

Yet the premium rests on a few markets, six months and one metro. Five markets supply 63% of overseas arrivals, and the UK, Germany and the USA alone 52%.[12] More than half the arrivals on the ten largest routes come through someone else's hub: the routes through Dubai, Doha, Addis Ababa and Istanbul carry 53% of them.[13] October to March carries between 61% and 62% of overseas visitor travel.[14] The Cape Metro holds 20,281 of the province's 50,332 tourism assets, or 40.3%, and visitors disperse from there.[15] Growth now needs new markets, new seasons and new regions.

The limits are physical and institutional

Five constraints cap the case, and none of them is a lack of interest in the province. [Summary of Findings, 14 Oct 2026, slides 3 and 4: align these five constraints with the deck's own list once the deck is in hand.]

[1] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p11; Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p25; the same series stood at 1.44 million in FY24/25; Wesgro Research, Western Cape Tourism Performance: Annual 2025; Wesgro, presentation to the parliamentary committee, 1 Apr 2026; on South African Tourism's provincial count the province received 1,538,142 in 2025, still below the 2 million of 2019, and the two series count different things, as section 1.1 sets out.
[2] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "The South African Market".
[3] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "International Comparisons".
[4] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p41.
[5] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Seasonality"; Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p101.
[6] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Seasonality".
[7] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p95.
[8] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19; Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p20; the model and the airport series count arrivals differently, as section 1.1 sets out.
[9] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p11, computed.
[10] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p15.
[11] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p11.
[12] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p13.
[13] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p13, computed.
[14] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p25, p32; Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p12; the 2025 shares are provisional and scaled to 100%.
[15] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p2, p22, p23.

The gateway. The growth model draws air access as a line at 1.8 million inbound seats, and the base path crosses it around 2030.[16] The line is the model's assumption, not a measured cap. In practice the runway binds first, at peak hours. Runway relief comes from about 2033.[17] Airports Company South Africa (ACSA) now schedules the realigned runway for December 2029, subject to contract award.[18] The plan's phasing assumes about 2033 and counts the earlier date as upside. George Airport is domestic only, and Cape Winelands Airport targets 2028 with no named carrier.[19]

Full routes. Five of the eleven full routes are mature long-haul services, led by Newark at 88.6%, Atlanta at 84.3% and Frankfurt and London Heathrow at 83.0%.[20] On full routes, carriers are expected to raise fares before they add seats.[21]

Seasons. The green season, April to September, is a seat problem and a demand problem at once: seats and visitors fall away together. Connecting traffic is "especially critical in the low season".[22] That ties winter seats to the hub carriers' own priorities.

Reach. Accessibility falls from 4.7 out of 5 in the Cape Metro to 1.0 in the Central Karoo, and one touring route of six is rated Ready. Beyond the Metro and the Garden Route the province is effectively car-only.[23]

Levers held elsewhere. National government and its state-owned entities hold visas, air service agreements and the airport and port programmes.[24] Mobility mandates are split across three tiers, and no approved method exists for provincial tourism GDP and jobs.[25]

Most of the five sit outside a marketing budget, and the runway and air rights sit outside the province.

What 2.5 million arrivals would take

Wesgro's original ask was larger: to "double international tourist arrivals to the Western Cape by 2035".[26] The evidence reframes that ambition as growth to 2.5 million. The province's Growth for Jobs Strategy sets 3 million by 2035 on South African Tourism's count.[27] That sits above every path the growth model draws, and section 1.1 explains why the two cannot yet be compared directly. [G4J 2023 document to be read and the 3 million target confirmed against it.]

The gateway sets the pace in the summer peak, and demand and conversion set it in the green season and beyond the Metro. The growth model draws three paths from a 2025 base of about 1.5 million.[28] By 2035 the conservative path reaches about 1.8 million, the base path about 2.2 million and the accelerated path about 2.5 million. Chapters 1 to 5 call the last two the base and accelerated cases.

The paths differ by intervention, not by demand potential. The base path assumes Wesgro holds its current effort while Emirates, Qatar, Ethiopian and Turkish Airlines keep adding capacity. The accelerated path also needs direct India and China routes and dedicated activation in India, China, the USA and the Gulf. Without confirmed routes, it reverts to base.[29]

[16] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p21.
[17] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p101 to p103.
[18] ACSA, Q1 2026/27 presentation to the Portfolio Committee on Transport, as reported by Travel News, Aug 2026.
[19] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p104 to p109.
[20] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Seasonality".
[21] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "In Conclusion".
[22] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Executive Summary".
[23] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p88 to p90, p30, p99.
[24] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p58; Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p103, p112.
[25] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p23, p37.
[26] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p4.
[27] Wesgro, presentation to the parliamentary committee, 1 Apr 2026, public source.
[28] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19; Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p20.
[29] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p19, p20.

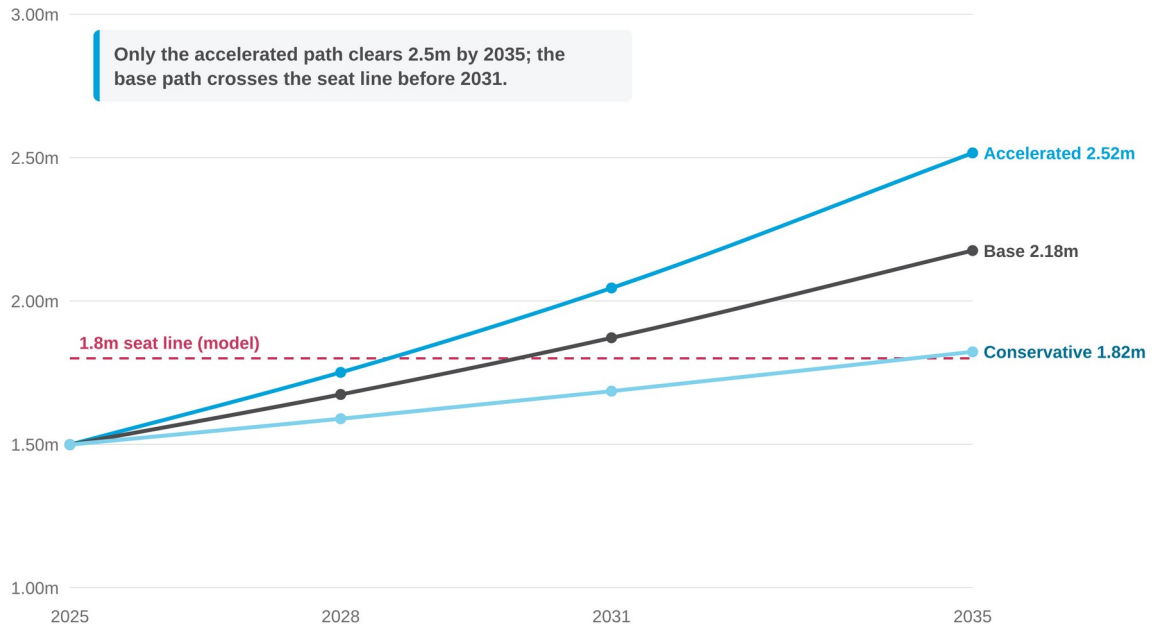


Figure ES.1. Arrivals paths to 2035

Source: Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19 (2025 base); Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p20, p21. The 2031 base value and the accelerated and conservative milestones are computed (section 5.3).

On the eleven full routes, marketing cannot make up for missing seats, but on the Dubai, Addis Ababa and Doha routes, at 65% to 72% load, it can.[30] The hub markets supply about 30% of the arrivals the base path adds, the largest share of any market group.[31]

The base path implies growth of 3.8% a year and the accelerated path 5.3%, against a global norm of 3% to 5%.[32] Faster growth has been sustained outside a recovery. Santiago's airport grew from about 16 million passengers in 2010 to more than 26 million in 2019, at least 5.5% a year. Chile's international seat capacity rose about 40% to 50% from 2013 to 2019.[33] The fastest growers aimed institutions, marketing and air access at one binding constraint.[34] For Chile that constraint was long-haul access. The Western Cape's constraint has the same shape: seats into one gateway airport.

The action plan makes three shifts

In Pillar 1, Reshape demand, the work moves from awareness to conversion. The province is under-sold in its growth markets and hard to book outside its core. Three of its six focus areas aim at conversion: green-season events, bookable product and hub traffic already in the air. About 101,000 Indian and Chinese travellers a year already reach Cape Town, mainly through Gulf and African hubs.[35] Singapore shows how a hub can turn transit into visits, and Melbourne uses its events calendar to steady demand.[36]

In Pillar 2, Transform supply, the work moves from new attractions to seats and finished experiences. The pillar has one capacity entry: frequency and larger aircraft on the full routes ahead of runway relief. Following Chile, Initiative I6 designs a public-private air access fund in 2027 and 2028 to back it (section

[30] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "In Conclusion", "Seasonality".
[31] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19, p20, computed.
[32] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19; Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p7.
[33] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p24 to p26, computed.
[34] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p58, p59.
[35] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p46, p48, computed.
[36] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p18, p40, p59.

4.3).[37] Five more cover cruise, reach, product and experience. Cruise grows through ships and excursions rather than port capital.[38] At the flagship sites the task is to manage flows, because Boulders is near carrying capacity and Cableway queues run up to three hours.[39] Elsewhere it is to turn existing assets into complete visitor experiences.[40]

In Pillar 3, Build enabling capability, the work moves from separate mandates to shared decisions, capital and data. The pillar answers four questions. First, who benefits: twenty township and rural communities hold 18.4% of the province's residents, but the spend traced to them is a floor of 0.02% to 0.04% of foreign direct spend.[41] Second, who pays: the capital pipeline funds airports, ports, roads and rail, but almost none of it reaches the beds, booking and product the regions lack.[42] Third, who decides: with visas and air service agreements held nationally, the province leads by escalation.[43] Fourth, who measures: more than twenty bodies produce tourism data, yet no one holds a single view of visitor behaviour.[44] The New Zealand case argues for yield over arrivals, so the plan tracks spend, season and spread beside arrivals (section 5.3).[45]

The three pillars make one case. Demand work fills seats only if the seats exist, and supply work pays only if the product can be booked. Both need the enabling base to last.

[37] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p28.
[38] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p112.
[39] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p24, p36.
[40] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p114.
[41] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p5.
[42] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p32 to p87, p100, p112.
[43] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p58.
[44] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p56, p57.
[45] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p55, p56.

Twenty focus areas at a glance

The research rests on a hypothesis tree of three pillars, six themes and twenty focus areas (section 1.4). Each focus area names a lever on growth, framed so the evidence could test it. Nineteen were tested against the evidence of a named workstream. The evidence supports all nineteen, nine strongly and ten with a gap or a qualifier (Appendix A1). The twentieth, workforce and service skills, waits on a labour analysis still to be commissioned.

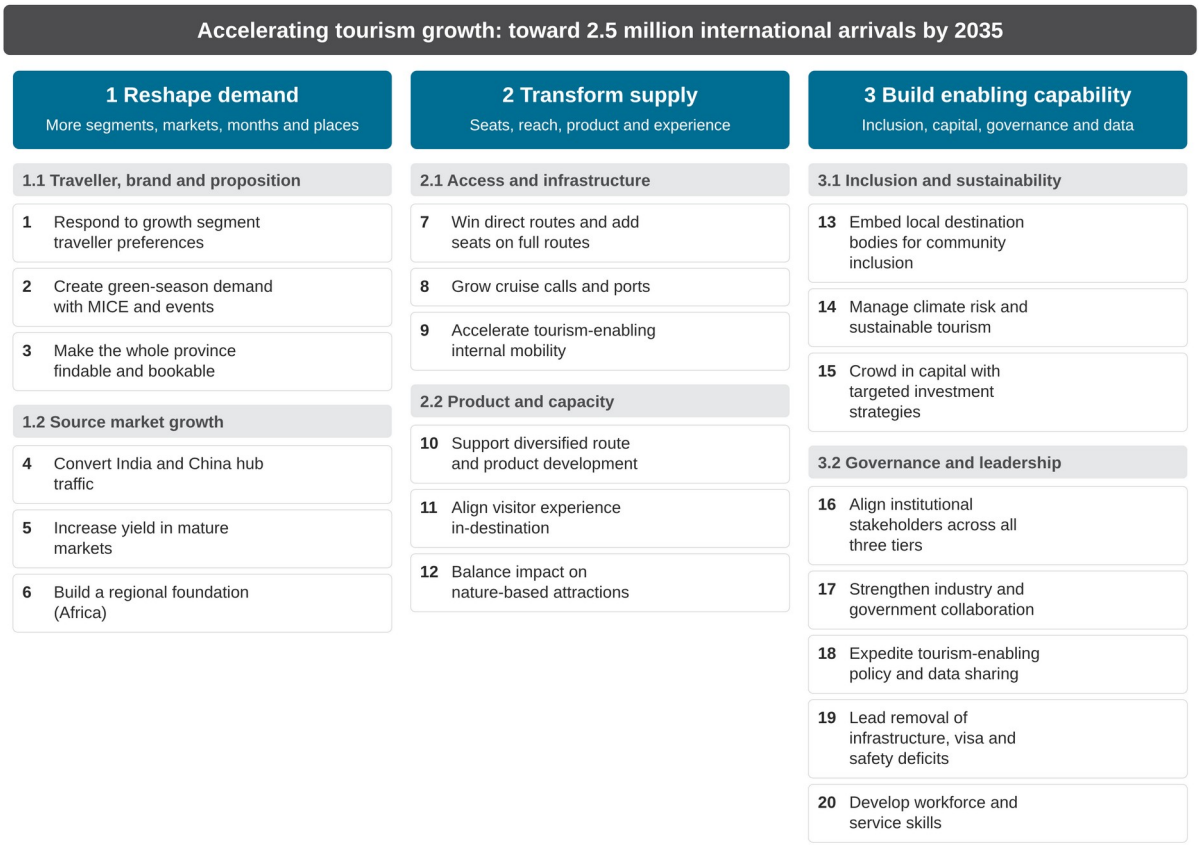


Figure ES.2. The hypothesis tree

Source: Letsema; Appendix A1 traces each focus area to its evidence.

Each table gives a focus area's Chapter 3 finding word for word and its initiative.

Table ES.1. Pillar 1: Reshape demand

> **Conversion, not awareness, holds back the growth markets, the green season and the province beyond its core.**

Focus area	What the evidence shows and what follows	Initiative
1 Respond to growth segment traveller preferences	Four traveller segments, each concentrated in named home markets, give Wesgro a sharper target than country alone, and the province scores 3.7 to 4.6 out of 5 on its ability to win them.	I1
2 Create green-season demand with MICE and events	The green season is a seat problem and an events problem at once. June holds 6.4% of the year's international seats, and business events are the lever best placed to fill the trough, though international meetings now peak from September to November.	I2
3 Make the whole province findable and bookable	Outside the Cape Peninsula, the Winelands and the Garden Route, most product cannot be booked where travellers book, so interest the province has already earned has nowhere to land.	I3

Focus area	What the evidence shows and what follows	Initiative
4 Convert India and China hub traffic	About 101,000 Indian and Chinese travellers a year already reach Cape Town, mainly through Gulf and African hubs, and with no direct Indian route likely before 2030, converting that flow is the lever available now.	I4
5 Increase yield in mature markets	The mature markets already pay the most and fill the fullest routes, so growth there comes from more value per visitor and more seats on existing routes, not from broad awareness campaigns.	I1
6 Build a regional foundation (Africa)	Regional Africa is the province's steadiest volume and its least developed premium market: Zimbabwe and Namibia supply 62% of African arrivals, while West African visitors spend the most per visit.	I5

Source: Chapter 3 toplines, quoted verbatim. Sources for each figure are in the Chapter 3 entry.

Table ES.2. Pillar 2: Transform supply

The gateway binds first, and beyond the Metro the product exists but is hard to reach, book or stay in.

Focus area	What the evidence shows and what follows	Initiative
7 Win direct routes and add seats on full routes	Eleven of 27 international routes run above 80% load and carriers are expected to price before adding seats, so the province must win frequency and larger aircraft before runway relief in about 2033.	I6
8 Grow cruise calls and ports	Cruise brings about R1.79bn a year and Cape Town's berth took 83 calls against room for 150 or more, so growth comes from ships, excursions and day stops, not port capital.	I7
9 Accelerate tourism-enabling internal mobility	Accessibility falls from 4.7 out of 5 in the Cape Metro to 1.0 in the Central Karoo, and beyond the Metro and the Garden Route the province is effectively car-only.	I8
10 Support diversified route and product development	The province does not lack attractions; it lacks finished experiences around them, with assets outside the Metro left without guides, interpretation or bookable product and one touring route of six rated Ready.	I9
11 Align visitor experience in-destination	The province offers luxury estates and basic self-catering with no mid-scale branded tier between them, and service, interpretation and language readiness thin out with distance from Cape Town.	I10
12 Balance impact on nature-based attractions	Boulders is near carrying capacity and Cableway queues reach three hours, so growth at the flagship nature sites must come from managing flows and steering visitors to under-marketed reserves.	I11

Source: Chapter 3 toplines, quoted verbatim. Sources for each figure are in the Chapter 3 entry.

Table ES.3. Pillar 3: Build enabling capability

Inclusion, capital, governance and data are thin, and several levers sit with national government.

Focus area	What the evidence shows and what follows	Initiative
13 Embed local destination bodies for community inclusion	Twenty communities hold 18.4% of the province's residents but receive only a small documented share of foreign direct spend, and in eleven the binding constraint is organisation, not distance or product.	I12
14 Manage climate risk and sustainable tourism	Climate is already costing the province sites, routes and revenue, while the local tourism bodies that would manage the response depend on municipal funding that MFMA Circular No. 131 has disrupted.	I13
15 Crowd in capital with targeted investment strategies	The province's capital pipeline funds airports, ports, roads, rail and the Metro waterfront, but almost none of it reaches regional product, bookability or community assets, where the growth case needs investment.	I14
16 Align institutional stakeholders across all three tiers	Air service agreements and visas sit with national government, mandates are split across three tiers and the national marketing body is under strain, so the province needs one shared agenda with clear decision rights.	I15
17 Strengthen industry and government collaboration	Fifteen of the sixteen organisations heard raised collaboration, and the channels already exist in JAMS, the bid teams and the tour-operator forums, so the task is to turn existing forums into one joint plan.	I15

Focus area	What the evidence shows and what follows	Initiative
18 Expedite tourism-enabling policy and data sharing	No approved method exists for provincial tourism GDP and jobs, operators cannot see their own customers and the arrivals series run unreconciled, so a data-sharing protocol is the precondition for every target.	I16
19 Lead removal of infrastructure, visa and safety deficits	Visas, air rights, the runway and policing sit with national government, so the province leads by escalation backed with evidence, and delivers the safety programmes and basic services that are its own.	I17
20 Develop workforce and service skills	The 300,000 tourism-linked jobs ambition has no baseline and no labour analysis behind it, so the first step is to commission that analysis, and the skills plan follows from it.	I18

Source: Chapter 3 toplines, quoted verbatim. Sources for each figure are in the Chapter 3 entry.

Seats and bookings move first

Air access and bookability move first, because every other lever runs through them. The plan runs in three phases. Activate, from 2027 to 2028, holds and adds seats on the full routes, counts the bookability gap and sets up the institutions the rest depends on. Gate 1 closes the phase at the end of 2028, two years before the base path crosses the seat line.[46] Expand, from 2029 to 2031, scales what works and meets the seat line at the 2030 mid-term review. Sustain, from 2032 to 2035, takes direct route cases to carriers as runway capacity arrives.

Eighteen initiatives carry the plan, one per focus area except where one owner delivers two. Wesgro is accountable for twelve. The Department of Economic Development and Tourism (DEDAT), the Department of Mobility, municipalities, local tourism organisations (LTOs) and site operators lead the other six. Thirteen draw mainly on Wesgro's operating budget. None has yet been costed, and setting the rand bands is the first funding task (section 4.6).

Twelve actions in three strands can start in the first 24 months, nine of them inside Wesgro's current mandate and budget.

Seats and season come first, from the first half of 2027. Cape Town Air Access holds winter seats through joint marketing with carriers on the full routes and tracks the runway quarterly (I6, I2). The Convention Bureau publishes a green-season events calendar and aims bids at May to September (I2).

Governance and baselines also start then. The Wesgro CEO's office and DEDAT constitute the Tourism Growth Steerco and table the first national escalation agenda (I15, I17). Wesgro's Research unit agrees a data-sharing protocol with ACSA, SA Tourism, Stats SA and Cape Town Tourism (I16). It also runs a bookability census by district and requests visitor counts from the five flagship sites (I3, I11).

Product and inclusion follow in the second half of 2027. Wesgro's Tourism unit packages the Garden Route and Route 62 with a shuttle transfer (I8, I9). It also packages the Southern Line as a visitor product with the City of Cape Town and the Passenger Rail Agency of South Africa (I8). It chooses two or three pilot communities, and from the first half of 2028 the LTOs give each community one live booking route before any promotion (I12, I3). Each action opens a seat, a baseline or a booking path a later initiative needs. Owners and start dates are proposals for Steerco to confirm (section 4.5).

How the Board will track progress

The Board will judge the plan on seven impact indicators, and today only arrivals and spend carry a modelled value for 2035. Beneath them sit twenty-five outcome and thirty-six output indicators. Steerco receives a quarterly scorecard and the Board an annual outlook against both paths. Gates at the end of 2028 and 2031, a mid-term review in 2030 and a terminal evaluation in 2035 decide what each phase funds.

Table ES.4. Impact indicators and targets

Arrivals carry targets on both paths, while jobs wait on the labour analysis and season, spread and community spend start from dated baselines.

Impact indicator	Baseline	2028 base / accelerated	2035 base / accelerated
T1-01 International arrivals	1,498,829 (2025, model value)	1,673,855 / 1,750,871*	2,175,778 / 2,516,282
T1-02 Arrivals by market group	Five groups, 2025	Base path by group	Base path by group; accelerated not split

[46] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p21.

Impact indicator	Baseline	2028 base / accelerated	2035 base / accelerated
T1-03 Direct foreign spend	R25.9bn (FY2025, nominal)	Not printed	R40.6bn (base, modelled, constant 2024 rand)
T1-04 Tourism jobs	Set by the labour analysis (I18)	Set at Gate 1	Set at Gate 1
T1-05 Green-season share	38.1% (2025, normalised); 39% (2024)	Level set at Gate 1	Rising
T1-06 Share outside the Metro	Not in hand; due in 2027	Baseline set	Rising
T1-07 Community share of spend	R4m to R10m a year (documented floor)	Pilots measured	1% (R259m) reference point

Source: Section 5.3. Computed values are marked *. Tourism jobs have no provincial baseline; the labour analysis (I18) sets one by Gate 1. T1-03 targets are in constant 2024 rand.

The table shows the model's arrivals baseline, and the airport count is tracked beside it, from 1.44 million in FY24/25 (section 5.3).[47] The spend target needs the same care. The model's 2024 spend of R27.12bn sits 19% above the R22.7bn reported for FY2024, so R40.6bn is not measured from R25.9bn.[48] [Open item: Skift to rebase the spend path on the FY2025 actual of R25.9bn.]

Jobs wait on the labour analysis, so the ambition of 300,000 tourism-linked jobs is tested before it becomes a target. The green-season share starts at 38.1%, but the share outside the Metro has no baseline until the data protocol delivers one in 2027 (section 5.3). Gate 1 turns the missing baselines into targets, so the first two years must produce data as well as results.

What could knock it off course

Ten of the fourteen material risks sit outside Wesgro's control, so the response to most is early warning and a route to the tier that can act. One is rated high on both likelihood and impact: restrictive bilateral air agreements and the US carrier cap. It calls for an escalation agenda with stated asks, plus route work inside existing rights.

Six are rated medium likelihood and high impact, in three pairs; first, two sit with the national tier and ACSA. Runway relief may slip past about 2033, so its milestones are tracked quarterly. Visa processing may not improve, and the escalation agenda carries it. Second, two sit in the markets. A Gulf hub disruption would cut connecting capacity, so hub work is spread across all four hubs. A downturn in the UK, Germany and the USA would hit 52% of overseas arrivals, so activation shifts towards Africa and the hub markets. Third, two sit closer to delivery. Safety incidents could deter visitors, so safety gates come before any pilot launch. A cut to Wesgro's operating budget would hit thirteen initiatives, so rand bands and a stop list are due before Gate 1 (section 4.6).

Two more are rated high likelihood and medium impact. Climate events that close sites and routes call for a climate risk register. The loss of LTO funding, which MFMA Circular No. 131 has disrupted, calls for stable funding agreements with a development mandate. Likelihood and impact are Letsema's assessment, and Steerco reviews the register each quarter (section 4.8).

Several items remain open, from page references still to confirm to the source of the 250-call cruise target and a provincial employment baseline. Each is marked in square brackets where it occurs and listed with an owner in the accompanying open-items register.

[47] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p11.
[48] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p10, p24.

Chapter 1

Context

1.1 Mandate and objective

Wesgro commissioned research and an action plan to "double international tourist arrivals to the Western Cape by 2035".[49] The evidence reframes that goal as growth to 2.5 million arrivals, paced by gateway capacity in the summer peak and by demand in the green season.

Wesgro acts through partners to create jobs

Wesgro promotes tourism, trade and investment for Cape Town and the Western Cape, so the tourism goal sits inside a wider economic brief. Its mission is to work "together with partners, drive inclusive and sustainable economic growth, strengthen competitiveness, and create jobs in Cape Town and the Western Cape". Its vision is to "be a leading regional tourism, trade and investment promotion agency".[50] Two points in the mission shape the recommendations: growth is a means to jobs, and Wesgro acts through partners rather than holding the levers itself.

Four of Wesgro's eight strategy statements bear directly on this study.[51] The first sets the destination proposition: Cape Town and the Western Cape "top of mind as a leading business and tourism destination with premium products and services". The fourth names new markets and buyers in China, ASEAN, India, Brazil and the Middle East, "while maintaining a continued focus on established markets". The sixth commits Wesgro to "Track and address systemic challenges influencing economic competitiveness", and the seventh to "Provide economic data, insights & analytics for the Western Cape". The growth-market work in focus area 4 centres on two of them: India and China, whose travellers already reach Cape Town through Gulf and African hubs.[52] The growth model's acceleration group holds the Gulf, China, India and Brazil.[53]

Of four ambitions, only arrivals has a target the evidence supports

The objective, set in November 2025, is "To develop an evidence-based tourism strategy that will double international tourist arrivals to the Western Cape by 2035". It continues: "through a holistic approach that drives demand, strengthens supply and enables inclusive, sustainable and geographically dispersed growth aligned with WESGRO's strategic priorities".[54] The research builds the evidence the objective calls for, and Chapters 3 and 4 turn it into recommendations and initiatives. The objective fixes the three pillars the report keeps throughout: demand, supply and enablement. Of its terms, only the doubling did not survive the evidence.

Four headline ambitions sat under the objective: 2.8 million international visitors, 300,000 tourism-linked jobs, 10,000 SMMEs onboarded and twice the airlift and cruise volumes.[55] The report carries all four forward. The evidence reframed the first and changed how the other three are measured.

Arrivals. The growth model tested the doubling and supports 2.2 million to 2.5 million by 2035. From 1,498,829 arrivals in 2025, its base case reaches 2,175,778 by 2035 and its accelerated case 2,516,282, above a conservative floor of 1,822,634.[56] The base case holds Wesgro's effort at 2025 intensity, with selective frequency gains and continued hub expansion. The accelerated case needs confirmed direct routes to India and China, above-baseline activation and more hub capacity into Cape Town; without the

[49] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p4.
[50] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p5.
[51] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p5.
[52] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p46, p48.
[53] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p20.
[54] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p4.
[55] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p4.
[56] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19; Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p20; this source prints the same 2035 points from a 2024 base.

routes, volume reverts to base.[57] Growth to 2.5 million is that case rounded, and it is the goal the report carries.

Even the base case outruns the model's air access. The model draws a seat line at 1.8 million inbound seats, and the base case first passes it at the 2030 year point, at 1,802,929 arrivals.[58] The line is an assumption rather than a measured cap. In practice the runway binds first, at peak hours (section 1.3). Growth to 2.5 million is therefore a supply programme before it is a marketing programme.

Jobs. The ambition was 300,000 tourism-linked jobs, yet the evidence holds no Western Cape tourism employment figure (section 2.4). Jobs therefore enter Chapter 5 without a baseline. Wesgro and DEDAT should commission a labour analysis in 2027 to set one (focus area 20).

SMMEs. The ambition was 10,000 SMMEs onboarded, with no baseline or definition printed [Wesgro to confirm the baseline count and definition of SMMEs onboarded]. The action plan treats it as community inclusion, measured in visitor spend reaching priority communities rather than a count of firms (section 2.4 and Chapter 5).

Airlift and cruise. The ambition was twice the airlift and cruise volumes. Section 3.2.1 sets airlift as the seats and routes needed to lift the model's 1.8 million seat line.[59] It sets cruise as calls and ports [Cruise Cape Town to confirm the call target and its definition]. The cruise baseline is 79 vessels in the 2024/25 season.[60] Of the four ambitions, only arrivals has a target the evidence supports today. The other three go forward with their baselines still to be fixed.

Wesgro's arrivals metric fits a ten-year reading

Wesgro measures itself against six strategic outcomes, each with one metric. Two bear on tourism: 800,000 to 1 million new international tourist arrivals and 161 business event bids secured, worth an estimated R4.5 billion.[61] None of the six states a period [Wesgro to confirm the period over which the six outcome metrics are measured].

The period decides how the arrivals metric compares with the growth case. Over ten years, 800,000 to 1 million new arrivals sits between the two paths, which add 676,949 and 1,017,453 from 2025 to 2035.[62] Yet over the five years to 2030 it is more than twice what the base case adds by then, about 304,000.[63]

The business-events metric ties to the plan's green-season focus (focus area 2). International association meetings in Cape Town rose from 33 in 2022 to 58 in 2024 and are "primarily hosted between May and November".[64] That window overlaps the green season, April to September,[65] but 74 of the 136 meetings from 2022 to 2024 fell between September and November.[66] Bids must therefore pull meetings into the trough months (section 3.1). Chapter 5 tracks the nearest indicators: international arrivals and association meetings in Cape Town (T1-01 and T2-02).

The Growth for Jobs target sits above both paths

The study's contract requires this report and its recommendations to align with two documents: the Growth for Jobs Strategy (G4J) and Wesgro's FY26 to FY30 plan.[67] This report is the Final Research Report

[57] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p18, p19.
[58] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p20.
[59] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p20.
[60] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p37.
[61] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p6; the other four are a 120 million audience reached, R30 billion of new investment, R9.1 billion of new export declarations and a future-fit and trusted Wesgro, with a clean audit, satisfied clients and low culture entropy.
[62] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19.
[63] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p20, computed.
[64] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p26.
[65] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p25.
[66] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p37, computed.
[67] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p22; the requirement itself sits in SLA Annexure B, clause 1.1.14.2.

under clause 1.1.14, and Chapter 5 answers the monitoring and evaluation clauses 1.1.4 and 1.1.10 [clause references to be checked against the signed SLA Annexure B, whose wording is not in hand].

The Growth for Jobs Strategy 2023, approved by Cabinet, designates tourism a primary tradable sector for the province.[68] Its arrivals target is 3 million international tourist arrivals by 2035 on the South African Tourism basis.[69] [G4J 2023 document to be read and the 3 million target confirmed against it.] On that basis the province received 1,538,142 in 2025,[70] still below the 2 million of 2019 on which G4J builds. The 3 million sits above both of the model's paths. Part of the gap is method: G4J adds 1 million to the 2019 count, while the model builds up market by market against the seats the gateway can carry. Part may be measure, because what the model counts is not yet confirmed (see the closing note). Until it is, the 2.5 million cannot be set directly against the 3 million.

Wesgro's FY26 to FY30 plan is the second test. Wesgro's strategy statements are quoted above at second hand, but the FY26 to FY30 plan itself, with its tourism targets, is not in the evidence base.[71] Until it is, alignment can be stated only in principle [Wesgro to supply the FY26 to FY30 plan and its tourism targets, so that the Chapter 5 baselines and the Chapter 4 phase gates can be mapped to the plan cycle]. Yet the timing already fits. Chapter 4 sets its first decision gate at the end of 2028, inside the plan period and before the base case crosses the model's seat line.

How the report counts arrivals

Four kinds of arrivals figure circulate around this study: ambitions, airport passengers, South African Tourism's tourist arrivals and the model's arrivals. Appendix A2 lists all eight with their bases. The report keeps them apart under three rules. Airport passenger arrivals at Cape Town International, by fiscal year, are the baseline and tracking series, with FY24/25 at 1.44 million.[72] The model's 2025 base of 1,498,829 and its 2035 points are the target series. [Open item: Skift to confirm in writing what the model counts (SA Tourism tourist arrivals, ACSA passengers including returning residents or OAG origin-and-destination flows) and how the Hubs group is built.] South African Tourism's provincial count is used once, to read across to the G4J target. The report quotes the series side by side and never adds one to the other [model owner to confirm the series and year basis behind the 2025 base of 1,498,829].

1.2 The Western Cape tourism system today

International arrivals at Cape Town International have recovered to a record, and the system that delivered the recovery runs through five source markets, six summer months and one metro.

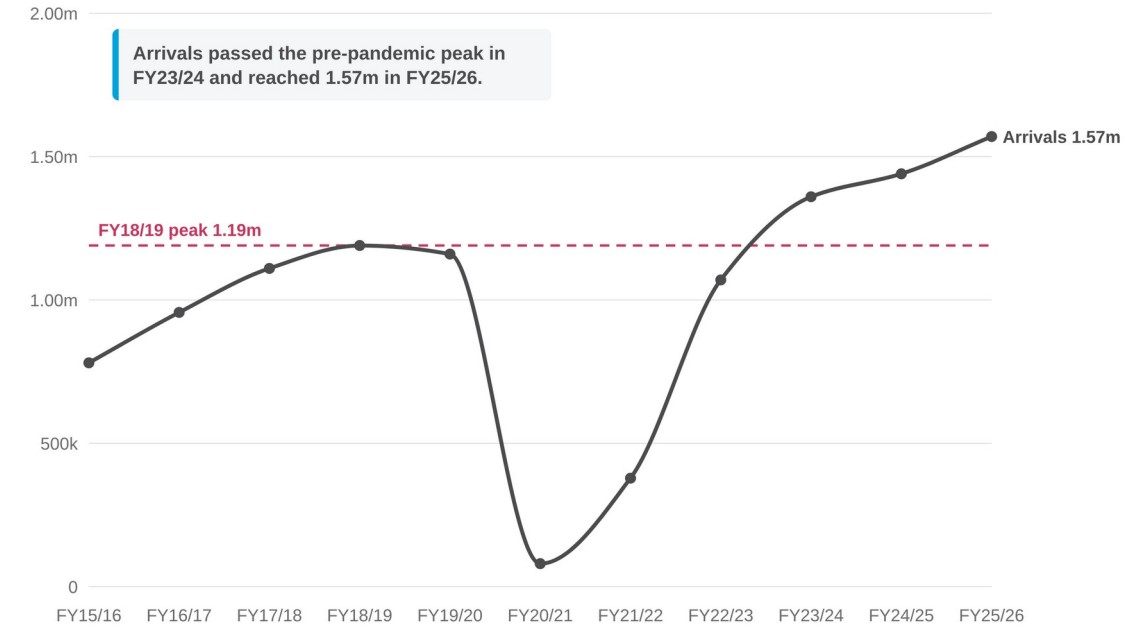
Arrivals and recovery

International passenger arrivals at Cape Town International reached 1.44m in FY24/25, against 1.16m in FY19/20, the last pre-pandemic year.[73] Arrivals passed the pre-pandemic peak of 1.19m, set in FY18/19, during FY23/24, when they reached 1.36m.[74] FY25/26 added a further step to 1.57m.[75]

[68] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p34; Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p5.
[69] Wesgro, presentation to the parliamentary committee, 1 Apr 2026, public source.
[70] Wesgro Research, Western Cape Tourism Performance: Annual 2025, from SA Tourism data, public source; the 2025 count rose 11.1% on the year.
[71] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p34.
[72] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p26, p41; the source uses Cape Town air arrivals as its provincial proxy.
[73] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p25.
[74] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p25.
[75] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p11.

The fall and the climb were both steep. Arrivals dropped to 80,400 in FY20/21 and 378,500 in FY21/22, then returned to 1.07m in FY22/23.[76] Two-way international passengers reached 2.90m in FY24/25, 29% above FY17/18,[77] and 3.3m in calendar 2025 inside a total of 11.1m, both up 7% on the year.[78]

Cape Town's recovery also ran ahead of the national one, so the destination gained share as it recovered. In the first half of 2024 its air arrivals had recovered further against 2019 than South Africa's in eight of the ten largest markets.[79] The USA stood at 162% and Australia at 172% of their 2019 level.[80]



International passenger arrivals by fiscal year, ACSA. FY25/26 from the Demand-Side Analysis.

Figure 1.1. Airport arrivals, FY15/16 to FY25/26

Source: Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p25 (FY15/16 to FY24/25); Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p11 (FY25/26). CTIA and ACSA CPT passenger statistics, international arrivals by fiscal year.

Spend and value

Foreign direct spend in the province rose from R22.7bn in FY2024 to R25.9bn in FY2025, a gain of 14% in one year.[81] The Western Cape earns that spend from a modest share of the national market. Across the four quarters of 2025 it took 16%, 13%, 13% and 16% of South Africa's foreign arrivals and 26%, 20%, 22% and 27% of foreign direct spend.[82]

The gap between the two shares is the province's premium. About a quarter of national spend from about a seventh of arrivals means the average foreign visitor to the Western Cape spends roughly 1.6 times the national average.[83] The province earns about US$890 per international arrival, against US$500 for the rest of South Africa and US$630 for Morocco, though below Kenya's US$1,460.[84]

More than a quarter of overseas visitors stay between 7 and 21 days, on printed bands that sum to only 48%.[85] Some 5% stay 1 to 2 days, 12% 3 to 4, 14% 7 to 10, 3% 11 to 14, 13% 15 to 21 and 1% other.[86]

[76] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p25.
[77] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p35.
[78] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p22.
[79] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p26.
[80] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p26.
[81] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p11.
[82] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p11.
[83] Computed from Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p11.
[84] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p15.
[85] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p12.
[86] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p12.

The 2024 Wesgro Visitor Tracking Survey gives the same distribution, and 52.33% of its respondents gave no length of stay, so the bands describe about half the sample.[87]

The modal visitor in the 2024 Wesgro survey spends R1,000 to R2,000 a day, is aged 36 to 50 and travels as a pair.[88] Nearly 40% spend more than R1,000 a day.[89] Self-catering at 17.4% and guesthouses at 9.7% lead accommodation choice, ahead of hotels at 3.6%;[90] together these shares cover under a third of respondents.

Source markets

Five markets supply 63% of overseas arrivals. In 2025 the UK held 19%, Germany 17%, the USA 16%, the Netherlands 7% and France 4%, and the three largest alone held 52%.[91] The report uses 63%, the sum of the printed shares.

Concentration is not new. On the Cape Town overseas air-arrivals basis for January to August 2024 the same five markets held 61%, with the UK and the USA at 18% each and Germany at 15%.[92] The growth markets remain small: India supplied about 2.6% of South Africa's overseas tourists in September 2025, the Middle East 2.3% and China 1.4%.[93]

The mature markets also pay the most. Average spend per visitor in 2024 ran from R32,900 for the USA, R26,500 for the UK and R25,600 for Germany down to R8,600 for Namibia and R8,500 for Zimbabwe.[94] The spread is 3.9 times, and the two regional markets compensate with stability, repeat demand and counter-seasonal volume.[95]

Most of these visitors arrive through someone else's hub. The UAE route carried 222,923 air arrivals into Cape Town in 2025, the UK 158,448, Qatar 126,078, Ethiopia 123,250 and Turkiye 89,090.[96] The four hub routes through Dubai, Doha, Addis Ababa and Istanbul carried 53% of arrivals on the ten largest routes,[97] so the hubs, not the source markets, are the province's working gateways.

[87] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p25.
[88] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p25.
[89] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p27.
[90] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p27.
[91] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p13.
[92] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p29.
[93] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p30.
[94] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p14.
[95] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p14.
[96] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p13.
[97] Computed from Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p13.

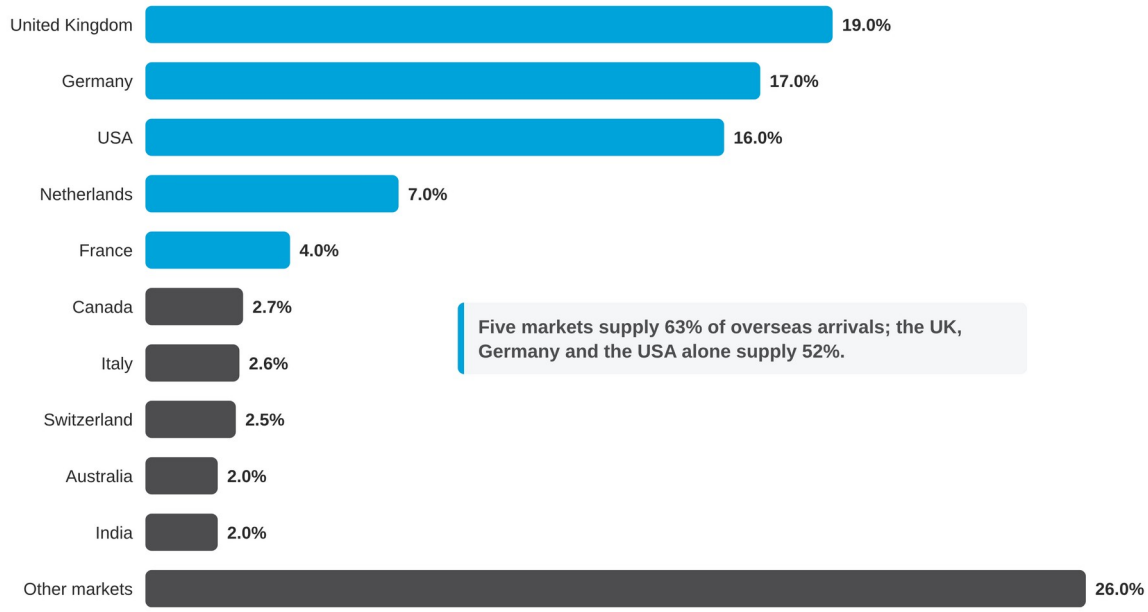


Figure 1.2. Overseas arrivals by market, 2025

Source: Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p13 (Stats SA and SAT International Performance Report 2025). The same slide prints 61% in its text; the five shares shown sum to 63%.

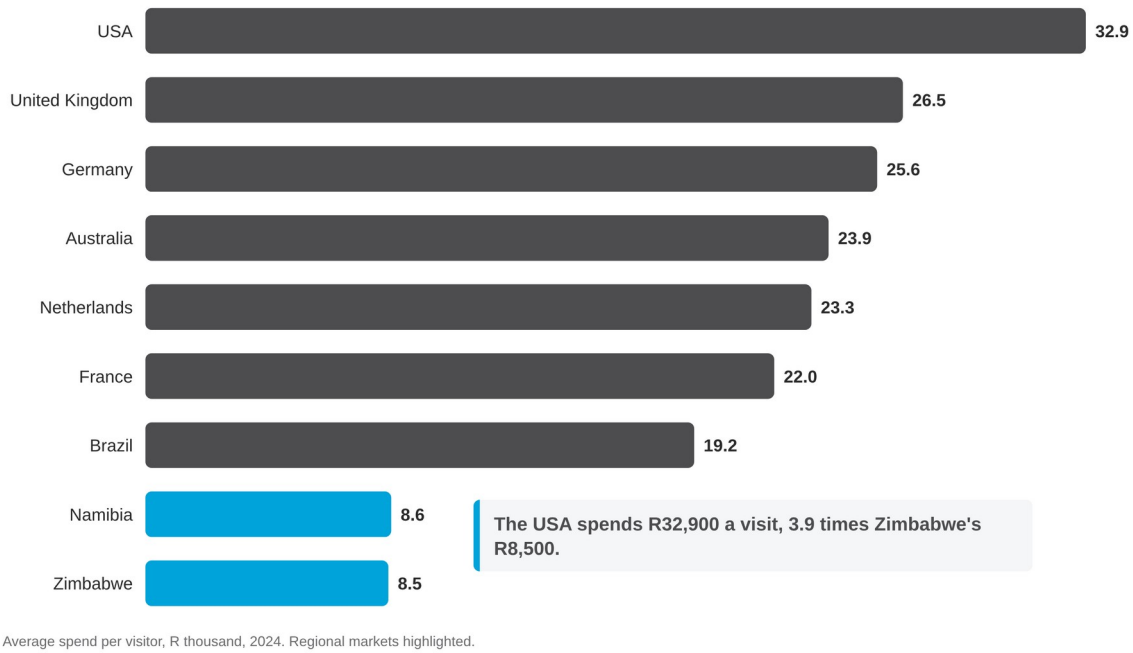


Figure 1.3. Spend per visitor by market, 2024

Source: Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p14 (Stats SA and SAT International Performance Report). Average spend in the Western Cape by source market, ZAR, 2024.

Seasonality

Demand peaks in the southern summer. In 2025, 12.7% of overseas visitors travelled in December, 11.5% in January and 11.3% in November, against 6.1% in June and 6.5% in August.[98] October to March

[98] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p12.

together account for about 62% of the year once the twelve printed shares, which sum to 104.9%, are scaled to 100% [Wesgro Research to confirm the 2025 month-of-travel shares].

The 2024 Wesgro Visitor Tracking Survey, whose monthly shares sum to 100%, gives 61% for October to March and 39% for April to September.[99]

Supply follows the same curve. June carries 6.4% of 2025 international seat capacity into Cape Town,[100] and Cape Town hotel occupancy was 53% in June 2023.[101] [Open item: Wesgro Research to supply June 2025 occupancy.] The conclusion follows: growth "will depend on improving conversion in Apr-Sep rather than pushing incremental demand into already busy peak months".[102]

Table 1.1. Month of travel, 2024 and 2025

Six summer months, October to March, carry between 61% and 62% of overseas visitors' travel in the two years for which month of travel is recorded.

Year	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Oct to Mar
2024	9%	13%	12%	8%	7%	4%	6%	7%	7%	10%	10%	7%	61%
2025 (provisional)	11.5 %	9.9%	10.3 %	6.9%	6.8%	6.1%	6.7%	6.5%	7.0%	9.2%	11.3 %	12.7 %	62%

Source: 2024: Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p25 and p32 (Wesgro Visitor Tracking Survey 2024; shares sum to 100%). 2025: Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p12 (Stats SA and SAT 2025; the printed shares sum to 104.9%, and the October to March share is computed with the 2025 shares normalised to 100%).

Air and sea access

Ten airlines fly to Cape Town International from Africa, nine from Europe, three from North and South America, two from the Middle East and one, Singapore Airlines, from Asia.[103] None flies nonstop between Cape Town and Asia, so the gap is "the absence of any direct capacity to any of the Asian markets", India and China included.[104] Twenty-nine international routes serve the airport in 2026.[105]

Cape Town International itself is now the physical ceiling. One runway with no parallel taxiway caps movements at about 30 an hour, and ACSA's programme of about R11.3bn brings relief from about 2032 for the international terminal and about 2033 for the runway.[106] ACSA's latest schedule sets December 2026 to December 2029 for the realigned runway, subject to contract award.[107] The secondary gateways do not change the picture. George, above its design limit at 911,000 passengers in 2025, doubles by 2028 or 2029, with construction from October 2026.[108] Cape Winelands Airport targets 2028 with no named carrier.[109]

Cruise has grown without new berth capacity. The province hosted 70, 67 and 79 vessels in the 2022/23, 2023/24 and 2024/25 seasons, carrying 144,125, 109,884 and 127,178 passengers.[110] The Cape Town berth took 83 calls in 2024/25, with 127,000 passengers and R1.79bn of economic impact.[111] [StratEcon 2024/25 cruise report to confirm whether 79 vessels and 83 calls differ by definition.]

[99] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p25, p32.
[100] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Seasonality".
[101] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p34.
[102] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p32.
[103] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p35.
[104] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "The Capetown Market".
[105] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Executive Summary".
[106] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p101 to p103.
[107] ACSA, Q1 2026/27 presentation to the Portfolio Committee on Transport, as reported by Travel News, Aug 2026.
[108] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p104, p105; George Herald, Jul 2026.
[109] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p106, p107.
[110] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p37.
[111] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p110.

Port reliability, not berth space, is the risk. The berth has room for 150 or more calls a season, and its limits are a 300m ship length and the South-Easter wind.[112] The Port of Cape Town is "a binding constraint, with congestion and equipment failures affecting export and cruise reliability".[113]

Geography of the system

The Cape Metro generates 72.5% of provincial GDPR, a whole-economy share rather than a tourism one.[114] The Cape Winelands follows at 11.2%, the Garden Route at 7.6%, the West Coast at 4.8%, the Overberg at 3% and the Central Karoo at 0.5%.[115] Only the Garden Route share is dated, to 2023, while the Metro chart is titled 2024 and the rest carry no year.[116]

Tourism supply is concentrated in the same way. The province holds 50,332 mapped tourism assets across the six regions, of which the Metro holds 20,281, or 40.3%.[117] The Garden Route holds 9,875, the Cape Winelands 7,730, the Overberg 6,176, the West Coast 4,752 and the Central Karoo 1,518.[118]

Cape Town is the axle of the system, "the province's global shopfront and primary dispersal hub".[119] Any capacity failure in Cape Town "quickly becomes a provincial risk, not just a city problem".[120] International visitors land there and disperse from there, and readiness falls with each step away: accessibility scores drop from 4.7 in the Metro to 1.0 in the Central Karoo.[121]

Beyond the Metro the visitor drives. The N2 is "the only continuous inter-regional tourism corridor, creating a single point of failure", and large parts of the province outside the Metro and the Garden Route remain effectively car-only destinations.[122] The further from Cape Town, the faster the infrastructure falls away.[123]

Table 1.2. District economy, assets and access

> **The Cape Metro holds 72.5% of provincial GDPR and 40% of the province's tourism assets, and accessibility falls with each step away from it.**

District	Share of provincial GDPR	Tourism assets	Share of assets	Accessibility score (1 to 5)
Cape Metro	72.5%	20,281	40.3%	4.7
Cape Winelands	11.2%	7,730	15.4%	3.3
Garden Route	7.6%	9,875	19.6%	3.0
West Coast	4.8%	4,752	9.4%	1.7
Overberg	3%	6,176	12.3%	2.0
Central Karoo	0.5%	1,518	3.0%	1.0
Western Cape		50,332	100%	

Source: GDPR shares: Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p39, p42, p44, p46, p48, p50 (year not printed; Garden Route share is for 2023). Asset counts: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p2, p23, p34, p45, p56, p67, p78 (Winelands share computed: 7,730 of 50,332 is 15.4%). Accessibility: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p88 to p90, attractions and services basis; the Metro scores 5.0 on transport.

Rail, roads and utilities

Passenger rail has collapsed as a mode. Trainsets fell from about 110 in 1995 to about 91, pushing some 400,000 commuters onto saturated roads, and congestion in the Metro costs an estimated R2.8bn a

[112] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p110.
[113] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p34.
[114] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p39; Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p22.
[115] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p42 to p50.
[116] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p39, p42.
[117] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p2, p23.
[118] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p34, p45, p56, p67, p78.
[119] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p22.
[120] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p41.
[121] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p88 to p90.
[122] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p98, p99.
[123] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p90.

year.[124] Metrorail still runs 460km, five lines and 104 of 121 stations, with 22.7m passenger trips in FY2025, but no line reaches the airport and it is rated functionally unusable for tourism.[125]

Utilities cap the periphery before demand does. Water scarcity in high-growth nodes such as the Garden Route acts as a "hard ceiling" for visitor load, and load shedding raises costs and degrades the experience in peripheral districts.[126] The airport has no fuel pipeline and depends on road tankers,[127] and the 2017 to 2018 water crisis left a lasting perception of resource pressure.[128]

The remedies are named but not scheduled. Four transport enablers are listed, none dated or costed: the Cape Town Integrator, rail restoration and devolution, a high-speed city to airport link and George to Cape Winelands passenger rail.[129] PRASA's R21.1bn programme and the City's R123bn, 30-year devolution case cover fleet and lines, and neither carries a tourism product or an airport link.[130]

Institutions

Wesgro runs the demand side of this system through six units: Cape Town Air Access, Cruise Cape Town, the Convention Bureau, Destination Marketing, Research and Tourism.[131] Around them sit fifteen external organisations across three spheres of government and industry.[132]

The levers that bind the system sit with those partners. National government and its agencies, among them South African Tourism, ACSA and Transnet, hold visa rules, air service agreements, route rights and airport and port operations. The province holds jobs, inclusion and spatial outcomes, sector development, safety programmes and infrastructure planning. The City delivers services, manages precincts and readies events. Industry, from Cape Town Tourism, the V&A Waterfront and the flagship sites to the cruise lines and hotels, holds route viability, demand generation and product standards.[133]

Alignment across those tiers is thin. Stakeholders described strain at SA Tourism and a lack of fiscal space.[134] More than twenty bodies produce tourism data and "there is no single view of visitor behaviour, making strategy reactive rather than predictive".[135] Fifteen of the sixteen organisations interviewed raised industry and government collaboration, and the Department of Economic Development named restrictive bilateral air agreements and below-peer destination funding as high-impact constraints.[136]

None of these constraints is a shortage of visitors. The runway, the single corridor, a rail network visitors cannot use, the thin winter schedule and decision rights split across three tiers all sit outside a marketing budget. The system has recovered; its constraints are now physical and institutional.

1.3 From recovery to growth

At the airport the recovery is complete. Gateway capacity now caps growth in the summer peak, and demand and conversion cap it in the green season.

[124] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p38.
[125] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p100, p90.
[126] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p38.
[127] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p38.
[128] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p55.
[129] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p38.
[130] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p100.
[131] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p7.
[132] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p7; organisations as shown on the stakeholder map and grouped by this report.
[133] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p58.
[134] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p58.
[135] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p56, p57.
[136] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p20 to p46, p24, p25; the count is of organisations with at least one insight under the theme.

The limits of recovery logic

The action plan's task is to move the Western Cape from recovery to growth. At the airport the first half is done. International passenger arrivals at Cape Town International reached 1.44m in FY24/25 against 1.16m in FY19/20, and 1.57m in FY25/26.[137] On South African Tourism's provincial count the province still stood below 2019 in 2025 (section 1.1).

Recovery logic assumed capacity waiting to be refilled. Arrivals fell to 80,400 in FY20/21,[138] and the task was to refill idle seats, rooms and routes. That slack is gone. South Africa's international seat capacity is back at pre-pandemic levels, and Cape Town International shares with Lanseria the highest load factor of the country's five largest airports, 79% across all its seats in 2025.[139]

Cape Town did more than refill its seats. It added 17 mainline international routes between 2015 and 2025, more than any of eight peer airports, and the result is "a 'what next' moment".[140] The rebound that a recovery plan is built to capture has already happened.

Seats in summer, demand in winter

Growth is now supply-constrained in the summer peak and demand-constrained in the green season, when airlines withdraw seats. A survey of 34 outbound markets counts 97 million high-value, South Africa-interested travellers, of whom only 1.4 million convert into arrivals.[141] The conclusion is that "the challenge is not demand generation but improving conversion into actual visits".[142]

The binding supply is peak capacity at the gateway. The growth model draws current air access as a line at 1.8 million inbound seats, and the base case, in which Wesgro maintains current activity, reaches 1,802,929 arrivals at the 2030 plotted year.[143] The chart below sets the base case against that line.

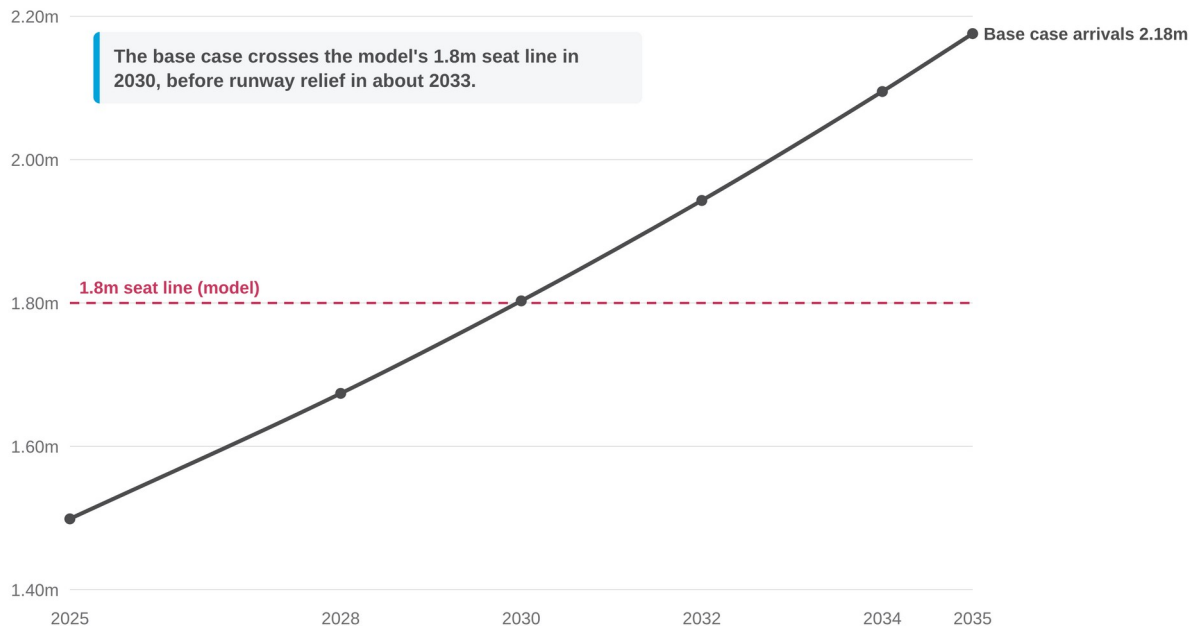


Figure 1.4. Base case against the seat line

Source: Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p20 (base case by year from a 2025 base of 1,498,829; the 2028 to 2035 points are identical in the Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p21). Seat line as drawn on the same slide. Airport relief from about 2032: Infrastructure Report, Jul

[137] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p11.
[138] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p11.
[139] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "The South African Market".
[140] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "International Comparisons"; "In Conclusion".
[141] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p41.
[142] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p41.
[143] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p20.

2026, p103. The model prints only these six year points and no seat table beneath the 1.8m line, so the crossing falls between 2028 (1,673,855) and 2030 (1,802,929). The conservative (1,822,634) and accelerated (2,516,282) cases are printed as 2035 end points only and are not plotted.

The line is the model's assumption, not a measured cap. At the international routes' 76.0% load factor, 1.8 million inbound seats would carry about 1.37 million arrivals, fewer than the 1.57 million ACSA recorded in FY25/26.[144] The route table counts 3,816,797 international seats for the year to November 2025, more than 1.8 million each way even if that total counts both directions.[145] What binds is the runway at peak hours in the summer peak, at about 30 movements an hour.[146] [Open item: ACSA or OAG to supply peak-hour and seasonal slot headroom at Cape Town International.]

The routes that exist are full. Eleven of the 27 international routes in the load-factor table ran above 80% in the year to November 2025. Together they averaged 76.0% on the printed total, below the airport's 79% across all seats.[147] Twenty-nine international routes serve the airport in 2026. Five of the eleven are mature long-haul routes, led by Newark at 88.6%, Atlanta at 84.3% and Frankfurt and London Heathrow at 83.0%.[148]

Full routes do not add seats of their own accord: "rather than increase capacity carriers will seek to increase revenues via higher selling fares rather than add new services".[149] Airlines also pull seats out of winter: June carries 6.4% of the year's international capacity and December 10.8%.[150]

Behind the routes sits the runway. "The airport, not a shortage of visitors is what now caps Cape Town's tourism growth".[151] The single runway caps movements at about 30 an hour until relief arrives in about 2033 (section 1.2).

The secondary gateways do not close the gap in time: "the certain fix is the latest, and the earliest big-capacity option is the least certain".[152] Route rights sit a tier up: air service agreements are a national function.[153] The Department of Economic Development rates restrictive bilateral agreements a high-impact constraint on airlift.[154]

Car-only regions and unbookable product

Beyond the Metro the constraint changes shape, not nature: accessibility falls from 4.7 in the Metro to 1.0 in the Central Karoo, and the visitor drives.[155]

Much of what the car can reach cannot be booked. Most rural properties have no OTA presence and Route 62 has the lowest online bookability of the six touring routes.[156] Even CapeNature takes about 70% of its reservations through a call centre rather than its online platform.[157]

Growth above the norm

Global tourism grows 3% to 5% a year under stable conditions, the band the benchmarking work calls organic growth.[158] In 2024 the world grew 11% as recovery ran on, and only Chile, at 40.4%, and

[144] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Seasonality"; Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p11, computed.
[145] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Seasonality".
[146] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p101.
[147] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Seasonality".
[148] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Seasonality".
[149] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "In Conclusion".
[150] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Seasonality".
[151] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p101.
[152] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p104 to p109.
[153] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p58.
[154] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p24.
[155] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p88 to p90, p99.
[156] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p95, p87.
[157] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p42.
[158] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p7.

Singapore, at 21%, grew far faster.[159] The longer record is the better test (section 2.1). Santiago's airport grew from about 16 million passengers in 2010 to more than 26 million in 2019, at least 5.5% a year.[160]

The Western Cape's two paths straddle the band. The base case implies 3.8% a year from 2025 to 2035 and the accelerated case 5.3%, and the accelerated case reverts to base "without confirmed routes".[161] Growth counts as structural only above that band, and only when it is "driven by deliberate changes to demand drivers, access conditions or product systems, rather than cyclical recovery or short-term promotion".[162]

Cape Town remains "the engine of the system, but growth cannot keep concentrating there".[163] The Department of Economic Development already reads the growth framing as overweight on volumes and asks for a value and spend lens in place of arrivals.[164] Growth now needs new markets, new seasons and new regions, and each of those is a supply problem before it is a marketing problem.

1.4 Approach and method

The study ran in four phases from November 2025, tested its hypothesis tree against the evidence of each workstream and took each figure from a ranked hierarchy of sources.

Four phases

The study ran in four phases: inception for one month, demand-side analysis for four and supply-side analysis for three.[165] Enablement and final reporting ran for seven months, from May to the end of November 2026.[166]

Each phase had a distinct job.[167] Inception aligned expectations and ways of working and produced the Current State Diagnostic as a literature-based baseline.[168] The demand phase covered source markets, India and China route to market, benchmarks and trends; the supply phase covered spatial readiness and community inclusion, and the two overlapped from February to April.[169]

The final phase built the M&E framework, consolidated the research into this report and prepared the launch.[170] Three mechanisms governed the work: fortnightly working sessions with Wesgro, Steering Committee sessions at milestones and fortnightly written status updates.[171]

The hypothesis tree

The analytical core is a hypothesis tree, in which each entry names a lever on growth and is framed so the evidence could test it. Three pillars carry the tree: Reshape demand, Transform supply and Build enabling capability. Each pillar holds two themes, and the six themes hold twenty focus areas [Summary of Findings, 14 Oct 2026, pp15 to 16: deck not in hand; page citation to confirm]. Nineteen of the twenty were tested against the evidence of a named workstream, and Appendix A1 traces each to the evidence behind it.

[159] UN Tourism, World Tourism Barometer, Jan 2025; Sernatur, Anuario de Turismo 2024, Dec 2025; Singapore Tourism Board, Feb 2025.
[160] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p24 to p26, computed.
[161] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19.
[162] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p8.
[163] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p114.
[164] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p24.
[165] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p11.
[166] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p11, p12.
[167] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p11.
[168] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p14.
[169] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p12, p18, p19.
[170] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p22, p23.
[171] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p27.

The tree disciplined the evidence. The stakeholder work coded each of its 223 insight statements to a pillar and a category of the tree before aggregating them.[172] Because the study team did the coding, the counts show where views cluster; they do not on their own confirm a focus area.

The workstreams divide the tree between them. The demand and aviation work tested five of the six demand focus areas and the case for routes and seats. The infrastructure work tested cruise, mobility, product, visitor experience and capital. The inclusion work tested community inclusion and, with the stakeholder and infrastructure work, bookability. The stakeholder engagement supplied most of the evidence on climate risk, the flagship nature sites and the governance theme. The twentieth focus area, workforce and service skills, has no workstream yet. The 300,000-jobs ambition has no labour analysis behind it.[173] Section 1.1 asks Wesgro and DEDAT to commission one in 2027.

Source hierarchy

Every figure in this report carries a source and page, and sources rank in five tiers. Where tiers disagree the higher tier wins; where two documents in one tier disagree, both values are recorded and the value used is stated with the reason. Nothing is reconciled by averaging.

1. Interim deliverables, cited by the date printed on the cover and by PDF page index, since none prints page numbers.
2. Working analyses: the Market Assessment Report of May 2026 and the three Skift memos on digital and search insights (December 2025), segmentation (March 2026) and African markets (March 2026), cited by section.
3. Wesgro and government data cited through a deliverable:[174] the Mero 2024 reports for all six districts, the Pero 2025 and the Growth for Jobs Strategy 2023. The same tier holds the Tourism Blueprint, Wesgro's five-year strategy and the StratEcon cruise liner economic contribution studies for 2023, 2024 and 2024/25.
4. Benchmark and reference reports, such as the UN Tourism barometer behind the global growth norm.[175]
5. External public sources, used only where no higher tier carries the figure and labelled as such.

Two conventions follow. The MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment and the Skift memos are Word files without page numbers, so they are cited by section title. Summary material ranks below the deliverables: where the two differ, the deliverable's figure is used and the difference is logged.

Interim deliverables

Nine dated documents carry the evidence. Appendix A9 dates each by its cover and gives the version in hand and the SLA clauses it answers. Chapter 2 draws them together as one body of analysis in four parts: the global benchmarks and their lessons (2.1), demand (2.2), supply (2.3) and the enabling environment (2.4). The Inception Report frames 1.1 and 1.4, and the Current State Diagnostic frames 1.2. The Market Assessment Report of May 2026 is the working analysis behind the Demand-Side Analysis and alone prints the 2025 base the growth case uses.[176]

Stakeholder engagement

Stakeholder engagement ran in four phases alongside the analysis.[177] Introduction and framing ran from January to March 2026, sense-making and validation in April and May, socialisation of draft

[172] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p5, p20 to p46.
[173] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p4.
[174] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p34.
[175] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p7.
[176] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19.
[177] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p4, p17.

recommendations in June and July and mobilisation from August into October. The Stakeholder Insights Report closed the first phase with insight tables for sixteen organisations, from Mossel Bay to the CTICC.[178] Sixteen is a count of those tables; the report prints no tally.

The method was strict about what an insight is. Sessions were run, insights extracted, each coded to a pillar and a category of the tree and then aggregated.[179] The 223 statements are the project team's paraphrases rated High, Medium or Low, not quotations, so this report attributes them to organisations and never to named individuals.[180]

Two gaps in the record matter: phase 1 engaged no airline, online travel agent or tour operator, and the six demand-side engagements were proposed for phase 2.[181] [Open item: test the gateway and governance chapters with ACSA, the Cape Town Air Access airline partners, the City of Cape Town and Cape Town Tourism before Steerco.] The demand work drew instead on discussions with more than 20 stakeholders of its own.[182] The outcomes of engagement phases 2 to 4 sit in no document in hand [Letsema to supply the phase 2 to 4 engagement record for Appendix A6].

Data limits

Five limits in the data shape how the findings read. The headline arrivals series counts international passenger arrivals at Cape Town International, not tourists, and Cape Town air arrivals stand proxy for the province in the market shares.[183] No approved methodology exists for provincial tourism GDP and jobs, and no deliverable prints a Western Cape tourism employment baseline.[184]

The supply dataset behind the Infrastructure Report (Supply_Infrastructure.xlsx) holds no geography below district, and its 17,195 records added after May 2026 are generated placeholders, as the study team found when it checked the file. [Open item: confirm whether the Infrastructure Report's count of 50,332 assets includes those records; if it does, restate Tables 1.2, 2.4 and A.18 and the district shares drawn from them.] The inclusion analysis runs on an OpenStreetMap asset layer, extracted on 16 September 2026, joined to Census 2011 sub-places, so its resident shares are fifteen years old.[185]

The growth model exists in two editions. The May Market Assessment runs from a 2025 base of 1,498,829 arrivals and the June Demand-Side Analysis from a 2024 base of 1,445,031.[186] Both reach 2,175,778 in the base case and 2,516,282 in the accelerated case by 2035. The report runs the growth case from the 2025 base, keeps FY24/25's 1.44m as the recovery baseline and states which is which wherever both appear.

Completion plan

A six-week completion plan agreed on 12 October 2026 governs the last stage of the work. [Summary of Findings, 14 Oct 2026: six-week plan from 12 October, with weekly outputs and owners, to be inserted; deck not in hand.] The report goes to Steerco, Exco and the Board before the public launch in February 2027.

[178] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p20 to p46.
[179] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p5.
[180] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p5, p20 to p46.
[181] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p16.
[182] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p7.
[183] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p25, p26, p29.
[184] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p37.
[185] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p14 to p17, p22.
[186] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19; Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p20.

1.5 How to read this report

The report is built so that a Board member can read the summary and any one focus area on its own, and a programme owner can run the plan from Chapters 3 to 5.

Chapter map

The report moves from context to evidence to recommendations to delivery.

The executive summary tells the case in short: where the province stands, what caps growth and what 2.5 million arrivals would take. It then sets out the three shifts and the twenty focus areas, the first 24 months, the headline indicators and the main risks. It stands alone, for the Board, Exco and the February 2027 launch audience. Chapter 1 is for every reader, and is the chapter of the body a Board member should read if they read no other. It sets out what Wesgro asked for, where the system stands after recovery, why the next step is constrained by peak capacity and how the study ran.

Chapter 2 sets out what the analysis found, in four parts: the global benchmarks and their lessons, demand, supply and the enabling environment. It serves readers checking the evidence behind a Chapter 3 entry, and each part closes with a box naming the focus areas it supports. Chapter 3 takes the twenty focus areas in turn. Each entry sets out the challenge or opportunity, the evidence, the course of action, why it can work and the link to the plan. The Board and Exco can read it entry by entry and the programme owner in full; section 3.4 gives the sequence.

Chapter 4 sets out which initiatives run, in what order, owned by whom, at what cost and with which decision gates, for the programme owner, Steerco and the partners named in the RACI. Chapter 5 sets out how progress is measured, through indicators, baselines, targets, data sources, the scorecard and the 2030 mid-term review, for Wesgro Research, the programme office and Steerco. Appendices A1 to A9 hold the traceability table, the demand model, the benchmark cases, readiness scores, the community fact base, stakeholder inputs, charters, the toolkit and references, for analysts and anyone checking a figure.

Citations and figures

Every figure carries its source and page in a footnote, in the form Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p21. The date is the cover date and the page is the PDF page index counted from the cover, because none of the decks prints page numbers. The MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment and the three Skift memos have no fixed pagination and are cited by section title.

Where a deliverable's file carries a later date than its cover, Appendix A9 shows both.

Where two inputs disagree the report states the value it uses, names the other with its page and gives the reason. The five-market share, printed as both 63% and 61% on one slide, is one case.[187] Nothing is averaged and nothing is reconciled silently.

Section 1.1 sets out how the report counts arrivals; the 2.5 million goal is the accelerated case rounded.

Marks and codes

Highlighted text in square brackets marks an open item: a figure no input in hand carries, with the figure needed and who holds it. Every page of this draft carries DRAFT FOR DISCUSSION in its header and the cover carries a draft line; both come off at sign-off.

Three codes tie the chapters together. A Chapter 3 kicker names the entry's theme, 1.1 to 3.2, above the focus area name as it reads on the tree [Summary of Findings, 14 Oct 2026, pp15 to 16: deck page

[187] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p13.

reference to be confirmed]; each entry closes with the initiative and indicator it links to. Initiatives in Chapter 4 run I1 onwards in one sequence; indicators in Chapter 5 run T1-01 onwards for impact, T2-01 for outcome and T3-01 for output.

Appendix A1 holds the evidence behind the tree. For each focus area it records the workstream and Chapter 2 sections behind it, rates the strength of the evidence and gives its initiative and indicator codes. Any Chapter 3 claim can be followed back to a page and forward to an owner and a measure. Nine focus areas rest on strong evidence and ten on adequate evidence. Two of the ten rest on indirect evidence: focus area 5 has no fare or yield data, and focus area 15 is an inference from the pipeline tables. Focus area 20 waits on a labour analysis still to be commissioned.

Chapter 2

Analysis and insights

Four parts build the case for the recommendations in Chapter 3. Section 2.1 draws lessons from comparator destinations; sections 2.2, 2.3 and 2.4 then examine demand, supply and the enabling environment, on which Pillars 1, 2 and 3 rest.

Demand is not what holds the province back. Its shape and the system that serves it do. Five markets and six months carry most overseas visits, and seats into Cape Town run out at the peak. Beyond the Metro, product is hard to reach and book, and in townships and rural settlements the missing piece is a local seller. The institutions that should hold the system together have thinned. Section 2.1 first shows how the fastest growers dealt with their own binding constraint.

Stakeholder evidence runs through sections 2.2 to 2.4. The first of four engagement phases ran from January to March 2026.[188] In it, 16 organisations from Mossel Bay to the CTICC gave 223 rated insights: 115 High, 102 Medium and 6 Low.[189] Each stakeholder statement in this chapter is the project team's paraphrase of a point an organisation made, attributed to that organisation and never to a person. [Open item: each organisation named here to approve its paraphrase before publication.] Each part ends with a box, "What this means for the focus areas", which links the part's evidence to each focus area it touches.

2.1 Global benchmarks and their lessons

The destinations that grew fastest ran institutions, marketing and air access as one system aimed at a single binding constraint. For the Western Cape that constraint is seats into one gateway; in its townships and rural settlements it is the lack of a local seller.

Benchmarks test the 2.5 million goal against proven growth

The action plan aims at 2.5 million international arrivals by 2035, 5.3% a year on the accelerated path and just above the world's norm (sections 1.1 and 1.3). Growth above trend is rare across whole regions; where it happens, it is specific to a destination.[190] Benchmarking asks which deliberate choices let comparable destinations outgrow the world, and which of them the Western Cape can adapt. It looks for how each destination removed what bound its growth, not for isolated good practice.[191]

The yardstick is the world's own growth. Growth of 3% to 5% a year is the norm under stable conditions; above 5% marks structural acceleration and 10% or more a structural shift.[192] UN Tourism puts global growth at 11% in 2024, while recovery was still running, and about 4% in 2025.[193] Growth counts as structural only when it is "driven by deliberate changes to demand drivers, access conditions or product systems, rather than cyclical recovery or short-term promotion".[194] Each case was read for its demand profile, two proven growth levers and how far they transfer to the Western Cape.[195]

Six comparators from a screen of 30

The screen scored 30 destinations across Africa, Europe, the Americas and Oceania against 12 criteria in four groups.[196] Market and access asks whether visitors arrive as the Western Cape's do, by long-haul air through hubs from the same markets. Destination and product structure asks whether a gateway city leads into several regions with a similar mix and price. Growth and inclusion compares growth stage,

[188] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p4, p17; the record of the three later phases is not yet in hand.
[189] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p20 to p46, counted.
[190] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p7.
[191] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p6.
[192] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p7.
[193] World Tourism Barometer, Jan 2025 and Jan 2026.
[194] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p8.
[195] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p13.
[196] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p29 to p31; Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p11, p12.

seasonality, community participation and climate pressure; performance compares volume, yield and infrastructure.[197] Appendix A3 lists all twelve.

Each destination received one average score across the twelve criteria, and the 30 were ranked on it.[198] Chile, Melbourne and Victoria, Valencia and Singapore came from the top of that ranking.[199] Partial likeness ruled out others in the upper half. Namibia lacks city, wine and cultural depth. Reykjavik and Iceland sell one nature product with extreme seasonality. The Eastern Cape and Garden Route have no long-haul hub or global brand role.[200] The screen chose on likeness to the Western Cape, not on growth, so a comparator can teach stability as well as speed.

Score alone did not settle the set, which also had to be balanced and grounded in Africa.[201] New Zealand, ranked seventh at 3.67, is remote, long-haul and entered through one gateway, as the Western Cape is, though its source markets and cruise trade differ.[202] Kenya, ranked eleventh at 3.50, gives the set its African case: a gateway city leading to coast, wildlife and culture, with long-haul reliance, regional dispersal and community-based tourism.[203] It is weaker on wine and agri-tourism and differs on price and governance, so it is read for access, dispersal and inclusion rather than product.[204]

The six cover the constraints the province faces. Chile and New Zealand show how a gateway wins long-haul seats and fills them; Singapore shows how hub traffic becomes visits, and Kenya how a gateway carries visitors beyond its best-known product. Melbourne shows how events spread demand across the year, and Valencia how quality is governed.

Table 2.1. The six comparators at a glance

Each comparator shares a core trait with the Western Cape and shows one way through a challenge the province also faces.

Comparator	Shares with the Western Cape	Challenge it addressed	Lead lever	Reported outcome
Chile	Long-haul city gateway to coast, wine and wilderness; Mediterranean seasons; dispersal beyond the capital	Long-haul access from distant markets	Gateway airport funded by concession; open skies; regions sold as one portfolio	Santiago traffic from about 16 million passengers (2010) to more than 26 million (2019); international seat capacity up about 40% to 50%, 2013 to 2019
Melbourne and Victoria	Gateway city leading into wine, food, wildlife and touring regions; long-haul dependence	Spreading demand beyond the summer peak	Year-round event portfolio and a knowledge-led conference brand	Hotel stock up 21%; monthly share of arrivals between 7% and 12%
Valencia	Coastal city of culture and food; comparable climate, product mix and price point	Fragmented governance and uneven quality	Destination-wide quality system under a permanent public-private body	3.5 million international visitors in 2024, 24.4% above 2019; spend up 21%
Singapore	Integrated air access, service quality, food culture and visitor segmentation	Turning transit into stays; moving up from low-value tourism	Stopover programme run by tourism board, airport and airline; hotel quality drive	16.5 million visitors and record receipts of about S$29 billion in 2024
Kenya	Gateway city linked to coast, wildlife and culture; long-haul reliance; community-based tourism	Gateway concentration and dispersal beyond safari	Conservation run as national economic infrastructure; Nairobi as regional hub	14.6% growth in 2024; about US$1,460 per international arrival

[197] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p30; Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p11.
[198] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p29, p31.
[199] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p31, p32; Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p12; ranks 1 to 6 and their scores are not printed.
[200] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p31.
[201] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p62.
[202] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p31; Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p51.
[203] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p12.
[204] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p31.

Comparator	Shares with the Western Cape	Challenge it addressed	Lead lever	Reported outcome
Auckland and New Zealand	Remote long-haul gateway that concentrates arrivals; coast, wine, nature and culture close together	The economics of long-haul air access	Marketing budgets tied to long-haul routes; premium regional circuits	More than 16,000 incremental bookings and about NZ$55 million return in 2023/24

Source: Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p12 (rationale), p15, p22, p30, p39, p46 and p51 (what each shares with the Western Cape), p15, p17, p18, p23 to p26, p30, p33, p34, p39 to p41, p46, p47, p54, p55 and p59 (challenges, levers and outcomes). Singapore: Singapore Tourism Board, Feb 2025. Kenya growth: Kenya Tourism data as reported, May 2025; revenue per international arrival: Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p15. Rationales shortened from the printed text.

Community cases and peer airports answer narrower questions

Five community cases ask what keeps tourism income in townships and rural settlements. Each matches one of four types among the province's 107 long-listed communities.[205] The types turn on two facts: whether a community lies within 45 minutes of a tourism node, and whether it holds an attraction. Vilakazi Street in Soweto and Santa Marta in Rio de Janeiro speak to communities near a node whose assets are underused. Kliptown speaks to communities near a node with no attraction of their own. Comuna 13 in Medellín, remote by access rather than distance, speaks to remote communities with assets, and Costa Rica's rural network to remote communities without them.[206]

Cape Town's route record was set against eight peer airports: Calgary, Christchurch, Edinburgh, Keflavik, Larnaca, Marrakech, Santiago and Valencia. Five are not their country's main airport, and most serve seasonal or fast-growing inbound leisure markets.[207] Santiago and Christchurch share Cape Town's remote geography, and Santiago targets tripling its passenger volumes in twenty years.[208]

Cape Town wins more mainline routes than its peers

Between 2015 and 2025 Cape Town added 17 mainline international services, more than any of the eight peer airports.[209] Santiago added 14 services, Valencia 12 and Calgary 8.[210] Yet winning routes is not the same as holding seats through the winter, and the routes won now run full (section 2.3). Low-cost carriers tell a different story: Edinburgh added 121 routes from 2015 to 2025, and low-cost carriers fly 81% of its routes.[211] At Cape Town, low-cost entry "would be a longer term opportunity".[212] The Western Cape does not need to learn how to win mainline routes. It needs what the leaders added: access funded as infrastructure and marketing tied to each route.

Fast growth in 2024 was partly recovery

Only Chile and Singapore grew far faster than the world in 2024: Chile by 40.4% and Singapore by 21%, against the world's 11%.[213] Neither rate proves structural growth. Singapore was still at 86% of its 2019 arrivals, and most of Chile's arrivals came overland, 40% of them from Argentina.[214] Kenya, Valencia and New Zealand grew only slightly faster than the world, and Melbourne's 4.3% is an Australia-wide forecast rather than an actual.[215] The lessons that follow come from what the leaders built over a decade, not from one year's rate.

[205] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p4, p14, p15.
[206] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p15.
[207] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "International Comparisons", counted.
[208] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "International Comparisons".
[209] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "International Comparisons".
[210] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Executive Summary", "International Comparisons"; other study documents count new routes from 2014 on a different basis.
[211] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Executive Summary", "International Comparisons".
[212] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "International Comparisons".
[213] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p9; Sernatur, Dec 2025; Singapore Tourism Board, Feb 2025.
[214] Sernatur, Dec 2025; Singapore Tourism Board, Feb 2025.
[215] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p9, p17, p53; the 12% shown for New Zealand matches its 2025 holiday-arrivals growth, with total arrivals up 5.9%.

Table 2.2. Comparator growth and recovery

Against global growth of 11% in 2024, only Chile and Singapore grew far faster, and three of the six were still below 2019.

Destination	Growth 2023 to 2024	Against 2019	Primary lever	System type
Chile	40.4%	116% of 2019; 55.6% of arrivals overland, 40% from Argentina	Gateway-led air concentration	Connectivity-led
Singapore	21%	86% of 2019; receipts at a record	Aviation hub and stopover conversion	Orchestrated experience
Kenya	14.6%	About 102% recovered	Conservation-led wildlife product	Product-led
Valencia	13% to 14%	124% recovered	Institutionalised quality governance	Governance-led
New Zealand	About 12% (matches 2025 holiday arrivals; total 5.9% in 2025)	90% recovered, higher yield	Demand-led route development	Value-led
Melbourne and Victoria	4.3% (Australia, forecast)	Near full recovery	Event-led demand	Events-led

Source: Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p9 (growth, recovery and levers), p53 (New Zealand arrivals), p17 (Australian forecast) and p61 (system type). Chile: Sernatur, Anuario de Turismo 2024 (Dec 2025). Singapore: Singapore Tourism Board (Feb 2025). Kenya growth: Kenya Tourism data as reported, May 2025.

The Western Cape should apply the same test to its own record: growth counts when deliberate change drives it, not when recovery returns lost visitors.[216]

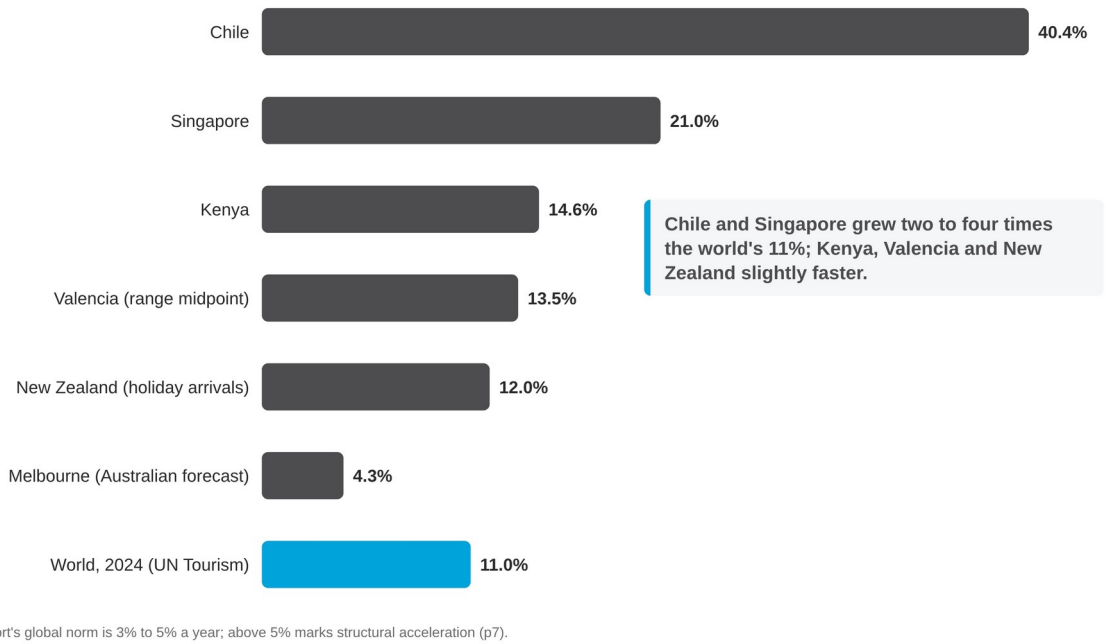


Figure 2.1. Comparator growth, 2023 to 2024

Source: Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p9 (comparators); Sernatur, Dec 2025 (Chile); Singapore Tourism Board, Feb 2025 (Singapore); Kenya Tourism data as reported, May 2025 (Kenya); UN Tourism, World Tourism Barometer, Jan 2025 (world, 2024). Where the report prints a range, the bar shows its midpoint: Valencia 13% to 14%.

[216] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p8.

What each comparator faced and what it did

Chile built access first

Chile was chosen as a long-haul city gateway to coast, wine and wilderness, with Mediterranean seasons like the Western Cape's.[217] South America supplies 55% to 60% of its arrivals.[218] Yet long-haul access was its binding constraint, and Chile treated it as infrastructure.[219] Santiago's airport traffic rose from about 16 million passengers in 2010 to more than 26 million in 2019.[220] A private concession won in 2015 funded about US$900 million of expansion, under one of the world's most liberal aviation systems built on open-skies agreements.[221] Direct routes now link Santiago with Europe and Australia, and a domestic network carries visitors on to Patagonia and the wine valleys.[222] The lesson is blunt: "Tourism demand follows air access".[223]

New Zealand tied marketing to routes

New Zealand holds coast, wine, nature and culture within short travel distances, as the Western Cape does.[224] Air access economics bind its growth.[225] It "shifted from awareness-driven marketing to route accountable demand generation", tying budgets to specific long-haul corridors and designing campaigns around airline breakeven and shoulder-season loads.[226] The programme reports more than 16,000 incremental bookings and a return of about NZ$55 million in 2023/24. Government-backed early-stage route incentives and data shared between tourism bodies and airlines support it.[227] In the regions it curates premium multi-day circuits and limits capacity to protect price.[228]

Singapore turned a hub into a destination

Singapore was chosen for joining air access, service quality, food culture and visitor segmentation in one approach.[229] Its question was how to turn transit through Changi into stays. Its answer is a stopover programme, with the tourism board, Changi Airport Group and Singapore Airlines working "under a coordinated strategy".[230] It received 16.5 million international visitors in 2024 and record tourism receipts of about S$29 billion.[231] A hotel transformation map and fund lifted quality alongside, moving Singapore "from lower-value stopover visits toward longer stays and higher-value tourism spending".[232]

Kenya made wildlife a governed system

Kenya is the African case, chosen for its long-haul reliance, regional dispersal and community-based tourism.[233] African markets supply 41% of its arrivals, while long-haul visitors spend more per head.[234] Kenya "institutionalised conservation as national economic infrastructure", joining wildlife protection, tourism and community participation in one governed system.[235] It positioned Nairobi as East Africa's aviation, diplomatic and business hub, and its main airport now carries 68% of arrivals.[236] Despite

[217] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p12, p22.
[218] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p24.
[219] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p59.
[220] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p24, p25; the source prints about 90% to 95% of 5.2 million international arrivals through Santiago, which can hold only for air arrivals, since land borders carried 55.6% in 2024.
[221] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p23, p26.
[222] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p25, p26.
[223] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p25.
[224] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p51.
[225] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p51.
[226] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p54.
[227] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p54.
[228] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p55.
[229] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p12.
[230] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p40.
[231] Singapore Tourism Board, Feb 2025.
[232] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p41.
[233] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p12.
[234] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p32.
[235] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p33.
[236] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p32, p34.

meaningful reforms, fragmented investment and regulatory hurdles remain ongoing challenges.[237] Kenya earned about US$1,460 per international arrival in 2024, against about US$890 for the Western Cape.[238]

Melbourne and Victoria fill the year with events

Melbourne plays the part for Victoria that Cape Town plays for the province: main point of entry, brand anchor and engine of demand.[239] Summer still brings the largest spike in international demand, so Victoria curates a portfolio of events that "generate repeat, predictable demand spikes across the year".[240] Behind the calendar, hotel stock grew 21%, about 5,000 rooms.[241] Melbourne "uses its event calendar to de-risk and stimulate aviation demand".[242] Its quietest months still hold 7% of arrivals and its busiest 12%, against 6.1% and 12.7% for the Western Cape on the provisional 2025 shares.[243] The gap is modest, so the lesson is less a flatter curve than an events calendar airlines can plan seats around. Its case rests on stability and yield rather than speed.

Valencia governed quality across the destination

Valencia, a coastal city of culture and food, matches the province on climate, product mix and price.[244] It faced a familiar problem: fragmented governance and uneven quality across regions, operators and seasons.[245] It adopted a destination-wide quality system across its tourism businesses.[246] Coordination sits in "a permanent public-private structure led by Visit València", which joins municipal, provincial and regional authorities in one decision-making system.[247] It received 3.5 million international visitors in 2024, 13.9% more than in 2023 and 24.4% above 2019. Spend rose faster still, by 21%.[248]

The leaders treat air access as infrastructure

The Western Cape faces both halves of the access problem Chile and New Zealand attacked: too few seats at the peak and thin demand off it. On the growth model, the base case passes a line of 1.8 million inbound seats by 2030.[249] That line is the model's assumption; in practice the runway binds at peak hours (section 2.3). Off-peak, June carries only 6.4% of the year's international capacity.[250]

The two cases point to three changes. Air access should be treated as "core economic infrastructure, not a tourism add-on", with "a permanent, well-funded Public-Private Air Access Fund".[251] The province should "actively lobby for air service liberalisation and simplified visa regimes".[252] Marketing budgets should be ring-fenced around priority long-haul corridors, with an aviation partnership framework and early-stage route support.[253]

Transit and events can be turned into demand

Singapore shows how a hub becomes a destination: its tourism board, airport and airline run one stopover programme under a coordinated strategy.[254] Cape Town's seven largest international routes all connect to global hubs, so the same partnership with the hub carriers is open to it.[255] Government, aviation, events

[237] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p31.
[238] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p15.
[239] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p15.
[240] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p17, p18.
[241] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p18.
[242] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p59.
[243] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p17; Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p12.
[244] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p12.
[245] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p46.
[246] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p47.
[247] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p47.
[248] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p46.
[249] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p20.
[250] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Seasonality".
[251] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p28.
[252] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p28.
[253] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p56.
[254] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p40.
[255] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Executive Summary", "The Capetown Market".

and industry should work to shared KPIs, linking air access, major events and joint marketing.[256] City, provincial and national actors should align around one gateway strategy, with MICE treated as a system lever.[257]

Events do the same work across the calendar, and the Western Cape has the green-season gap they address (section 2.2). The province needs one event acquisition and calendar strategy across Wesgro, the Convention Bureau, the City and the Province, with conference bidding aligned to sector strengths.[258]

Quality and value are governed, not encouraged

The leaders manage quality as a deliberate outcome. Valencia and Singapore set standards through standing bodies rather than leaving them to operators.[259] The results reported for Singapore include longer stays and higher spend per visitor; those for Valencia include more consistent service, a stronger reputation and more repeat visits.[260]

The cases ask the Western Cape first for a province-wide quality and standards framework led by Wesgro.[261] Within it would sit a provincial quality charter phased by district, with certification "visible across booking platforms", alongside standing sector councils for wine, MICE, adventure and culture.[262] The cases also ask the province to measure its regions by yield rather than arrivals and to build conservation and community inclusion into the offer.[263]

In communities, lasting sellers matter more than capital

In communities the binding constraint is the seller. The five cases show that local sellers outlast the programmes that launch them.[264] In Santa Marta in Rio de Janeiro, about 20 resident guides ran the tours by 2015 and outside jeep firms had left. The guides kept selling after the launch programme ended, while assets and training without a route to market did not last.[265] Access and safety were preconditions, not product.

Scale brings its own limits. Medellín's Comuna 13 drew 1.98 million visitors in 2025, 52% of them international, with about 300 professional guides. Mobility built for residents became the stage, but carrying-capacity limits came late.[266] On Vilakazi Street in Soweto, ten restaurants employ more than 800 people. Public space upgrades amplify existing assets, but benefits concentrate on street-front owners.[267]

Neither capital nor donor money lasts without a seller that can stand alone. Costa Rica's community network turned over more than USD 800,000 in 2013 and dissolved at the end of 2018; it did not survive donor exit, though the record names no single cause.[268] Kliptown in Soweto received a first allocation of R436 million and was projected to draw almost 200,000 international visitors a year. By 2017 its museum drew about 4,000 visitors a year, because capital built before an operator yields no operating income.[269]

The cases converge on one order: "a seller with a stake, a safe and workable visit, product that keeps spend in the community, then exposure".[270] In the Western Cape's communities, the seller therefore comes before the asset (section 2.4). In Doringbaai and Elands Bay, a local entity comes before more

[256] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p42.
[257] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p35.
[258] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p20.
[259] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p41, p47.
[260] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p41, p47.
[261] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p42.
[262] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p49.
[263] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p35, p55, p56.
[264] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p7 to p11.
[265] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p7, p30.
[266] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p8.
[267] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p9.
[268] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p10.
[269] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p11.
[270] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p12.

product, with its own selling channel and a succession plan that does not rest on a donor.[271] Assets follow proven demand.[272]

The system matters more than any lever

No single lever explains the leaders' growth. Sustained tourism growth "is not created by fragmented interventions, but by a coordinated destination system in which governance, demand generation and access reinforce one another".[273] Chile's coordination works best "when anchored around a single strategic constraint".[274] The Western Cape's constraint has the same shape as Chile's long-haul access: seats into one gateway airport (section 2.3).

Yet coordination is hard everywhere. Victoria reports tension between national and state bodies over roles and branding.[275] Valencia struggles to join its data across institutions.[276] The Western Cape's three tiers of government show the same strain (section 2.4). The province should anchor its plan on one constraint, as Chile did: peak seats into Cape Town first, one system built around them and, in the communities, a seller before any asset.

What the comparison cannot show

The cases show what worked elsewhere; they cannot prove it will work here. Singapore's tourism board answers to one ministry, in a system strongly directed by the state yet closely tied to the private sector.[277] The Western Cape works across three tiers, and air rights and visas sit with national government (section 2.4). New Zealand's governance differs too, and transfer means adapting governance, data and capability to local realities.[278]

The evidence also has gaps. No score by criterion is printed, and among the six only New Zealand (3.67) and Kenya (3.50) have a printed score.[279] The margins behind the choice cannot be checked. No case of failure was studied.[280] [Open item: add one comparator that underperformed, as the Inception Report's plan asked (Inception Report, Nov 2025, p16).] Several comparator charts are unlabelled, so only printed figures are quoted here, and Valencia's figures name no primary source.[281] The recommended air access fund carries no amount.[282] None of the cases holds Western Cape data, so the province's side of each comparison comes from sections 2.2 to 2.4. The six cases point the same way; the precise rates are indicative.

[271] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p10.
[272] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p31.
[273] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p58.
[274] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p59.
[275] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p16.
[276] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p45.
[277] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p38.
[278] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p51.
[279] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p31; Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p12.
[280] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p16; the plan asked for four success cases and two that underperformed.
[281] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p24, p39, p46, p53.
[282] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p28.

What this means for the focus areas

FA02, Create green-season demand with MICE and events. Melbourne's events-led system and unified calendar.

FA04, Convert India and China hub traffic, and FA06, Build a regional foundation (Africa). Singapore's joint strategy with its airport and airline; Kenya's hub strategy and African base.

FA05, Increase yield in mature markets, FA12, Balance impact on nature-based attractions, and FA14, Manage climate risk and sustainable tourism. Yield-based metrics, capacity discipline and conservation-led product.

FA07, Win direct routes and add seats on full routes, and FA15, Crowd in capital with targeted investment strategies. Chile's airport concession and air access fund; New Zealand's route-tied marketing.

FA10, Support diversified route and product development. Chile's regional portfolio; New Zealand's premium circuits.

FA11, Align visitor experience in-destination, and FA03, Make the whole province findable and bookable. Valencia's governed quality and certification visible on booking platforms.

FA13, Embed local destination bodies for community inclusion. Resident sellers outlasted the programmes that launched them, and capital built before an operator, as in Kliptown, earned no operating income.

FA16, Align institutional stakeholders across all three tiers, FA17, Strengthen industry and government collaboration, and FA18, Expedite tourism-enabling policy and data sharing. One coordinated system of governance, marketing and access, with shared data between tourism bodies and airlines.

FA19, Lead removal of infrastructure, visa and safety deficits. Chile's open skies; safety before product in the community cases.

FA20, Develop workforce and service skills. Singapore's hotel quality drive; the province's own labour analysis is still to be commissioned.

2.2 Demand-side factors

Interest in the Western Cape is broad and growing. Yet demand is concentrated in five markets and six months. The growth markets fly in through Gulf and African hubs and book on platforms where Western Cape product is hard to find.

A 2025 values-based survey reached more than 25,000 travellers in 34 outbound markets, 17 of them Wesgro priority markets, with 800 to 1,600 in each.[283] More than 20 discussions with market-facing stakeholders added judgement to desk review of Wesgro reports, Statistics South Africa and Google search data.[284]

Five markets carry the province and pay among the most

The UK, Germany, the USA, the Netherlands and France supplied 63% of overseas arrivals in 2025, and the first three alone 52%.[285] The pattern is not new: the top five held 61% of Cape Town overseas air arrivals from January to August 2024.[286]

[283] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p40.
[284] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p7.
[285] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p13; the slide prints 61% in its text, and 63% is the sum of its printed shares.
[286] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p29.

The same markets pay among the most. Average spend per visitor in 2024 ran from R32,900 for the USA and R26,500 for the UK down to R8,600 for Namibia and R8,500 for Zimbabwe.[287] Only Nigerians and Ghanaians spend as much, from a far smaller base (below). High-spend visitors come from Europe and North America, "tying future value growth to slower-growing source markets".[288] The Western Cape must therefore hold yield in its mature markets while volume growth comes from elsewhere.

Six months carry three fifths of demand

Demand peaks in the southern summer and thins in winter. December, January and November took 12.7%, 11.5% and 11.3% of overseas visitors in 2025, while June fell to 6.1%.[289] October to March hold about 62% of the year.[290] The 2024 Wesgro Visitor Tracking Survey gives a similar split of 61% and 39%.[291]

Growth therefore depends on "improving conversion in Apr-Sep rather than pushing incremental demand into already busy peak months".[292] Airlines cut seats in those same months, so filling the April to September green season needs seats as well as conversion (section 2.3).

Removing barriers, not demand, sets the upside

The scenarios differ by intervention, not by demand: "the difference between scenarios is not demand potential, but the extent to which structural barriers are removed".[293] The growth model builds each market's rate from four levers: outbound growth, the Western Cape's penetration, the airlift ceiling and structural conditions such as currency and visas.[294] It anchors on OAG aviation data for access and traveller data for demand.[295]

From the 2025 base, the base case reaches 2,175,778 arrivals by 2035, implied growth of 3.8% a year. The conservative case reaches 1,822,634, at 2.0%, and the accelerated case 2,516,282, at 5.3%.[296] The base case's 3.8% sits within the 3% to 5% norm, and only the accelerated case clears the 5% mark of structural acceleration (section 2.1).

[287] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p14.
[288] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p14.
[289] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p12.
[290] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p12, computed; the twelve printed monthly shares sum to 104.9% and are normalised here.
[291] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p32.
[292] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p25.
[293] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p19.
[294] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p18.
[295] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p8; the traveller data are Skift's.
[296] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19; Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p20; the second source prints the same 2035 points from a 2024 base.

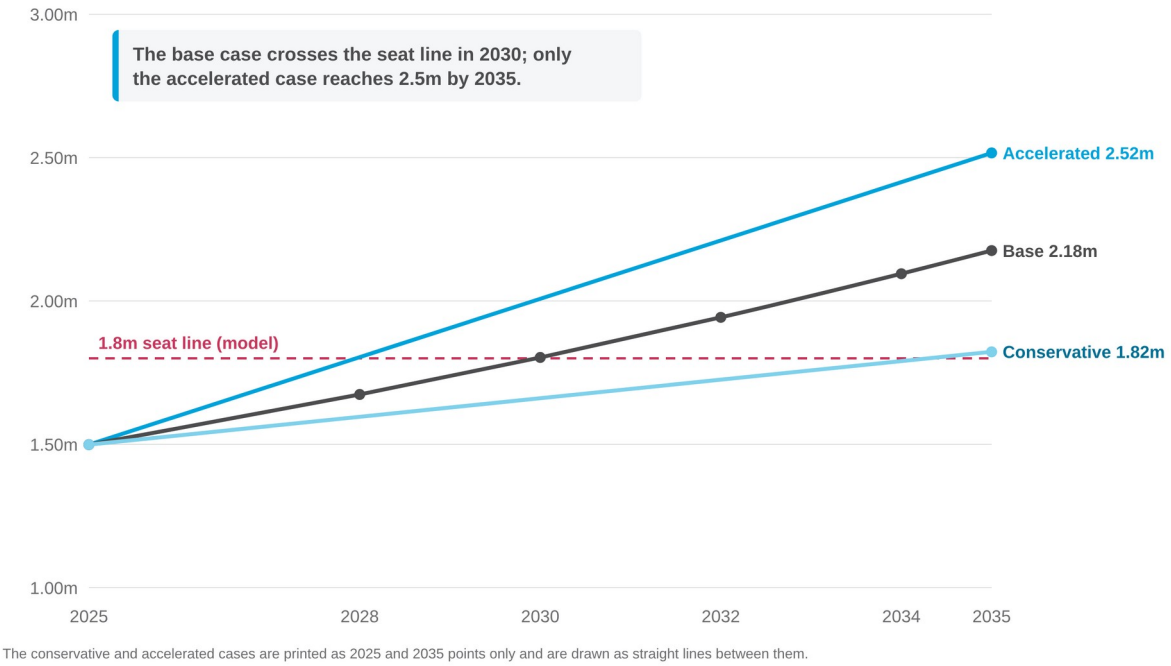


Figure 2.2. Growth scenarios to 2035

Source: Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19 (scenario end points) and p20 (base-case year points and the seat line as drawn). OAG Aviation Analytics.

The step from 2,175,778 to 2,516,282 rests on confirmed direct routes to India and China, above-baseline activation and more hub capacity into Cape Town.[297] The dependency is hard: "without confirmed routes, volume reverts to base".[298] Those routes are not close. A direct Indian service is unlikely before 2030, and China is a longer prize still.[299] Until they come, the hub carriers carry the growth markets. Even the base case passes the model's seat line at the 2030 year point (section 2.3).

Hub markets add most arrivals, and India and China grow fastest

In the base case the hub markets add the most arrivals and the acceleration markets grow fastest. The hub markets are the UAE, Ethiopia, Qatar and Turkey. The acceleration markets are the Gulf, China, India and Brazil ([Open item: Skift to confirm which Gulf markets the acceleration group holds, since the UAE and Qatar sit in the hub group.]).[300] Between 2025 and 2035 hub markets add 206,584 arrivals, mature markets 178,780, acceleration markets 175,818, regional markets 110,298 and Japan and South Korea 5,469.[301]

[297] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p18; rounded, the two points are 2.18m and 2.52m.
[298] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19.
[299] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p48; MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "The Chinese Market Opportunity".
[300] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p20.
[301] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p20, computed.

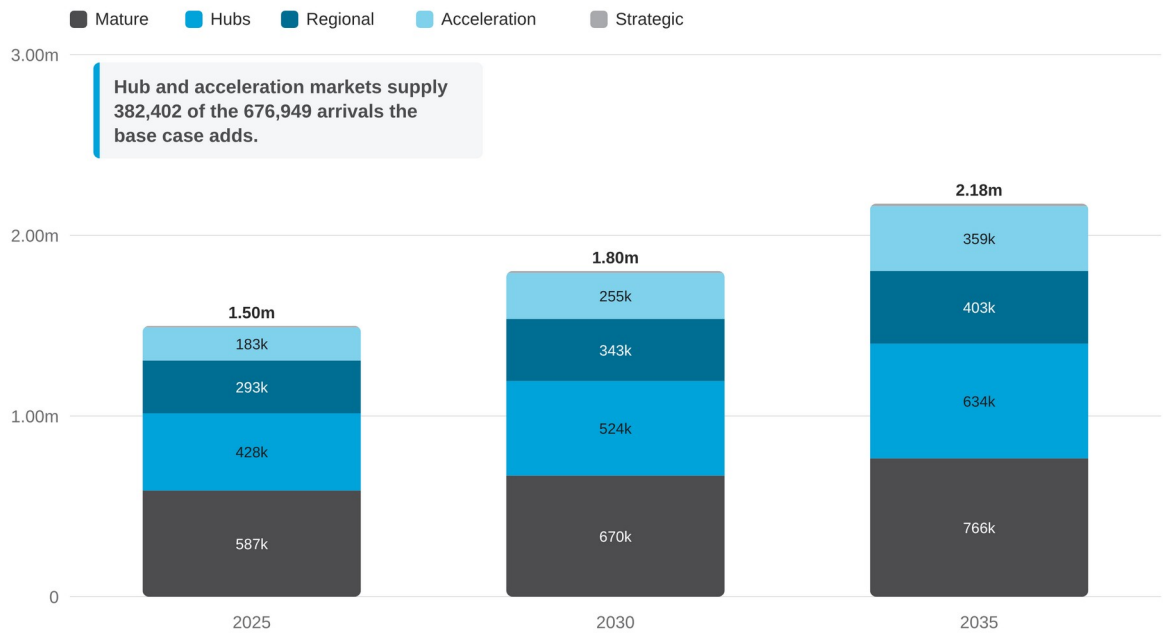


Figure 2.3. Base-case growth by market group

Source: Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p20. Groups as printed: Mature (UK, Germany, USA, Netherlands, France, Switzerland); Hubs (UAE, Ethiopia, Qatar, Turkey); Regional (Namibia, Zimbabwe, Zambia, Botswana, Kenya and others); Acceleration (Gulf, China, India, Brazil); Strategic (Japan, South Korea).

India more than doubles from 76,547 to 165,260 arrivals and China with Hong Kong from 43,412 to 92,598, both at 8% a year.[302] Spend follows the mix. The model fixes average spend for each group, from R24,500 a visitor in mature markets to R8,500 in regional ones. On that basis base-case foreign spend rises from a modelled R27.12bn in 2024 to R40.59bn in 2035.[303] Volume and value come from different markets.

The right segments can spread demand

Four values-based segments fit the Western Cape, together about 97 million addressable travellers.[304] Each has priority markets: Curious Explorers in the UK and the USA, and Creative Connectors in India. Discerning Connoisseurs are paired with China and the UAE, and Reflective Adventurers with Germany.[305]

Table 2.3. Four traveller segments

Four segments hold about 97 million addressable travellers, and each is most concentrated in a named set of markets.

Segment	Addressable travellers	What drives them	Priority markets	Long-haul trip spend
Curious Explorers	30m (31%)	Cultural immersion, learning and authentic connection	UK, USA	$4,800 to $6,200
Creative Connectors	25m (26%)	Design, food and urban creativity	India	$4,200 to $5,400
Discerning Connoisseurs	19m (20%)	Exclusivity, refinement and access	China, UAE	$8,500 to $14,000
Reflective Adventurers	23m (23%)	Renewal and connection with nature	Germany	$4,600 to $5,900

[302] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p22.
[303] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p10, p24; the modelled 2024 figure sits 19% above the R22.7bn SA Tourism reported for FY2024, and section 5.3 records the open item to rebase on the FY2025 actual.
[304] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p41 to p43.
[305] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p43.

Source: Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p42, p43, p45, p48, p51, p54. Priority pairs are the cells highlighted on p43. Trip spend is average long-haul trip spend as printed; the currency is not named on the slides.

Curious Explorers and Discerning Connoisseurs are "most aligned to the Western Cape's offering".[306] The segments also matter for spread, not only for volume. Curious Explorers offer the "strongest opportunity for geographic dispersal beyond Cape Town"; Reflective Adventurers have "strong potential to support seasonality mitigation" through year-round outdoor and wellness travel.[307] These two are the segments to target for the regions and the green season.

India and China already arrive through hubs

The growth markets are already in the air, on other carriers. About 71,000 Indian travellers and about 30,000 Chinese reach Cape Town each year through connecting hubs, together about 101,000 journeys.[308] Addis Ababa and Dubai carry 81% of the Indian travellers, and half of them start in Mumbai.[309] Direct Indian service is "unlikely before 2030 due to aircraft constraints at Air India and IndiGo".[310] For China, a China Southern service from Guangzhou is the likeliest first direct route.[311]

Australia (61,000 indirect travellers) and Saudi Arabia (137,000 passengers, with Riyadh Air's planned hub) come next.[312] The Western Cape should grow this hub traffic now. Singapore shows the method: its tourism board, airport and airline work to one strategy (section 2.1). Here the partners are the hub carriers: Emirates, Ethiopian, Qatar Airways and Turkish Airlines. Wesgro should build early relationships with the Indian carriers and Indian government authorities.[313] It should treat China as a long-term investment in awareness and indirect volume before any non-stop service.[314]

Each market books on its own platforms

Conversion happens on platforms that differ by market. Chinese travellers discover on Douyin and Xiaohongshu and book on Trip.com, Qunar and Fliggy. Indian travellers book through MakeMyTrip, Booking.com and Expedia, and much Gulf travel still runs through private advisors and concierge agencies.[315]

Each market also has its own gap. Cape Town has no direct flight to Mumbai or Delhi and thin Indian-friendly adaptation, while Gulf travellers find no Arabic-language booking or local-currency pricing.[316] Visas add a further barrier, and they sit with national government (section 2.4).

The province's own channels also lag. The Department of Economic Development rates destination platforms behind international practice in online presence and AI adoption. The Overberg says its proximity to Cape Town is not packaged before travellers book flights.[317] The money should therefore follow the platforms: activate inside them and shift investment "toward trade-led conversion rather than broad awareness campaigns".[318]

[306] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p4.
[307] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p56.
[308] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p46, p48, computed.
[309] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "The Indian Market Opportunity"; Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p48; the second source puts the two hubs at more than 80%.
[310] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p48; MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Executive Summary".
[311] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "The Chinese Market Opportunity"; the aviation assessment counts about 29,600 travellers from China.
[312] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "The Australian Market Opportunity", "The Saudi Arabian Market Opportunity".
[313] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "The Indian Market Opportunity".
[314] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "The Chinese Market Opportunity".
[315] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p45, p47, p49; Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p34, p35.
[316] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p51.
[317] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p24, p26.
[318] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p55.

Africa is a base and a growth market

Closer to home, Africa already supplies a large and steady base. The province recorded 323,971 tourist arrivals from 16 reported African markets in 2024, 62% of them from Zimbabwe and Namibia.[319] African visitors spent R4.2bn in the province in 2025, and among them Nigerians and Ghanaians spent most per visit, at R31,000 and R27,700.[320] Namibia and Zimbabwe "add stability, repeat demand and counter-seasonal volume".[321]

Nigeria, Kenya and Ghana are the priority growth markets, though the sources rank Ghana differently.[322] Nigeria's addressable market is modelled at 310,000 to 510,000 adult trips a year and Kenya's at 240,000 to 400,000.[323] Africa is therefore both a regional foundation to keep and a source of high-spending visitors to grow.

Business events can fill the trough if bids aim at it

Business events run on a different calendar from leisure travel. International association meetings in Cape Town rose from 33 in 2022 to 58 in 2024. Of the 136 held over the three years, 109 fell between May and November, but 74 fell in September to November alone.[324] Most meetings therefore land at the edge of the trough, not in it. Cape Town ranked 35th in the 2024 ICCA ranking and hosted 37 of South Africa's 64 UIA-recorded meetings in 2025.[325] Hotel occupancy in Cape Town was 53% in June 2023, the gap such events could fill.[326]

Yet MICE is not one business. Meetings, incentives, conventions and exhibitions have different buyers and lead times. Only conferences are measured well, and meetings are "absent from consolidated provincial statistics".[327] Stellenbosch and George are credible secondary hubs that can take delegates' extra nights while major events stay in Cape Town.[328] The lever needs one events calendar, as Melbourne has (section 2.1), bids aimed at May to August and measures for each of its four businesses.

Pillar 1 must fill the green season, win growth markets on the routes and platforms they already use, hold yield in mature markets and build the African base. Seats, regional product and the enabling environment (sections 2.3 and 2.4) decide whether that demand lands.

[319] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p27.
[320] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p29.
[321] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p14.
[322] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p30; Skift African Market Analysis memo, Mar 2026, section 2; the memo places Ghana among fourth-tier watch markets for brand seeding rather than conversion.
[323] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p28, p30.
[324] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p37, computed.
[325] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p36, p38.
[326] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p34.
[327] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p35, p36.
[328] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p41.

What this means for the focus areas

FA01, Respond to growth segment traveller preferences. Four segments, each with named priority markets.

FA02, Create green-season demand with MICE and events. Most international association meetings fall from May to November, but 74 of 136 fell in September to November. Bids must aim at the May to August trough. The seat side of the case sits in section 2.3.

FA03, Make the whole province findable and bookable. Conversion runs through market-specific platforms that Western Cape product must reach.

FA04, Convert India and China hub traffic. About 101,000 hub journeys a year and a direct Indian route unlikely before 2030.

FA05, Increase yield in mature markets. The highest-spending visitors come from the slowest-growing markets.

FA06, Build a regional foundation (Africa). A large regional base and two high-yield growth markets.

2.3 Supply-side factors

Supply sets the ceiling on growth. The gateway's busiest direct routes run full, the new runway is years away and airlines are expected to raise fares before they add seats. Beyond the Metro the product exists but is hard to reach, book or stay in.

Stakeholders rate supply constraints the most severe: 44 of the 68 insights on supply are rated High, against 23 of 64 on demand.[329] Two bodies of evidence test that view. Scheduled seats and estimated bookings cover every Cape Town route, with bookings from the airlines' global distribution systems to November 2025.[330] On the ground, 50,332 tourism assets are mapped across six regions in three layers: attractions, services and enabling infrastructure. The map draws on Wesgro's supply database, SANParks and CapeNature data and open geographic sources. Its premise is that "destination performance is constrained by the weakest layer".[331] [Dataset limits, including the absence of geography below district level, to be confirmed against the supply dataset notes.] Each region is scored from 1 to 5 on attractiveness (40%), readiness and capacity (30%) and accessibility (30%).[332]

The model hits its seat line by 2030

On the growth model, seats run out before demand does. The model draws current air access as "a hard ceiling at 1.8 million inbound seats". The base case passes that line by 2030, at 1,802,929 arrivals, up from 1,673,855 in 2028.[333] The line is the model's assumption, not a measured cap; what binds in practice is the runway at peak hours (section 1.3). On the model's own judgement, even 2.1 million arrivals by 2035, below the base case (section 2.2), needs deliberate intervention to add capacity.[334] Growth to 2.5 million is therefore a supply programme before it is a marketing one.

[329] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p20 to p46, counted; insights filed under Transform Supply and Reshape Demand.
[330] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "The South African Market", "Seasonality"; bookings are weighted to the full market, so they "will not always reconcile exactly with airport published data".
[331] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p2, p4, p9, p10.
[332] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p17, p18; the scores "are evidence informed, not purely formula derived" and missing data is not scored as poor performance.
[333] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p20; only six year points are printed, so the crossing falls between 2028 and 2030.
[334] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p20.

Cape Town's routes already run full

Cape Town has won more routes than its peers (section 2.1), and they now run full. Twenty-nine international routes serve the airport in 2026, and Cape Town's share of South Africa's international capacity rose from 10% in 2010 to 25%.[335] In the year to November 2025, 11 of the 27 routes with load data ran above 80%. Newark led at 88.6%, ahead of Atlanta at 84.3% and Frankfurt and London Heathrow at 83.0%.[336] Sixteen ran at 75% or more.[337]

Eleven of 27 routes ran above 80% load in the year to November 2025, and sixteen at 75% or more.

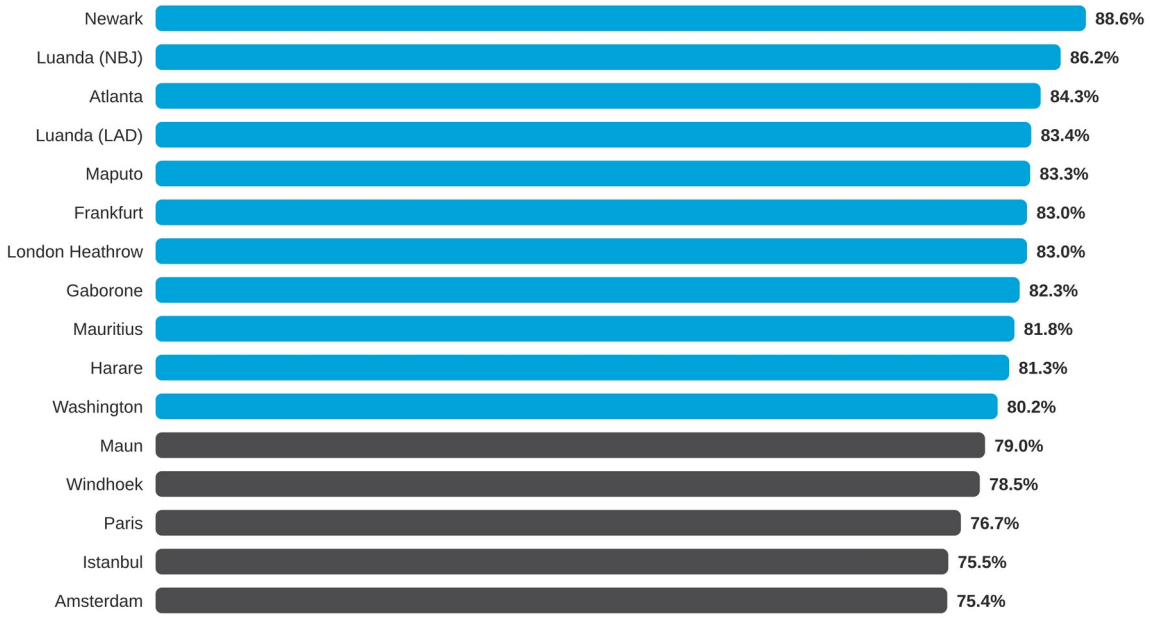


Figure 2.4. Route load factors to November 2025

Source: MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Seasonality" (international route load-factor table: estimated bookings divided by capacity, bookings for the twelve months to November 2025). Routes above 80% highlighted; the eleven routes below 75% are not shown.

Across all its routes, domestic included, Cape Town's 79% load factor is the joint highest of South Africa's five largest airports, with Lanseria. South Africa averages about 70% and Africa 75%, and Cape Town's international routes alone average 76%.[338] Regional routes also run full, and all five markets are named for more capacity. Luanda ran at 86.2% and 83.4% on its two airports, Maputo 83.3%, Gaborone 82.3%, Mauritius 81.8% and Harare 81.3%. Domestically, Cape Town to Durban runs at 90.0% and warrants more seats, while other domestic routes sit between 70% and 80%.[339]

Cape Town has reached "a 'what next' moment". Near-term seats must come from more frequencies and larger aircraft on routes already full. Beyond that, the province needs a route strategy that "looks for long-term gains rather than short-term wins".[340]

The network runs through hubs and skips Asia

Cape Town's seven largest international markets are all hub airports, with 2.7 million seats in 2026 against 2.0 million in 2019. Western Europe holds 38% of international capacity, the Middle East 23%, Southern

[335] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Executive Summary", "The Capetown Market".
[336] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Seasonality".
[337] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Seasonality", computed; the printed network total is 76.0% on 3,816,797 seats, while the 27 listed rows sum to 75.0%.
[338] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "The South African Market", "Seasonality"; the source puts the global average at 84%.
[339] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Seasonality".
[340] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "In Conclusion".

Africa 17%, Eastern Africa 14% and North America 6%.[341] Most hub passengers connect: Emirates' connecting share is "above 80% annually" and Qatar Airways' is nine in ten.[342]

New carriers lean towards Africa and the hubs. Seven of the twelve that launched Cape Town services since 2014 fly to African points. By 2026 seats the largest are Airlink to regional points (441,602) and Ethiopian to Addis Ababa (437,430). Turkish to Istanbul (240,200), United to Newark and Washington (172,190) and Kenya Airways to Nairobi (127,138) follow.[343]

Yet no seat flies direct to Asia: the network shows "the absence of any direct capacity to any of the Asian markets".[344] Thirteen of the 27 routes in the load table serve African or Indian Ocean points, and none serves Asia.[345] A direct Asian route is therefore a long-term prize, and the near-term seats sit with the hub carriers. The hub routes are not full. Dubai ran at 72.3%, Addis Ababa at 71.9% and Doha at 65.2% in the year to November 2025.[346] On those routes marketing can still fill seats, which it cannot do on the eleven full ones.

Airlines cut winter seats and may raise fares

On full routes, airlines are expected to raise fares before they add seats. The forecast is that "carriers will seek to increase revenues via higher selling fares rather than add new services", which "will frustrate that desire for increased visitors".[347] No fare data backs the forecast; it rests on judgement of airline behaviour. In winter carriers withdraw seats. June carried 6.4% of Cape Town's 2025 international seats and December 10.8%, with May, July, August and September at 6.9% each.[348]

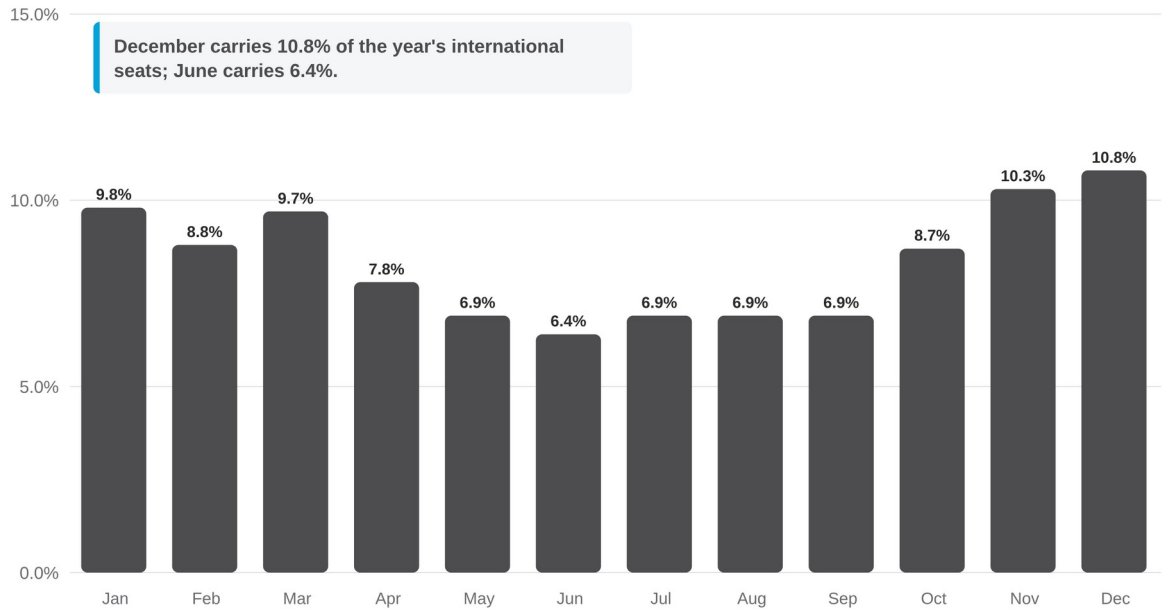


Figure 2.5. International seats by month, 2025

Source: MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Seasonality" (Capetown international capacity by month, 2025, printed data labels).

[341] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "The Capetown Market".
[342] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Seasonality".
[343] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "The Capetown Market"; the other seven are Delta Air Lines to Atlanta with 110,612 seats, Norse Atlantic UK to London Gatwick with 103,428, LATAM Airlines Group to São Paulo with 47,084, Air Tanzania to Dar es Salaam and Victoria Falls with 37,716, Safair to Windhoek with 32,130, Proflight Zambia to Livingstone with 14,600 and Eswatini Air to Manzini with 3,700.
[344] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "The Capetown Market".
[345] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Seasonality", computed.
[346] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Seasonality".
[347] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "In Conclusion".
[348] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Seasonality".

Connecting traffic is "especially critical in the low season", which ties the winter schedule to the hub carriers' own priorities.[349] New seats must therefore be won route by route and season by season, as New Zealand did with route-tied marketing (section 2.1).

One runway caps the gateway

The airport, not the airlines, sets the outer limit. Cape Town International's single runway has no parallel taxiway and caps movements at about 30 an hour. Two of the airport's seven parts are already full. The R6.39bn runway relocation lifts the cap to 45 movements an hour, a 50% rise. On the planning timeline it completes around 2033, with terminal relief from about 2032.[350] ACSA's latest schedule is earlier, with the runway finished by December 2029, subject to contract award.[351] This report assumes about 2033 and treats the earlier date as upside.

The alternatives arrive sooner but carry less. George handled 911,000 passengers in 2025, above its design limit. A R310m terminal expansion doubles its capacity to about 2 million passengers by 2028 or 2029. Cape Winelands Airport targets first passengers in 2028 on an R8bn first phase but has no firm airline. Capacity and certainty pull apart: "the certain fix is the latest, and the earliest big-capacity option is the least certain".[352]

Yet no stakeholder named Cape Town International's capacity as a constraint, and it appears only as a transfer-time reference. No airline or airport sat among the 16 organisations, so the runway's absence from their concerns is a gap in the record, not a finding.[353] The outer limit is a national lever, held by ACSA (section 2.4).

Cruise needs product, not berths

Cape Town's cruise berth has room, and port spending is not going to cruise. In 2024/25 the berth handled 83 calls against a season capacity of 150 or more, with about 127,000 passengers and R1.79bn of impact.[354] Its limits are a 300m ship length, the South-Easter wind and no shore power.[355]

Mossel Bay handled 21 calls and about 13,000 passengers and opened a R22m passenger facility in November 2025. Ships anchor and tender because it has no cruise quay, and only small and mid-sized ships call. Saldanha Bay has had 3 trial calls and shares the ore terminal, with no cruise berth or passenger facility. Its R4bn port upgrade serves iron ore.[356] Mossel Bay's own count differs: calls rose from four before COVID to 27 a season.[357]

Mossel Bay is ready for day stops, so the stance is to protect Cape Town, back Mossel Bay now and watch Saldanha Bay. The province should grow cruise "through product and marketing, not capital works".[358]

The flagships are full in season

The province's best-known sites run at capacity in summer. At the Table Mountain Aerial Cableway, peak queues of up to three hours up and two down detract from the visitor experience.[359] Chapman's Peak suffers disruptions, and the peak over December and January "overwhelms transport and accommodation

[349] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Executive Summary".
[350] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p101, p102, p103; Minister of Transport, parliamentary reply, Apr 2025; the 45 comes from the parliamentary reply, while the Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p103, prints about 40% more flights an hour.
[351] ACSA, Q1 2026/27 presentation to the Portfolio Committee on Transport, Aug 2026.
[352] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p104, p105, p106, p109.
[353] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p16, p22, p43; those voices were scheduled for later engagement phases.
[354] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p110; Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p37; that source counts 79 vessels for the season, while passengers and impact agree; the Infrastructure Report also prints about 40% use of the season, on a basis it does not state.
[355] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p110 to p112.
[356] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p110 to p112.
[357] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p20; the town was the only stakeholder to raise cruise.
[358] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p110 to p112.
[359] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p36; Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p28, p32; the second puts peak queues at two to three hours.

capacity".[360] Boulders is "already near carrying capacity", and summit expansion on Table Mountain is severely limited.[361] Yet Cape Point and the township attractions are underused.[362] Eleven of the 16 organisations see the offer as concentrated around Cape Town and a narrow set of icons.[363] The peak must therefore spread to product with room, under the capacity discipline New Zealand applies (section 2.1). The regions cannot yet take the overflow.

Readiness and access fall away from the Metro

Overall readiness halves between the Metro and the periphery. The Cape Metro rates 4.5 out of 5, the Winelands and the Garden Route 3.4, the Overberg 2.7, the West Coast 2.5 and the Central Karoo 1.9.[364] Accessibility falls fastest. On attractions it scores 4.7 in the Metro, 3.3 in the Winelands and 3.0 on the Garden Route. It drops to 2.0 in the Overberg, 1.7 on the West Coast and 1.0 in the Central Karoo, while the Metro scores 5.0 on transport.[365]

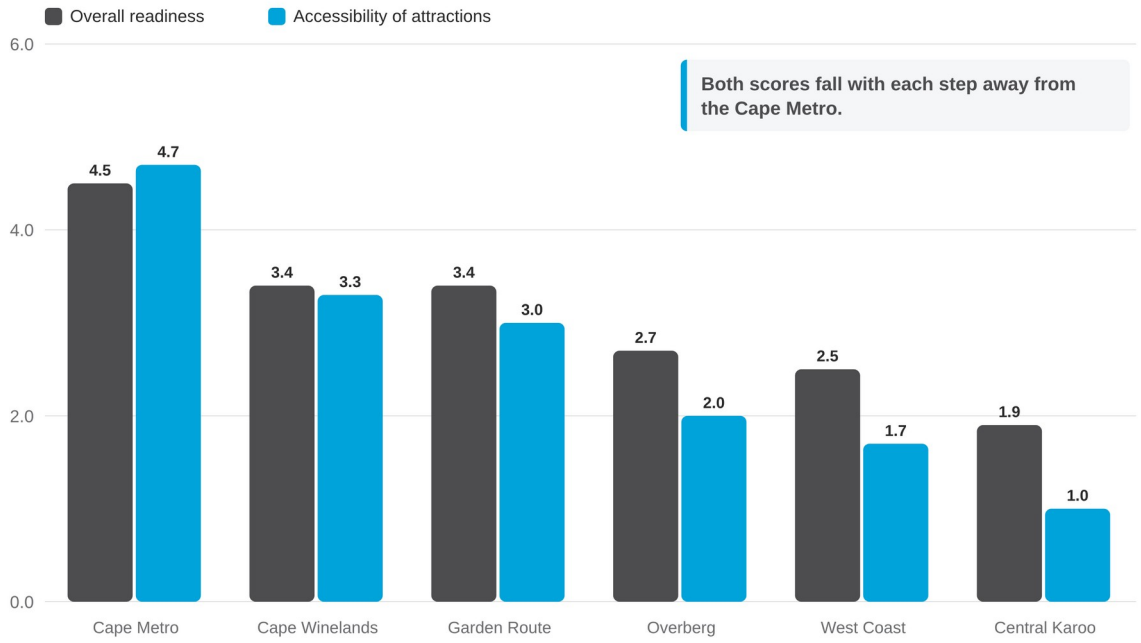


Figure 2.6. Readiness and accessibility by district

Source: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026: overall ratings p28, p41, p52, p63, p74, p85; accessibility of attractions p88. Scale 1 (very weak) to 5 (leading). Districts ordered from the Metro outward.

Cape Town is both the gateway and the dispersal point. The Metro holds 20,281 of the 50,332 assets (40.3%) and five of the province's six highest-volume attractions. It is the only region with an international airport and rapid transit.[366] It also generates 72.5% of provincial output, measured as GDPR.[367]

[360] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p28, p32.
[361] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p24, p36.
[362] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p24.
[363] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p11; the count is reconstructed from the appendix tables.
[364] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p28, p41, p52, p63, p74, p85.
[365] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p88 to p90.
[366] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p23, p88, p90.
[367] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p39.

Table 2.4. District strengths and weaknesses

Each district has a distinct strength, and the Metro holds two in every five of the province's tourism assets.

District	Assets	Share	Strength	Weakness
Cape Metro	20,281	40.3%	Five of the six highest-volume attractions; the only international airport and rapid transit	Peak congestion at flagship sites; rail unusable for tourism
Garden Route	9,875	19.6%	Second-largest accommodation stock; a regional airport with direct flights	300km of coastline fragments the route; no inter-town shuttle
Cape Winelands	7,730	15.4%	Largest commercial and leisure base, anchored by 200-plus wine estates	Wine dominates; adventure and heritage under-promoted
Overberg	6,176	12.3%	Whale coast; the only market where demand and pricing peak in winter	Public transport effectively absent; interpretation gaps
West Coast	4,752	9.4%	Highest natural-asset attractiveness; accessible pricing	Short wildflower season; dining in a handful of nodes
Central Karoo	1,518	3.0%	Niche assets of the highest uniqueness; dark-sky astro-tourism	A service desert outside Prince Albert and Beaufort West

Source: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026: asset counts p23, p34, p45, p56, p67, p78 (Winelands share computed: 7,730 of 50,332 is 15.4%); strengths and weaknesses p88 to p90.

Beyond the Metro the visitor drives. Even the Garden Route, with its airport, has no shuttle between towns. Public transport is "effectively absent" on the West Coast and in the Overberg, and the Winelands have no transit between estates or valleys. Every accessibility measure in the Central Karoo "sits at the floor", and even Metro rail is "functionally unusable for tourism".[368] Stakeholders call weak public transport, congestion and unreliable last-mile access "structural barriers to visitor movement within and beyond Cape Town".[369] Dispersal therefore "needs deliberate corridor investment, not organic spillover from Cape Town".[370]

Strong regional assets lack beds and booking

The assets that could draw visitors outward sit where few can stay or book. The West Coast has the province's highest natural-asset attractiveness and the Central Karoo its most unique niche assets, yet both score lowest on readiness. Inland areas north of the N2 on the Garden Route are tourism-inactive. Industrial belts in the Metro show "zero tourism conversion" despite nearby attractions.[371]

Beds are one gap. In the Winelands mid-market accommodation "is effectively absent outside Stellenbosch", and a "luxury-skewed product mix excludes mid-market and family segments". Accommodation is thin beyond Langebaan and Paternoster on the West Coast and thin at international grade along Route 62.[372] No bed count yet sizes the gap.

Booking is the second gap, and it is widest in the regions. Six touring routes were rated Ready, Developing or Gap on access, accommodation, safety and bookability (Emerging is the overall rating as printed for the West Coast route).[373] Route 62 has the lowest online bookability of the six, and the West Coast route rates Gap on digital distribution and payments.[374] CapeNature takes about 70% of its

[368] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p49, p88 to p90.
[369] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p10.
[370] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p5.
[371] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p24, p35, p88.
[372] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p47, p53, p62, p84.
[373] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p19; the July final supersedes a June draft.
[374] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p62, p84, p87.

reservations through its call centre rather than its online platform.[375] Even in the Metro, about 40% or more of smaller operators lack online booking.[376]

Table 2.5. Touring route readiness

Only the Cape Peninsula route is rated ready for international visitors; the Winelands and the Garden Route fall short on safety, and the outer routes on access, accommodation or bookability.

Route	From Cape Town	Access	Accommodation	Safety	Bookability	Overall
Cape Peninsula	0 km	Ready	Ready	Developing	Ready	Ready
Cape Winelands	50 km	Ready	Ready	Developing	Ready	Developing
Whale Coast and Overberg	120 km	Developing	Developing	Developing	Developing	Developing
West Coast and Cederberg	120 km	Developing	Gap	Ready	Gap	Emerging
Route 62 and Klein Karoo	160 km	Developing	Developing	Developing	Gap	Developing
Garden Route	385 km	Ready	Ready	Developing	Ready	Developing

Source: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p29, p30, p39, p40, p50, p51, p61, p62, p72, p73, p83, p84.

The regions need beds and a booking route before marketing, with quality visible on booking platforms, as in Valencia (section 2.1).

No committed money closes the regional gaps

Committed capital closes the air gaps, not the regional ones. The Metro's pipeline exceeds R30bn, led by ACSA's R11.3bn airport overhaul, the R20bn V&A Granger Bay expansion and the R3.3bn MyCiTi Phase 2. Outside the Metro the money goes to roads, ports, airports and a few precincts: Cape Winelands Airport, the George terminal, the R693m Malmesbury bypass, the R62 reconstruction and the R81.7m Agulhas lighthouse precinct.[377]

None of it buys transit between towns, mid-market beds or a booking route. Section 2.4 shows that the bodies that manage and sell the regions are short of money themselves.

Pillar 2 must therefore win seats into the gateway first, then build the corridors, beds and booking that decide where growth lands.

[375] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p42.
[376] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p32.
[377] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p32, p43, p54, p65, p76, p87; the pipeline also holds a wider Winelands airport precinct of R16bn to R20bn, a R9.4m landing-system upgrade at George, the R17m Malgas road, the Saldanha port upgrade and rural broadband to 2026.

What this means for the focus areas

FA07, Win direct routes and add seats on full routes. Eleven routes run above 80% and fares are likely to rise before seats. The runway is the binding constraint until about 2033, and the base case passes the model's seat line by 2030.

FA08, Grow cruise calls and ports. Cruise needs product, not berths.

FA07 and FA15, Crowd in capital with targeted investment strategies. Airport capital is committed, but regional gaps have no committed capital.

FA09, Accelerate tourism-enabling internal mobility. Accessibility falls from 4.7 to 1.0, and public transport is absent beyond the Metro. Stakeholders name last-mile access as a barrier, which supports it.

FA10, Support diversified route and product development, and FA11, Align visitor experience in-destination. Strong assets sit in areas with little tourism use, and mid-market beds are missing. Stakeholders' account of a narrow product set supports FA10.

FA12, Balance impact on nature-based attractions. Flagships are full at peak while alternatives are underused, as stakeholders also report.

FA03, Make the whole province findable and bookable. Bookability is weakest in the regions, and stakeholders report product that cannot be booked online.

FA02, FA04, FA05 and FA06, from the air side. Winter seats fall to 6.4% of the year in June. No seat flies direct to Asia today, and the hub routes still have seats, so conversion runs through the hubs. The mature long-haul routes are the fullest, and routes to five regional markets run above 80% and are named for more capacity.

2.4 The enabling environment

The enabling system is thinnest where the action plan needs it most. The decisive levers sit nationally, local tourism bodies' funding has been disrupted and the province has no approved way to count its tourism jobs. In the communities, organisation rather than distance keeps visitor spend out.

The binding levers sit with national government

The levers that most limit growth are held nationally. In an insight rated High, the Department of Economic Development reports that "restrictive bilateral air agreements are limiting airlift growth", leaving the province less competitive than peers.[378] Chinese routes are "frequently an extension of government-to-government relations".[379] The runway that caps Cape Town International sits with ACSA, a national body (sections 1.2 and 2.3).

Visas and national marketing follow the same pattern. Chinese and Gulf travellers face slow, document-heavy visa processes.[380] Four organisations raised visas, among them the Cableway for India and China and the CTICC for African events.[381] The Department of Economic Development also finds that SA Tourism's institutional weakness constrains international marketing.[382] The Western Cape holds none of these levers (section 1.2), so it must move them by escalation backed with evidence. Chile's case points the same way: lobby for air service liberalisation and simpler visas (section 2.1).

[378] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p24; insights are the project team's statements, attributed to the organisation engaged.
[379] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "The Chinese Market Opportunity".
[380] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p51.
[381] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p36, p45.
[382] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p24, p25.

Funding has thinned and mandates blur

The bodies that manage and sell the destination are weaker than a decade ago. The Department of Economic Development rates Western Cape and Cape Town tourism funding "materially below peer destinations" for destination management and marketing. It finds that tourism institutional capacity "has eroded over the past decade at both provincial and municipal level", and both findings are rated High.[383]

National Treasury's MFMA Circular No. 131 of 31 March 2025 has since disrupted established municipal funding for local tourism organisations (LTOs), a finding also rated High. Most of them "are not operationally sustainable without municipal funding support".[384] Mandates also blur at district level. The West Coast District Municipality reports "a mandate disconnect" between the district, local municipalities and LTOs that leaves tourism development without a clear owner.[385]

Fiscal pressure is turning attention to a tourism levy and blended finance.[386] The committed capital in section 2.3 builds airports, ports, roads, transit and precincts, but none of it funds the bodies that manage and sell the destination. The plan cannot rest on LTOs until their funding and mandates are settled.

Climate losses already fall on the flagships

Climate risk is now an operating cost at Robben Island and in CapeNature's reserves. Robben Island Museum loses about R16 million a year to weather-cancelled trips, a High-rated insight.[387] CapeNature reports climate-related flooding, fire and heat closing sites.[388] Sustainable destination management is therefore risk management for the province's flagship product today, and should be funded as such, not as a later add-on.

Collaboration platforms exist; data does not flow

Collaboration and data sharing are the barriers stakeholders raise most often. Fifteen of the 16 organisations raised industry and government collaboration, and fifteen raised policy and data sharing.[389]

[383] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p25.
[384] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p25.
[385] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p39.
[386] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p23, p25.
[387] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p33.
[388] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p43.
[389] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p20 to p46, counted.

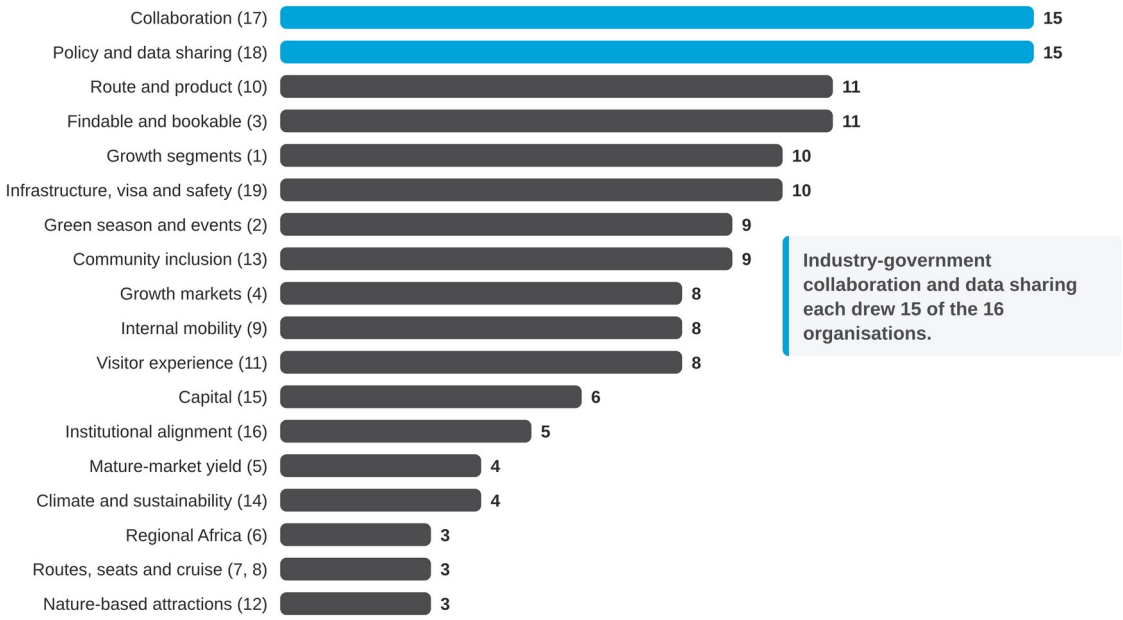


Figure 2.7. Focus areas stakeholders raised

Source: Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p20 to p46: number of the 16 organisations with at least one insight in each category the appendix tables code, shown against the focus area it bears on (computed). Routes and cruise are coded as one category, and none covers skills. The report prints no tally.

Data sharing also draws 30 insights and 16 High ratings, the most of any category.[390] Stakeholders describe the data architecture as "too fragmented, lagged and proxy-based to provide a reliable view of visitor volumes, spend, spread or economic impact at provincial level".[391]

Coordination is hard everywhere, as the comparators show (section 2.1). Yet the platforms for collaboration already exist here. FEDHASA points to JAMS, through which tourism associations coordinate with Wesgro, the Western Cape Government and the City of Cape Town.[392] What is missing is an agreed way to share data across those bodies, not another forum.

The province has no approved jobs count

The province cannot yet measure tourism's jobs or its contribution to GDP. The national Department of Tourism reports that "there is no approved official methodology for provincial tourism GDP and jobs estimates", rated High.[393] Stats SA cites 749 vacancies behind delays to the tourism satellite account and infers provincial flows partly from ports-of-entry data.[394]

The communities show the same gap at small scale. No community profile counts tourism employment inside its boundary. The figures are node-side instead, such as about 4,700 formal Town Centre jobs for 82,393 employed Mitchells Plain residents.[395] Need rests on fifteen-year-old Census data.[396] CapeNature, the West Coast District and the Overberg raise skills gaps, but no labour analysis sits behind them.[397]

For the Western Cape, a jobs baseline must come before a jobs target. The ambition of 300,000 tourism-linked jobs (section 1.1) has no baseline yet. The yield-based regional metrics that New Zealand recommends (section 2.1) also need a reliable view of spend and spread, which today's data cannot give.

[390] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p20 to p46, counted.
[391] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p13.
[392] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p31.
[393] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p37.
[394] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p30.
[395] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p22.
[396] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p15.
[397] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p27, p39, p43.

Communities hold people, not spend

Foreign visitors spent R25.9bn in the province in FY2025, but little of it reaches its townships and rural settlements.[398] The 20 shortlisted communities come from a long-list of every Census sub-place cluster of 1,500 people or more with official unemployment of 25% or more. Named mission, fishing and farm settlements are added.[399] That gives 107 communities holding 2.81 million people in 2011, 48% of the province.[400] Five weighted criteria (need, tourism potential, proximity, readiness and access) produce the shortlist of 20, five in the Cape Metro and three in each district.[401]

The 20 hold 18.4% of the province's residents and 15.4% of employed residents (Census 2011), yet receive 0.02% to 0.04% of foreign direct spend.[402] This comes to about R4m to R10m a year on the documented floor, against R259m a year if they captured 1% of FY2025 foreign direct spend.[403]

Inclusion here means activity inside the community. A tour, a meal, a bed or a market counts; a resident commuting to a hotel job in town does not.[404] Inclusion therefore turns on where visitor spend lands, not on how many visitors come.

Organisation, not distance, keeps spend out

Distance is not the barrier. Of the 107 long-listed communities, 93 lie within 45 minutes of one of 35 tourism nodes or three corridors.[405] Langa is 12 minutes from Cape Town International and Zwelihle seven from Hermanus.[406] Distance is the binding constraint in none of the 20.[407] Yet proximity and access carried 35% of the shortlist score, so the result is partly built into the selection (Appendix A5, "Community shortlist criteria").

Organisation is the binding constraint in 11 of the 20. Ten have no identified active tourism body, and nine show no benefit visible to residents.[408]

[398] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p11.
[399] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p14, p15, p16; the evidence joins Census 2011 sub-places to an OpenStreetMap asset layer of September 2026 with road travel times and municipal plans, and need rests on Census 2011 because Census 2022 is not published below ward level and asked no income question.
[400] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p16.
[401] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p14, p16.
[402] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p5.
[403] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p5.
[404] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p4.
[405] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p16; the archetype counts give 92 near a node, while the source prints 93.
[406] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p18.
[407] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p30.
[408] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p28, p30.

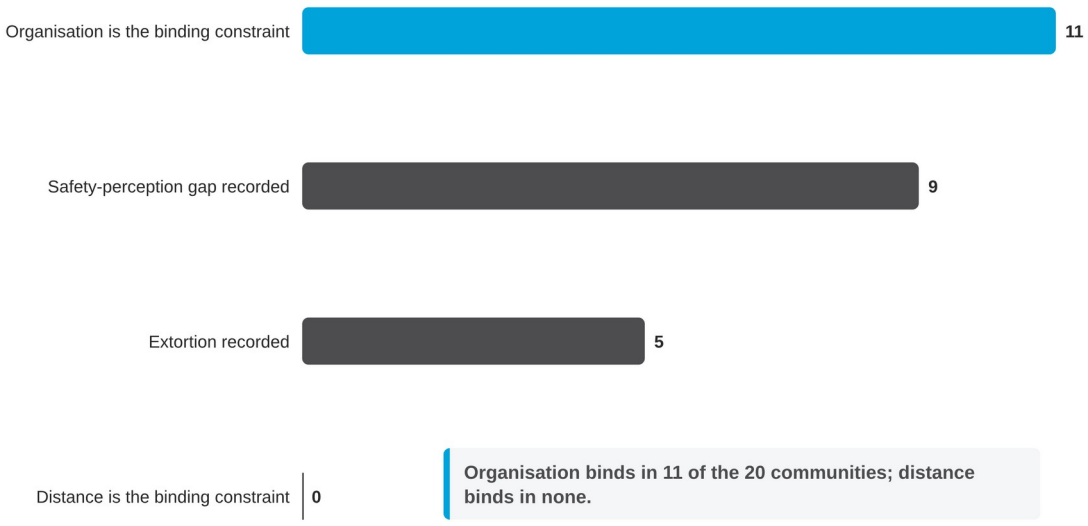


Figure 2.8. Binding constraints in 20 communities

Source: SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p30 (constraint tally across the 20 shortlisted communities).

Product often exists without a seller. Langa's walk sells on global platforms at ratings above 4.8, yet city firms sell most of the 23 Langa walks on Viator.[409] Zwelihle's four resident guides sell by phone with no shared booking channel.[410] The Mitchells Plain festival drew 27,800 visitors in November 2025 with no local operator or LTO behind it.[411] The communities cannot yet be found or booked on the channels visitors use. What they lack is a local seller, not a shorter journey.

Safety is the second gate

After a seller, safety is the next gate a visit must pass. Nine of the 20 communities record a safety-perception gap and five record extortion.[412] Seven stakeholder organisations raised safety, a barrier that runs across transport, township tourism and international selling.[413] Tourism cannot fix this alone: "tourism activity alone cannot resolve crime or extortion".[414] Safety is therefore a launch requirement in its own right, not an outcome of the pilot. No community pilot should open until it is met.

Each community type needs a different first move

The largest group of long-listed communities sits near a node and has something worth visiting, and each type needs its own first move.[415] Near a node with assets underused, 49 long-listed and 11 shortlisted communities need sellers organised and a slot in the node's itineraries, procurement and events. Near a node with nothing inside, 43 long-listed and 6 shortlisted communities need a seller first, then one anchor asset under a covenant, then integration.

Remote communities with underused assets, 7 long-listed and 2 shortlisted, need access opened and the asset placed on a route product the LTO already sells (Atlantis is classed remote by Wesgro's naming,

[409] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p20, p28.
[410] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p22, p34.
[411] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p22, p34.
[412] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p30.
[413] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p10.
[414] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p35.
[415] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p15, p17; p4 prints 48 and 8 for the two assets-underused rows.

though it lies 26 minutes from Darling).[416] Remote communities with nothing inside, 8 long-listed and 1 shortlisted, need procurement and skills first and an asset only once a route product exists. The first move differs by type, but in each the seller or the route comes before the asset.

Table 2.6. The 20 shortlisted communities

The 20 shortlisted communities span every region and sit between 1 and 111 minutes from their nearest node.

Region	Community	Type	Score	Minutes to node	Binding constraint
Cape Metro	Langa	N-A	3.00	12 to CTIA	Organisation
Cape Metro	Khayelitsha	N-A	3.00	15 to CTIA	Organisation
Cape Metro	Gugulethu	N-A	2.80	8 to CTIA	Attraction
Cape Metro	Mitchells Plain	N-A	2.35	16 to CTIA	Organisation
Cape Metro	Atlantis	R-A	2.20	26 to Darling	Organisation
Cape Winelands	Kayamandi	N-0	2.55	8 to Stellenbosch	Safety
Cape Winelands	Mbekweni	N-0	2.40	10 to Paarl	Attraction
Cape Winelands	Nkqubela	N-0	1.90	22 to the R62	Attraction
Overberg	Genadendal	N-A	2.45	11 to Greyton	Organisation
Overberg	Zwelihle	N-A	2.05	7 to Hermanus	Organisation
Overberg	Kassiesbaai	N-A	2.05	1 to Arniston	Organisation
Garden Route	Knysna northern townships	N-0	2.60	9 to Knysna	Market link
Garden Route	Thembalethu	N-0	2.30	11 to George	Attraction
Garden Route	De Rust	N-A	2.30	42 to the R62	Infrastructure
West Coast	Laingville	N-A	2.10	4 to St Helena Bay	Organisation
West Coast	Doringbaai	R-0	2.00	111 to Clanwilliam	Organisation
West Coast	Elands Bay	R-A	1.85	87 to Clanwilliam	Organisation
Central Karoo	Laingsburg (Bergsig)	N-A	2.35	22 to Matjiesfontein	Attraction
Central Karoo	Kwa-Mandlenkosi	N-0	2.20	6 to Beaufort West	Organisation
Central Karoo	Prince Albert North	N-A	1.80	4 to Prince Albert	Attraction

Source: SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p18 (shortlist, composite score, free-flow minutes) and p53 to p58 (binding constraint). Archetypes abbreviated: N = near a node (45 minutes or less); R = remote; A = assets underused; 0 = no community-based product. [Open item: re-measure Metro travel times to a visitor node such as the V&A Waterfront or the CBD, not CTIA.]

A seller with a stake comes first

The evidence points to a model built around a seller. It joins a functioning selling capability to demand the node already has, behind launch gates for safety, access and a viable operating model.[417] A pilot in two or three of the six communities profiled first would test it. The six are Langa, Kayamandi, Zwelihle, De Rust, Doringbaai and Laingsburg, one in each region.[418] It would scale only once bookings, local spend, delivery and safety meet thresholds agreed before launch.[419]

The first output is deliberately small: "one live booking route, published operating dates, a named customer contact and a simple record of bookings and local revenue".[420] Most first moves carry no dedicated budget line.[421] Chapter 4 sets out roles and funding. The order the cases support (section 2.1) therefore becomes the order of delivery: a seller first, then a safe visit, then product and exposure.

[416] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p17.
[417] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p32.
[418] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p14.
[419] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p32.
[420] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p33.
[421] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p36.

Every gap in this part is a question of who benefits, who pays, who decides or who measures. Pillar 3 must settle those four questions, because Pillars 1 and 2 cannot deliver without the answers.

What this means for the focus areas

FA13, Embed local destination bodies for community inclusion. The binding constraint is a seller with a stake, then a safe way in, then demand pulled from the adjacent node.

FA14, Manage climate risk and sustainable tourism, and FA15, Crowd in capital with targeted investment strategies. Unfunded local tourism bodies and climate losses at flagship sites.

FA10, Support diversified route and product development, and FA15. Assets follow sellers and route products, not the reverse.

FA16, Align institutional stakeholders across all three tiers. Air rights, visas and SA Tourism sit nationally, Chinese routes follow government-to-government agreements and airport capacity sits with ACSA.

FA19, Lead removal of infrastructure, visa and safety deficits, a governance task because visas and air rights sit nationally. Visas slow Chinese and Gulf travellers, and safety and extortion gate activation in up to nine communities.

FA17, Strengthen industry and government collaboration, and FA18, Expedite tourism-enabling policy and data sharing. Each raised by 15 of 16 organisations, with existing platforms such as JAMS to build on.

FA20, Develop workforce and service skills, waits on analysis still to be commissioned. Skills gaps raised by CapeNature, the West Coast District and the Overberg District have no labour analysis behind them. No count of tourism jobs exists, which also supports FA18.

FA03, Make the whole province findable and bookable. Community product sells by phone or through city operators.

Chapter 3

Findings and recommendations

3.1 Pillar 1: Reshape demand

Latent interest is not what holds Pillar 1 back; turning it into bookings is. The province is known in its mature markets, under-sold in its growth markets and hard to book outside its core.

Pillar 1 sets out to break through three ceilings on demand, in markets, seasons and spread, by reshaping the brand toward new traveller segments. Five markets supplied 63% of overseas arrivals in 2025, and the UK, Germany and the USA supplied 52% between them.[422] June held 6.4% of the year's international seats at Cape Town International in 2025, against 10.8% in December.[423] Beyond the core routes, most rural properties have no OTA presence and are invisible to the market.[424]

The gap between interest and arrival is wide. About 97 million high-value travellers in 34 markets have an interest in South Africa, and about 1.4 million convert into arrivals.[425] In the growth markets, "the constraint is conversion and access, not only awareness".[426] Each ceiling therefore needs a path from interest to booking: green-season seats and events, bookable product and hub traffic that stops in Cape Town.

Two themes carry the pillar. The first, traveller, brand and proposition, decides whom the province sells to, when and how. Its focus areas target four segments in their home markets, build green-season demand from business events and make the whole province bookable (focus areas 1 to 3). The second theme, source market growth and diversification, decides which markets grow the base. It converts Indian and Chinese travellers already flying in through hubs, raises yield in the mature markets and builds the regional African base (focus areas 4 to 6).

The two themes work as one. The segments set the target inside each market, and the market groups set where volume and value come from. The green season and bookability decide whether the demand they win lands in the months and places with room to take it. Initiatives I1 to I5 carry the six focus areas, and section 4.3 sets out each one.

Pillar 1 carries most of the base case. Between 2025 and 2035 the base case adds 676,949 arrivals.[427] The four hub markets, the UAE, Qatar, Ethiopia and Turkey, supply 206,584 of them and the mature markets 178,780. The acceleration markets, led by India and China, supply 175,818, regional Africa 110,298 and the strategic group 5,469.[428] None of it lands without seats, so the air access focus area in Pillar 2 runs beside this pillar from the first phase (focus area 7). The Board will judge the pillar on arrivals by market group, direct foreign spend and the green-season share, not on arrivals alone (section 5.2).

[422] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p13.
[423] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Seasonality".
[424] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p95.
[425] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p41; the slide gives no year or source for the 1.4 million.
[426] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p30.
[427] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19.
[428] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p20, computed.

3.1.1 Traveller, brand and proposition

The first theme is about whom the Western Cape sells to, when and how. It holds three focus areas: the segments, the green season and the bookability of the province. Together they decide whether interest becomes a trip: the right travellers, in months with room and on product they can book.

THEME 1.1 · TRAVELLER, BRAND AND PROPOSITION · FOCUS AREA 1

Respond to growth segment traveller preferences

Four traveller segments, each concentrated in named home markets, give Wesgro a sharper target than country alone, and the province scores 3.7 to 4.6 out of 5 on its ability to win them.

The opportunity

Country is too blunt a target for a long-haul destination. Within one market, travellers differ in what they want from a trip, what they spend and where they book. Four values-based segments fit the Western Cape. Together they hold about 97 million addressable travellers, and each is concentrated in named home markets.[429] Marketing to a segment inside a market puts each rand where the province is most likely to win.

The prize to 2035 is value as much as volume. Curious Explorers and Creative Connectors together hold over 40% of global outbound leisure demand, while Discerning Connoisseurs deliver the highest economic impact per arrival.[430] The segments also help with season and spread. Curious Explorers offer the strongest opportunity for dispersal beyond Cape Town, and Reflective Adventurers support seasonality mitigation through year-round outdoor and wellness travel.[431]

The measure holds the province back as much as the message. Performance is judged on arrivals. The Department of Economic Development says current growth framing "overemphasises visitor volumes" and that a value and spend lens may suit better.[432]

What the evidence shows

Table 3.1. Evidence for focus area 1

Four segments are sized, scored and tied to home markets, and the highest-yield segment is the smallest.

Finding	Figure	Source
Four segments are sized	Curious Explorers about 30m, Creative Connectors about 25m, Discerning Connoisseurs about 19m and Reflective Adventurers about 23m addressable long-haul travellers across 34 markets	Skift, Executive Summary; MA p43
The province can win them	Ability-to-win 4.6, 4.1, 4.0 and 3.7 out of 5.0, scored on product fit, brand fit, competition and ease of air access	Skift, Ability-to-Win Assessment
Each segment has home markets	Curious Explorers are 30% of UK and US travellers; Reflective Adventurers 33% of German; Creative Connectors 32% of Indian; Discerning Connoisseurs 40% of UAE	Skift, Segment Incidence by Market; MA p43
The smallest segment yields most	Discerning Connoisseurs spend $8,500 to $14,000 a long-haul trip, three to four times the other segments	Skift, segment 03; MA p51
Each segment books differently	Creative Connectors book 42% through OTAs; Discerning Connoisseurs 42% through luxury travel advisors and 6% through OTAs	Skift, Travel Behaviour and Spend; MA p49, p52

[429] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p41 to p43.
[430] Skift Segmentation Analysis, Mar 2026, "Strategic Implications".
[431] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p56.
[432] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p24.

Finding	Figure	Source
Conversion is the gap	About 97 million addressable travellers across 34 markets; about 1.4 million convert into arrivals	MA p41

Source: Skift Segmentation Analysis, Mar 2026 (working analysis, cited by section); Market Assessment Report, May 2026 (MA). Trip spend in the currency printed, which the documents do not name. The 1.4 million carries no year or source line.

The four segments rest on a May 2025 survey of more than 25,000 outbound travellers in 34 markets, applied to 17 priority markets.[433] Each segment has its own home markets, spend and booking channels, so one campaign cannot reach all four. China holds the largest pool, about 21.49 million, but air access and visas constrain its conversion.[434]

Yet two limits apply. The survey leaves out the domestic market and seven African markets, among them Nigeria, Kenya and Ghana.[435] Its findings are directional rather than definitive, and no Western Cape validation exists yet.[436] Stakeholders also name interests outside the four: medical tourism, township culture, eco-adventure and international MICE.[437] These are product interests that cut across the segments, not a fifth segment.

The course of action

Wesgro should market by segment within market and judge results by value as well as volume. The UK and Germany anchor the near term with a combined pool of about 12.5 million, and the USA is the largest single pool outside China.[438] The same research that tests the segments here should extend them to the domestic and African markets, which the survey leaves out.

The order matters. Segment targets and validation come first, in 2027. The findings are directional, and the budget should not move on them at scale until they hold for the Western Cape (section 4.3). Spend moves to each segment's own channels from 2028. Spend per visitor joins Wesgro's targets from 2029, once the data exists to track it.

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Set segment targets inside each priority market: Curious Explorers in the UK and USA, Reflective Adventurers in Germany, Creative Connectors in India, Discerning Connoisseurs in the UAE	Destination Marketing; Research
Wesgro	Move spend from broad awareness to trade-led conversion through each segment's own channels, from luxury advisors to mobile-first OTAs	Destination Marketing; trade and OTA partners
Wesgro	Commission destination-specific research to validate the segments, extend it to the domestic and African markets and build the segments into brand tracking	Research
Partners	Develop segment-matched product: heritage and township experiences, creative districts, private-access wine and food and a certified network of wellness retreats and trails	Product owners; CapeNature; SANParks; LTOs
National	Agree one segment frame with SA Tourism for long-haul campaigns, so provincial and national spend target the same travellers	SA Tourism

Why it can work

Segment targeting works because it moves money to where incidence, fit and channel meet. Curious Explorers are 30% of UK and US travellers, and the province scores 4.6 out of 5 on its ability to win

[433] Skift Segmentation Analysis, Mar 2026, "Research Methodology".
[434] Skift Segmentation Analysis, Mar 2026, "Comparative Market Potential Overview".
[435] Skift Segmentation Analysis, Mar 2026, "Research Methodology".
[436] Skift Segmentation Analysis, Mar 2026, "Disclaimer".
[437] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p34, p35, p42, p45.
[438] Skift Segmentation Analysis, Mar 2026, "Strategic Implications".

them.[439] Discerning Connoisseurs book 42% of trips through luxury travel advisors and 6% through OTAs.[440] Broad awareness misses them, while advisor partnerships reach them at the point of sale.

New Zealand gives each priority market a role, with the USA as its high-yield growth engine.[441] It judges performance on revenue per visitor and length of stay over arrivals.[442] Valencia matches product to purpose in a similar way, with sector-led programmes from gastronomy to business events that attract purpose-driven, higher-value travellers.[443] Its tourist spend rose 21% in 2024 and spending per trip 6.3%, though no source isolates the programmes' share of that rise.[444] The transfer depends on two changes: yield metrics beside the arrivals count, and partnerships with specialist distribution networks.[445]

Link forward

Initiative I1, segment-led activation and yield in mature markets, carries this entry with focus area 5 (section 4.3). **Indicators** T1-01 international arrivals, T1-02 arrivals by market group and T1-03 direct foreign spend at impact level, and T2-01 segment home-market arrivals at outcome level (section 5.2).

[439] Skift Segmentation Analysis, Mar 2026, "Segment Incidence by Market", "Ability-to-Win Assessment".
[440] Skift Segmentation Analysis, Mar 2026, "Travel Behaviour and Spend".
[441] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p53.
[442] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p55.
[443] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p48.
[444] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p46.
[445] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p56.

THEME 1.1 · TRAVELLER, BRAND AND PROPOSITION · FOCUS AREA 2

Create green-season demand with MICE and events

The green season is a seat problem and an events problem at once. June holds 6.4% of the year's international seats, and business events are the lever best placed to fill the trough, though international meetings now peak from September to November.

The challenge

The green season is where the province has room to grow. Capacity sits underused in the green season and across the regions.[446] Cape Town hotel occupancy was 53% in June 2023.[447] Growth to 2035 depends on "improving conversion in Apr-Sep rather than pushing incremental demand into already busy peak months".[448]

Yet the trough is a seat problem as well as a demand problem. Airlines cut seats in the same months that visitors fall away, and connecting traffic is "especially critical in the low season".[449] Leisure marketing alone cannot fill a month that carriers have already thinned (section 2.3). The province needs reasons to travel that are fixed in the calendar, booked months ahead and sold with the seats.

Business events are the best of those reasons. They can be scheduled more flexibly than leisure trips, so they can strengthen demand in shoulder and green-season periods.[450] Two gaps remain: aim and measurement. International meetings cluster just after the trough, and only conferences are counted well (section 2.2).

What the evidence shows

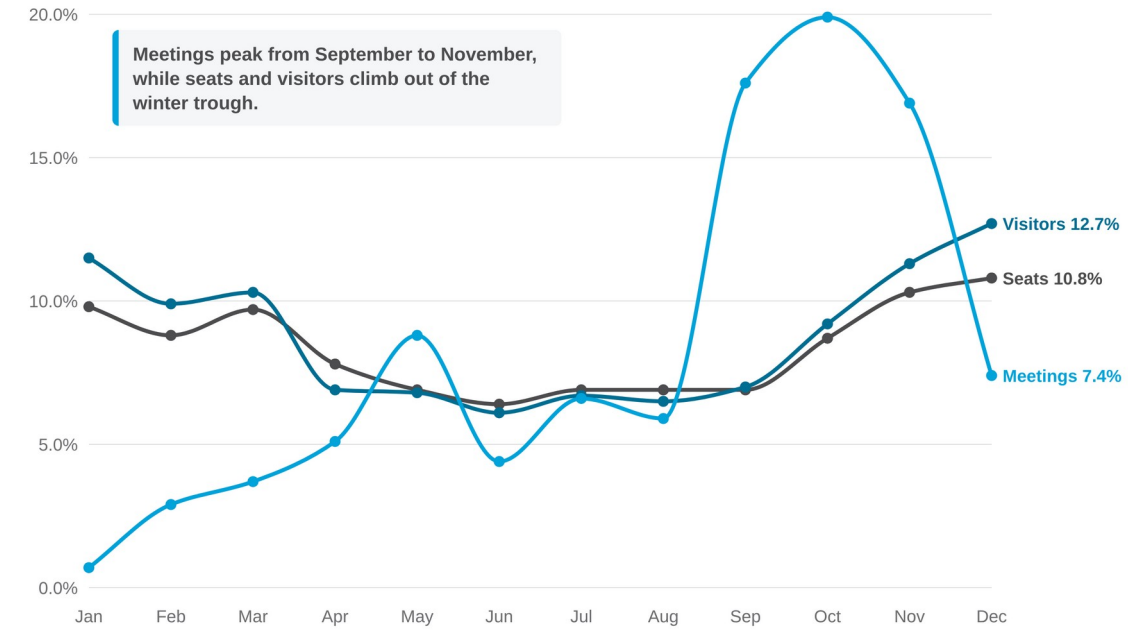
Table 3.2. Evidence for focus area 2

Leisure demand and seats trough from May to September, while international meetings peak from September to November.

Finding	Figure	Source
June has the fewest seats	June 6.4% of 2025 international seat capacity at Cape Town International; May to September 6.4% to 6.9% a month; November 10.3% and December 10.8%	MIDAS, Seasonality
Visitors follow the seats	About 62% of 2025 overseas visitor travel fell between October and March (normalised); the printed 2024 split is 61% to 39%	DSA p12; Diag p32
Meetings sit beside the trough	109 of 136 ICCA meetings in Cape Town from 2022 to 2024 fell between May and November; September to November alone held 74	DSA p37
The meetings base is growing	ICCA meetings 33 in 2022, 46 in 2023 and 58 in 2024 (41,571 participants); 37 UIA association meetings in 2025, 58% of South Africa's	DSA p37, p38
Business events lift yield	International business-event delegates to South Africa spend R6,400 a day; Cape Town hotel occupancy was 53% in June 2023	DSA p34
The venue confirms the gap	June to August and December to January are structurally weak for MICE, and peak-date constraints lose events	SIR p45, p46 (CTICC)

Source: MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026 (scheduled seats); Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025 (Diag; Wesgro Visitor Tracking Survey 2024); Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026 (DSA); Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR). The ICCA months are summed from the printed monthly counts. The 2025 ICCA row of 65 covers Stellenbosch and Cape Town and is not comparable. [Open item: Wesgro Convention Bureau to confirm the 2023 ICCA count (46 printed; Wesgro reported 42 in May 2025) and reconcile the yearly total of 137 with the 136 monthly records.]

[446] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p53.
[447] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p34.
[448] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p25.
[449] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Executive Summary".
[450] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p34.



Share of the year by month. Seats and visitors 2025; meetings 2022 to 2024. Printed visitor shares sum to 104.9%.

Figure 3.1. Meetings, seats and visitors by month

Source: MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, Seasonality (share of 2025 international seat capacity at Cape Town International); Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p12 (month of travel, Western Cape overseas visitors, 2025) and p37 (ICCA meetings in Cape Town by month, 2022 to 2024, shares of 136 computed from the printed counts).

Seats and visitors both fall away from April to September. International meetings run thin from June to August and peak from September to November, at the edge of the trough rather than in it. Events therefore have one job: win new dates in May to September, where seats and visitors are thinnest.

Two limits qualify the numbers. The October to March share is about 62% for 2025, computed from a month-of-travel table whose shares sum to 104.9% and normalised.[451] The only printed split is 61% to 39% for 2024,[452] and this report carries both. And only conferences are measured: meetings are absent from provincial statistics, incentive volumes are unverified and exhibitions are unquantified.[453]

The course of action

Wesgro should build an April to September events spine and sell it with the seats. The spine rests on a small set of flagship weeks, with green-season flight, stay and experience packages sold through airline and trade partners.[454] Bids follow the buyer. Conference bids aim at off-peak dates in sectors where the province is strong. Incentive packages test the cooler season with Indian and Gulf planners, and winter midweek packages target corporate meetings.[455]

The shared strategy and the count come first, in 2027. Wesgro agrees one event acquisition and calendar strategy with the Convention Bureau, the City and the Province. It also sets up a way to measure meetings, incentives and exhibitions. Without that count, no one can tell whether the calendar fills the trough. It then publishes the calendar and aims bids at May to September (section 4.3).

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Publish a green-season events calendar and aim Convention Bureau bids at May to September in the province's strongest sectors	Convention Bureau; Destination Marketing

[451] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p12, computed.
[452] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p32.
[453] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p36.
[454] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p32.
[455] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p40.

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Package green-season flight, stay and experiences with airlines and trade, and test cooler-season incentive packages with Indian and Gulf planners	Air Access; Destination Marketing; airlines
Wesgro	Measure meetings, incentives and exhibitions, which provincial statistics do not cover today	Research; CTICC
Partners	Programme lifestyle events in December and January and keep peak dates for international events; market flower, fynbos and whale events earlier	CTICC; Overberg and West Coast LTOs
Partners	Agree one event acquisition and calendar strategy across Wesgro, the Convention Bureau, the City and the Province	City of Cape Town; DEDAT
National	Ease visas for regional African delegates, whose event demand the venue operator rates as visa-constrained	Home Affairs; SA National Convention Bureau

Why it can work

Association conferences are won with long lead times, and they bring visitors who might not otherwise consider the province.[456] A congress confirmed for July gives carriers a load to plan against, and that is the case Wesgro needs to hold winter seats (focus area 7). Events used this way sustain "year-round tourism demand and air connectivity".[457] They also reach beyond the city. The main event can stay in Cape Town while delegates spend extra nights elsewhere, and Stellenbosch and George can host the next phase of regional conferences.[458]

Melbourne's monthly arrivals stay between 7% and 12% of the year, a balance that events and education travel help create. Yet summer still brings its largest international spike.[459] Victoria builds the balance by curating a portfolio of global, cultural, regional and business events that generate repeat, predictable demand spikes across the year.[460] The condition is the shared calendar and a proactive bidding pipeline behind it.[461] Without them, the gap stays where it is: June to August remains structurally weak for business events.[462]

Link forward

Initiative I2, green-season events and business-events calendar (section 4.3). **Indicators** T1-05 green-season share at impact level, and T2-02 ICCA meetings and T2-03 April to September seat share at outcome level (section 5.2).

[456] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p40, p41.
[457] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p37.
[458] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p41.
[459] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p17.
[460] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p18.
[461] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p20.
[462] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p45.

THEME 1.1 · TRAVELLER, BRAND AND PROPOSITION · FOCUS AREA 3

Make the whole province findable and bookable

Outside the Cape Peninsula, the Winelands and the Garden Route, most product cannot be booked where travellers book, so interest the province has already earned has nowhere to land.

The challenge

Interest that cannot be booked is lost. Travellers discover and book on platforms, and each growth market uses its own (section 2.2). China books on Trip.com and Fliggy, India on MakeMyTrip and the Gulf on Almosafer.[463] Product that is missing from those platforms does not exist for the traveller, however good it is. For the Western Cape this is the gap between Cape Town and the rest of the province.

The gap decides how far growth to 2035 spreads. Cape Town is the gateway, and the case for growth beyond the Metro rests on visitors moving out and staying longer. The Overberg says it does not package its offer early enough to be front of mind when travellers book flights.[464] Each room or tour outside the core that cannot be booked online depends on a traveller willing to pick up the phone.

The barriers are basic: online booking, card payment and rural broadband. Small operators, community guides and even large public attractions still sell by phone. Rural broadband sits outside Wesgro's reach as a national programme.

What the evidence shows

Table 3.3. Evidence for focus area 3

Bookability holds on the three core routes and falls away on the outer routes and in every profiled community.

Finding	Figure	Source
Three of six routes are bookable	Digital and bookability rated Ready on the Cape Peninsula, Garden Route and Cape Winelands routes; Developing on the Whale Coast; Gap on the West Coast and Route 62	IR p30, p40, p51, p62, p73, p84
Rural stock is invisible	Most rural properties have no OTA presence; outer-district stock has near-zero visibility on booking platforms	IR p95
Small operators lack booking	About 40% or more of smaller operators lack online booking, a gap no capital programme addresses	IR p32
No community is bookable	None of 19 profiled communities rates Ready on digital and bookability; 8 rate Developing and 11 Gap	SCIP p20 to p26, p40 to p51
Community product sells by phone	Four Zwelihle guides sell by phone with no shared booking channel; Visit Knysna lists nine township guides as phone contacts	SCIP p34, p47
Large attractions rely on phones	CapeNature takes about 70% of its reservations through its call centre rather than its online platform	SIR p42

Source: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR; the ~40% has no printed scope or source); SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026 (SCIP; ratings compiled from the community profiles, LTO confirmation outstanding); Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR). The 70% is CapeNature's own reservation mix, not a provincial share.

Bookability is strongest on the three core routes where visitors already go. It is weakest on the outer routes and in the communities the province wants to reach. Much of the gap is listing and payment: guides, small operators and reserves exist, but many sell only by phone. Elsewhere the product itself is missing: the Overberg and West Coast marine and wildflower assets have no guided tours and no

[463] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p45, p47, p49.
[464] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p26.

bookable product.[465] Yet no count of bookable products exists.[466] The indicator this focus area needs most, the share of provincial product listed on OTAs by district, therefore has no baseline yet [bookable-product count by district: Wesgro Research to build; see section 5.4].

The course of action

Wesgro should treat bookability as infrastructure: count it, close it district by district and then place it on the platforms each market uses. Each pilot community's first deliverable is one live booking route, published operating dates, a named customer contact and a simple record of bookings and local revenue.[467]

The census comes first, in 2027, because the indicator has no baseline. Onboarding on the West Coast, Route 62 and the Overberg follows from 2028. Packaged itineraries go onto market platforms from 2029, once there is outer-district product to list (section 4.3).

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Run a bookability census of provincial product by district and publish it as the baseline	Research; LTOs
Wesgro	Run a digital onboarding drive for small operators and cellars on the West Coast, Route 62 and the Overberg	Tourism; district municipalities
Wesgro	Deepen OTA partnerships with Trip.com, Almosafer and Booking.com, and list packaged regional itineraries on them	Destination Marketing; OTAs
Partners	Give each pilot community one live booking route before any promotion (focus area 13)	LTOs; community sellers
Partners	Move CapeNature reservations online and complete cashless payments at reserve level	CapeNature
National	Extend rural broadband under SA Connect, so operators outside the core can take online bookings and card payments	National government

Why it can work

Bookability turns interest the province has already earned into payment. It does not replace awareness: the Overberg says potential visitors "do not sufficiently understand how close the district is to Cape Town".[468] Listing and packaging therefore go together. A listing on the platform where a traveller already plans puts outer-district product in front of that traveller at the moment of decision. The census then shows, district by district, whether the gap is closing.

New Zealand packages regional clusters into bookable long-haul itineraries and pairs regional operators with specialist global travel designers.[469] Its regions gain higher revenue per visitor and better seasonal resilience.[470] The lesson is to use Cape Town as a gateway that spreads value across the province through bookable regional experiences.[471] In communities, a booking route also needs a seller behind it. In Santa Marta in Rio de Janeiro, about 20 resident guides ran the tours by 2015 and kept selling after the launch programme ended.[472] The condition is connectivity, payment and a seller with a stake.

Link forward

Initiative I3, bookable province programme (section 4.3); the community booking routes run through **I12** (focus area 13). **Indicators** T2-04 share of operators bookable online and T2-05 CapeNature online booking share (section 5.2).

[465] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p93.
[466] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p32, p95; both pages describe the gap without counting it.
[467] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p33.
[468] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p26.
[469] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p55.
[470] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p55.
[471] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p51.
[472] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p7, p30.

3.1.2 Source market growth and diversification

The second theme is about which markets grow the base. It holds three focus areas: India and China, the fastest-growing markets, which reach the province through hubs; the mature long-haul markets; and regional Africa. Volume and value come from different groups, so each needs its own lever (section 2.2).

THEME 1.2 · SOURCE MARKET GROWTH AND DIVERSIFICATION · FOCUS AREA 4

Convert India and China hub traffic

About 101,000 Indian and Chinese travellers a year already reach Cape Town, mainly through Gulf and African hubs, and with no direct Indian route likely before 2030, converting that flow is the lever available now.

The opportunity

India and China grow fastest in the base case, at 8% a year to 2035, against 5% for the Middle East and Brazil in their acceleration group.[473] India and China start from a low base, at about 2.6% and 1.4% of South Africa's overseas tourists in September 2025.[474] The upside is large, and much of it is already in the air.

About 71,000 Indian and about 30,000 Chinese travellers reach Cape Town each year through Gulf and African hubs.[475] They fly with carriers whose Cape Town business is built on onward traffic. Nine in ten of Qatar Airways' Cape Town passengers connect through its hub, as do more than 80% of Emirates'.[476] Hub routes through Dubai, Addis Ababa and Doha run at 65.2% to 72.3% load, so they have room for more.[477]

The province is absent where these travellers decide. Both markets plan and book on their own platforms, where Western Cape product is hard to find (section 2.2). Access and product add friction. Cape Town has no direct flight to Mumbai or Delhi and thin Indian-friendly adaptation, while Chinese travellers face complex visas and few Mandarin-language services.[478]

What the evidence shows

Table 3.4. Evidence for focus area 4

India and China reach Cape Town only through hubs, and the direct route that would change that is at least five years away.

Finding	Figure	Source
India flies in through hubs	About 71,000 Indian travellers a year reach Cape Town via hubs; Addis Ababa and Dubai carry more than 80% of them	DSA p48; MIDAS, Indian Market
China flies in through hubs	About 30,000 Chinese travellers a year via Dubai, Addis Ababa, Doha and Singapore (MIDAS: 29,600 in 2025)	DSA p46; MIDAS, Chinese Market
No Indian route before 2030	Air India and IndiGo have no aircraft to spare before the end of the decade, and no South African airline can fly the sector	MIDAS, Indian Market; DSA p48
A Chinese route is a state decision	Chinese routes follow government-to-government agreements; Guangzhou is the likely start, with China Southern or China Eastern	MIDAS, Chinese Market
Hub routes have room	Load factor Dubai 72.3%, Addis Ababa 71.9% and Doha 65.2%, year to November 2025	MIDAS, Seasonality

[473] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p22.
[474] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p30.
[475] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p46, p48.
[476] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Seasonality".
[477] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Seasonality".
[478] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p51.

Finding	Figure	Source
Growth is fast from a low base	India 76,547 to 165,260 (88,713 more) and China with Hong Kong 43,412 to 92,598 (49,186 more), base case, 2025 to 2035	MA p22; DSA p23

Source: Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026 (DSA); MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026 (weighted GDS bookings, twelve months to November 2025); Market Assessment Report, May 2026 (MA, 2025 base). The 101,000 is the sum of the two printed estimates; the hub tables beneath them sum to 97,579 and carry no year.

The upside comes in two parts. The hub flow is available now, on routes with spare seats and carriers that gain from every connecting passenger. The direct route is not: the accelerated case depends on confirmed direct routes, and without them volume reverts to base.[479] This focus area therefore works the hub flow now and builds the route case for later.

The course of action

Wesgro should run India and China as conversion markets through the hubs and as relationship markets for the direct route. The money shifts toward trade-led conversion rather than broad awareness.[480] India needs early relationships with its carriers and authorities. China is a long-term investment in which awareness and indirect volume come before any non-stop service.[481]

The hub work comes first because it needs no new seats. Wesgro agrees joint market support with the three hub carriers in 2027, and activation on the Chinese and Indian platforms runs in market from 2028 (section 4.3). The direct route cases wait for runway capacity and go to carriers from 2032.

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Secure added frequency from Emirates, Qatar Airways and Ethiopian Airlines, with joint market support tied to Indian and Chinese sales	Air Access; hub carriers
Wesgro	Activate inside Xiaohongshu, Douyin and MakeMyTrip with market-specific itineraries and Trip.com packages	Destination Marketing; OTAs; trade
Wesgro	Build long-term route cases for the India and China corridors and keep a standing relationship with Indian carriers, China Southern and China Eastern	Air Access
Partners	Ready the product for both markets: Mandarin and Indian-language guiding, Alipay and WeChat Pay, visible vegetarian options	Product owners; attractions; hospitality bodies
National	Escalate visa processing for China and India, and the route designation for China that is decided government to government	Home Affairs; Department of Transport

Why it can work

Conversion works here because the travellers are already moving. Each Indian or Chinese visitor routed to Cape Town fills a seat the hub carrier already flies. The carrier gains from joint marketing without adding capacity. Activation inside the platforms where these travellers plan and pay reaches them at the point of decision, which broad awareness does not.

Singapore converts transit into visits through its Stopover Programme and Free Singapore Tour, run by the tourism board, Changi Airport Group and Singapore Airlines under one strategy.[482] It received 16.5 million international visitors in 2024 and record receipts of about S$29 billion, though no source isolates the programme's share.[483] The condition is visas and the hubs themselves. A Gulf hub disruption would cut connecting capacity, so the work spreads across Dubai, Doha, Addis Ababa and Istanbul (section 4.8).

[479] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p20.
[480] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p55.
[481] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "The Indian Market Opportunity", "The Chinese Market Opportunity".
[482] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p40.
[483] Singapore Tourism Board, Feb 2025.

Link forward

Initiative I4, India and China hub conversion (section 4.3), with the direct-route cases run under **I6** (focus area 7). **Indicators** T1-02 arrivals by market group at impact level and T2-06 India and China hub arrivals at outcome level (section 5.2).

THEME 1.2 · SOURCE MARKET GROWTH AND DIVERSIFICATION · FOCUS AREA 5

Increase yield in mature markets

The mature markets already pay the most and fill the fullest routes, so growth there comes from more value per visitor and more seats on existing routes, not from broad awareness campaigns.

The opportunity

The mature markets are where the province earns its premium. High-spend visitors come from Europe and North America, "tying future value growth to slower-growing source markets".[484] The mature group grows steadily to 2035, but more slowly than the hub and acceleration markets (section 2.2). Growth here comes from value per visitor more than from volume.

Value matters to the growth case because seats are scarce. Five mature long-haul routes already run above 80% load: Newark, Atlanta, Frankfurt, Heathrow and Washington.[485] The runway binds at the peak until relief arrives in about 2033 (section 2.3). Each extra rand per visitor on a full route is growth that needs no extra seat. Longer stays and travel beyond the Metro add value in the same way.

Two things stand in the way: carrier pricing and the province's own measures. On full routes, carriers are expected to raise fares rather than add new services, which "will frustrate that desire for increased visitors".[486] The province must therefore earn more per visitor without losing share. Yet its targets count arrivals, and spend per visitor by market is printed for a single year.

What the evidence shows

Table 3.5. Evidence for focus area 5

The highest-spending visitors come from the slowest-growing markets on the fullest routes.

Finding	Figure	Source
Five mature routes are full	Load factor Newark 88.6%, Atlanta 84.3%, Frankfurt 83.0%, Heathrow 83.0% and Washington 80.2%; eleven of the 27 tabled routes run above 80%	MIDAS, Seasonality
Carriers are expected to price first	Carriers on full routes are expected to seek higher fares rather than add services	MIDAS, In Conclusion
Mature visitors spend most	Average spend in the province USA R32,900, UK R26,500 and Germany R25,600, against Zimbabwe R8,500 (2024)	DSA p14
The province earns a premium	13% to 16% of national arrivals by quarter in 2025, but 20% to 27% of national foreign direct spend	DSA p11
Five markets dominate	The top five supplied 63% of overseas arrivals in 2025, and the UK, Germany and USA 52%	DSA p13
Growth is steady	Mature group 587,287 to 766,067 arrivals in the base case, 2025 to 2035	MA p21; DSA p22

Source: MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026 (year to November 2025); Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026 (DSA); Market Assessment Report, May 2026 (MA, 2025 base). No deliverable carries fare, revenue-per-seat or yield data.

The constraint is well documented; the lever is not. The five routes are full and their visitors pay most. Yet none of the work behind this report holds fare, revenue-per-seat or yield data. None models a yield uplift either. The yield lever rests on how carriers are expected to behave on full routes. This focus area therefore sets yield as an indicator to establish, not a target to hit, until spend per visitor by market is tracked every year [yield baseline: SAT spend per visitor by market as an annual series; only 2024 is printed].

[484] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p14.
[485] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Seasonality".
[486] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "In Conclusion"; a judgement of airline behaviour, not backed by fare data.

The course of action

Wesgro should protect share and raise value per visitor in the mature markets, and work the full routes for frequency and gauge before it chases new ones. Drawing these visitors beyond the Metro serves the same end while the growth markets develop.[487] There is tactical room for added frequency on some routes and larger aircraft from some airlines.[488]

The full routes come first. From 2027 Wesgro makes the frequency and gauge case to their carriers, because seats held now protect share until the runway relief arrives (section 4.3). Luxury-advisor distribution follows in 2028. Spend per visitor and length of stay join Wesgro's own targets from 2029, once the data-sharing protocol supplies them (focus area 18).

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Make the case to carriers on the five full routes for added frequency or larger aircraft, backed by green-season marketing	Air Access; airlines
Wesgro	Sell Discerning Connoisseur product through luxury advisors and high-end operators in the UK, USA, Germany, France and Switzerland	Destination Marketing; trade
Wesgro	Add a yield measure, spend per visitor by market with length of stay, beside arrivals in Wesgro's own targets	Research
Partners	Invest in premium product outside the Metro and in the midscale branded accommodation the province lacks (focus areas 11 and 15)	Accommodation investors; hospitality bodies
National	Escalate the cap on US carriers, the absence of an Open Skies agreement and the bilateral agreements that limit airlift	Department of Transport

Why it can work

Yield work suits full routes. When seats are scarce, a visitor who stays longer, travels further and spends more adds value without adding a seat. Selling to the highest-spending segment through luxury advisors lifts the average spend of the travellers the seats already carry. Full routes also give Wesgro a frequency case to put, though not a promise of seats, because carriers are expected to raise fares first.[489]

Kenya shows that value per visitor can outrun volume. With about 2.4 million arrivals in 2024, against Morocco's 17.4 million, Kenya earned about US$1,460 per international arrival. Morocco earned about US$630 and the Western Cape about US$890.[490] The condition is a measure. Without spend per visitor by market as an annual series, yield can be neither managed nor judged, so the data-sharing protocol comes first (focus area 18).

Link forward

Initiative I1, segment-led activation and yield in mature markets (section 4.3), with the frequency case run under **I6** (focus area 7). **Indicators** T1-03 direct foreign spend at impact level and T2-07 mature-market spend per visitor at outcome level (section 5.2).

[487] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p17.
[488] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "In Conclusion".
[489] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "In Conclusion".
[490] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p15.

THEME 1.2 · SOURCE MARKET GROWTH AND DIVERSIFICATION · FOCUS AREA 6

Build a regional foundation (Africa)

Regional Africa is the province's steadiest volume and its least developed premium market: Zimbabwe and Namibia supply 62% of African arrivals, while West African visitors spend the most per visit.

The opportunity

Africa is the province's nearest market and its steadiest. Namibia and Zimbabwe "add stability, repeat demand and counter-seasonal volume".[491] Regional trips are shorter in lead time and easier to convert, which helps the green season.[492] Africa is therefore both a base to keep and a market to grow (section 2.2).

The opportunity to 2035 is premium growth on top of that base. Nigerian and Ghanaian visitors spend as much per visit as visitors from the mature markets, from a far smaller base (section 2.2). Kenya's case rests on scale rather than spend. Its visitors spend R16,900 a visit, but its pool of 240,000 to 400,000 trips a year is second only to Nigeria's outside South Africa.[493] The growth model also gives it the strongest regional upside.[494] Cape Town is not a cold start in Nigeria or Kenya, where awareness of South Africa exists and needs converting rather than building from scratch.[495]

Access is the constraint. Routes to Luanda, Maputo, Gaborone, Harare and Mauritius run above 80% load, so added demand there meets full aircraft.[496] Visas add friction: the CTICC reports that regional African event demand is constrained by visa requirements.[497]

What the evidence shows

Table 3.6. Evidence for focus area 6

African demand is a Southern African volume base with two high-spending West African markets and regional routes above 80% load.

Finding	Figure	Source
A Southern African base	323,971 African arrivals across 16 markets in 2024; Zimbabwe and Namibia supplied 62%	DSA p27
Two high-spend markets	Spend per visitor Nigeria R31,000, Ghana R27,700 and Kenya R16,900 (printed averages; they do not reconcile with the printed totals); African visitors spent R4.2bn in 2025	DSA p29, p30
Regional routes are full	Luanda 86.2% and 83.4%, Maputo 83.3%, Gaborone 82.3%, Mauritius 81.8% and Harare 81.3%; MIDAS names all five markets for added capacity	MIDAS, Seasonality
The pool is large	Nigeria 310,000 to 510,000 and Kenya 240,000 to 400,000 addressable adult trips a year; Ghana 55,000 to 100,000	Skift African, s3
South Africa is considered	10.9% consideration share among Nigerian and 13.4% among Kenyan outbound travellers, second only to Dubai in Kenya	Skift African, s4.2, s4.3
Regional growth is steady	Regional group 292,514 to 402,812 arrivals in the base case, 2025 to 2035, with Kenya the strongest upside (nine modelled markets; the 16-market figure above is a survey total)	MA p20, p23; DSA p24

[491] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p14.
[492] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p31.
[493] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p29, p30; Skift African Market Analysis, 16 Mar 2026, s3.
[494] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p23.
[495] Skift African Market Analysis, 16 Mar 2026, s4.2, s5.
[496] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Seasonality".
[497] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p45.

Source: Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026 (DSA; SA Tourism 2024 Departure Survey and 2025 performance report); MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026 (year to November 2025); Skift African Market Analysis, 16 Mar 2026 (working analysis, by section); Market Assessment Report, May 2026 (MA). The printed spend averages do not reproduce from the totals and visitor counts on the same slide; the report quotes the printed averages.

Africa holds two different markets. A Southern African base delivers volume, while Nigeria and Kenya offer premium demand from a large addressable pool. Three cautions apply. Nigeria and Ghana have no row in the growth model, so no 2035 arrivals figure exists for the two highest-spending African markets [Nigeria and Ghana arrivals targets: not modelled; Wesgro Research to add both]. Ghana sits in the watch tier for brand seeding rather than conversion.[498] And regional travellers tend to stop in Johannesburg rather than continue to Cape Town.[499]

The course of action

Wesgro should run Africa as two markets: a regional volume base held through capacity and value, and a premium growth market in Nigeria and Kenya won through conversion. Nigeria is the priority for luxury, status-driven and conference travel. Kenya is the priority for business mobility and premium urban breaks, and both are reached through premium activation and the trade.[500]

The groundwork comes first. In 2027 Nigeria and Ghana enter the growth model, because the two highest-spending African markets have no targets yet (section 4.3). Premium activation in Nigeria and Kenya starts in 2028. The capacity case on the five full regional routes follows from 2029, made by Air Access once the route fund is running (focus area 7).

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Make the capacity case on the five full regional routes with Airlink, Ethiopian Airlines, Kenya Airways and the other regional carriers	Air Access (focus area 7); airlines
Wesgro	Run premium, trade-led activation in Nigeria and Kenya for leisure, weddings and conferences with leisure extensions	Destination Marketing; Convention Bureau; trade
Wesgro	Add Nigeria and Ghana to the growth model and commission consumer research for Botswana, Zambia, Ghana and Rwanda	Research
Partners	Convert rest-of-Africa travellers who stop in Johannesburg with onward packages, and give regional delegates leisure extensions	Cape Town Tourism; CTICC; tour operators; Cross-Border Road Transport Agency
National	Escalate visas for African markets, building on the Ghana visa waiver of November 2023, and liberalisation of regional air routes	Home Affairs; Department of Transport

Why it can work

The two-market approach matches the lever to the demand. On the five full regional routes, volume is capped by seats, so the capacity case is where it grows. Premium demand in Nigeria and Kenya already knows South Africa, which ranks second only to Dubai in Kenyan outbound consideration.[501] Activation converts that awareness rather than having to create it. Conferences with leisure extensions serve both, because business travel can help smooth demand across the calendar and event attendance can become longer stays.[502]

Kenya splits its demand in a similar way. Regional African markets drive its volume and business travel, while long-haul markets bring leisure demand and higher spend per visitor.[503] It draws 41% of its arrivals from Africa, mainly from Uganda and Tanzania.[504] Nairobi serves as East Africa's aviation, diplomatic and business hub through Kenya Airways' regional network.[505] Its arrivals grew 14.6% in 2024 to about 2.4

[498] Skift African Market Analysis, 16 Mar 2026, s5.
[499] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p35.
[500] Skift African Market Analysis, 16 Mar 2026, s5.
[501] Skift African Market Analysis, 16 Mar 2026, s4.3.
[502] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p17, p41.
[503] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p32.
[504] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p32.
[505] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p34.

million, against world growth of 11%.[506] The transferable changes are to treat MICE as a system lever and to align city, provincial and national actors around one gateway strategy.[507] The condition is seats and visas. Activation in Nigeria and Kenya converts only travellers who can get a visa and a seat.

Link forward

Initiative I5, regional Africa programme (section 4.3), with the regional capacity case run under **I6** (focus area 7). **Indicators** T1-02 arrivals by market group at impact level and T2-08 African arrivals and spend at outcome level (section 5.2).

[506] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p32; World Tourism Barometer, Jan 2025.
[507] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p35.

3.2 Pillar 2: Transform supply

Supply sets the ceiling on the growth case. The airport caps arrivals before its relief arrives, and outside the Metro the product exists but is hard to reach, book or stay in.

Pillar 2 removes the mobility, infrastructure and product constraints that limit how many visitors the province can carry and where they can go. Demand work in Pillar 1 fills seats only if the seats exist. It pays outside the Metro only if visitors can reach, book and stay in the product there (section 2.3).

The first constraint is the gateway. The growth model draws current air access as a line at 1.8 million inbound seats, and the base case crosses it at the 2030 year point.[508] The runway binds at peak hours before that.[509] The international terminal upgrade at Cape Town International is due about 2032 and the relocated runway about 2033.[510]

Transport is a connectivity and dispersal challenge, not a province-wide capacity crisis. Cape Town International is the key gateway risk.[511] Beyond the gateway, the constraint is reach and readiness. Accessibility to attractions and services falls from 4.7 out of 5 in the Cape Metro to 1.0 in the Central Karoo.[512] Only one touring route of six is rated Ready.[513]

The pillar holds two themes. The first is how visitors reach the province and move through it (focus areas 7 to 9). The second is what they find on arrival (focus areas 10 to 12).

Only the air entry needs more transport capacity. Cruise has room at the berth: it handled 83 calls in 2024/25 against a season capacity of 150 or more.[514] The flagship nature sites face a limit of a different kind, which calls for managing flows rather than adding volume (focus area 12). The other three entries concern reach, product and experience. The entries also have an order. Seats into the gateway come first; corridors, beds and booking then decide where growth lands (section 2.3). Visas, air service agreements and the runway are national levers, which the province leads by escalation in Pillar 3 (section 3.3.2).

By 2035 the pillar must do two things. It must hold and add seats on the full routes until runway relief arrives. It must also lift the share of arrivals and spend outside the Metro, by giving visitors product they can reach, book and stay in. Initiatives I6 to I11 deliver the six entries (section 4.3).

[508] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p21.
[509] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p101, p102.
[510] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p103.
[511] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p114.
[512] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p88 to p90.
[513] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p30, p40, p51, p62, p73, p84.
[514] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p110.

3.2.1 Accessibility, connectivity and infrastructure

The first supply theme covers how visitors reach the province and move through it. Air access and cruise bring visitors in, and internal mobility carries them beyond Cape Town.

THEME 2.1 · ACCESSIBILITY, CONNECTIVITY AND INFRASTRUCTURE · FOCUS AREA 7

Win direct routes and add seats on full routes

Eleven of 27 international routes run above 80% load and carriers are expected to price before adding seats, so the province must win frequency and larger aircraft before runway relief in about 2033.

The challenge

Cape Town International is the province's only international airport, so the growth case runs through one gateway.[515] On the growth model, seats run out before demand does, at the 2030 year point.[516] Growth to 2035 is therefore a supply programme before it is a marketing one (section 2.3).

Two limits bind before that line. The first is commercial. Cape Town's best routes already run full, and on the mature long-haul routes carriers are expected to raise fares rather than add services.[517] The second is physical. A single runway caps movements at about 30 an hour, and the relocated runway that lifts the cap is due about 2033.[518] ACSA's latest schedule is earlier, with the runway finished by December 2029, subject to contract award.[519] The phasing in Chapter 4 assumes about 2033 and treats the earlier date as upside.

Yet the province starts from strength. It added 17 mainline international routes between 2015 and 2025, more than any of eight peer airports.[520] The task is to hold and enlarge those routes until the runway arrives, and to have the next ones ready when it does.

What the evidence shows

Table 3.7. Evidence for focus area 7

> **The network is full on its best routes, the airport is full at its runway at peak, and planned relief lands after the base case crosses the model's seat line.**

Finding	Figure	Source
Routes are full	11 of 27 tabled routes above 80% load and 16 at 75% or more; network load 76.0%	MIDAS, Seasonality
Fares expected before seats	Carriers on full routes will seek higher fares rather than add services, though there is tactical room for added frequency and larger aircraft	MIDAS, In Conclusion
A record to build on	17 mainline international routes added from 2015 to 2025, ahead of Santiago (14), Valencia (12) and Calgary (8)	MIDAS, International Comparisons
A seat line in 2030	The model draws current air access at 1.8 million inbound seats; the base case crosses it at the 2030 year point (1,802,929)	DSA p21
Relief lands late	The single runway caps movements at about 30 an hour; ACSA's ~R11.3bn programme brings the international terminal about 2032 and the runway about 2033; ACSA's latest schedule shows the runway by December 2029	IR p101 to p103; ACSA, Aug 2026

[515] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p90.
[516] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p21.
[517] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "In Conclusion".
[518] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p101 to p103.
[519] ACSA, Q1 2026/27 presentation to the Portfolio Committee on Transport, Aug 2026.
[520] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "International Comparisons".

Finding	Figure	Source
Second gateways	George doubles by 2028 or 2029 (R310m, to about 2m passengers); Cape Winelands is an upside bet with no firm named carrier	IR p104 to p109

Source: MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026 (twelve months to November 2025; 76.0% is the printed network total and the 27 rows sum to 75.0%); Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026 (DSA); Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR).

The evidence describes a timing problem more than a demand problem. The fares forecast covers the mature long-haul routes only, and no fare data yet tests it.[521] The five regional markets that also run above 80% are named for more capacity.[522] The hub routes still have room, with Dubai at 72.3%, Addis Ababa at 71.9% and Doha at 65.2%.[523] On those routes marketing can still fill seats.

Relief also comes in the wrong order: "the certain fix is the latest, and the earliest big-capacity option is the least certain".[524] George doubles its capacity but flies domestic routes only, and Cape Winelands has no firm named carrier.[525] No airline is among the 16 organisations whose views this report draws on, so carriers' views on frequency and gauge are untested.[526]

The course of action

The approach splits the air agenda by horizon. Until runway relief arrives in about 2033, the job is to fill and enlarge what already flies. The near-term moves are added frequency from Emirates, Qatar Airways and Ethiopian Airlines, with airline incentives coordinated through Cape Town Air Access. Route cases for India and China are the long-term move.[527] Wesgro also presses for more seats to Luanda, Maputo, Gaborone, Harare and Mauritius, the five regional markets above 80%.

Cape Town Air Access's route fund becomes a ring-fenced public-private fund, designed in 2027 and 2028. It is then running when the regional frequency cases are made from 2029. The India and China cases go to carriers from 2032, as runway capacity arrives (section 4.3). ACSA delivers the runway and terminals, and Wesgro tracks them quarterly as the first risk. Air service agreements, the cap on US carriers and immigration processing sit with national government, so the province escalates them (section 3.3.2).

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Run a seat-retention and frequency programme on the full routes, with joint marketing tied to route performance	Air Access; Destination Marketing; airlines
Wesgro	Scale and ring-fence Cape Town Air Access's route fund as a public-private fund for route support, with a set size and governance	Air Access; DEDAT; City of Cape Town; private sector
Wesgro	Treat runway delivery as the first risk: track approvals and milestones quarterly and commission a capacity-against-demand model to 2035	Air Access; Research
Partners	Deliver the runway, terminals and George upgrade on the published dates; close the funding and name a carrier at Cape Winelands	ACSA; Cape Winelands Airport
National	Escalate bilateral air service agreements, the cap on US carriers and immigration processing at Cape Town International	Department of Transport; Home Affairs

Why it can work

The programme works on the airline's decision, not the visitor's. A carrier on a mature long-haul route seeks revenue through fares, yet there is tactical room for added frequency and larger aircraft.[528] Joint marketing and a ring-fenced fund lower the carrier's risk on extra capacity. The province then buys seats,

[521] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "In Conclusion".
[522] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Seasonality".
[523] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Seasonality".
[524] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p109.
[525] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p104 to p107.
[526] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p16.
[527] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p54.
[528] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "In Conclusion".

not higher fares. New Zealand tied marketing budgets to long-haul corridors and designed campaigns around airline breakeven. It reports more than 16,000 incremental bookings and a return of about NZ$55 million in 2023/24.[529]

Chile shows the infrastructure half. A private concession funded about US$900 million of expansion at Santiago, and international seats grew about 40% to 50% between 2013 and 2019 under open-skies agreements.[530] The route fund is the province's to scale; open skies and private airport finance are national levers, carried in the escalation agenda (focus area 19). The condition is the runway. If relief slips past about 2033, existing routes must carry growth for longer.

Link forward

Initiative I6, route development and seat retention with a public-private air access fund (section 4.3). **Indicators** T1-01 international arrivals at impact level, and T2-09 seats and routes and T2-10 seats added on full routes at outcome level (section 5.2).

[529] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p54.
[530] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p23, p25, p26.

THEME 2.1 · ACCESSIBILITY, CONNECTIVITY AND INFRASTRUCTURE · FOCUS AREA 8

Grow cruise calls and ports

Cruise brings about R1.79bn a year and Cape Town's berth took 83 calls against room for 150 or more, so growth comes from ships, excursions and day stops, not port capital.

The opportunity

Cruise has room to grow at the berth Cape Town already has. The equipped berth handled 83 calls in 2024/25 against a season capacity of 150 or more, and the season brought about R1.79bn of economic impact.[531] Growth here needs product and marketing, not capital works.[532]

Cruise also carries spend beyond the city. Cape Town anchors the itinerary, and Mossel Bay and Saldanha Bay can extend it east and west.[533] Stakeholders name home porting and expedition vessels as the segments that bring longer stays and higher local spend.[534]

What limits growth is ships and product, not berths (section 2.3). The equipped berth takes ships of up to 300m, the South-Easter delays berthing and there is no shore power.[535] Port capital goes to freight: Saldanha's R4bn iron-ore expansion and Cape Town's container expansion add no cruise capacity.[536]

What the evidence shows

Table 3.8. Evidence for focus area 8

Cape Town's berth has room, ship size and wind are the constraints, and port capital is going to freight.

Finding	Figure	Source
Calls and passengers	79 vessels and 127,178 passengers in 2024/25, up from 67 vessels in 2023/24	Diag p37
A berth with room	Cape Town's equipped berth took 83 calls in 2024/25 against a season capacity of 150 or more; R1.79bn economic impact	IR p110
Ship size and wind bind	300m maximum ship length at the equipped berth; the South-Easter delays berthing; no shore power	IR p110
Regional ports extend the route	Mossel Bay 21 calls and about 13,000 passengers, with a R22m reception facility opened in November 2025; Saldanha Bay 3 trial calls into an ore terminal	IR p111
Port capital is for freight	Cape Town's container expansion and Saldanha's R4bn iron-ore expansion add no cruise capacity; the R22m Mossel Bay facility is the only cruise capital	IR p112
Packaging works	Mossel Bay calls rose from four before COVID to 27 a season through closer coordination and better excursion packaging, with Wesgro credited	SIR p20, p21

Source: Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025 (Diag; Western Cape Cruise Liner Industry Economic Contribution 2024/25 Season, cited through the Diagnostic); Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR); Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR). The Diagnostic counts 79 vessels and the Infrastructure Report 83 calls for the same season; passengers and economic impact agree. Mossel Bay's 27 a season is its own figure; the Infrastructure Report prints 21.

The evidence sets a clear stance: protect Cape Town, back Mossel Bay now and watch Saldanha Bay.[537] Mossel Bay handled 21 calls in 2024/25, opened a new passenger facility in November 2025 and expects about 23 calls next season.[538] Yet ships anchor and tender there, and only small and mid-sized ships

[531] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p110; Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p37; the second counts 79 vessels for the same season.
[532] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p112.
[533] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p111.
[534] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p9.
[535] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p110.
[536] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p112.
[537] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p112.
[538] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p111.

call.[539] Saldanha Bay has no passenger facility. The regional ports work as day stops rather than home ports, so they spread spend rather than multiply the passenger total.[540]

A plan to grow to 250 calls a season has no source, horizon or definition in the evidence, so this report holds it open [plan to 250 cruise calls: source, horizon and definition to confirm with Cruise Cape Town]. At about 150 calls a season, Cape Town's berth could reach 250 only with a second berth, a longer season or the regional ports counted in (section 5.4).

The course of action

The approach works with the berth Cape Town has rather than waiting for a new one. Cruise Cape Town leads, and the sequence follows readiness. Line targeting and the Mossel Bay excursion packages are designed in 2027, together with a sourced definition of the 250-call plan. Marketing to expedition and home-porting operators follows in 2028, alongside community product on cruise-operator channels (section 4.3). Saldanha Bay waits until demand is proven, because its port capital serves iron ore.

The port itself stays with its owners. Transnet National Ports Authority and the V&A Waterfront hold berth scheduling, wind delays, shore power and the 300m limit. The national ask is that Transnet puts cruise into port planning, since current Western Cape port capital carries none.

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Market Cape Town to lines whose ships fit the 300m berth and to expedition and home-porting operators, with pre- and post-cruise stays	Cruise Cape Town; Destination Marketing
Wesgro	Back Mossel Bay now with packaged excursions and line marketing; keep Saldanha Bay on watch until demand is proven	Cruise Cape Town; Mossel Bay municipality
Wesgro	Put community and regional product on cruise-operator channels, starting with a bookable walk in the Knysna townships	Cruise Cape Town; LTOs
Partners	Manage berth scheduling and wind delays at Cape Town, plan for shore power and review the 300m limit	Transnet National Ports Authority; V&A Waterfront
National	Put cruise into port planning, since current Western Cape port capital carries no cruise capacity	Transnet

Why it can work

The actions match the constraint. The berth has headroom; the gaps are ship-size flexibility, weather reliability and tourism product.[541] Each line won with ships that fit adds calls without capital works. Packaged excursions give passengers more to buy ashore, and regional day stops spread that spend along the coast.[542]

The best precedent is local. On its own count, Mossel Bay's calls rose from four before COVID to 27 a season, supported by closer coordination and better excursion packaging.[543] The town credits its partnership with Wesgro.[544] No benchmark destination offers a cruise precedent, so the case rests on Mossel Bay. The condition is that today's ship deployments hold. Recent growth leans on Red Sea reroutes, and their reversal is the main risk.[545]

Link forward

Initiative I7, cruise growth through product (section 4.3). **Indicator** T2-11 cruise calls and passengers at outcome level, with the target held open until the 250-call plan is sourced (section 5.2).

[539] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p111.
[540] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p111, p112.
[541] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p112.
[542] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p112.
[543] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p20; the Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p111, prints 21 calls for 2024/25.
[544] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p21.
[545] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p110, p112.

THEME 2.1 · ACCESSIBILITY, CONNECTIVITY AND INFRASTRUCTURE · FOCUS AREA 9

Accelerate tourism-enabling internal mobility

Accessibility falls from 4.7 out of 5 in the Cape Metro to 1.0 in the Central Karoo, and beyond the Metro and the Garden Route the province is effectively car-only.

The challenge

Growth to 2035 has to spread beyond Cape Town, yet large parts of the province outside the Metro and the Garden Route are effectively car-only.[546] The N2 is the only continuous inter-regional tourism corridor, a single point of failure.[547] Limited public transport "restricts access for non-driving visitors and reduces the addressable tourism market".[548] Section 2.3 shows readiness and access falling with each step away from the Metro.

The problem is reach, not capacity.[549] Even in the Metro no rail line reaches the airport, and safety perceptions and limited visitor wayfinding hold back Metrorail's tourism potential.[550] Stakeholders call weak public transport, congestion and unreliable last-mile access structural barriers to visitor movement.[551]

No single body owns the visitor's journey. The Department of Mobility notes that mobility responsibilities are split across three tiers of government, and argues the case for a dedicated transport authority.[552]

What the evidence shows

Table 3.9. Evidence for focus area 9

Access falls away with distance from Cape Town, and the rail and road assets that exist are not run for visitors.

Finding	Figure	Source
Access decays with distance	Accessibility Cape Metro 4.7 (5.0 on transport), Cape Winelands 3.3, Garden Route 3.0, Overberg 2.0, West Coast 1.7, Central Karoo 1.0	IR p88 to p90
One corridor, mostly car-only	The N2 is the only continuous inter-regional tourism corridor; beyond the Metro and the Garden Route the province is effectively car-only	IR p98, p99
Rail exists but not for visitors	Metrorail runs 104 of 121 stations and 22.7m trips (FY2025), but no rail reaches the airport and the Southern Line's visitor branding dates to 2007	IR p100
The Metro's last mile is unfunded	MyCiTi Phase 2 (R3.3bn) does not reach Chapman's Peak, Constantia or Cape Point south	IR p32
No shuttles between towns	No inter-town shuttle on the Garden Route despite obvious demand; no public tourism transport between Hermanus, Stanford, Elim and Agulhas	IR p90, p67
Stakeholders rank it high	18 insight rows from 8 of 16 organisations, 10 rated High, including public transport and airport transfer times	SIR p22, p20 to p46

Source: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR; comparative regional analysis on a 1 to 5 scale); Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR; the theme count is reconstructed from the appendix tables, which print no tally).

The evidence shows transport assets that exist but are not run for visitors. The Cape Town to Simon's Town line is fully operational. The Southern Line runs through Muizenberg, Kalk Bay, Boulders and

[546] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p99.
[547] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p98, p99.
[548] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p99.
[549] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p114.
[550] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p98 to p100.
[551] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p10.
[552] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p23.

Simon's Town as a ready-made, low-cost scenic corridor.[553] Yet its visitor branding dates to 2007.[554] The gaps between towns are services rather than roads. The Garden Route has no inter-town shuttle despite obvious demand, and Hermanus, Stanford, Elim and Agulhas have no public tourism transport between them.[555]

The shuttle gap has a commercial fix. A shared shuttle needs demand aggregation and booking integration to work, as !Khwa ttu says of the West Coast.[556] Part of the answer is therefore within reach of a marketing and packaging body, while the rail and road assets stay with their owners.

The course of action

Wesgro does not build transport. It makes existing transport usable for visitors and gathers the demand that makes shuttles pay. The Department of Mobility leads the work, with Wesgro's Tourism unit. The Southern Line product, shuttle aggregation and transfers sold inside itineraries are piloted in 2027 and 2028. Shuttle products run from 2029, as the City and PRASA complete the Central Line recovery and MyCiTi Phase 2. The Cape Town to George rapid rail decision and the last mile to Cape Point come later in the period (section 4.3). National government is asked to lift the rule that bars bank-card payments on the George bus and to fund passenger rail beyond the Metro.

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Package the Southern Line as a visitor product, with refreshed branding and day passes	Tourism; Destination Marketing; City of Cape Town; PRASA
Wesgro	Aggregate demand and bookings for corridor shuttles, starting on the Garden Route and between Cape Town, Darling and the West Coast	Tourism; district municipalities; private operators
Wesgro	Sell the transfer inside the itinerary on the N2 and R62 routes, so visitors without a car can buy the trip	Destination Marketing; operators
Partners	Complete the Central Line recovery, MyCiTi Phase 2 and the unfunded last mile to Cape Point, with integrated ticketing	City of Cape Town; PRASA; Department of Mobility
Partners	Take forward the Cape Town to George rapid rail assessment and extend the George public transport model	Department of Mobility
National	Lift the national rule that blocks bank-card payments on the George bus, and fund passenger rail beyond the Metro	National government; PRASA

Why it can work

The mechanism is aggregation. A shuttle pays only at volume, and pooled bookings across operators, sold inside a multi-day itinerary, turn scattered requests into a load that can run. The Southern Line needs no new track to become a product, only branding, passes and marketing. Each step widens the market to visitors without a car, the market that limited public transport now narrows.[557]

None of the six benchmark destinations carries an internal mobility lever with figures.[558] Medellín shows the principle at city scale. A cable-car line carrying about 35,000 passengers a day and six outdoor escalators, built for Comuna 13's residents, became part of the visit. The area drew 1.98 million visitors in 2025, 52% of them international.[559] The Cape Winelands shows it at home: its heritage tram, built to connect wine estates, solves the drink-and-drive barrier.[560] The condition is shared ownership and an early

[553] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p100.
[554] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p100.
[555] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p90, p67.
[556] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p41.
[557] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p99.
[558] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p25, p27; the nearest is Chile's domestic air network, run as a designed portfolio linking Santiago to its regions.
[559] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p8.
[560] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p90.

capacity limit. The three tiers must run the visitor's journey as one, and trains must be safe enough to sell. Visitor caps must also come before the crowds, which in Comuna 13 they did not.[561]

Link forward

Initiative I8, corridor mobility (section 4.3). **Indicators** T1-06 share of arrivals and spend outside the Metro at impact level, and T2-12 accessibility score by district and T2-13 corridor transfer products at outcome level (section 5.2).

[561] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p8.

3.2.2 Product and destination capacity

The second supply theme covers what visitors find once they arrive: product beyond the icons, the quality of the stay and the limits of the flagship sites. The three focus areas work as a set. New product gives visitors a reason to travel outward, quality standards make that product safe to sell and flow management at the flagships sends the overflow to it.

THEME 2.2 · PRODUCT AND DESTINATION CAPACITY · FOCUS AREA 10

Support diversified route and product development

The province does not lack attractions; it lacks finished experiences around them, with assets outside the Metro left without guides, interpretation or bookable product and one touring route of six rated Ready.

The challenge

The growth case needs visitors to travel beyond the Cape Peninsula, stay longer and spend in more places. The province has the assets to support that. Of 50,332 mapped tourism assets, the Cape Metro holds 40.3% and the five other districts the rest.[562] The West Coast has the highest natural-asset attractiveness in the province and the Central Karoo its most unique niche assets.[563]

Yet both score lowest on readiness, and the product around the assets is unfinished (section 2.3). Eleven of 16 organisations engaged see the offer as concentrated around Cape Town and a narrow set of icons.[564] The Department of Economic Development adds that destination development has focused more on managing barriers than on building product outside the Cape Peninsula.[565]

Concentration costs the province twice. The flagships run full in season while Cape Point and the township attractions are underused.[566] Further out, strong product sits where visitors cannot easily reach or afford it.[567]

What the evidence shows

Table 3.10. Evidence for focus area 10

Assets are spread across the province, but product, packaging and investment stop at the core routes.

Finding	Figure	Source
Assets are spread	50,332 mapped tourism assets; the Cape Metro holds 40.3% and the five other districts the rest	IR p2, p23
Assets are not activated	Overberg and West Coast marine and wildflower assets have no guided tours, interpretation centres or bookable product; the Central Karoo and northern inland are attraction deserts	IR p93
Cold zones in every district	Industrial belts with zero tourism conversion in the Metro; the inland Garden Route north of the N2; the Rûens interior; large parts of the Central Karoo off the N1 transit core	IR p24, p35, p68, p79
One route is Ready	Cape Peninsula Ready; Garden Route, Cape Winelands, Whale Coast and Route 62 Developing; West Coast and Cederberg Emerging	IR p30, p40, p51, p62, p73, p84
No capital for product	Non-wine diversification in the Winelands is strategy, not committed capital; De Hoop lacks accommodation investment; Overberg year-round product is unfunded	IR p54, p76

[562] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p2, p23.
[563] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p88.
[564] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p11; the count is reconstructed from the appendix tables.
[565] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p24.
[566] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p24.
[567] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p89.

Finding	Figure	Source
Stakeholders see concentration	11 of 16 organisations raised the theme; the offer is seen as concentrated around Cape Town and a narrow set of icons	SIR p11

Source: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR; route ratings are approximate and the asset count carries no year); Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR; organisation count reconstructed from the appendix tables).

The evidence locates the constraint. It is less about creating new attractions and more about turning existing assets into complete, accessible visitor experiences.[568] Each route falls short on something different: accommodation and bookability on the West Coast, bookability on Route 62 and depth beyond Hermanus on the Whale Coast.[569] The Winelands and the Garden Route fall short only on safety (section 2.3).

No committed capital yet follows the gap.[570] No source counts the assets that have no product around them [assets with no bookable product or guided access, by district: needs the Wesgro supply database behind the 50,332 count]. The first design task is therefore to size the gap district by district.

The course of action

Wesgro works outward from strength. The Garden Route, the Cape Winelands and the Overberg already have strong underlying product and need connectivity, packaging and service depth.[571] Route 62 and the West Coast are packaged as slow-travel products. In 2027 and 2028 the Tourism unit designs bookable itineraries for all six touring routes. Delivery starts from 2029 on the Garden Route, the Cape Winelands and the Overberg, which are closest to ready. It moves to Route 62 and the West Coast once their product is online (focus area 3; section 4.3).

Stellenbosch and George can anchor regional business events, which gives the Convention Bureau a part to play.[572] The capital sits with others. Accommodation investors and municipalities add beds and service depth in secondary towns later in the period (focus area 15). SANParks carries the precinct projects, and rural broadband sits with national government (focus area 3).

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Package bookable multi-day itineraries on each of the six touring routes, delivering first on the Garden Route, the Cape Winelands and the Overberg, then Route 62 and the West Coast	Tourism; Destination Marketing; LTOs
Wesgro	Activate cold-zone assets with guided tours, interpretation and bookable product, beginning with the marine and wildflower assets	Tourism; CapeNature; SANParks; LTOs
Wesgro	Build regional conference offers in Stellenbosch and George, with stays before and after Cape Town events	Convention Bureau
Partners	Invest in accommodation and service depth beyond Hermanus, in Route 62's secondary towns and beyond Langebaan and Paternoster (focus area 15)	Accommodation investors; municipalities
Partners	Refresh flagship product: Robben Island beyond the prison tour; the Cableway's lower station	Robben Island Museum; Table Mountain Aerial Cableway
National	Complete SANParks precinct projects such as the R81.7m Agulhas lighthouse precinct	SANParks

Why it can work

The actions supply what the assets lack: a guide, a bed and a booking route. Packaging turns scattered assets into a trip a visitor can buy, and a multi-day itinerary gives a reason to stay outside the Metro. The Overberg shows both the pull and the limit. Its whale-watching anchor sustains operator confidence

[568] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p114.
[569] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p62, p73, p84.
[570] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p54, p76.
[571] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p114.
[572] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p41.

despite flat accessibility, yet De Hoop still lacks accommodation investment and year-round product is unfunded.[573]

Chile ran Santiago, Valparaíso, the wine valleys and Patagonia as one portfolio. It reports longer stays and shoulder-season revenue from the approach, though no figure is printed for either.[574] The change for the Western Cape is to sell experiences as curated journeys and move from asset marketing to experience-led packaging.[575] The condition is that the other entries keep pace. Itineraries sell only if the product can be booked (focus area 3), reached without a car (focus area 9) and stayed in. Without beds, a packaged route stays a day trip from Cape Town.

Link forward

Initiative I9, corridor product development (section 4.3). **Indicators** T1-06 share of arrivals and spend outside the Metro at impact level and T2-14 readiness by district at outcome level (section 5.2).

[573] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p75, p76.
[574] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p27.
[575] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p28.

THEME 2.2 · PRODUCT AND DESTINATION CAPACITY · FOCUS AREA 11

Align visitor experience in-destination

The province offers luxury estates and basic self-catering with no mid-scale branded tier between them, and service, interpretation and language readiness thin out with distance from Cape Town.

The challenge

The growth case needs visitors the current offer serves poorly. Province-wide, no midscale branded product sits between luxury estates and basic self-catering.[576] In the Winelands, a luxury-skewed product mix excludes mid-market and family segments.[577] The Garden Route is short of quality-graded hotels that anchor midweek, conference or business travel.[578]

The experience is weakest at the arrival gate and at the periphery. The international airport is the most negative node in Cape Town's online mentions.[579] Further out, readiness falls with distance from the Metro (section 2.3). Accommodation readiness drops from 4.7 in the Metro to 2.0 in the Central Karoo.[580]

The growth markets add their own needs. Chinese visitors find few Mandarin-language services. Indian visitors see little sign of vegetarian options or Indian-language guides. Gulf visitors find no Arabic-language booking or local-currency options.[581] These are the markets Pillar 1 courts, so the gaps sit on the growth path (section 3.1).

What the evidence shows

Table 3.11. Evidence for focus area 11

The experience breaks at the middle of the accommodation market, at the service counter and at the arrival gate.

Finding	Figure	Source
No mid-scale tier	Province-wide, no midscale branded product sits between luxury estates and basic self-catering; mid-market stock is effectively absent outside Stellenbosch	IR p95, p47
Accommodation range thins	Accommodation range Ready on three routes, Developing on the Whale Coast and Route 62 and Gap on the West Coast	IR p30, p40, p51, p62, p73, p84
A two-tier system	Strong product sits where visitors cannot easily reach or afford it; accommodation readiness 4.7 in the Metro against 2.0 in the Central Karoo	IR p89
Service is uneven	Mossel Bay calls restaurant quality and service a major weakness; CapeNature is wary of scaling international demand because service readiness is uneven	SIR p20, p43
Growth markets need adapting	Limited Mandarin-language services; little visibility of vegetarian options or Indian-language guides; no Arabic-language booking or local-currency options	DSA p51
The arrival is the weak point	The international airport is the most negative node in Cape Town's online mentions; immigration processing and peak-hour throughput need work	Diag p22; DSA p54

Source: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR); Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR); Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026 (DSA); Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025 (Diag; Mentionlytics sentiment data).

[576] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p95.
[577] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p53.
[578] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p95.
[579] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p22.
[580] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p89.
[581] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p51.

The evidence shows a gap in the middle of the market and at the service counter, not a shortage of premium product. Service quality worries the operators themselves: CapeNature is cautious about scaling international demand while service readiness is uneven across its sites.[582]

Two measures are missing. No source counts mid-scale rooms or beds by district [mid-scale room count by district: needs the Wesgro supply database or an accommodation audit], and none prints a visitor satisfaction score.

The course of action

The quality charter comes first, because it sets the standard the other actions aim at. DEDAT leads it with Wesgro's Tourism unit. It is a province-wide framework that aligns all tourism stakeholders under consistent benchmarks.[583] It is phased by district, with certification visible on booking platforms and support for SMMEs to comply.[584] Design runs through 2027 and 2028, and the district phases start in 2029 (section 4.3).

The investment case for mid-scale hotels follows the charter from 2029, so that investors build to a known standard (focus area 15). The arrival gate sits outside the province's reach: Home Affairs and ACSA hold immigration processing and peak-hour throughput at Cape Town International, so the province presses them.

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Prepare for growth markets: multilingual guiding, digital payments and culturally relevant product for Chinese, Indian and Gulf visitors	Tourism; Destination Marketing
Wesgro	Make the investment case for mid-scale and conference-capable hotels in George and Mossel Bay, east of Hermanus and on Route 62 (focus area 15)	Tourism; private investors
Partners	Set up a provincial quality charter, phased by district, with certification visible on booking platforms and support for SMMEs to comply	DEDAT, with Wesgro Tourism; industry bodies
Partners	Close service and interpretation gaps at named sites: Robben Island interpretation, CapeNature service readiness, restaurant quality in Mossel Bay	Attraction operators; municipalities; CATHSSETA
National	Improve immigration processing and peak-hour throughput at Cape Town International, and deliver the terminal relief due about 2032	Home Affairs; ACSA

Why it can work

A visible standard solves a problem of trust. A visitor booking a guesthouse on Route 62 cannot judge its service from abroad; certification shown on the booking platform can. The same standard gives small operators a clear target and a route to support, and it lets the province sell product outside the core with confidence.

Quality governance was Valencia's primary lever. Its Qualitur programme and SICTED quality system raised service consistency, reputation and repeat visitation.[585] The city received 3.5 million international visitors in 2024, 13.9% more than in 2023 and 24.4% above 2019.[586] Singapore's tourism board used a hotel industry transformation map, a hotel rejuvenation fund and the Hotels Act. The aim was to move from short stopovers towards longer stays and higher spend.[587] The condition is that small businesses can comply. The compliance burden and skills shortages are the main risks, so the charter needs SMME support from the start and the skills work in focus area 20.

[582] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p43.
[583] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p42; that source proposes Wesgro as lead.
[584] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p49.
[585] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p47.
[586] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p46; growth across all levers, not attributed to quality alone.
[587] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p41.

Link forward

Initiative I10, visitor experience and quality standards (section 4.3). **Indicator** T2-15 routes rated Ready at outcome level (section 5.2).

THEME 2.2 · PRODUCT AND DESTINATION CAPACITY · FOCUS AREA 12

Balance impact on nature-based attractions

Boulders is near carrying capacity and Cableway queues reach three hours, so growth at the flagship nature sites must come from managing flows and steering visitors to under-marketed reserves.

The challenge

The flagship nature sites carry the province's brand. Table Mountain, Robben Island and Kirstenbosch form the only globally branded landmark cluster, and the Metro holds five of the province's six highest-volume attractions.[588] In season they run full (section 2.3). Peak queues at the Cableway of up to three hours detract from the visitor experience.[589]

More volume at these sites is the wrong goal. The Department of Economic Development wants further growth directed to under-visited parts of the province rather than constrained flagships.[590] Yet the flagships congest at the peak while the overflow reserves remain under-marketed.[591]

Nature tourism also funds conservation. CapeNature cannot rely on public funding alone and treats tourism as a revenue business to support its conservation mandate.[592] Flooding, fire and heat are already closing CapeNature sites, so the reserves that should take the overflow are themselves under strain.[593]

What the evidence shows

Table 3.12. Evidence for focus area 12

The flagship sites are at or near their limits, the overflow reserves are under-marketed and climate is already closing sites.

Finding	Figure	Source
Boulders is near capacity	Some nature-based attractions, Boulders among them, are already near carrying capacity, so more volume there is undesirable (Department of Economic Development)	SIR p24
The summit cannot grow	Environmental restrictions limit permanent expansion on Table Mountain's summit; peak queues run up to three hours up and two hours down	SIR p36; IR p28
Overflow is under-marketed	Peak-season congestion at flagship sites while overflow reserves remain under-marketed	IR p88
Tourism funds conservation	CapeNature's ecotourism income pays for alien clearing, fire response and species protection, and public funding alone will not suffice	SIR p43, p44
Climate already bites	Flooding, fire and heat are closing CapeNature sites; weather cancellations cost Robben Island roughly R16m a year	SIR p43, p33
Seasonal windows are narrow	Whale season peaks from September to November; climate change threatens the predictability of the wildflower season	IR p67, p64

Source: Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR; insight statements by organisation, not quotations); Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR).

The evidence agrees on direction but lacks a baseline. Operators and the province state the limits, yet no source prints annual visitors or permitted capacity for Table Mountain, Boulders, Robben Island, Cape Point or Kirstenbosch [flagship visitor counts and capacity: request from SANParks, the Cableway,

[588] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p88.
[589] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p36.
[590] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p24.
[591] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p88.
[592] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p44.
[593] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p43.

Robben Island Museum and SANBI]. Without counts, the province cannot set caps, price the peak or show that steering visitors works. The first task is therefore a baseline.

The course of action

Wesgro stops marketing volume to the flagship sites and uses them as the hook that sends visitors elsewhere. The Peninsula route's own opportunities are to disperse visitors beyond the highest-volume attractions and to expand shoulder-season experiences.[594] The baseline comes first. In 2027 and 2028 Wesgro's Research unit asks the five flagship sites for visitor counts and capacity, while destination marketing promotes the alternatives (section 4.3).

The site operators hold the flow tools, from digital flow management to tiered pricing.[595] From 2029 the operators bring these tools to the Cableway and Boulders, where mandates allow. Later in the period CapeNature makes reserve product climate-resilient. SANParks carries the national step: a visitor management plan for Table Mountain National Park and Boulders, agreed with the City and the operators.

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Market Cape Point, the under-used reserves and the Southern Line to Muizenberg, Kalk Bay and Simon's Town as alternatives to peak-hour visits at the Cableway and Boulders	Destination Marketing; CapeNature; SANParks; PRASA
Wesgro	Request visitor counts and capacity for the five flagship sites and publish them as the baseline	Research; site operators
Wesgro	Report spend per visitor and length of stay for nature product alongside visitor numbers	Research
Partners	Introduce digital visitor-flow management at the Cableway and Boulders, with tiered pricing where mandates allow	Table Mountain Aerial Cableway; SANParks; CapeNature
Partners	Make reserve product climate-resilient by reassessing asset formats and siting	CapeNature
National	Agree a visitor management plan for Table Mountain National Park and Boulders with the City and the operators	SANParks

Why it can work

Flow management protects the visit and the revenue together. Digital flow tools and tiered pricing spread arrivals across the day and the season. A site then serves its visitors without a three-hour queue and earns more at the peak. Marketing the alternatives at the point of booking sends the overflow to the under-marketed reserves, and their income pays for conservation there.

New Zealand uses land-use controls and premium curation on the principle that capacity discipline protects long-term pricing power.[596] Kenya treats conservation as national economic infrastructure, with tourism-funded conservation financing and community conservancies that sustain demand and environmental integrity.[597] The City already runs the model at small scale. Since August 2025 Witzands permits have been capped by day, and 80% are pre-booked online.[598] The condition is the operators. They must share their counts, and their mandates must allow pricing: CapeNature's statutory affordability mandate has kept its prices conservative, and CapeNature is now moving towards tiered pricing.[599]

Link forward

Initiative I11, flagship site demand management (section 4.3). **Indicator** T2-16 peak queue at the Cableway at outcome level, with flagship visitor counts added once the baseline is in hand (section 5.2).

[594] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p30.
[595] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p3; Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p44.
[596] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p55.
[597] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p33.
[598] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p41.
[599] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p44.

3.3 Pillar 3: Build enabling capability

Pillar 3 decides whether the other two can be delivered and shared: who benefits, who pays, who decides and who measures.

Pillar 3 sets out to build an inclusive, well-governed tourism system that supports sustainable growth, returns and development. The other two pillars depend on it. Demand work fills seats and supply work opens the regions, but neither lasts unless someone owns the decisions, pays for the assets and counts the results. Section 2.4 found that system thin at each point the action plan relies on.

Each question starts from a gap. On who benefits, 20 township and rural communities hold 18.4% of the province's residents but receive a traced 0.02% to 0.04% of foreign direct spend.[600] On who pays, the capital pipeline funds airports, ports, roads, rail and the Metro waterfront, but almost none of it reaches regional product, bookability or community assets.[601] On who decides, visas and air service agreements sit with national government, and mobility mandates are split across three tiers.[602] On who measures, no approved methodology exists for provincial tourism GDP and jobs.[603]

Two themes and eight focus areas carry the pillar. The first theme, investment, inclusion and sustainability, settles who benefits from growth, how it is paid for and how it lasts. It gives community product a local seller, manages climate risk through funded local bodies and builds an investment pipeline that follows demand (focus areas 13 to 15). The second theme, governance and leadership, settles who decides and who measures. It aligns the three tiers of government, turns industry forums into one joint plan and agrees how data is shared (focus areas 16 to 18). The same theme holds two further focus areas. Focus area 19 takes the national deficits in infrastructure, visas and safety to the tier that holds them. Focus area 20 commissions the labour analysis a skills plan will rest on.

The eight entries work as a sequence, not a menu. Governance starts alongside the first seat and bookability moves (section 3.4). Steerco, the data-sharing protocol and the escalation agenda start in the first quarter of 2027, because every other initiative reports through them (section 4.2). The community pilots start in the same phase, with booking routes shared with focus area 3 and safety plans drawn from focus area 19. Climate risk, local tourism funding, the investment pipeline and the labour analysis spend 2027 and 2028 on design. Each first needs a baseline or a case that does not yet exist. Capital for product and community assets comes last. It follows demand that the pilots and the regional product have shown, not the reverse (section 2.1).

The evidence behind the pillar is mostly qualitative. It rests on statements attributed to the 16 organisations with recorded insights, a one-page table of what each tier holds, the community profiles and the district gap tables.[604] The pillar therefore carries more open items than the other two. Several entries start by building the baseline they will be judged against.

By 2035 the pillar must leave the province able to deliver its growth and share it. Visitor spend should reach the communities, measured against a reference point of 1% of foreign direct spend, R259m a year at FY2025 levels (section 5.3). Local tourism bodies should hold stable funding, and tourism projects should reach financial close. The national tier should answer the province's asks, and the province should count its own tourism jobs and spend. Initiatives I12 to I18 carry the eight focus areas, with focus areas 16 and 17 sharing one forum in I15 (section 4.1).

[600] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p5.
[601] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p32 to p87, p100, p112.
[602] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p58; Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p23.
[603] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p37.
[604] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p20 to p46; Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p58; SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p20 to p28; Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p32 to p87.

3.3.1 Investment, inclusion and sustainability

The first enabling theme covers who benefits from growth, how it is paid for and how it lasts. It holds three focus areas: community inclusion, climate risk and investment. The inclusion model is set out at concept level, and Chapter 4 assigns its roles and funding.

THEME 3.1 · INVESTMENT, INCLUSION AND SUSTAINABILITY · FOCUS AREA 13

Embed local destination bodies for community inclusion

Twenty communities hold 18.4% of the province's residents but receive only a small documented share of foreign direct spend, and in eleven the binding constraint is organisation, not distance or product.

The opportunity

Community inclusion decides whether growth to 2035 is shared. Inclusion here means visitor activity inside the community: a tour, a meal, a bed or a market. A resident commuting to a hotel job in town counts for little or nothing.[605] On that measure the province starts near zero. Foreign visitors spent R25.9bn in FY2025, and the 20 shortlisted communities received a documented floor of R4m to R10m of it.[606]

The prize is large. At 1% of FY2025 foreign direct spend, the 20 communities would receive R259m a year; at 1% of the 2035 spend ambition, R547m.[607] Both are reference points, not adopted targets (section 5.3). The visitors are already close, and organisation rather than distance keeps their spend out (section 2.4).

Inclusion also widens what the province sells. SATVITO finds that more township and village product could widen market reach and lift visitor spend, yet negative safety perceptions of the townships hold demand back.[608] The opportunity opens only to a community that can sell and a visit that is safe.

What the evidence shows

Table 3.13. Evidence for focus area 13

The shortlisted communities sit close to visitors but earn almost nothing from them, and most lack a body that can sell.

Finding	Figure	Source
Close to demand	93 of 107 long-listed communities lie within 45 minutes of a tourism node or corridor; distance is the binding constraint in none of the 20	SCIP p16, p30
Almost no spend	18.4% of residents (Census 2011) against a traced floor of 0.02% to 0.04% of foreign direct spend, about R4m to R10m a year	SCIP p5
Organisation binds	Organisation is the binding constraint in 11 of 20 communities, and 10 have no identified active tourism body	SCIP p28, p30
Product sells by phone	No profiled community rates Ready on digital and bookability; Zwelihle's four resident guides sell by phone with no shared channel	SCIP p20 to p26, p34
Safety is a gate	9 of 20 communities record a safety-perception gap and 5 record extortion (SAPS 2025/26 station data)	SCIP p27, p30
The prize	1% of FY2025 foreign direct spend is R259m a year, about 26 to 65 times today's documented floor	SCIP p5

[605] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p4.
[606] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p11; SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p5.
[607] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p5.
[608] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p34.

Source: SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026 (SCIP; desk research 17 to 23 September 2026, ratings from the community side with LTO confirmation outstanding). The R259m is 1% of the R25.9bn FY2025 foreign direct spend in the Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p11. The plan does not describe how the spend floor was traced. The multiple of today's floor is computed.

The evidence places the main gap in selling, not proximity. Organisation binds in 11 of the 20 communities, attraction in six and distance in none.[609] No profiled community yet rates Ready on digital and bookability.[610] The spend floor is uncertain, because the method behind it is not yet shown. [Open item: the Inclusion Plan to set out how the R4m to R10m floor was traced.]

The cases set the order of action: a seller with a stake, then a safe and workable visit, then product that keeps spend in the community and only then exposure.[611] Kliptown in Soweto shows the cost of the reverse order. Walter Sisulu Square cost R160 million to R180 million, out of the R436 million first allocated to Kliptown, before an operator was in place (section 2.1).[612] By 2017 it drew about 4,000 museum visitors a year, against a business case of almost 200,000 international visitors.[613] Safety is the second gate. In Rio, security collapsed in 2017 and public support was withdrawn early.[614] Nine communities record a safety-perception gap and five record extortion, so every pilot needs a site-specific safety plan before launch.[615]

The course of action

Wesgro should connect community product to the demand it already moves, and leave the building of selling bodies to municipalities, LTOs and the communities themselves. The model has three parts: a selling capability that works, a link to demand that already exists and gates that must be passed before activation and investment.[616] The four gates are a site-specific safety and access plan, a viable operating model, an operating budget and a maintenance and marketing covenant.

In 2027 Wesgro and its partners choose two or three pilots on readiness and agree who funds a seller with a stake in each. Safety plans follow in the same year (section 4.3). In 2028 each pilot opens one live booking route and runs a fixed-date test, and Wesgro places the product in its itineraries and calendars. Investment follows demand, and pilots scale from 2029 only once bookings, local spend, delivery and safety meet thresholds agreed before launch.[617]

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Put pilot community product into the itineraries, calendars and channels Wesgro already runs, such as the Langa and Kayamandi routes and the Mal'va festival listing	Tourism; Destination Marketing
Wesgro	Choose the two or three pilots with partners on the plan's readiness criteria, and keep the record of bookings, visitors and locally retained revenue	Research; Tourism
Partners	Form or fund a local selling body in each pilot community, with one live booking route, published dates and a named customer contact	Municipalities; LTOs; community sellers
Partners	Attach maintenance and marketing covenants to public assets before any re-letting or upgrade	Municipalities
National	Commit SAPS to the launch safety plans the pilots need, and open ACSA and other national procurement to businesses trading inside the communities	SAPS; ACSA

[609] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p30, p53 to p58.
[610] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p20 to p26, p40 to p51.
[611] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p12.
[612] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p11.
[613] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p11.
[614] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p7.
[615] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p27, p35.
[616] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p32.
[617] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p31, p32.

Why it can work

The model supplies the missing piece and little else. Demand already passes within minutes of most communities. A local seller with a booking route turns that passing demand into bookings, and the gates stop capital from arriving before visitors do. The seller records bookings, visitors and locally retained revenue, so each pilot can be judged on its results.[618]

Resident sellers have outlasted the programmes that launched them. In Rio de Janeiro's Santa Marta, about 20 resident guides ran the tours by 2015 and outside jeep firms had left.[619] Medellín's Comuna 13 drew 1.98 million visitors in 2025 around resident-run product.[620] On Vilakazi Street in Soweto, residents opened Sakhumzi in 2001 with four employees; it employed about 110 by 2019.[621] The condition is a seller that survives without a sponsor. Costa Rica's community network turned over more than USD 800,000 in 2013 and did not survive donor exit, dissolving at the end of 2018, though the record names no single cause.[622] The lesson drawn there is an entity with its own selling channel and a succession plan that does not rest on a donor.[623] Most first moves carry no budget line, and the LTOs that would carry a seller depend on municipal funding that Circular 131 has disrupted (focus area 14).[624] No pilot launches until a named municipality or partner has funded its seller.

Link forward

Initiative I12, community inclusion pilots (section 4.3), with booking routes shared with **I3** (focus area 3). **Indicators** T1-07 community share of foreign direct spend at impact level and T2-17 communities with a live booking route at outcome level (section 5.2).

[618] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p33.
[619] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p7, p30.
[620] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p8.
[621] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p9.
[622] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p10.
[623] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p10.
[624] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p36.

THEME 3.1 · INVESTMENT, INCLUSION AND SUSTAINABILITY · FOCUS AREA 14

Manage climate risk and sustainable tourism

Climate is already costing the province sites, routes and revenue, while the local tourism bodies that would manage the response depend on municipal funding that MFMA Circular No. 131 has disrupted.

The challenge

Growth to 2035 rests on sites and routes that weather can close, and the losses already fall on the flagship sites (section 2.4). Each district carries its own climate risk, from water security on the Garden Route to extreme summer heat in the Central Karoo.[625] Water scarcity acts as a hard ceiling on visitor load in high-growth nodes such as the Garden Route.[626] A risk spread across every district needs an owner in each.

Yet the bodies that should manage the response locally are the weakest link. The Department of Economic Development rates Western Cape and Cape Town funding for destination management and marketing materially below peer destinations. It also finds that most local tourism organisations (LTOs) cannot sustain operations without municipal funding, which MFMA Circular No. 131 has disrupted.[627] A body unsure of next year's budget cannot plan for a flood or a fire season.

What the evidence shows

Table 3.14. Evidence for focus area 14

Climate losses are dated and site-specific, and the bodies that manage destinations locally have no stable funding.

Finding	Figure	Source
LTOs depend on municipalities	Most local tourism bodies are not operationally sustainable without municipal funding, and MFMA Circular No. 131 has disrupted that route (Department of Economic Development)	SIR p25
LTO budgets go to marketing	LTO contracts and budgets are weighted toward destination marketing, leaving little for tourism development (West Coast District Municipality)	SIR p39
A flood cut a route	Meiringspoort closed since the flood of 6 May 2026; rebuild R421m over about 26 months; De Rust's pass-through trade cut; a temporary one-lane reopening is targeted for December 2026	SCIP p24; Western Cape Government, Jul 2026
Weather costs a flagship	Weather cancellations cost Robben Island roughly R16m a year, on management's estimate	SIR p33
Sites are closing	Flooding, fire and extreme heat are closing CapeNature sites and restricting trails; high winds close the Cableway for a significant part of the year	SIR p43, p36
Every district has a climate risk	Water security in the Metro and the Garden Route; drought, heat and fire in the Cape Winelands; wildflower predictability on the West Coast; whale migration and sea levels in the Overberg; summer heat in the Central Karoo	IR p31, p64, p75, p86; Diag p43, p45

Source: Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR; statements attributed to organisations, not quotations); SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026 (SCIP); Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR); Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025 (Diag). No deliverable quantifies climate risk province-wide.

The evidence is dated and site-specific, but it does not add up to a provincial picture. No source puts a provincial figure on tourism revenue at risk from weather or water [provincial estimate of tourism revenue at risk: none in hand]. None counts the LTOs or their grant funding [number of Western Cape LTOs and

[625] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p43; Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p86.
[626] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p38.
[627] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p25.

their municipal funding before and after Circular 131: DEDAT to supply]. The LTO funding finding rests on two organisations, the Department of Economic Development and the West Coast District Municipality.[628]

The response exists in pieces. Mossel Bay's membership inspections check water-wise and green practices, the only working sustainability standard on record.[629] CapeNature is reassessing asset formats and siting to cut losses from flooding, fire and extreme weather.[630] What is missing is a provincial record of losses and a stable owner for local destination management.

The course of action

Wesgro should treat climate as a destination-management risk it records and plans around, and press for stable funding of the local bodies that do the work. In 2027 and 2028 DEDAT and Wesgro's Research unit build a climate and weather risk register for sites and routes, starting with the dated losses (section 4.3). They also design an LTO funding model that answers Circular 131. Wesgro routes itineraries around Meiringspoort while it is closed. From 2029 funding agreements with a development mandate are signed, and routing around closures draws on the register. The quality charter carries sustainability checks on the Mossel Bay model (focus area 11). From 2032 climate risk and LTO funding sit in municipal IDPs, with reporting.

The register comes first, because routing, funding and capital choices all depend on knowing which sites close and how often. Three districts then have positions to build on: the Cape Winelands as a climate-smart wine region, the Overberg as a nature-positive test bed and the Garden Route as a case for resilience investment.[631]

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Keep a climate and weather risk register for tourism sites and routes, starting with the Robben Island, Cableway and CapeNature losses and the Meiringspoort closure	Research; DEDAT; site operators
Wesgro	Build sustainability checks into the provincial quality charter (focus area 11) on the Mossel Bay model	Tourism; LTOs
Wesgro	Route itineraries and marketing around closures, starting with alternatives to Meiringspoort until the pass reopens	Destination Marketing; Garden Route and Klein Karoo LTOs
Partners	Give LTOs a stable funding agreement with a development mandate, written into IDPs with reporting	Municipalities; district municipalities; DEDAT
Partners	Make reserve and attraction assets climate-resilient, with off-grid power at remote sites	CapeNature; site operators
National	Resolve the effect of MFMA Circular No. 131 on municipal funding of local tourism bodies, and complete the Meiringspoort rebuild	National Treasury; the road authority

Why it can work

The register turns scattered losses into decisions. Some losses already carry a figure: weather cancellations cost Robben Island roughly R16m a year, and the Meiringspoort rebuild costs R421m.[632] Once losses are dated and costed by site, Wesgro can route itineraries around a closure and operators can weigh resilience spending against the loss it avoids. Stable funding works on the other half. An LTO with a multi-year agreement and a development mandate can plan for a fire season, not only the next campaign.

The evidence diagnoses this risk more than it prescribes for it. No comparator carries a climate-adaptation or local funding lever, so the precedents are partial. Kenya finances conservation from tourism, a self-

[628] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p25, p39.
[629] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p21.
[630] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p43.
[631] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p45, p49, p43.
[632] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p33; SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p24.

financing system that supports conservation and sustains tourism demand.[633] Valencia runs its SICTED quality system with environmental compliance frameworks, and counts a stronger reputation for quality and sustainability among the results.[634] Mossel Bay's inspections show the same checks can work at town scale. The condition is national. Until the effect of Circular 131 is resolved, the funding agreements the plan needs rest on uncertain ground.

Link forward

Initiative I13, climate resilience and destination management, including LTO funding (section 4.3).
Indicators T2-18 LTOs with a funding agreement and T2-19 weather losses at flagship sites at outcome level (section 5.2).

[633] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p33.
[634] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p47.

THEME 3.1 · INVESTMENT, INCLUSION AND SUSTAINABILITY · FOCUS AREA 15

Crowd in capital with targeted investment strategies

The province's capital pipeline funds airports, ports, roads, rail and the Metro waterfront, but almost none of it reaches regional product, bookability or community assets, where the growth case needs investment.

The challenge

The growth case needs capital where the current pipeline does not reach. Visitors who travel beyond the Metro need beds, a booking route and finished product. The communities need assets a local seller can run. Yet committed capital closes the air gaps, not the regional ones (section 2.3). The province does not lack capital works. It lacks capital aimed at tourism outside the Metro.

Tourism funding is also tight, and below peer destinations (focus area 14). Fiscal pressure is prompting consideration of a tourism levy.[635] The Department of Mobility sees a need for climate, development, blended-finance and private-sector models to fund tourism-enabling mobility.[636] Much of the product gap will therefore fall to private capital, which moves only where a case is ready.

The accommodation gap shows what is at stake. Province-wide, no mid-scale branded product sits between luxury estates and basic self-catering, and the Garden Route is short of quality-graded hotels for midweek, conference and business travel.[637] Mossel Bay reports that limited upper-upscale hotel capacity, particularly a recognised brand able to host conferences, holds back its higher-value and business demand.[638]

What the evidence shows

Table 3.15. Evidence for focus area 15

Capital is committed to gateways and transport, and each district's tourism gaps carry no committed capital.

Finding	Figure	Source
The Metro pipeline	About R30bn or more planned: ~R11.3bn at Cape Town International, R20bn for the V&A Granger Bay expansion and R3.3bn for MyCiTi Phase 2; SME bookability and township product sit outside every capital programme	IR p32
Airports are funded	R310m George terminal by 2028; Cape Winelands Airport ~R8bn private phase 1, with funding not yet locked in	IR p43, p106
Tourism gaps are not	No committed capital for West Coast accommodation and payments, De Hoop accommodation, Whale Coast bookability, Overberg year-round product or Route 62 accommodation	IR p65, p76, p87
Port capital is for freight	Of the port capital listed, only the R22m Mossel Bay reception facility is for cruise	IR p112
Funding is below peers	Western Cape tourism funding is materially below peer destinations, and a tourism levy and blended finance are under consideration	SIR p25, p23
Capital first fails	Kliptown's Walter Sisulu Square cost R160m to R180m before an operator and drew about 4,000 museum visitors a year by 2017	SCIP p11

Source: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR; the ~R11.3bn CTIA headline itemises to R9.94bn on p103); Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR); SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026 (SCIP). No deliverable gives a Western Cape tourism funding-gap figure.

[635] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p25.
[636] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p23.
[637] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p94, p95.
[638] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p21.

The evidence shows a gap in direction as much as in volume. The district tables list a large capital pipeline, and their gap columns show that none of it reaches regional product, SME bookability or township product. That finding is an inference from the tables rather than a printed statement, and no source gives a Western Cape tourism funding-gap figure [Western Cape tourism funding against the peer set: DEDAT and Wesgro budget data needed]. Kliptown is the warning case: capital built before an operator earned no operating income (section 2.1).

No scored list of tourism investment opportunities exists yet. The district gap-closure tables are its ready input: each names a gap, where it sits and whether any capital is committed to it. Scoring them for return, jobs and inclusion turns a list of needs into a ranked pipeline.

The course of action

Wesgro should build the tourism investment pipeline the gap tables imply, and commit public capital only where demand has been shown. In 2027 and 2028 Wesgro's investment promotion team scores the gaps for return, jobs and inclusion and prepares the first investment cases (section 4.3). These cover mid-scale and conference-capable hotels in secondary nodes and accommodation at De Hoop and on Route 62. From 2029 it takes the cases to investors, and DEDAT and the City of Cape Town test a tourism levy and blended-finance vehicles. The pipeline is refreshed each year.

One rule runs across the portfolio: invest after demand, and attach a maintenance and marketing covenant to any public asset before it is let or upgraded.[639] The order matters. A levy or a blended-finance vehicle needs projects to fund, so both are tested only once the first cases exist.

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Build a tourism investment pipeline from the gap-closure tables, scored for return, jobs and inclusion, and take it to investors	Wesgro investment promotion; Tourism; DEDAT
Wesgro	Prepare investment cases for mid-scale and conference-capable hotels in secondary nodes and for accommodation at De Hoop and on Route 62	Wesgro investment promotion; private investors
Wesgro	Scale Cape Town Air Access's route fund into the public-private air access fund, with ring-fenced corridor budgets (focus area 7)	Air Access; DEDAT; City of Cape Town; private sector
Partners	Test a tourism levy and blended-finance vehicles for destination management and mobility	DEDAT; City of Cape Town
Partners	Attach covenants to public assets before re-letting or upgrading them, and invest in community assets only after demand is proven	Municipalities
National	Hold ACSA, PRASA and Transnet to their published capital dates, and add tourism use to the port plans	ACSA; PRASA; Transnet

Why it can work

A scored pipeline lowers the cost of finding a deal. Investors see ranked cases with demand evidence attached, rather than a list of district needs. Investing after demand reverses the Kliptown sequence, and covenants keep a public asset maintained and marketed after it opens. Wesgro has brokered community-linked capital before, though outside tourism. It brokered IDC funding for the Doringbaai abalone farm in 2015; the village trust holds 37% and the farm employs about 50.[640]

The comparators pair public direction with private capital. Chile funded about US$900 million of expansion at its gateway airport through a private concession awarded by its Ministry of Public Works.[641] Melbourne paired its event strategy with 21% growth in hotel rooms, 5,000 new rooms and the entry of global hotel

[639] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p31, p15.
[640] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p25.
[641] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p26.

brands.[642] The condition is demand first. Beds in secondary nodes pay only if the routes, events and booking work in Pillars 1 and 2 bring visitors to them.

Link forward

Initiative I14, tourism investment pipeline (section 4.3). **Indicator** T2-20 pipeline projects at financial close at outcome level (section 5.2).

[642] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p18.

3.3.2 Governance and leadership

The second enabling theme covers who decides, who measures and how the plan is run. It holds five focus areas. Three build the means of joint decision: three-tier alignment, collaboration with industry and shared policy and data (focus areas 16 to 18). Two apply them to specific gaps. Focus area 19 escalates the national deficits in infrastructure, visas and safety. Focus area 20 builds workforce skills on a labour analysis still to be commissioned.

THEME 3.2 · GOVERNANCE AND LEADERSHIP · FOCUS AREA 16

Align institutional stakeholders across all three tiers

Air service agreements and visas sit with national government, mandates are split across three tiers and the national marketing body is under strain, so the province needs one shared agenda with clear decision rights.

The challenge

The levers the growth case needs are spread across three tiers of government, and none of them answers to one plan. The national tier holds visa rules, air service agreements and route rights. The province holds jobs, safety programmes and infrastructure planning. Local government holds basic services and precinct management.[643] The levers that bind growth most sit nationally (section 2.4). The province must therefore move decisions it does not make.

The bodies that should carry this work have thinned. The Department of Economic Development finds that tourism institutional capacity has eroded over a decade at provincial and municipal level.[644] Even working partnerships lapse. FEDHASA reports that the Discover Garden Route MOU has expired, and that Knysna municipality's non-participation limited its reach.[645] Without one provincial voice, each ask reaches the national tier from several directions or not at all.

What the evidence shows

Table 3.16. Evidence for focus area 16

The levers the growth case needs are spread across three tiers, and the bodies that hold them are thin or out of step.

Finding	Figure	Source
National holds air rights and visas	The national tier holds visa rules and border compliance, and air service agreements and route rights; the province holds jobs, safety programmes and infrastructure planning	Diag p58
Bilateral agreements bind	Restrictive bilateral air agreements limit airlift and leave the province less competitive than peers (Department of Economic Development)	SIR p24
Chinese routes are state decisions	Chinese routes follow government-to-government agreements, and the designated airline may learn of its designation late	MIDAS, Chinese Market Opportunity
Capacity has eroded	Tourism institutional capacity has eroded at provincial and municipal level over a decade; SA Tourism's weakness constrains otherwise sound international strategies	SIR p25
Mandates are split	Mobility responsibilities are split across three tiers; a district, local and LTO mandate disconnect leaves tourism development without a clear owner	SIR p23, p39

[643] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p58.
[644] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p25.
[645] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p31.

Finding	Figure	Source
The capital is national	ACSA's runway (R6.39bn, about 2033), Transnet's port plans and PRASA's R21.1bn rail programme all sit with national SOEs	IR p100, p103, p112

Source: Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025 (Diag); Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR; statements attributed to organisations, not quotations); MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026; Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR). The only national government bodies with an appendix table in the first phase of engagement, Stats SA and the Department of Tourism, speak to data alone; SA Tourism has none.

The evidence agrees on the problem and is thin on the fix. What is needed is "a shared growth agenda with clear decision rights and joint delivery plans".[646] No source maps decision rights by tier beyond one summary table. The national tier is barely heard: the Department of Tourism and Stats SA spoke only to data, and SA Tourism has no recorded view.[647] The first task is therefore to hear the national tier directly and write down who decides what.

The course of action

Wesgro should convene the shared agenda and hold the evidence the national tier needs, rather than try to own levers it cannot. In the first quarter of 2027 the Wesgro CEO's office and DEDAT constitute a Tourism Growth Steerco (section 4.2). Wesgro's CEO and DEDAT's Head of Department co-chair it, with Cape Town Tourism as a standing member (section 4.7). Steerco agrees a decision-rights map by tier and tables the first national escalation agenda (focus area 19). It gives the province one voice and one route to national decisions.

Route work runs alongside, inside existing agreements, through standing relationships with Indian carriers and authorities and with China's state-owned carriers (section 4.4).[648]

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Constitute the Tourism Growth Steerco, co-chaired with DEDAT and with Cape Town Tourism as a standing member, and agree a decision-rights map by tier, building on the tier split in section 1.2	Wesgro CEO's office; DEDAT; Cape Town Tourism
Wesgro	Hold standing relationships with Indian carriers and authorities, with China Southern and China Eastern and with Riyadh Air	Air Access
Wesgro	Track the national capital programmes that bind the plan (runway, ports and rail) and report on them each quarter	Air Access; Research
Partners	Settle district, local and LTO mandates, restore a tourism development function where it has lapsed and revisit the Discover Garden Route partnership	District municipalities; municipalities; LTOs
Partners	Test a dedicated transport authority model for tourism-enabling mobility	Department of Mobility
National	Agree with the province how marketing and data roles divide between national and provincial bodies	SA Tourism; Department of Tourism

Why it can work

Alignment works by settling ownership before it is contested. A decision-rights map shows each tier what it owns, so provincial and local bodies stop waiting on decisions that are theirs to make. One forum then speaks for the province, so national bodies receive one position rather than several. Where the comparators name the body that negotiates air service agreements, it is national: Chile's civil aviation board and Singapore's aviation authority.[649] The province's lever is evidence and alignment, not authority.

Coordination across tiers works where it is permanent. A public-private structure led by Visit València embeds municipal, provincial and regional authorities in one decision-making system.[650] The change

[646] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p58.
[647] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p16, p30, p37.
[648] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "The Indian Market Opportunity", "The Chinese Market Opportunity".
[649] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p23, p38.
[650] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p47.

asked of the Western Cape is to embed tourism governance in permanent public-private structures.[651] Yet coordination strains even among the leaders: in Victoria, roles and branding remain a source of tension between national and state bodies.[652] The condition is national engagement. The plan works only if the national tier takes part in Steerco's agenda and answers its asks, which section 5.2 tracks.

Link forward

Initiative I15, Tourism Growth Steerco and three-tier alignment, carries this entry with focus area 17 (section 4.3). **Indicator** T2-21 escalation items answered by the national tier at outcome level (section 5.2).

[651] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p49.
[652] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p16.

THEME 3.2 · GOVERNANCE AND LEADERSHIP · FOCUS AREA 17

Strengthen industry and government collaboration

Fifteen of the sixteen organisations heard raised collaboration, and the channels already exist in JAMS, the bid teams and the tour-operator forums, so the task is to turn existing forums into one joint plan.

The opportunity

Collaboration is one of the two concerns stakeholders share most widely, and the channels for it already work. Fifteen of the 16 organisations heard raised it, as many as raised data sharing (section 2.4).[653] FEDHASA reports that Western Cape tourism associations already coordinate through JAMS with Wesgro, the Western Cape Government and the City of Cape Town.[654] C-BRTA cites biannual tour-operator forums, and the Department of Tourism cites statistics committees that already convene public and private stakeholders.[655] The province does not need another forum. It needs the forums it has to plan together.

Joint work already pays where the task is concrete. Mossel Bay's cruise calls rose from four before Covid to 27 a season, supported by closer coordination and better excursion packaging.[656] The town credits its public-private tourism model with faster decisions.[657] The CTICC finds the same on bids: destination stakeholders collaborate effectively on bid development and international event attraction.[658]

Growth to 2035 needs that discipline applied to development, and here the system falls short. The West Coast District Municipality finds provincial and regional forums dominated by destination marketing rather than development.[659] Operators are represented only through LTOs and business chambers, so private participants are sometimes unaware of tourism plans and projects.[660] The Department of Economic Development reports that misalignment between public tourism institutions and key industry bodies is weakening collaboration.[661]

What the evidence shows

Table 3.17. Evidence for focus area 17

Collaboration is wanted almost everywhere and already works in places, but the forums are marketing-led and the trade's voice is missing.

Finding	Figure	Source
Almost everyone raised it	15 of the 16 organisations raised at least one collaboration insight, 23 rows in all	SIR p20 to p46
A channel exists	Tourism associations already coordinate through JAMS with Wesgro, the Western Cape Government and the City of Cape Town (FEDHASA)	SIR p31
Out of step	Misalignment between public tourism institutions and key industry bodies is weakening collaboration (Department of Economic Development)	SIR p25
Forums are marketing-led	Provincial and regional forums are dominated by destination marketing rather than development, and support is not tailored to districts (West Coast District Municipality)	SIR p39

[653] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p20 to p46; a rough count of organisations with at least one collaboration insight, taken from the appendix tables by organisation and not weighted by insight row.
[654] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p31.
[655] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p28, p37.
[656] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p20.
[657] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p21.
[658] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p46.
[659] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p39.
[660] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p39.
[661] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p25.

Finding	Figure	Source
Joint selling works	Stakeholders collaborate well on bids; 36 conference bids secured in 2024/25 are expected to bring 27,000+ delegates and R745 million by 2028	SIR p46; DSA p36
The trade is missing	No airline, OTA or tour operator gave a recorded view	SIR p16

Source: Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR; organisation count reconstructed from the appendix tables); Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026 (DSA).

The record describes a system that collaborates to sell and stalls when it must plan. Joint work succeeds on a bid, a cruise call or a route, where the task is bounded and the payoff shared. It weakens on development, where no forum owns the agenda and operators sit one step removed. The airlines and distributors that fill the seats are also absent. No airline, online travel agency or tour operator gave a recorded view.[662]

The course of action

Wesgro uses the forums that exist and gives them a development agenda and one joint plan. In 2027 it adopts JAMS as the single channel to the associations, because FEDHASA expects consultation through it to cascade more efficiently than approaching each body separately.[663] It adds the Tour Guides Association, so frontline operators have a voice.[664] Sector councils for wine, business events, adventure and culture are designed inside Steerco's structure (section 4.7) and run from 2029 (section 4.3).

Partners carry the regional and bidding work. District municipalities, DEDAT and the LTOs give regional forums a development agenda and tailor provincial support to district needs. The CTICC and the universities supply the academic and sector champions on whom international bids depend.[665] Nationally, the province asks SA Tourism to include provincial assets in its campaigns for emerging source markets, which Robben Island Museum also seeks.[666] From 2029 the joint industry plan is agreed and reviewed each year.

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Use JAMS as the single consultation channel to the associations, and add the Tour Guides Association	Wesgro CEO's office; FEDHASA
Wesgro	Set up sector councils for wine, business events, adventure and culture inside Steerco's structure	Tourism; Convention Bureau; industry bodies
Wesgro	Bring airlines, online travel agencies and tour operators into the joint plan, starting with Trip.com Group, Thomas Cook India, dnata Travel, China International Travel Service and Emirates	Destination Marketing; Air Access
Partners	Supply academic and sector champions for international bids	CTICC; universities
Partners	Give regional forums a development agenda and tailor provincial support to district needs	District municipalities; DEDAT; LTOs
National	Include provincial assets in SA Tourism's campaigns for emerging source markets	SA Tourism

Why it can work

A joint plan gives each forum a decision to make, not just information to exchange. Sector councils give wine, business events, adventure and culture a standing seat, so the market, not officials, sets development priorities. Shared targets already pay here. Cape Town secured 36 conference bids in 2024/25, expected to bring more than 27,000 delegates and R745 million in economic impact through 2028.[667] Cape Town also added 17 mainline international routes from 2015 to 2025, more than any of

[662] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p16.
[663] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p31.
[664] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p31.
[665] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p46.
[666] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p33.
[667] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p36.

eight secondary airports in the comparison. That record is credited to Wesgro's commercial and relationship-driven route development.[668]

Valencia shows the model at destination scale. Sector-led executive committees, with the regional business confederation on the governing board, keep tourism development market-driven rather than bureaucratically led.[669] Valencia received 3.5 million international visitors in 2024, 24.4% above 2019.[670] That performance is credited to governance that is decentralised, sector-led and embedded across the destination.[671] Singapore's tourism board, airport group and national airline work under one coordinated strategy with shared KPIs.[672] The condition is commitment from industry. The plan holds only if the associations and the trade sign up, so the number of partners signed up is its measure of success (section 5.2).

Link forward

Initiative I15, Tourism Growth Steerco and three-tier alignment (section 4.3). **Indicator** T2-22 industry partners signed up to the joint plan at outcome level (section 5.2).

[668] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, "Executive Summary", "International Comparisons".
[669] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p45, p48, p49.
[670] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p46.
[671] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p60.
[672] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p40, p42.

THEME 3.2 · GOVERNANCE AND LEADERSHIP · FOCUS AREA 18

Expedite tourism-enabling policy and data sharing

No approved method exists for provincial tourism GDP and jobs, operators cannot see their own customers and the arrivals series run unreconciled, so a data-sharing protocol is the precondition for every target.

The challenge

The province cannot yet measure what the plan sets out to grow. The Department of Tourism reports no approved method for provincial tourism GDP and jobs estimates. Official tourism GDP and employment data have also lagged since Covid-era method changes, it adds.[673] Data sharing draws more stakeholder insights than any other theme, as section 2.4 shows. Bodies from Stats SA and SA Tourism to ACSA, the airlines and the card schemes produce tourism data. Yet they collect different metrics at different frequencies with different definitions.[674]

Every target to 2035 depends on fixing this. The plan tracks spend, season and spread beside arrivals. No source yet prints visitor spend by district (section 5.3). Even arrivals are counted in ways that are not reconciled. Section 1.2 sets out three measures: ACSA passenger arrivals, SA Tourism tourist arrivals and the growth model's international arrivals. OAG's air series adds a fourth count.[675] Without a shared data layer, no intervention can be targeted or measured.[676]

Policy and the operators' own data are as thin. The Department of Economic Development reports a provincial tourism policy gap, with limited legislation and out-of-date master-planning frameworks.[677] At the sites, third-party ticketing channels do not share visitor-level data with the Table Mountain Aerial Cableway.[678] Robben Island Museum cannot link its marketing spend to visitor acquisition.[679]

What the evidence shows

Table 3.18. Evidence for focus area 18

Data is the largest theme in the stakeholder record, and the gaps run from national methodology to operators' own customer records.

Finding	Figure	Source
The largest theme	15 of 16 organisations and 30 insight rows, the most of any theme, 16 of them rated High	SIR p20 to p46
No provincial method	No approved methodology for provincial tourism GDP and jobs; official tourism data lag after Covid-era method changes (Department of Tourism)	SIR p37
National capacity is short	Tourism satellite account timeliness is constrained, with 749 Stats SA vacancies cited	SIR p30
No single view	No single view of visitor behaviour; stakeholders collect different metrics at different frequencies with different definitions	Diag p56, p57
Operators cannot see customers	Third-party ticketing channels do not share visitor-level data; Robben Island cannot link marketing spend to visitor acquisition	SIR p36, p33
Platforms exist	JAMS, the provincial tourism statistics committees and a cross-agency task team exist; the Cape Town Tourism and Google collaboration is still exploratory	SIR p29, p30, p31, p37

[673] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p37.
[674] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p56, p57.
[675] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p11, p13, p20, p27.
[676] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p5.
[677] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p25.
[678] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p36.
[679] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p33.

Source: Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR; organisation count reconstructed from the appendix tables); Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025 (Diag).

The evidence locates the gap in sharing, not in supply. Provincial macro-research is strong; what is missing is granular data on movement within regions and conversion along the path to purchase.[680] The platforms to share it exist in JAMS, the statistics committees and a cross-agency task team. None of them holds an agreement on what each body shares, in what form and how often. No source describes a data-sharing protocol or a policy revision in progress at provincial level [data-sharing protocol or policy revision in progress, with owner and start date: Wesgro Research and DEDAT to confirm].

Part of the gap is national and beyond the province's reach. Stats SA cites 749 vacancies as one factor that appears to slow the tourism satellite account.[681] The province can agree terms with data holders now. A recognised provincial jobs and GDP method needs the Department of Tourism.

The course of action

Wesgro's Research unit agrees data-sharing terms with each data holder and runs one indicator register and dashboard, as section 5.5 sets out. In 2027 it builds the register and agrees terms with ACSA, SA Tourism, Stats SA, Cape Town Tourism, the site operators and the booking platforms. In 2028 the dashboard goes live with automated arrivals, seat and cruise feeds and quarterly digital tracking (section 4.3). The dashboard sets campaign results against airline capacity and hotel trends, and annual or twice-yearly brand research sits beside it.[682] Wesgro also starts to measure meetings, incentives and exhibitions. Meetings are absent from consolidated provincial statistics, and the scale of the other two is unverified.[683]

Partners and the national tier hold the rest. Attraction operators and CapeNature share visitor-level data from their ticketing and reservation systems. DEDAT and the municipalities close the provincial policy gap and embed tourism in IDPs and spatial plans, with reporting, as the West Coast District Municipality asks.[684] Nationally, the province asks the Department of Tourism to approve a provincial tourism GDP and jobs methodology and Stats SA to resource the tourism satellite account.

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Agree data-sharing terms with ACSA, SA Tourism, Stats SA, Cape Town Tourism, the site operators and the booking platforms	Research
Wesgro	Run one indicator register and dashboard, with quarterly digital tracking and annual brand research	Research; programme office
Wesgro	Measure meetings, incentives and exhibitions	Research; Convention Bureau
Partners	Close the provincial tourism policy gap and embed tourism in IDPs and spatial plans, with reporting	DEDAT; municipalities
Partners	Share visitor-level data from ticketing and reservation systems	Attraction operators; CapeNature
National	Approve a provincial tourism GDP and jobs methodology and resource the tourism satellite account	Department of Tourism; Stats SA

Why it can work

A protocol fixes definitions once, so the data the province already has begins to add up. The arrivals measures can be bridged, so each is read against the others and the growth model is checked against counted arrivals. Spend and spread gain a district baseline. Operators who see their own customers can

[680] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p56, p57.
[681] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p30.
[682] Skift Digital and Search Insights memo, 10 Dec 2025, section 6.
[683] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p36.
[684] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p39.

price, target and report, which gives them a reason to share. The dashboard also gives Steerco one set of facts, so collaboration (focus area 17) argues over decisions rather than numbers.

New Zealand shows what shared data can support. Data shared between tourism bodies and airlines is one of four enablers of its route-accountable marketing, with airport readiness, route incentives and co-investment tied to route KPIs.[685] That marketing reports more than 16,000 incremental bookings and a return of about NZ$55 million in 2023/24.[686] Valencia is the realism check: integrating data systems across institutions there can create technical and organisational challenges.[687] The condition is consent. Each data holder must sign, so the number of agreements signed is the first measure of progress (section 4.3).

Link forward

Initiative I16, data-sharing protocol and visitor intelligence (section 4.3). **Indicator** T2-23 automated data feeds in the dashboard at outcome level (section 5.2).

[685] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p54.
[686] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p54.
[687] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p45.

THEME 3.2 · GOVERNANCE AND LEADERSHIP · FOCUS AREA 19

Lead removal of infrastructure, visa and safety deficits

Visas, air rights, the runway and policing sit with national government, so the province leads by escalation backed with evidence, and delivers the safety programmes and basic services that are its own.

The challenge

Visas, air rights, airport capacity and policing shape how many visitors reach the province and how safe they feel. The province holds few of these levers. National government holds visa rules, border compliance and air service agreements. The province holds safety programmes and local government holds basic services.[688] ACSA, a national body, holds the runway (section 2.4). Escalation is therefore the province's main tool for the national share.

The deficits bear hardest on the markets the growth case needs. Chinese and Middle Eastern travellers face slow, document-heavy visa processes.[689] The Table Mountain Aerial Cableway cites visas as a constraint on growth from India and recovery from China, and the CTICC on regional African events.[690]

Inside the province, safety and basic services gate both visits and community growth. Nine of the 20 shortlisted communities record a safety-perception gap and five record extortion. A formal safety assessment remains a separate requirement before any community product launches.[691] Congestion costs the Metro an estimated R2.8 billion a year, and water scarcity acts as a hard ceiling on visitor load in high-growth nodes.[692] Here the province and the municipalities hold part of the answer.

What the evidence shows

Table 3.19. Evidence for focus area 19

Ten of the 16 organisations raise the deficits, and most of the levers sit with national government or SOEs.

Finding	Figure	Source
Raised widely	10 of 16 organisations raised the theme; across all themes, safety perception came from seven organisations, visas from four and utilities from four	SIR p20 to p46
Visas hold back growth markets	Visa issues constrain growth from India and recovery from China; regional African event demand is visa-constrained	SIR p36, p45
Safety is cross-cutting	Perceptions of crime feature in overseas sales conversations; township product and shared mobility are held back by safety perception	SIR p46, p34, p22
Safety and visas top the barriers	Skift's barrier research ranks crime and personal safety first and visa and entry requirements second; e-visa reforms are promising but unproven for the province	Diag p55, p34
The gateway binds	The single runway caps movements at about 30 an hour; terminal relief lands about 2032 and runway relief about 2033; immigration processing at peak needs work	IR p101 to p103; DSA p54
Visa reform is credited with arrivals	Ghanaian arrivals to South Africa reached 36,656 in 2024; the source credits the visa waiver but prints no earlier year	Skift African, s4.6

Source: Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR; organisation counts reconstructed from the appendix tables); Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025 (Diag; Skift, Barriers to visiting Cape Town, 2024, as cited); Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR); Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026 (DSA); Skift African Market Analysis, 16 Mar 2026 (working analysis; arrivals to South Africa, not Cape Town).

[688] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p58.
[689] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p51.
[690] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p36, p45.
[691] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p30, p35.
[692] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p38.

Stakeholders raise the deficits widely. Ten of the 16 organisations raised them, and safety perception alone came from seven.[693] Yet even this evidence, broad as it is, is statement rather than measure. No visa processing time is in hand for any priority market (section 5.2).

National reform can move arrivals. Ghanaian arrivals to South Africa reached 36,656 in 2024, a level the source credits to the visa waiver without printing an earlier year[694] [Ghana visa waiver start date, given as 1 November 2023 and as 2024: Wesgro Research to confirm]. E-visa expansion and the Trusted Tour Operator Scheme are promising, but their effect on Western Cape arrivals is not yet proven.[695] The province's task is to make the case for reform in its own markets, with its own numbers.

The course of action

Wesgro runs a standing escalation agenda at Steerco. Each item names the decision, the national body that owns it and the date the province asks for. The first agenda is tabled in 2027 (section 4.3). It covers visa categories and processing for China, India, the Middle East and Africa. It also covers air service agreements and immigration throughput at Cape Town International. Wesgro's Research and Destination Marketing units build the evidence for each ask, market by market. Stakeholder insights already point to the evidence needed: the safety issues most damaging to demand and the access barriers across air, visas and onward travel.[696]

The province delivers its own share in parallel. The Western Cape Government, the municipalities and SAPS set up the dedicated tourism safety units and programmes the Metro needs.[697] Safety compacts follow in pilot communities. Municipalities and CapeNature fix basic services, water and connectivity at remote reserves and in tourism towns. Wesgro carries a visitor-safety narrative in its marketing. It applies the four launch gates set in focus area 13 to any community product it sells. From 2029 responses to the national asks are logged and followed up each quarter.

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Table an escalation agenda at Steerco: visa categories and processing for China, India, the Middle East and Africa; air service agreements; immigration throughput at Cape Town International	Wesgro CEO's office; DEDAT
Wesgro	Build the market-by-market evidence for each ask, from visa processing times to safety perception in source markets	Research; Destination Marketing
Wesgro	Carry a visitor-safety narrative in marketing, and apply the four launch gates set in focus area 13 to any community product Wesgro sells	Destination Marketing; Tourism
Partners	Set up dedicated tourism safety units and programmes, with safety compacts in pilot communities	Western Cape Government; municipalities; SAPS
Partners	Fix basic services, water and connectivity at remote reserves and in tourism towns	Municipalities; CapeNature
National	Decide on visa processing, air service agreements and immigration counters, and make station security a rail line item	Home Affairs; Department of Transport; PRASA

Why it can work

Escalation works when the ask is specific and the evidence is local. The method has already moved decisions taken elsewhere. Cape Town added 17 mainline international routes from 2015 to 2025, more than any of eight secondary-airport peers, a record credited to Wesgro's commercial and relationship-driven route development (focus area 17). A standing agenda keeps each ask alive across budget cycles, so a refusal becomes a follow-up rather than an end. It also gives coordination one anchor. Chile's coordination is most powerful when anchored around a single strategic constraint, long-haul access.[698]

[693] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p20 to p46, counted.
[694] Skift African Market Analysis, 16 Mar 2026, s4.6; arrivals to South Africa, not Cape Town.
[695] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p34.
[696] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p14.
[697] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p41.
[698] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p59.

Action on its own share, from safety units to basic services, strengthens the province's hand when it asks others to act.

Chile shows what national access policy can achieve. It runs one of the world's most liberal aviation systems, using open-skies agreements, strong aviation institutions and private sector participation.[699] Passenger traffic at Santiago's airport rose from about 16 million in 2010 to more than 26 million in 2019.[700] For the Western Cape, the lesson is to lobby actively for air service liberalisation and simplified visa regimes.[701] Kenya reduces entry friction to position Nairobi as a regional hub.[702] No comparator shows a region escalating to its national government, so the province's own record is the first real test. The condition is a national answer. The province cannot compel one, so it measures what it can: visa processing times in priority markets and the share of its asks answered (section 5.2).

Link forward

Initiative I17, access and safety escalation agenda (section 4.3). **Indicators** T2-24 visa processing time for priority markets and T2-21 escalation items answered at outcome level (section 5.2).

[699] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p23.
[700] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p25, p26.
[701] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p28.
[702] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p59.

THEME 3.2 · GOVERNANCE AND LEADERSHIP · FOCUS AREA 20

Develop workforce and service skills

The 300,000 tourism-linked jobs ambition has no baseline and no labour analysis behind it, so the first step is to commission that analysis, and the skills plan follows from it.

The challenge

The province cannot yet count the jobs that growth is meant to create. The ambition of 300,000 tourism-linked jobs is one of four headline ambitions, with no base year, baseline or target year. No labour analysis sits behind it.[703] The Department of Tourism reports that no approved methodology exists for provincial tourism GDP and jobs estimates.[704] This focus area therefore rests on analysis still to be commissioned. Section 2.4 sets out why a jobs baseline must come before a jobs target.

Jobs matter to the action plan as much as arrivals. Wesgro's mission is to drive inclusive and sustainable growth and create jobs in Cape Town and the Western Cape.[705] Service quality also rests on people. Mossel Bay names inconsistent restaurant quality and service delivery as a major weakness.[706] CapeNature is cautious about scaling international demand because service readiness is uneven across its sites.[707]

Yet skills gaps surface only in passing. CapeNature finds low baseline skills in communities near reserves, which need substantial upskilling before they can meet service standards.[708] The West Coast District Municipality reports stretched municipal officials, and the Overberg calls for substantial mentoring and business support.[709] Each is a statement, not a measure.

What the evidence shows

Table 3.20. Evidence for focus area 20

No deliverable carries a provincial tourism employment figure, and the skills evidence is a handful of statements and two training programmes.

Finding	Figure	Source
The ambition has no base	300,000 tourism-linked jobs, one of four headline ambitions, with no base year, baseline or target year	Inc p4
No provincial method	No approved methodology for provincial tourism GDP and jobs estimates (Department of Tourism)	SIR p37
Skills gaps near reserves	Low baseline skills in communities near reserves need substantial upskilling before service standards can be met (CapeNature)	SIR p43
Municipal capacity is stretched	Local municipalities face skills and staffing constraints, and skills support is not tailored to districts (West Coast District Municipality)	SIR p39
Training exists in places	20 CATHSSETA site guides certified in Mbekweni in August 2026; a hospitality academy in Prince Albert from early 2026	SCIP p42, p51
One provincial series	1,234 direct cruise jobs in the Western Cape in 2024/25, the only provincial tourism jobs figure in a deliverable	Diag p37

Source: Inception Report, Nov 2025 (Inc); Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR); SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026 (SCIP); Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025 (Diag; Western Cape Cruise Liner Industry Economic Contribution 2024/25 Season, as cited). The 2024/25 jobs value equals the 2022/23 GDP value in the same table, so the source study should be checked before the figure is used as a baseline.

[703] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p4.
[704] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p37.
[705] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p5.
[706] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p20.
[707] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p43.
[708] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p43.
[709] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p39, p27.

The evidence holds parts but no whole. The only provincial tourism jobs figure the evidence prints is 1,234 direct cruise jobs in 2024/25. Its source study needs checking before it serves as a baseline.[710] Public sources give the scale the analysis must work from. Direct tourism employment was 106,707 in Cape Town in 2024 and 953,981 nationally.[711] Some municipal counts exist too, such as 12,015 tourism jobs in Knysna in 2024.[712]

A provincial figure exists in a source Wesgro holds.[713] The Pero 2025 carries a tourism employment table that this report could not retrieve [provincial tourism employment from the Pero 2025: Wesgro Research to extract]. Training also exists in places, from the CATHSSETA site guides certified in Mbekweni to the hospitality academy in Prince Albert.[714] What is missing is the sizing step that links these pieces to the growth case.

The course of action

Wesgro and DEDAT commission a tourism labour analysis in 2027. It fixes a provincial employment baseline and definition, tests the 300,000 ambition and identifies the occupations and skills the growth case needs. Before the analysis starts, Wesgro Research extracts the tourism employment table from the Pero 2025. Until the analysis reports, Chapter 5 carries jobs without a baseline or target. It sets the targets at the first gate, at the end of 2028, so the baseline must be in place by then (sections 4.7 and 5.3).

The skills plan follows the analysis and runs through the provincial quality charter (focus area 11). The Singapore lesson behind it pairs a province-wide quality framework with investment in workforce capability.[715] From 2029 CapeNature, CATHSSETA, training providers and municipalities run training partnerships around reserves and in pilot communities. LTOs and tour operators help newly trained guides stay in the sector with bookings from existing itineraries. Nationally, the province asks the Department of Tourism to approve a provincial jobs methodology and Stats SA to resource the tourism satellite account.

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Commission the labour analysis with DEDAT: baseline, definition, occupations, skills gaps and the training pipeline	Research; DEDAT
Wesgro	Extract the tourism employment table from the Pero 2025	Research
Wesgro	Build a workforce strand into the provincial quality charter (focus area 11)	Tourism
Partners	Run training partnerships around reserves and in pilot communities, building on the CATHSSETA guide certification and the Prince Albert academy	CapeNature; CATHSSETA; training providers; municipalities
Partners	Help newly trained guides stay in the sector with bookings from existing itineraries	LTOs; tour operators
National	Approve a provincial tourism jobs methodology and resource the tourism satellite account	Department of Tourism; Stats SA

Why it can work

Measurement comes first because a skills plan without a baseline can be neither targeted nor judged. The analysis shows which occupations bind growth, where and by when, so training money follows the gap rather than the loudest request. Linking skills to the quality charter ties training to the standards visitors judge. Linking training to bookings answers the Overberg's finding that low early earnings make it hard for newly trained guides to stay in the sector.[716]

[710] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p37.
[711] City of Cape Town, Economic Value of Tourism, 2025; Stats SA Tourism Satellite Account, provisional, 2026, public sources.
[712] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p47.
[713] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p34.
[714] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p42, p51.
[715] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p42.
[716] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p27.

Singapore's Hotel Industry Transformation Map, run by the tourism board with the hotel association and backed by dedicated funds, lifted service quality and spend per visitor.[717] Across the cases, assets and training without a durable route to market did not produce comparable continuity.[718] None of the six comparators carries a labour analysis or a tourism employment target, so the sizing step has no precedent in the benchmark set. The condition is a recognised method. Without the Department of Tourism's approval, the analysis can set a provincial baseline but not one the national accounts share.

Link forward

Initiative I18, tourism labour analysis and skills plan (section 4.3). **Indicators** T1-04 tourism jobs at impact level, with its baseline set by the analysis, and T2-25 labour analysis published at outcome level (section 5.2).

[717] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p41.
[718] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p30.

3.4 The integrated case

The three pillars make one case. Demand work fills seats only if the seats exist, supply work pays only if the product can be booked, and both need the enabling base to last.

The growth model sets out three paths from the 2025 base of 1,498,829 arrivals: 1,822,634 in 2035 on the conservative path, 2,175,778 on the base path and 2,516,282 on the accelerated path.[719] The paths differ by intervention, not by demand potential.[720] Each step of the growth case therefore rests on a named set of interventions. The first two steps draw on Pillars 1 and 2 alone. Pillar 3 adds arrivals only on the third step, through the three-tier agenda and national escalation (focus areas 16 and 19). Its other six focus areas decide whether growth is shared, funded, sustained and measured.

The conservative path, 1,822,634 arrivals in 2035, holds existing air access with no added frequencies or routes and continues trade and marketing, with growth in the mature markets and current corridors. Focus areas 5 and 7 hold that base. The base path adds 353,144 arrivals to reach 2,175,778. It assumes Wesgro's trade and marketing continue at 2025 intensity while Emirates, Qatar, Ethiopian and Turkish Airlines add frequency and capacity, and India, China and regional Africa grow through hub connections.[721] Focus areas 1 to 7, 9 and 10 hold it. The accelerated path adds a further 340,504 to reach 2,516,282. It needs direct India and China routes secured and dedicated activation in India, China, the USA and the GCC, with India, China and the Middle East growing ahead of their source markets. Focus areas 4, 7, 16 and 19 deliver it on top of the base.[722]

The gateway binds first, at peak. The growth model draws current air access as a line at 1.8 million inbound seats, and the base case crosses it at the 2030 year point.[723] Relief at Cape Town International arrives about 2032 for the international terminal and about 2033 for the runway.[724] ACSA now schedules the realigned runway for December 2029, subject to contract award. This plan keeps about 2033 as its planning date and treats the earlier date as upside.[725] Between those dates, growth has to come from larger aircraft and added frequency on the full routes and from hub-carrier capacity (focus areas 5, 6 and 7). Domestic connections can also grow through George, whose terminal doubles by 2028 or 2029.

If the supply moves slip, growth flattens near the seat line. The conservative path, with no new seats, ends at 1.82 million in 2035, just above the 1.8 million line. Projected growth cannot be realised without added capacity or frequency, and without confirmed routes the accelerated case reverts to base.[726] On the full routes, demand work cannot make up the gap, because marketing raises fares rather than seats;[727] on the hub routes, which have seats to spare, it can.

Below the gateway, the pillars depend on each other. Green-season demand needs seats in the months carriers now cut (focus areas 2 and 7). Dispersal needs product that can be booked and reached (focus areas 3, 9 and 10). Inclusion needs a seller and a safe visit before exposure (focus areas 13 and 19). Every target needs data that today sits with SA Tourism, ACSA and the booking platforms (focus area 18).

Air access and bookability move first, because every other lever runs through them. Three phases follow from that logic. Activate, 2027 to 2028, works on seats, bookability, green-season events, the

[719] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19; Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p20.
[720] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p19.
[721] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p18; the Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p20 describes the same case as existing Wesgro programmes expanded.
[722] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p19, p20; Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19, the 2025 base; increments computed from the printed end points; the mapping to focus areas is this report's.
[723] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p21; arrivals and seats share one axis and no seat table sits behind the 1.8 million line; the crossing is read from the chart, after the 2028 point of 1,673,855 and by the 2030 point of 1,802,929.
[724] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p103.
[725] ACSA, Q1 2026/27 presentation to the Portfolio Committee on Transport, as reported by Travel News, Aug 2026.
[726] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p20, p21.
[727] MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, In Conclusion.

inclusion pilots and the governance base before the seat line. Expand, 2029 to 2031, scales hub conversion, corridor product and quality and closes the first investments. Sustain, 2032 to 2035, takes the direct routes to carriers as runway relief arrives. Chapter 4 turns the sequence into eighteen initiatives with owners, phases and decision gates (section 4.2).

Chapter 4

Execution plan

4.1 From focus areas to initiatives

Twenty focus areas become eighteen initiatives, one per focus area except where one owner delivers two.

The plan follows one chain from vision to measure. Each level answers a different question. The pillar says what must change and the focus area says where; the initiative says what Wesgro and its partners do, and the indicator says how Steerco will know it has happened (section 5.1).

Seven levels run from the vision to the measures, and each has a fixed count in this plan. One vision says where the province is going: grow international arrivals from 1.5m in 2025 toward 2.5m by 2035. Three pillars say what must change, such as Reshape demand. Six themes say in which part of the system, such as source market growth and diversification. Twenty focus areas say where the evidence says to act, such as Convert India and China hub traffic. Eighteen initiatives say what Wesgro and its partners do, such as I4 India and China hub conversion. The 112 actions say who does what, by tier, such as activation inside Xiaohongshu, Douyin and MakeMyTrip. The indicators, 7 at impact, 25 at outcome and 36 at output level, say how Steerco knows, such as T2-06 India and China hub arrivals. The counts come from Chapter 3, the action tables and the traceability table in Appendix A1.

Two merges take twenty focus areas to eighteen initiatives. Segment-led marketing and mature-market yield share one owner and one set of channels, so focus areas 1 and 5 form initiative I1. Institutional alignment and industry collaboration share one forum, so focus areas 16 and 17 form I15. Every other focus area has its own initiative, numbered I1 to I18 in one sequence so that the M&E toolkit can track them on one list.

Leads are proposed, not agreed. They follow the Wesgro units named in the Inception Report's stakeholder map and the actions in Chapter 3, and Steerco confirms them at its first meeting [Steerco to confirm initiative leads and partners]. Six initiatives have a partner as the accountable lead, because the main lever sits outside Wesgro's mandate: corridor mobility, quality standards, flagship sites, community pilots, LTO funding and skills.

Table 4.1. The eighteen initiatives

Eighteen initiatives cover the twenty focus areas, and eleven of them are in implementation by 2028. Thirteen draw mainly on Wesgro's operating budget, and four need private capital as a main source.

Code	Initiative	Focus areas	Proposed lead	Phase 1 role	Main funding	Supporting funding
I1	Segment-led activation and yield in mature markets	1, 5	Destination Marketing	Design, then implement	Wesgro operating	Private capital
I2	Green-season events and business-events calendar	2	Convention Bureau	Design, then implement	Wesgro operating; Provincial and municipal	Private capital
I3	Bookable province programme	3	Tourism	Design, then implement	Wesgro operating; Provincial and municipal	National and SOE; Private capital
I4	India and China hub conversion	4	Destination Marketing	Design, then implement	Wesgro operating	Private capital
I5	Regional Africa programme	6	Destination Marketing	Design, then implement	Wesgro operating	Private capital

Code	Initiative	Focus areas	Proposed lead	Phase 1 role	Main funding	Supporting funding
I6	Route development and seat retention, with a public-private air access fund	7	Air Access	Implement	Wesgro operating; Provincial and municipal; Private capital	National and SOE
I7	Cruise growth through product	8	Cruise Cape Town	Design, then implement	Wesgro operating; National and SOE	Private capital
I8	Corridor mobility	9	Department of Mobility, with Wesgro Tourism	Design	Provincial and municipal; National and SOE	Wesgro operating; Private capital
I9	Corridor product development	10	Tourism	Design	Wesgro operating; Provincial and municipal; Private capital	National and SOE
I10	Visitor experience and quality standards	11	DEDAT, with Wesgro Tourism	Design	Provincial and municipal	Wesgro operating; Private capital
I11	Flagship site demand management	12	Site operators, with Wesgro Research	Design	National and SOE; Private capital	Wesgro operating; Provincial and municipal
I12	Community inclusion pilots	13	Municipalities and LTOs, with Wesgro Tourism	Design, then implement	Provincial and municipal	Wesgro operating; National and SOE; Private capital
I13	Climate resilience and destination management, including LTO funding	14	DEDAT, with Wesgro Research	Design	Provincial and municipal	Wesgro operating; National and SOE; Private capital
I14	Tourism investment pipeline	15	Wesgro investment promotion	Design	Wesgro operating; Provincial and municipal; Private capital	None
I15	Tourism Growth Steerco and three-tier alignment	16, 17	Wesgro CEO's office	Implement	Wesgro operating; Provincial and municipal	None
I16	Data-sharing protocol and visitor intelligence	18	Research	Design, then implement	Wesgro operating	Provincial and municipal; National and SOE; Private capital
I17	Access and safety escalation agenda	19	Wesgro CEO's office, with DEDAT	Implement	Wesgro operating; Provincial and municipal	None
I18	Tourism labour analysis and skills plan	20	DEDAT, with Wesgro Research	Design	Wesgro operating; Provincial and municipal	National and SOE; Private capital

Source: Chapter 3 entries; proposed leads for Steerco to confirm. Phase 1 role from the Gantt in section 4.2. Funding routes from the initiative charters (section 4.3); rand values are not estimated.

4.2 Sequencing and phases

Three phases run to 2035, and the first is weighted to the moves that change the 2030 constraint: seats, bookability, green-season events and the inclusion pilots.

The phases follow calendar years: Activate from 2027 to 2028, Expand from 2029 to 2031 and Sustain from 2032 to 2035. Each phase ends at a decision gate tied to the Chapter 5 indicators (section 4.7). The first gate, at the end of 2028, falls in Wesgro's FY2028/29, two years before the base case crosses the model's seat line around 2030.[728]

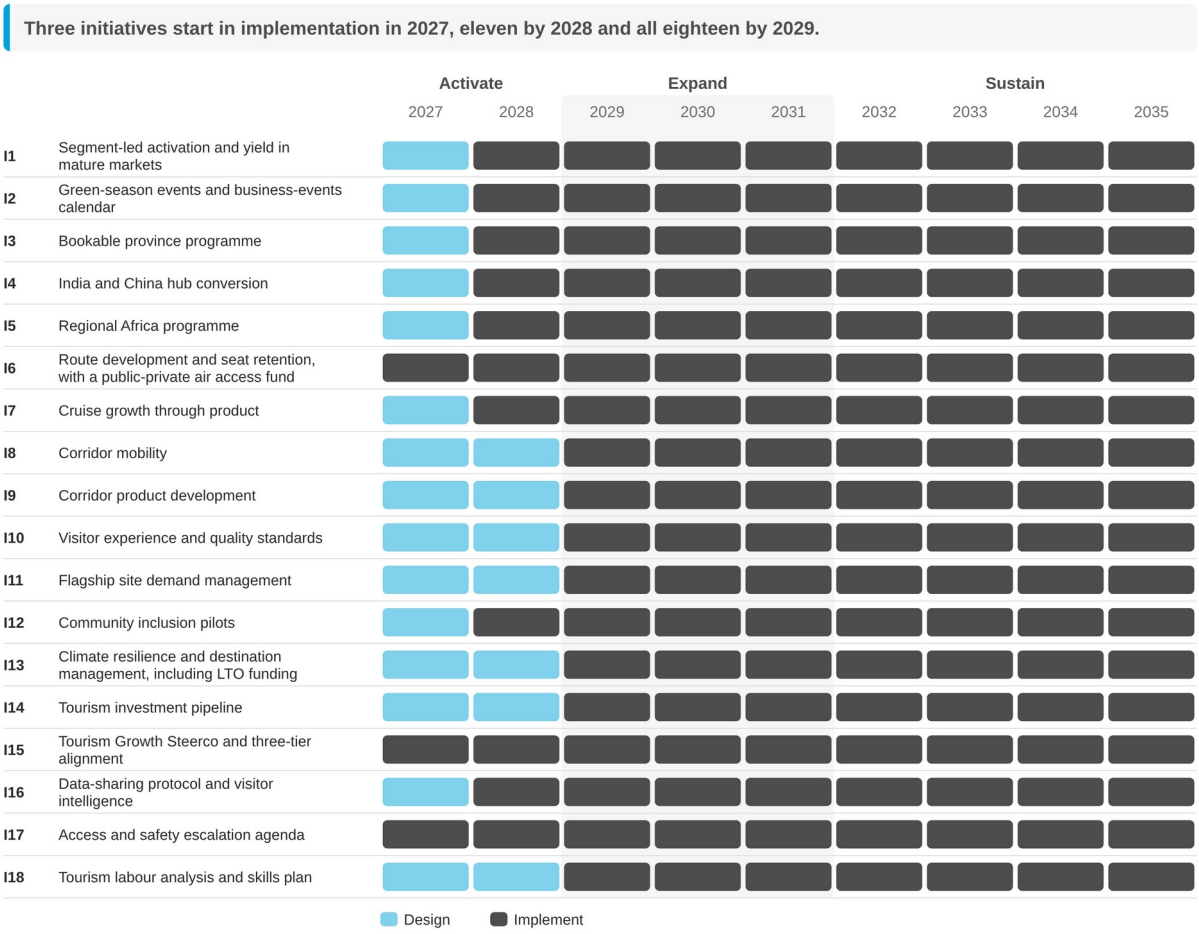


Figure 4.1. Initiative timeline, 2027 to 2035

Source: Letsema, initiative portfolio (sections 4.1 and 4.3). Design means scoping, data, agreements and pilots; implement means delivery at scale.

Phase 1: Activate, 2027 to 2028

Phase 1 works inside Wesgro's mandate and budget and on the levers that move before the airport can. It holds and adds seats on the full routes and builds the air access fund (I6). It publishes the green-season calendar (I2), counts and starts to close the bookability gap (I3) and starts two or three inclusion pilots (I12). Steerco, the data-sharing protocol and the escalation agenda start in the first quarter (I15, I16, I17), because every other initiative reports through them.

The marketing initiatives (I1, I4, I5) and cruise (I7) spend 2027 on design: segment targets, hub-carrier agreements, the Nigeria and Kenya plans and excursion products. Seven initiatives use both years for design (I8 to I11, I13, I14, I18). Their first task is a baseline or a case that no deliverable holds: corridor

[728] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p21.

mobility, product, quality, flagship capacity, climate risk and LTO funding, the investment pipeline and the labour analysis. The gate at the end of 2028 asks three questions. Have seats on the full routes held? Does the bookability baseline exist and is it moving? Has any pilot met its thresholds?

Phase 2: Expand, 2029 to 2031

Phase 2 scales what Phase 1 proved and meets the model's seat line. Hub conversion, regional Africa and segment marketing run at scale. Corridor mobility and product move from design to delivery, on the Garden Route, the Winelands and the Overberg first. The quality charter is adopted and phased by district, and the investment pipeline reaches financial close on its first projects. The mid-term review in 2030 tests arrivals against the base path when the base case crosses the model's seat line, and checks that the runway is on its published dates (section 5.6).

Phase 3: Sustain, 2032 to 2035

Phase 3 runs as relief arrives at Cape Town International: the international terminal about 2032 and the runway about 2033.[729] The direct India and China route cases built since 2027 go to carriers as capacity frees up, which is the step the accelerated case depends on. Inclusion pilots that met their thresholds scale through channels, climate risk and LTO funding are embedded in municipal planning, and the terminal evaluation in 2035 closes the plan (section 5.6).

[729] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p103.

4.3 Initiative charters

Each initiative has a one-page charter that a lead can run from and Steerco can hold to account.

Every charter uses the same fields. It states the objective, the focus areas served, the proposed lead and partners and the tier of government. It then sets the actions in each phase, marked Design or Implement, and closes with the dependencies, the funding route, the risks and the indicators it moves. Actions come from the Chapter 3 action tables. Leads are proposals for Steerco to confirm, and rand bands are set in section 4.6.

I1 Segment-led activation and yield in mature markets

Field	Charter
Objective	Raise value per visitor from the mature markets and target every priority market by segment, not by country alone.
Focus areas	1, 5
Proposed lead	Destination Marketing
Partners	Research; trade and OTA partners; SA Tourism
Tier of government	Provincial (Wesgro); national alignment with SA Tourism
Activate, 2027 to 2028	Design (2027): segment targets inside each priority market; a shared segment frame with SA Tourism; destination-specific segment research. Implement (2028): move spend from broad awareness to trade-led conversion; luxury-advisor and high-end operator distribution in the UK, USA, Germany, France and Switzerland.
Expand, 2029 to 2031	Segment campaigns at scale; spend per visitor and length of stay added to Wesgro's own targets; segments built into brand tracking.
Sustain, 2032 to 2035	Segment research refreshed; budget shifted toward the segments and markets with the highest yield.
Dependencies	I6 for seats on the full routes; I16 for spend-per-visitor data; I10 for product quality.
Funding route	Main: Wesgro operating budget. Supporting: private capital. Rand band to be set (section 4.6).
Risks	Carriers on full routes raise fares rather than seats; SA Tourism's institutional weakness limits joint campaigns (Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p25).
Indicators	T1-01, T1-02, T1-03; T2-01, T2-07; T3-01 segment targets in Wesgro's annual plan; T3-02 share of market budget in trade-led conversion.

I2 Green-season events and business-events calendar

Field	Charter
Objective	Build an April to September demand spine from business events and flagship weeks, and sell it with the seats.
Focus areas	2
Proposed lead	Convention Bureau
Partners	Destination Marketing; CTICC; City of Cape Town; DEDAT; LTOs
Tier of government	Provincial and local; national for delegate visas
Activate, 2027 to 2028	Design (2027): one event acquisition and calendar strategy across Wesgro, the Convention Bureau, the City and the Province; a way to measure meetings, incentives and exhibitions. Implement (2028): publish the calendar; aim bids at May to September; green-season packages with airlines and trade; cooler-season incentive packages for Indian and Gulf planners.
Expand, 2029 to 2031	Regional conferences in Stellenbosch and George; lifestyle events at CTICC in December and January; flower, fynbos and whale events marketed earlier.
Sustain, 2032 to 2035	Calendar refreshed each year; a standing bid pipeline for green-season dates.
Dependencies	I6 for seats in the trough months; I9 for regional venues; I17 for visas for African delegates.
Funding route	Main: Wesgro operating budget, provincial and municipal budgets. Supporting: private capital. Rand band to be set (section 4.6).
Risks	Weather limits summit and outdoor events (Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p35); peak hotel prices deter December and January events (p46).
Indicators	T1-05; T2-02 ICCA meetings, T2-03 April to September seat share; T3-03 calendar published; T3-04 bids for May to September events.

I3 Bookable province programme

Field	Charter
Objective	Make provincial product bookable where travellers book, district by district.
Focus areas	3
Proposed lead	Tourism
Partners	Research; LTOs; district municipalities; OTAs; CapeNature
Tier of government	Provincial and local; national for broadband
Activate, 2027 to 2028	Design (2027): a bookability census of provincial product by district. Implement (2028): a digital onboarding drive for small operators and cellars on the West Coast, Route 62 and the Overberg; OTA partnerships with Trip.com, Almosafer and Booking.com; community booking routes with I12.
Expand, 2029 to 2031	Packaged regional itineraries listed on OTAs; CapeNature reservations moved online.
Sustain, 2032 to 2035	Census repeated every two years; listing extended to every route.
Dependencies	I12 for community routes; I16 for the census data; SA Connect rural broadband.
Funding route	Main: Wesgro operating budget, provincial and municipal budgets. Supporting: national programmes and SOEs, private capital. Rand band to be set (section 4.6).
Risks	Rural connectivity and payments; compliance cost for small operators.
Indicators	T2-04 share of operators bookable online, T2-05 CapeNature online share; T3-05 census published; T3-06 operators onboarded.

I4 India and China hub conversion

Field	Charter
Objective	Convert the Indian and Chinese travellers already flying in through hubs, and prepare the direct route case for when runway capacity arrives.
Focus areas	4
Proposed lead	Destination Marketing
Partners	Air Access; hub carriers; OTAs; trade
Tier of government	Provincial; national for visas and route designation
Activate, 2027 to 2028	Design (2027): joint market support with Emirates, Qatar Airways and Ethiopian Airlines; activation plans for Xiaohongshu, Douyin and MakeMyTrip. Implement (2028): in-market activation with Trip.com packages and market-specific itineraries; product readiness with Mandarin and Indian-language guiding and Alipay and WeChat Pay.
Expand, 2029 to 2031	Activation at scale; standing relationships with Indian carriers, China Southern and China Eastern.
Sustain, 2032 to 2035	Direct route cases taken to carriers as runway capacity arrives, with I6.
Dependencies	I6 for route cases; I10 for product readiness; I17 for visas and route designation.
Funding route	Main: Wesgro operating budget. Supporting: private capital. Rand band to be set (section 4.6).
Risks	Visa processing; no Indian aircraft for a direct route before 2030 (MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, Indian Market Opportunity).
Indicators	T1-02; T2-06 India and China hub arrivals; T3-07 hub-carrier agreements; T3-08 route cases prepared.

I5 Regional Africa programme

Field	Charter
Objective	Hold the regional volume base and grow Nigeria and Kenya as premium markets.
Focus areas	6
Proposed lead	Destination Marketing
Partners	Air Access; Convention Bureau; regional carriers; trade
Tier of government	Provincial; national for visas and route liberalisation
Activate, 2027 to 2028	Design (2027): Nigeria and Kenya activation plans; Nigeria and Ghana added to the growth model; consumer research for Botswana, Zambia, Ghana and Rwanda. Implement (2028): premium, trade-led activation.
Expand, 2029 to 2031	Conferences with leisure extensions; onward packages for regional travellers who stop in Johannesburg.
Sustain, 2032 to 2035	Effort shifted with results; brand seeding in the watch markets.
Dependencies	I6 for regional capacity; I2 for conference demand; I17 for visas.
Funding route	Main: Wesgro operating budget. Supporting: private capital. Rand band to be set (section 4.6).
Risks	Visa friction and budget sensitivity of regional demand (Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p45).
Indicators	T1-02; T2-08 African arrivals and spend; T3-09 activation programmes run; T3-10 regional capacity cases made.

I6 Route development and seat retention, with a public-private air access fund

Field	Charter
Objective	Hold and add seats on the full routes until runway relief, and have direct route cases ready when it arrives.
Focus areas	7
Proposed lead	Air Access
Partners	DEDAT; City of Cape Town; ACSA; airlines; private sector
Tier of government	Provincial and local; national for air service agreements; ACSA for airport capacity
Activate, 2027 to 2028	Implement (2027): a seat-retention and frequency programme on the full routes with joint marketing; quarterly runway milestone tracking; a capacity-against-demand model to 2035. Design (2027 to 2028): a public-private air access fund with ring-fenced corridor budgets.
Expand, 2029 to 2031	Fund in operation; frequency and gauge cases on the five full regional routes; growth at George.
Sustain, 2032 to 2035	Direct India and China route cases taken to carriers as runway capacity arrives.
Dependencies	ACSA's programme at Cape Town International; I17 for air service agreements; I4 and I5 for demand.
Funding route	Main: Wesgro operating budget, provincial and municipal budgets, private capital. Supporting: national programmes and SOEs. Rand band to be set (section 4.6). [Open item: Air Access to give the current size and funders of its route fund.]
Risks	Runway relief slips; bilateral agreements stay restrictive (section 4.8).
Indicators	T1-01; T2-09 seats and routes, T2-10 seats added on full routes; T3-11 fund constituted; T3-12 runway milestone reports issued.

I7 Cruise growth through product

Field	Charter
Objective	Grow cruise calls and shore spend through ships that fit, packaged excursions and regional day stops.
Focus areas	8
Proposed lead	Cruise Cape Town
Partners	Transnet National Ports Authority; V&A Waterfront; Mossel Bay municipality; cruise lines
Tier of government	Provincial and local; Transnet for ports
Activate, 2027 to 2028	Design (2027): line targeting for ships that fit the 300m berth; Mossel Bay excursion packages; source and define the 250-call plan. Implement (2028): marketing to expedition and home-porting operators; community product on cruise-operator channels.
Expand, 2029 to 2031	Saldanha Bay only if demand is proven; shore power and wind planning with the ports authority.
Sustain, 2032 to 2035	Longer itineraries and pre- and post-cruise stays.
Dependencies	Berth scheduling by Transnet National Ports Authority; I3 and I12 for bookable shore product.
Funding route	Main: Wesgro operating budget, national programmes and SOEs. Supporting: private capital. Rand band to be set (section 4.6).
Risks	Red Sea reroutes reverse; the 300m ship-length limit (Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p110, p112).
Indicators	T2-11 cruise calls and passengers; T3-13 excursion packages listed; T3-14 lines engaged.

I8 Corridor mobility

Field	Charter
Objective	Make the transport that exists usable for visitors and aggregate the demand that makes corridor shuttles viable.
Focus areas	9
Proposed lead	Department of Mobility, with Wesgro Tourism
Partners	City of Cape Town; PRASA; district municipalities; private operators
Tier of government	Provincial, local and national (PRASA)
Activate, 2027 to 2028	Design and pilot (2027 to 2028): a Southern Line visitor product with the City and PRASA; shuttle demand aggregation on the Garden Route and between Cape Town, Darling and the West Coast; transfers sold inside N2 and R62 itineraries.
Expand, 2029 to 2031	Shuttle products in operation; Central Line recovery, MyCiTi Phase 2 and integrated ticketing.
Sustain, 2032 to 2035	A decision on Cape Town to George rapid rail; the last mile to Cape Point.
Dependencies	PRASA and the City of Cape Town; the national rule on bank-card payments on the George bus; I9 for itineraries.
Funding route	Main: provincial and municipal budgets, national programmes and SOEs. Supporting: Wesgro operating budget, private capital. Rand band to be set (section 4.6).
Risks	Rail safety and reliability; shuttle viability at low volumes.
Indicators	T1-06; T2-12 accessibility score, T2-13 corridor transfer products; T3-15 Southern Line product launched; T3-16 shuttle products bookable.

I9 Corridor product development

Field	Charter
Objective	Turn assets outside the Metro into bookable multi-day itineraries, starting with the corridors closest to ready.
Focus areas	10
Proposed lead	Tourism
Partners	LTOs; district municipalities; CapeNature; SANParks; private investors
Tier of government	Provincial and local; national for SANParks precincts
Activate, 2027 to 2028	Design (2027 to 2028): itineraries for the six touring routes; a plan to activate cold-zone assets; regional conference offers in Stellenbosch and George.
Expand, 2029 to 2031	Delivery on the Garden Route, the Cape Winelands and the Overberg first, then Route 62 and the West Coast.
Sustain, 2032 to 2035	Accommodation and service depth in secondary towns; refreshed flagship product.
Dependencies	I3 for bookability; I8 for transfers; I14 for capital.
Funding route	Main: Wesgro operating budget, provincial and municipal budgets, private capital. Supporting: national programmes and SOEs. Rand band to be set (section 4.6).
Risks	No committed capital for product (Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p54, p76); operator capacity.
Indicators	T1-06; T2-14 readiness by district; T3-17 multi-day itineraries listed; T3-18 cold-zone assets activated.

I10 Visitor experience and quality standards

Field	Charter
Objective	Adopt a provincial quality charter, phased by district, and prepare the province for growth-market visitors.
Focus areas	11
Proposed lead	DEDAT, with Wesgro Tourism
Partners	Industry bodies; CATHSSETA; attraction operators
Tier of government	Provincial; industry
Activate, 2027 to 2028	Design (2027 to 2028): a charter with certification visible on booking platforms; support for SMMEs to comply; readiness standards for language, payments and food.
Expand, 2029 to 2031	Charter adopted and phased by district; investment case for mid-scale hotels with I14.
Sustain, 2032 to 2035	Charter embedded in grading; measurement repeated.
Dependencies	I14 for mid-scale capital; I18 for skills; I3 for visibility on platforms.
Funding route	Main: provincial and municipal budgets. Supporting: Wesgro operating budget, private capital. Rand band to be set (section 4.6).
Risks	Compliance burden on small businesses; skills shortages.
Indicators	T2-15 routes rated Ready; T3-19 charter adopted; T3-20 businesses certified.

I11 Flagship site demand management

Field	Charter
Objective	Manage visitor flows at the flagship nature sites and steer visitors to under-marketed reserves.
Focus areas	12
Proposed lead	Site operators, with Wesgro Research
Partners	SANParks; Table Mountain Aerial Cableway; CapeNature; Robben Island Museum; City of Cape Town
Tier of government	National (SANParks), provincial (CapeNature) and site operators
Activate, 2027 to 2028	Design (2027 to 2028): a baseline of visitor counts and capacity for five flagship sites; marketing of Cape Point, the reserves and the Southern Line as alternatives.
Expand, 2029 to 2031	Digital flow management and tiered pricing at the Cableway and Boulders; a visitor management plan for Table Mountain National Park and Boulders.
Sustain, 2032 to 2035	Yield measures for nature product; climate-resilient asset formats.
Dependencies	I8 for the Southern Line; I16 for data; I13 for climate risk.
Funding route	Main: national programmes and SOEs, private capital. Supporting: Wesgro operating budget, provincial and municipal budgets. Rand band to be set (section 4.6).
Risks	Operators do not share data; mandates limit pricing (Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p44).
Indicators	T2-16 peak Cableway queue; T3-21 flagship baseline published; T3-22 flow tools in place.

I12 Community inclusion pilots

Field	Charter
Objective	Test the Inclusion Plan's model in two or three communities: a seller with a stake, a link to existing demand and gates before any investment.
Focus areas	13
Proposed lead	Municipalities and LTOs, with Wesgro Tourism
Partners	Municipalities; LTOs; community sellers; SAPS
Tier of government	Local and provincial; national for safety (SAPS)
Activate, 2027 to 2028	Design (2027): pilots chosen on readiness; agreement on who funds a seller with a stake in each; safety plans. Implement (2028): one live booking route per pilot; a fixed-date test; product placed in Wesgro's itineraries and calendars.
Expand, 2029 to 2031	Pilots that meet their thresholds scale; covenants on public assets; links to tourism procurement.
Sustain, 2032 to 2035	Extension to more shortlisted communities through channels.
Dependencies	I3 for booking routes; I17 for safety; municipal assets.
Funding route	Main: provincial and municipal budgets. Supporting: Wesgro operating budget, national programmes and SOEs, private capital. Rand band to be set (section 4.6).
Risks	Safety; the selling body is not sustained; capital ahead of demand (SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p11).
Indicators	T1-07; T2-17 communities with a live booking route; T3-23 pilots selected; T3-24 fixed-date tests held.

I13 Climate resilience and destination management, including LTO funding

Field	Charter
Objective	Track and plan for climate losses, and give local tourism bodies stable funding with a development mandate.
Focus areas	14
Proposed lead	DEDAT, with Wesgro Research
Partners	Municipalities; district municipalities; CapeNature; site operators
Tier of government	Provincial and local; national for MFMA Circular No. 131
Activate, 2027 to 2028	Design (2027 to 2028): a climate and weather risk register for sites and routes; an LTO funding model in response to Circular 131.
Expand, 2029 to 2031	Funding agreements signed; sustainability checks in the quality charter; itineraries routed around closures.
Sustain, 2032 to 2035	Climate risk and LTO funding embedded in IDPs with reporting.
Dependencies	National Treasury on Circular 131; I10 for the charter.
Funding route	Main: provincial and municipal budgets. Supporting: Wesgro operating budget, national programmes and SOEs, private capital. Rand band to be set (section 4.6).
Risks	Circular 131 unresolved; further climate events (section 4.8).
Indicators	T2-18 LTOs with a funding agreement, T2-19 weather losses at flagship sites; T3-25 risk register published; T3-26 LTO funding model agreed.

I14 Tourism investment pipeline

Field	Charter
Objective	Build a scored pipeline of tourism investments from the gap-closure tables and take it to investors.
Focus areas	15
Proposed lead	Wesgro investment promotion
Partners	DEDAT; Tourism; private investors; municipalities
Tier of government	Provincial and local; private
Activate, 2027 to 2028	Design (2027 to 2028): a pipeline from the gap tables, scored for return, jobs and inclusion; return projections for the SLA; investment cases for mid-scale and conference hotels and for accommodation at De Hoop and on Route 62.
Expand, 2029 to 2031	Investor engagement; first projects at financial close; a tourism levy and blended finance tested with DEDAT.
Sustain, 2032 to 2035	Pipeline refreshed each year; covenants on public assets.
Dependencies	I9 and I10 for product and quality; I6 for the air access fund.
Funding route	Main: Wesgro operating budget, provincial and municipal budgets, private capital. Rand band to be set (section 4.6).
Risks	Capital ahead of demand; tight fiscal space (Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p25).
Indicators	T2-20 projects at financial close; T3-27 investment cases prepared; T3-28 investor engagements.

I15 Tourism Growth Steerco and three-tier alignment

Field	Charter
Objective	Give the province one forum, one shared agenda with clear decision rights and one joint plan with industry.
Focus areas	16, 17
Proposed lead	Wesgro CEO's office
Partners	DEDAT; Cape Town Tourism; City of Cape Town; district municipalities; industry bodies
Tier of government	All three tiers and industry
Activate, 2027 to 2028	Implement (2027): Steerco constituted with terms of reference; a decision-rights map by tier from the Diagnostic's tier table; JAMS adopted as the consultation channel; sector councils designed; airlines, OTAs and tour operators brought into the joint plan.
Expand, 2029 to 2031	A joint industry plan agreed and reviewed each year; sector councils running; regional forums carrying a development agenda.
Sustain, 2032 to 2035	Steerco embedded as the standing governance of the plan; the programme office hands over to the line units by the end of 2031.
Dependencies	DEDAT and Cape Town Tourism as standing members; I17 for the national asks; I16 for the scorecard.
Funding route	Main: Wesgro operating budget, provincial and municipal budgets. Rand band to be set (section 4.6).
Risks	Misalignment between public institutions and industry bodies persists (Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p25); SA Tourism's institutional weakness.
Indicators	T2-21 escalation items answered, T2-22 partners in the joint plan; T3-29 Steerco meetings held each quarter; T3-30 joint industry plan agreed.

I16 Data-sharing protocol and visitor intelligence

Field	Charter
Objective	Agree data-sharing terms with every data holder and run one indicator register and dashboard.
Focus areas	18
Proposed lead	Research
Partners	Stats SA; SA Tourism; ACSA; Cape Town Tourism; booking platforms
Tier of government	Provincial; national for the jobs methodology and the tourism satellite account
Activate, 2027 to 2028	Design (2027): data-sharing terms with ACSA, SA Tourism, Stats SA, Cape Town Tourism, site operators and booking platforms; the indicator register. Implement (2028): dashboard live with automated arrivals, seats and cruise feeds; quarterly digital tracking; measurement of meetings, incentives and exhibitions.
Expand, 2029 to 2031	District arrivals and spend baseline; annual brand research.
Sustain, 2032 to 2035	Arrivals series bridged and read against each other; the register refreshed each year.
Dependencies	Agreement from each data holder; the Department of Tourism's methodology; I15 for the forum.
Funding route	Main: Wesgro operating budget. Supporting: provincial and municipal budgets, national programmes and SOEs, private capital. Rand band to be set (section 4.6).
Risks	Data holders do not share; national data lag (Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p30, p37).
Indicators	T2-23 automated data feeds; T3-31 data-sharing agreements signed; T3-32 dashboard live.

I17 Access and safety escalation agenda

Field	Charter
Objective	Turn the national deficits into a standing agenda of asks, each with an owner, a decision and a date, backed by evidence.
Focus areas	19
Proposed lead	Wesgro CEO's office, with DEDAT
Partners	Home Affairs; Department of Transport; SAPS; ACSA; SA Tourism
Tier of government	National (Home Affairs, Transport, SAPS, ACSA, PRASA); provincial for safety programmes; local for basic services
Activate, 2027 to 2028	Implement (2027): the first agenda tabled at Steerco: visa categories and processing for China, India, the Middle East and Africa; air service agreements and the US carrier cap; immigration throughput at Cape Town International; station security. Evidence built market by market.
Expand, 2029 to 2031	Responses logged and followed up each quarter; tourism safety units and programmes with the Western Cape Government; safety compacts in pilot communities.
Sustain, 2032 to 2035	Asks updated as airport relief arrives; direct route designations pursued with the national tier.
Dependencies	I15 for the forum; I16 for evidence; I4 to I6 for the market case.
Funding route	Main: Wesgro operating budget, provincial and municipal budgets. Rand band to be set (section 4.6).
Risks	National asks go unanswered; safety incidents (section 4.8).
Indicators	T2-24 visa processing time, T2-21 items answered; T3-33 agenda tabled; T3-34 responses logged.

I18 Tourism labour analysis and skills plan

Field	Charter
Objective	Fix a provincial tourism employment baseline, test the 300,000 ambition and set a skills plan from the result.
Focus areas	20
Proposed lead	DEDAT, with Wesgro Research
Partners	CATHSSETA; industry bodies; training providers
Tier of government	Provincial; national for the jobs methodology and sector training
Activate, 2027 to 2028	Design (2027 to 2028): the labour analysis commissioned; the Pero 2025 tourism employment table extracted; a workforce strand built into the quality charter.
Expand, 2029 to 2031	Skills plan adopted; training partnerships around reserves and in pilot communities; the jobs indicator moved from the ratio to a provincial measure.
Sustain, 2032 to 2035	Labour analysis refreshed for the terminal evaluation.
Dependencies	I10 for the quality charter; I16 for data; the Department of Tourism's methodology.
Funding route	Main: Wesgro operating budget, provincial and municipal budgets. Supporting: national programmes and SOEs, private capital. Rand band to be set (section 4.6).
Risks	No provincial methodology is approved; skills shortages cap service quality.
Indicators	T1-04; T2-25 labour analysis published; T3-35 analysis published; T3-36 skills plan adopted.

4.4 Roles and accountabilities

Wesgro is accountable for twelve initiatives and does part of the work in all eighteen; for the other six, the accountable lead sits with another tier, and the plan names it.

The matrix below assigns each initiative to the four roles: responsible (R) for doing the work, accountable (A) for the result, consulted (C) before decisions and informed (I) of progress. Where Wesgro is accountable and does the work itself, the cell reads A/R. Assignments are proposals for Steerco to confirm, built from the actions in Chapter 3.

Table 4.2. Accountability by initiative and tier

Wesgro is accountable for twelve initiatives; provincial departments, municipalities or site operators are accountable for six, and SOEs or national departments do part of the work in four.

Code	Initiative	Wesgro	Province	City, CTT	Districts, LTOs	SOEs	SAT	National	Industry, sites
I1	Segment-led activation and yield in mature markets	A/R	C	I	I	-	C	-	C
I2	Green-season events and business-events calendar	A/R	C	R	R	-	I	-	C
I3	Bookable province programme	A/R	C	C	R	-	-	I	C
I4	India and China hub conversion	A/R	I	I	-	C	C	C	C
I5	Regional Africa programme	A/R	I	I	-	C	C	C	C
I6	Route development and seat retention, with a public-private air access fund	A/R	R	R	-	C	I	C	C
I7	Cruise growth through product	A/R	I	C	C	R	-	-	C
I8	Corridor mobility	R	A	R	R	R	-	C	C
I9	Corridor product development	A/R	C	C	R	-	-	C	C
I10	Visitor experience and quality standards	R	A	C	C	-	-	-	R
I11	Flagship site demand management	R	C	C	C	-	-	C	A
I12	Community inclusion pilots	R	C	R	A	-	-	C	C
I13	Climate resilience and destination management, including LTO funding	R	A	C	R	-	-	C	R
I14	Tourism investment pipeline	A/R	R	C	C	C	-	-	C
I15	Tourism Growth Steerco and three-tier alignment	A/R	R	R	R	C	C	C	R
I16	Data-sharing protocol and visitor intelligence	A/R	C	R	C	R	R	R	C
I17	Access and safety escalation agenda	A/R	R	C	C	C	C	R	C
I18	Tourism labour analysis and skills plan	R	A	C	C	-	-	C	R

Source: Letsema, from the Chapter 3 action tables; proposed for Steerco to confirm. Province: DEDAT and the Department of Mobility. SOEs: ACSA, Transnet and PRASA. National: Home Affairs, Transport, National Treasury and SAPS. Industry: industry bodies, airlines, CapeNature, SANParks and attraction operators.

National government and the state-owned entities

Four levers sit outside the province and cannot be bought or marketed into place. Route rights and visas sit with the national tier,[730] the airport and port capital programmes with national SOEs[731] and policing with SAPS. The plan treats them as an escalation agenda (I17), carried by Steerco through DEDAT to the national departments and SOEs. Each item is stated as a decision, an owner and a date the province is asking for. Wesgro's own route work (I6) runs inside the existing agreements meanwhile.

Provincial government

DEDAT is a standing member of Steerco and the accountable lead where the lever is policy or funding rather than promotion: quality standards (I10), LTO funding and climate risk (I13) and the labour analysis (I18). The Department of Mobility leads the transport half of corridor mobility (I8). Wesgro's units lead the demand, access, product and data initiatives and report through the programme office.

District and local government

Municipalities and LTOs hold the assets, the selling bodies and the visitor services that the regional and inclusion initiatives depend on. They lead the community selling bodies in the pilots (I12), attach covenants to public assets (I12, I14) and carry the route and product work in their districts (I3, I9). The City of Cape Town and Cape Town Tourism are partners on events, mobility and data (I2, I8, I16) and sit on Steerco.

The private sector and site operators

Airlines decide frequency and gauge, hotel investors decide the mid-scale tier and attraction operators manage their own capacity. The plan gives them the evidence and the demand case. It asks for the decisions it cannot make for them: seats on full routes (I6), investment in secondary nodes (I14) and visitor-flow management at flagship sites, where the operators are accountable (I11).

[730] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p58.
[731] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p103, p112.

4.5 Tactical wins for the first 24 months

Twelve actions can start by mid-2028, nine of them inside Wesgro's current mandate and budget, and each one opens a baseline, a seat or a booking path that a later initiative needs.

The list is weighted the way Phase 1 is: seats, bookability, the green season, inclusion pilots and the data the rest of the plan reports on. Start dates are proposals in half-years. No action needs new capital; the funding route column says where the money comes from.

Table 4.3. First-24-month actions and funding

Twelve actions for the first 24 months use existing mandates and budgets and open the baselines and booking paths the later initiatives need.

Action	Initiative	Proposed owner	Start	Funding route	What it opens
Hold winter seats with demand: joint green-season marketing with carriers on the full routes	I6, I2	Air Access	2027 H1	Wesgro operating	Seats kept in May to September, when carriers cut first
Publish a green-season events calendar and aim bids at May to September	I2	Convention Bureau	2027 H1	Wesgro operating	A demand spine for the trough months
Track the runway programme quarterly and commission a capacity-against-demand model to 2035	I6	Air Access	2027 H1	Wesgro operating	Early warning on the binding constraint
Constitute Steerco with terms of reference and table the first escalation agenda	I15, I17	Wesgro CEO's office; DEDAT	2027 H1	Wesgro operating	One forum and one route to national decisions
Agree the data-sharing protocol with ACSA, SA Tourism, Stats SA and Cape Town Tourism	I16	Research	2027 H1	Wesgro operating	The feeds the scorecard needs
Run a bookability census of provincial product by district	I3	Research	2027 H1	Wesgro operating	The baseline for the bookability indicator
Request visitor counts and capacity from the five flagship sites	I11	Research	2027 H1	Wesgro operating	The flagship capacity baseline
Commission the tourism labour analysis behind the jobs ambition	I18	DEDAT, with Wesgro Research	2027 H1	Wesgro and DEDAT operating	A tested jobs target
Package the Garden Route and Route 62 with a shuttle transfer sold inside the itinerary	I8, I9	Tourism	2027 H2	Wesgro operating; operators	Car-free multi-day trips beyond the Metro
Package the Southern Line as a visitor product with the City and PRASA	I8	Tourism	2027 H2	Wesgro operating; City	A scenic rail route to Boulders and Simon's Town
Choose two or three pilot communities and agree with municipalities and LTOs who funds a seller with a stake in each	I12	Tourism	2027 H2	Municipal and LTO budgets	The first test of the inclusion model
Give each pilot community one live booking route before any promotion	I12, I3	LTOs, with Tourism	2028 H1	Municipal and LTO budgets	Community product that can be bought

Source: Letsema, from the Chapter 3 action tables and the initiative charters (section 4.3). Owners and start dates are proposals for Steerco to confirm.

4.6 Funding and investment

Most of the plan runs on budgets that already exist; the capital it needs sits with ACSA, PRASA, Transnet and private investors, and none of it has been costed yet.

No deliverable costs any initiative. The Inception Report scoped an investment opportunity framework with return scoring, but no separate output was delivered,[732] and stakeholders describe Western Cape tourism funding as materially below peer destinations without giving a figure.[733] Thirteen initiatives draw mainly on Wesgro's operating budget, and four need private capital as a main source; the initiatives table in section 4.1 gives each one's main and supporting funding routes. This section leaves the rand bands to be set with Wesgro Finance and DEDAT [cost band per initiative and phase: Wesgro Finance and DEDAT to set before Steerco signs off the plan]. Wesgro Finance and DEDAT also agree a stop list before Gate 1, naming the Wesgro work deprioritised to fund the initiatives (section 4.8). [Open item: Wesgro Finance to give an indicative rand band for the first 24 months.]

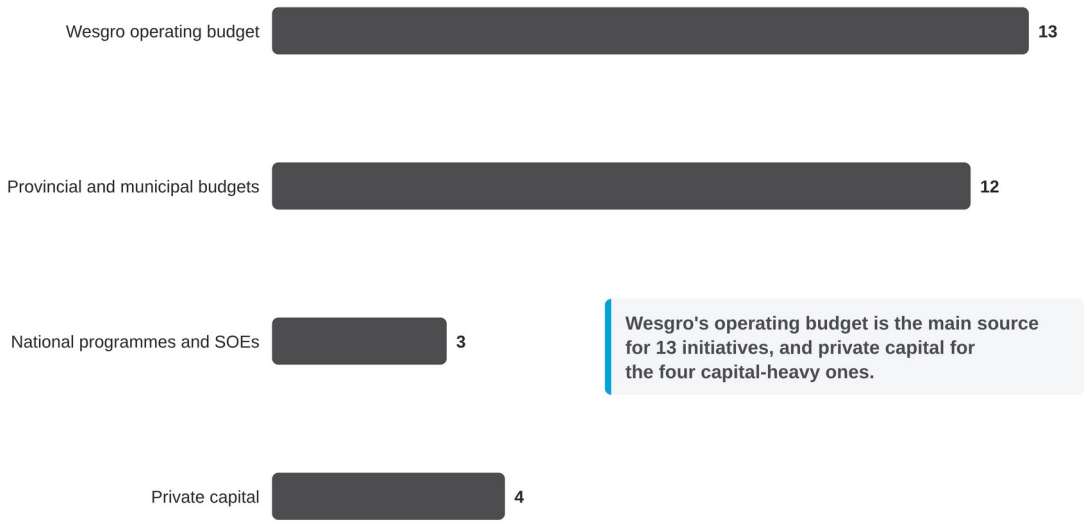


Figure 4.2. Initiatives by main funding source

Source: Letsema, count of initiatives by main funding source from Table 4.1. An initiative can have more than one main source.

Crowding in capital. The rule for capital is the Inclusion Plan's: invest after demand is shown, and attach a maintenance and marketing covenant to any public asset.[734] Wesgro's investment promotion work builds the tourism pipeline from the Infrastructure Report's gap-closure tables, where every district lists tourism gaps with no committed capital (I14).[735] The air access fund scales Cape Town Air Access's existing route fund with public and private money (I6).

What the SLA asks and what is still to do. The SLA asks for return projections on infrastructure priorities (clause 1.1.8.3) [clause wording to be checked against the signed Annexure B]. Those need costed projects, and the only costed items in hand are the airport, rail and port programmes the province does not fund. The return case is therefore an output of I14 in Phase 1, built project by project as the pipeline forms.

[732] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p18, p20.
[733] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p25.
[734] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p15, p31, p32.
[735] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p32 to p87.

4.7 Delivery governance

One Steerco, one programme office and four fixed decision points keep eighteen initiatives and three tiers of government on one plan.



Figure 4.3. Delivery governance structure

Source: Letsema, proposed delivery governance.

Steerco. A Tourism Growth Steerco co-chaired by Wesgro's CEO and DEDAT's Head of Department, with Cape Town Tourism as a standing member and the City of Cape Town, the district municipalities and the industry bodies at the table. It is distinct from the Unlocking Tourism Steerco that oversees this study. It receives the quarterly scorecard, clears cross-initiative issues, holds the escalation agenda and recommends gate decisions to the Board. Stakeholders asked for this kind of alignment directly: mobility responsibilities alone are split across three tiers of government.[736]

Programme office. A small office inside Wesgro runs the plan on a build, operate and transfer basis. It builds the charters, the dashboard and the reporting calendar in Phase 1, runs them through Phase 2 and hands them to the line units by the end of 2031. It owns the scorecard and the dashboard, and Wesgro Research owns the indicator definitions and the data protocol (I16).

Cadence. Initiative leads report monthly to the programme office, Steerco meets quarterly and the Board receives an annual outlook, which also anchors the Unlocking Tourism business outlook event. The plan is refreshed each year against the indicators and the gate decisions.

Table 4.4. Decision gates and reviews

Four decision points test the plan against its indicators, and each one decides what the next phase funds.

Gate	When	What it tests	What it decides
Gate 1	End 2028	Seats on full routes held or added (T2-09, T2-10); bookability baseline published and moving (T2-04); pilots against thresholds (T2-17); data protocol live (T2-23)	Move to Expand; scale or stop each pilot; confirm route cases for India and China, and bring them into Phase 2 if ACSA awards the runway contract on its December 2029 schedule

[736] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p23.

Gate	When	What it tests	What it decides
Mid-term review	2030	Arrivals against the base path at the model's seat line (T1-01); peak-hour runway headroom; runway on its published dates; green-season share (T1-05)	Re-sequence Phase 2 if peak capacity binds early or relief slips
Gate 2	End 2031	Spend and spread (T1-03, T1-06); corridor readiness (T2-14); investment at financial close (T2-20)	Commit Phase 3 funding; take direct route cases to carriers
Terminal evaluation	2035	All Tier 1 indicators against the base and accelerated paths	Close the plan and set the next one

Source: Letsema, proposed gates; indicator codes from section 5.2.

4.8 Risks and dependencies

Ten of the fourteen material risks sit outside Wesgro's control, so the mitigation for most of them is early warning and a route to the tier that can act.

Likelihood and impact are Letsema's assessment on a three-point scale, from the evidence cited in each row. Steerco reviews the register each quarter and the owner reports on any risk rated high on both.

Table 4.5. Risks and their mitigation

Fourteen risks could move the plan off its path, and the one rated high on both measures concerns the national air regime.

Risk	Evidence	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation	Owner
Runway relief at Cape Town International slips past about 2033	IR p103, p109	Medium	High	Quarterly milestone tracking; frequency and gauge on full routes; George for domestic connections (I6)	Air Access; ACSA
Bilateral air agreements and the US carrier cap stay restrictive	SIR p24; Inc p8	High	High	Escalation agenda with stated asks (I17); route work inside existing rights (I6)	Steerco; DEDAT
Visa processing for China, India and African markets does not improve	SIR p36, p45; Diag p34	Medium	High	Escalation agenda; processing time tracked as T2-24 (I17)	Steerco
Safety incidents or perception deter visitors	Diag p55; SCIP p27, p30	Medium	High	Safety gates before any pilot launch (I12); escalation to SAPS (I17)	Tourism; Steerco
Climate events close sites and routes	SCIP p24; SIR p33, p43	High	Medium	Climate risk register; itineraries routed around closures (I13)	Research; DEDAT
Water and power supply fail in peak season	Diag p38, p43; IR p31	Medium	Medium	Escalation of utility risks; off-grid power at remote sites (I13, I17)	DEDAT; site operators
LTO funding collapses under MFMA Circular No. 131	SIR p25, p39	High	Medium	Stable funding agreements with a development mandate (I13)	DEDAT; municipalities
Data holders do not share data	SIR p37; Diag p57	Medium	Medium	Data-sharing protocol with each holder (I16)	Research
Cruise growth reverses as Red Sea reroutes end	IR p112	Medium	Low	Diversify lines and add Mossel Bay day stops (I7)	Cruise Cape Town
Skills shortages cap service quality	SIR p43; Inc p8	Medium	Medium	Labour analysis and skills plan (I18); quality charter (I10)	Research; DEDAT
Gulf hub disruption cuts connecting capacity	Hub routes carry 53% of arrivals on the ten largest routes (DSA p13)	Medium	High	Spread hub-carrier work across Dubai, Doha, Addis Ababa and Istanbul; keep direct-route cases ready (I4, I6)	Air Access
A downturn in the core markets	The UK, Germany and the USA supply 52% of overseas arrivals (DSA p13)	Medium	High	Rebalance activation towards Africa and the hub markets (I1, I4, I5)	Destination Marketing
Wesgro's operating budget is cut	Thirteen initiatives draw mainly on Wesgro's operating budget (Table 4.1)	Medium	High	Rand bands and a stop list agreed with DEDAT before Gate 1 (section 4.6)	Wesgro CEO's office; DEDAT

Risk	Evidence	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation	Owner
Resident pushback in the Metro	Public debate on locals' costs and access (Hypertext, Apr 2026)	Medium	Medium	Spread visitors in time and space (I2, I8, I9); track resident sentiment	City of Cape Town; Cape Town Tourism

Source: Letsema assessment. Evidence: Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025 (Diag); Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026 (DSA); Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR); Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR); SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026 (SCIP); Inception Report, Nov 2025 (Inc).

Chapter 5

Monitoring and evaluation framework

5.1 Results chain

Every initiative is measured at three levels: what it produces, what changes because of it and what that adds to the 2035 case.

The framework is the written form of the M&E toolkit the SLA requires (clauses 1.1.4 and 1.1.10). It sets indicators, baselines and targets for arrivals, spend, jobs, airlift, cruise and SMME inclusion, with the tools to track them [clause wording to be checked against the signed Annexure B]. The Inception Report adds geographic spread and asks for definitions, sources, frequency, owners and governance for each indicator.[737]

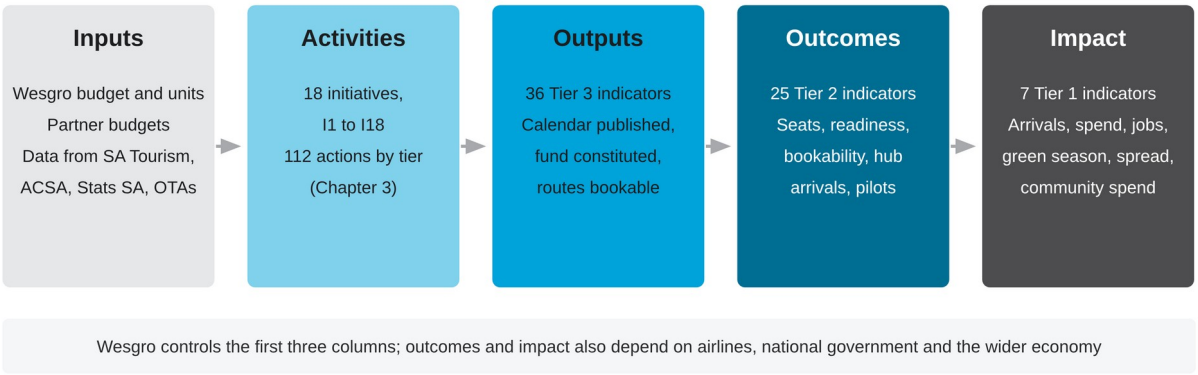


Figure 5.1. Results chain for the plan

Source: Letsema, results chain for the plan.

The table below gives the chain for each initiative, pillar by pillar. Tier 3 output indicators come from the initiative charters, Tier 2 outcome indicators from the focus areas and Tier 1 impact indicators from the growth case.

Table 5.1. Results chain by initiative

Pillar 1 initiatives (I1 to I5) move arrivals, market mix, spend and the green-season share. Pillar 2 initiatives (I6 to I11) move seats, cruise volumes and the share of visitors and spend outside the Metro. Pillar 3 initiatives (I12 to I18) move community spend and jobs, and supply the governance and data every other indicator relies on.

Initiative (activity)	Outputs (Tier 3)	Outcomes (Tier 2)	Impact (Tier 1)
I1 Segment-led activation and yield	T3-01, T3-02 segment targets set; spend moved to conversion	T2-01 segment home-market arrivals; T2-07 mature-market spend per visitor	T1-01, T1-02, T1-03
I2 Green-season events calendar	T3-03, T3-04 calendar published; green-season bids	T2-02 ICCA meetings; T2-03 April to September seat share	T1-05
I3 Bookable province	T3-05, T3-06 census published; operators onboarded	T2-04 operators bookable online; T2-05 CapeNature online share	T1-06
I4 India and China hub conversion	T3-07, T3-08 carrier agreements; route cases	T2-06 India and China hub arrivals	T1-01, T1-02
I5 Regional Africa	T3-09, T3-10 activation run; capacity cases	T2-08 African arrivals and spend	T1-02, T1-03
I6 Route development and seat retention	T3-11, T3-12 fund constituted; runway reports	T2-09 seats and routes; T2-10 seats added on full routes	T1-01
I7 Cruise growth through product	T3-13, T3-14 excursions listed; lines engaged	T2-11 cruise calls and passengers	T1-03

[737] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p23.

Initiative (activity)	Outputs (Tier 3)	Outcomes (Tier 2)	Impact (Tier 1)
I8 Corridor mobility	T3-15, T3-16 Southern Line product; shuttles bookable	T2-12 accessibility; T2-13 corridor transfer products	T1-06
I9 Corridor product development	T3-17, T3-18 itineraries listed; assets activated	T2-14 readiness by district	T1-06
I10 Visitor experience and quality	T3-19, T3-20 charter adopted; businesses certified	T2-15 routes rated Ready	T1-03
I11 Flagship site demand management	T3-21, T3-22 baseline published; flow tools in place	T2-16 peak Cableway queue	T1-06
I12 Community inclusion pilots	T3-23, T3-24 pilots selected; tests held	T2-17 communities with a live booking route	T1-07
I13 Climate resilience and LTO funding	T3-25, T3-26 risk register; funding model	T2-18 LTOs funded; T2-19 weather losses	T1-06
I14 Tourism investment pipeline	T3-27, T3-28 cases prepared; investor engagements	T2-20 projects at financial close	T1-03, T1-04
I15 Steerco and three-tier alignment	T3-29, T3-30 quarterly Steerco; joint industry plan	T2-21 escalations resolved; T2-22 partners in the joint plan	All
I16 Data protocol and intelligence	T3-31, T3-32 agreements signed; dashboard live	T2-23 data feeds in the dashboard	All
I17 Access and safety escalation	T3-33, T3-34 agenda tabled; responses logged	T2-24 visa processing time	T1-01, T1-02
I18 Labour analysis and skills plan	T3-35, T3-36 analysis published; skills plan adopted	T2-25 labour analysis published	T1-04

Source: Initiative charters (section 4.3); indicator register (section 5.2).

5.2 Indicator set

Seven impact indicators, twenty-five outcome indicators and thirty-six output indicators measure the plan, each with a definition, a source, an owner and a frequency.

Tier 1 measures the 2035 case and is reported to the Board. Tier 2 measures the focus areas, one or two each, and is reported to Steerco each quarter where the source allows. Tier 3 measures the initiatives' own outputs and is reported by the leads to the programme office each month. The full register, with targets, sits in the toolkit (section 5.7).

Table 5.2. Tier 1 impact indicators

Code	Indicator	Definition	Source	Frequency	Owner
T1-01	International arrivals	Arrivals, growth-model basis; quarterly proxy: international passenger arrivals at CTIA	SA Tourism; ACSA	Annual; quarterly proxy	Research
T1-02	Arrivals by market group	Arrivals in the mature, hub, regional, acceleration and strategic groups	SA Tourism [Open item: SA Tourism cannot report the Hubs group; Skift to define it.]	Annual	Research
T1-03	Direct foreign spend	Foreign direct spend in the Western Cape, rand	SA Tourism	Annual; quarterly shares	Research
T1-04	Tourism jobs	Tourism jobs in the Western Cape, on the measure the labour analysis sets (I18)	Labour analysis (I18); Stats SA TSA	Annual	Research
T1-05	Green-season share	Share of overseas visitor travel in April to September	SA Tourism; Wesgro visitor tracking	Annual	Research
T1-06	Share outside the Metro	Share of arrivals and of spend recorded outside the Cape Metro	SA Tourism provincial data; data protocol	Annual	Research
T1-07	Community share of foreign direct spend	Spend traced to businesses trading inside the pilot communities, as a share of foreign direct spend; widened to the 20 shortlisted communities once a source covers them	Pilot records; SA Tourism	Annual	Tourism; Research

Source: Letsema, indicator register; SLA clauses 1.1.4 and 1.1.10; Inception Report, Nov 2025, p22, p23. Baselines and targets in section 5.3.

Table 5.3. Tier 2 outcome indicators

Twenty-five Tier 2 indicators give each focus area one or two outcome measures, and seven of them have no baseline yet.

Code	Indicator	Focus area	Baseline	Source
T2-01	Arrivals from the four largest segment home markets (UK, Germany, USA, India)	1	503,277 (2025, computed)	MA p21, p22
T2-02	ICCA association meetings in Cape Town	2	58 (2024)	DSA p37
T2-03	April to September share of international seats at CTIA	2	41.8% (2025, computed)	MIDAS, Seasonality
T2-04	Share of operators bookable online, by district	3	Not in hand; about 40% or more of smaller operators lack online booking (Metro slide, scope not stated)	IR p32

Code	Indicator	Focus area	Baseline	Source
T2-05	CapeNature reservations made online	3	About 70% through the call centre	SIR p42
T2-06	India and China arrivals via hubs	4	India 76,547; China with Hong Kong 43,412 (2025, model value)	MA p20, p22
T2-07	Spend per visitor, mature markets	5	USA R32,900; UK R26,500; Germany R25,600 (2024)	DSA p14
T2-08	African arrivals and spend	6	292,514 arrivals (2025, model value, regional group); R4.2bn spend (2025)	MA p20; DSA p29
T2-09	International seats and routes at CTIA	7	3,816,797 seats, printed network total (27 routes tabled; year to Nov 2025); 29 routes (2026)	MIDAS, The Capetown Market; Seasonality
T2-10	Seats added on routes above 80% load	7	11 routes above 80% (year to Nov 2025); seats added from the capacity-against-demand model (I6)	MIDAS, Seasonality
T2-11	Cruise calls and passengers	8	79 vessels; 127,178 passengers (2024/25); the Infrastructure Report counts 83 calls (p110)	Diag p37
T2-12	Accessibility score by district	9	Metro 4.7 to Central Karoo 1.0 (2026)	IR p88
T2-13	Corridor transfer products on sale	9	No inter-town tourism shuttle on the Garden Route	IR p90
T2-14	Overall readiness by district	10	Metro 4.5; Garden Route and Winelands 3.4; Overberg 2.7; West Coast 2.5; Central Karoo 1.9	IR p28 to p85
T2-15	Touring routes rated Ready	11	1 of 6 (2026)	IR p30, p40, p51, p62, p73, p84
T2-16	Peak queue at the Cableway	12	Up to three hours up and two down	SIR p36
T2-17	Communities with a live booking route	13	0 of 19 profiled rate Ready on bookability	SCIP p20 to p26, p40 to p51
T2-18	LTOs with a funding agreement	14	Not in hand	SIR p25
T2-19	Weather losses at flagship sites	14	Robben Island roughly R16m a year	SIR p33
T2-20	Tourism projects at financial close	15	None; tourism gaps carry no committed capital	IR p32 to p87
T2-21	Escalation items answered by the national tier	16	No agenda tabled yet	This plan
T2-22	Industry partners signed up to the joint plan	17	No joint plan; 15 of 16 organisations raised collaboration	SIR p20 to p46
T2-23	Automated data feeds in the dashboard	18	None; no dashboard	This plan
T2-24	Visa processing time, priority markets	19	Not in hand	SIR p36, p45
T2-25	Tourism labour analysis published	20	No labour analysis in any deliverable	Inc p4

Source: Chapter 3 evidence tables. MA: Market Assessment Report, May 2026. DSA: Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026. IR: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026. SIR: Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026. SCIP: SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026. Diag: Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025. Inc: Inception Report, Nov 2025. MIDAS: MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026. Computed values are sums or shares of printed figures.

The seven without a baseline are T2-04, T2-18, T2-20, T2-21, T2-23, T2-24 and T2-25. Each carries no target until its baseline exists, on the dates in Table 5.7.

Table 5.4. Tier 3 output indicators

Codes	Initiative	Outputs
T3-01, T3-02	I1	Segment targets in Wesgro's annual plan; share of market budget in trade-led conversion
T3-03, T3-04	I2	Green-season calendar published; bids submitted for May to September events
T3-05, T3-06	I3	Bookability census published; operators onboarded to online booking

Codes	Initiative	Outputs
T3-07, T3-08	I4	Joint marketing agreements with hub carriers; India and China route cases prepared
T3-09, T3-10	I5	Activation programmes run in Nigeria and Kenya; regional capacity cases made
T3-11, T3-12	I6	Air access fund constituted; quarterly runway milestone reports issued
T3-13, T3-14	I7	Excursion packages listed; lines engaged on expedition and home-porting
T3-15, T3-16	I8	Southern Line visitor product launched; corridor shuttle products bookable
T3-17, T3-18	I9	Multi-day itineraries listed per route; cold-zone assets activated
T3-19, T3-20	I10	Quality charter adopted; businesses certified
T3-21, T3-22	I11	Flagship baseline published; flow-management tools in place
T3-23, T3-24	I12	Pilot communities selected; fixed-date tests held
T3-25, T3-26	I13	Climate risk register published; LTO funding model agreed
T3-27, T3-28	I14	Investment cases prepared; investor engagements held
T3-29, T3-30	I15	Steerco meetings held each quarter; joint industry plan agreed
T3-31, T3-32	I16	Data-sharing agreements signed; dashboard live
T3-33, T3-34	I17	Escalation agenda tabled; responses logged
T3-35, T3-36	I18	Labour analysis published; skills plan adopted

Source: Initiative charters, section 4.3. Each output has a baseline of zero at the start of 2027.

5.3 Baselines and targets

The arrivals targets come straight from the growth model, while the jobs and other Tier 1 targets wait for baselines that do not yet exist.

Baselines are fixed at 2025, the growth model's base year, for the growth-model indicators and at FY2024/25 for the airport series, the recovery baseline used in Chapter 1. Targets follow two paths: the base case, which assumes Wesgro's current activity continues with hub carriers adding capacity, and the accelerated case, which adds direct India and China routes and dedicated activation.[738] The model prints the base case for 2028, 2030, 2032, 2034 and 2035, and the other paths for 2035 only. The 2031 base value and the accelerated milestones are computed and marked as such.

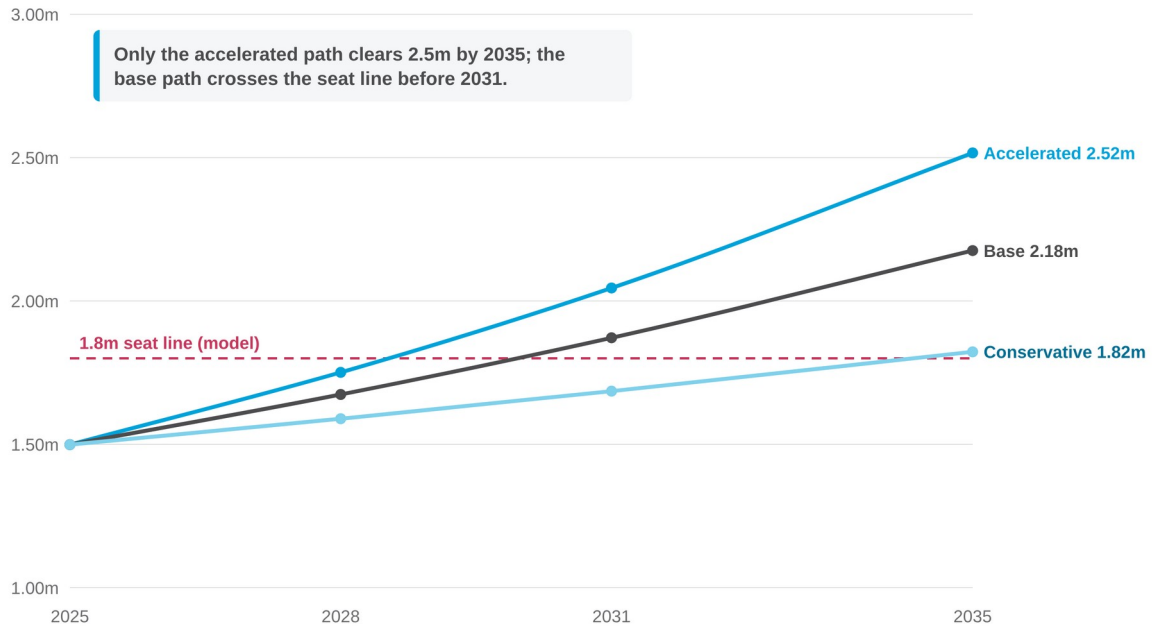


Figure 5.2. Arrivals paths and milestones to 2035

Source: Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19 (2025 base); Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p20, p21 (2028 and 2035 points; 1.8m seat line). The 2031 base value is the geometric mean of the printed 2030 and 2032 points; the accelerated and conservative milestones are computed at a constant rate between the printed 2025 and 2035 values.

Table 5.5. Tier 1 baselines and targets

Arrivals carry targets on both paths; spend carries the working analysis's base path; jobs and the other Tier 1 indicators set baselines first.

Indicator	Baseline	2028 base / accelerated	2031 base / accelerated	2035 base / accelerated
T1-01 International arrivals	1,498,829 (2025, model value); CTIA 1.44m (FY24/25)	1,673,855 / 1,750,871*	1,871,637 / *2,045,297*	2,175,778 / 2,516,282
T1-02 Arrivals by market group	Mature 587,287; hubs 427,803; regional 292,514; acceleration 182,815 (2025)	Base path by group, section 2.2	2030: 670,350; 523,523; 343,096; 255,159	766,067; 634,387; 402,812; 358,633 (base); accelerated not split

[738] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p19.

Indicator	Baseline	2028 base / accelerated	2031 base / accelerated	2035 base / accelerated
T1-03 Direct foreign spend	R25.9bn (FY2025, nominal)	Not printed	R33.7bn in 2030 (base, modelled, constant 2024 rand)	R40.6bn (base, modelled, constant 2024 rand); accelerated not modelled
T1-04 Tourism jobs	Set by the labour analysis (I18)	Set at Gate 1	Set at Gate 1	Set at Gate 1
T1-05 Green-season share	38.1% (2025, normalised); 39% (2024)	Level set at Gate 1	Rising	Rising
T1-06 Share outside the Metro	Not in hand; baseline due in 2027 from the data protocol	Baseline set	Rising	Rising
T1-07 Community share of spend	0.02% to 0.04%; R4m to R10m a year (floor)	Pilots measured	Level set after the pilots	1% (R259m at FY2025 spend) as the reference point

Source: T1-01: Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19; Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p11, p20, p21 (computed values marked *). T1-02: Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p20. T1-03: Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p11 (baseline); Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p24 (modelled base path, working analysis). T1-04: baseline and targets to be set by the labour analysis (I18). T1-05: Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p12; Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p32. T1-07: SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p5.

Arrivals. The model's 2025 base and the airport series measure different things: arrivals on the growth model's basis, which Skift is to confirm (section 1.1), and international passenger arrivals at Cape Town International. The airport series is the quarterly proxy because ACSA publishes it, and it stood at 1.44m in FY24/25 and 1.57m in FY25/26.[739] Both are reported, each against its own history.

Spend. T1-03's path holds spend per arrival fixed, so its targets are in constant 2024 rand, while SA Tourism reports nominal rand; progress is read after deflating by CPI. The model's 2024 spend of R27.12bn sits 19% above the R22.7bn SA Tourism reported for FY2024.[740] [Open item: Skift to rebase the spend path on the FY2025 actual of R25.9bn.]

Jobs. No deliverable carries a provincial tourism employment baseline, and the Pero tourism table could not be retrieved [provincial tourism employment baseline: Wesgro Research to supply from the Pero 2025 or the Stats SA provincial TSA]. T1-04 therefore carries no baseline or modelled path until the labour analysis sets a provincial measure (I18).

The report restates the 300,000 as a total-sector figure for the labour analysis to test (I18). For context, public sources put direct tourism employment at 106,707 in Cape Town in 2024[741] and 953,981 nationally in 2024.[742]

Green season. The 2025 month table sums to 104.9%. Normalised, it gives 61.9% for October to March and 38.1% for the green season, in line with the printed 61% and 39% for 2024.[743] T1-05 uses 38.1% as its baseline.

Spread and community spend. No deliverable prints district visitor spend, so the share outside the Metro has no baseline until the data protocol delivers one (I16). The community share starts from the Inclusion Plan's traced floor; its 1% is a reference point the plan prints, not a target any party has adopted.[744]

[739] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p11.
[740] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p10, p24.
[741] City of Cape Town, Economic Value of Tourism, 2025.
[742] Stats SA Tourism Satellite Account, provisional, as reported in 2026.
[743] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p12; Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p32.
[744] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p5.

5.4 Data sources and gaps

Arrivals, seats and cruise volumes can be tracked from existing feeds; spread, bookability, jobs and community spend cannot until new data is built or shared.

Stakeholders put data among the top barriers: no approved methodology exists for provincial tourism GDP and jobs,[745] and no one holds a single view of visitor behaviour.[746] The data-sharing protocol under focus area 18 (I16) is the route to closing the gaps below.

Table 5.6. Data sources and holders

Source	Holder	Indicators	Frequency	Status
Departure survey and performance reports	SA Tourism	T1-01 to T1-03, T1-05, T2-07, T2-08	Quarterly and annual	Published; provincial cuts on request
Passenger statistics and schedules	ACSA; OAG	T1-01 proxy, T2-03, T2-09	Monthly	Available; automated feed possible
GDS bookings by route	MIDAS or a data vendor	T2-06, T2-10	Annual	Repeat commission needed
Cruise season economic contribution	Cruise Cape Town (economic contribution study)	T2-11	Each season	Received by Wesgro; study not in this evidence base
Infrastructure readiness scores	Wesgro; Letsema method	T2-12, T2-14, T2-15	Every three years	Re-score in 2029 and 2032 [Open item: publish the scoring formula before the 2029 re-score; the Infrastructure Report's overall ratings are judgement-based (Appendix A4).]
Operator, site and pilot records	LTOs; CapeNature; site operators; pilots	T2-04, T2-05, T2-16, T2-17, T2-19	Annual	New collection under the protocol

Source: Letsema, from the indicator register; data holders in part as listed in Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p56, p57.

Table 5.7. Data gaps and owners

Ten data gaps stand between the plan and a full baseline, and each has a proposed owner and date.

Gap	Indicator	Proposed owner	Proposed date	Route
District-level visitor arrivals and spend	T1-06	Research	End 2027	SA Tourism cut; protocol
Provincial tourism employment baseline	T1-04	Research	Mid 2027	Pero; Stats SA provincial TSA
Count of bookable products by district	T2-04	Research	End 2027	Bookability census (I3)
Visitor counts and capacity at five flagship sites	T2-16	Research	End 2027	Request to operators (I11)
Meetings, incentives and exhibitions volumes	T2-02	Convention Bureau	End 2028	Venue and DMC returns
LTOs and their municipal funding	T2-18	DEDAT	End 2027	LTO survey
Visa processing times by market	T2-24	Wesgro CEO's office	End 2027	Request to Home Affairs (I17)
Nigeria and Ghana in the growth model	T1-02	Research	Mid 2027	Model update

[745] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p37.
[746] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p56, p57.

Gap	Indicator	Proposed owner	Proposed date	Route
Source and definition of the 250 cruise-call plan	T2-11	Cruise Cape Town	Mid 2027	Cruise Cape Town
Mid-scale accommodation stock by district	T2-15	Research	End 2028	Supply database or audit

Source: Letsema, from the placeholders in Chapters 3 and 5; owners and dates proposed for Steerco to confirm.

5.5 Tracking mechanism

A quarterly scorecard to Steerco, an annual outlook to the Board and a live dashboard where the sources allow it.

Four principles run the tracking. Automate before collecting by hand: arrivals, seats and cruise volumes come from feeds that already exist. Name one owner for the dashboard (the programme office) and one for the definitions (Wesgro Research). Report every indicator against its own baseline and both paths. Refresh the register each year at the plan review.

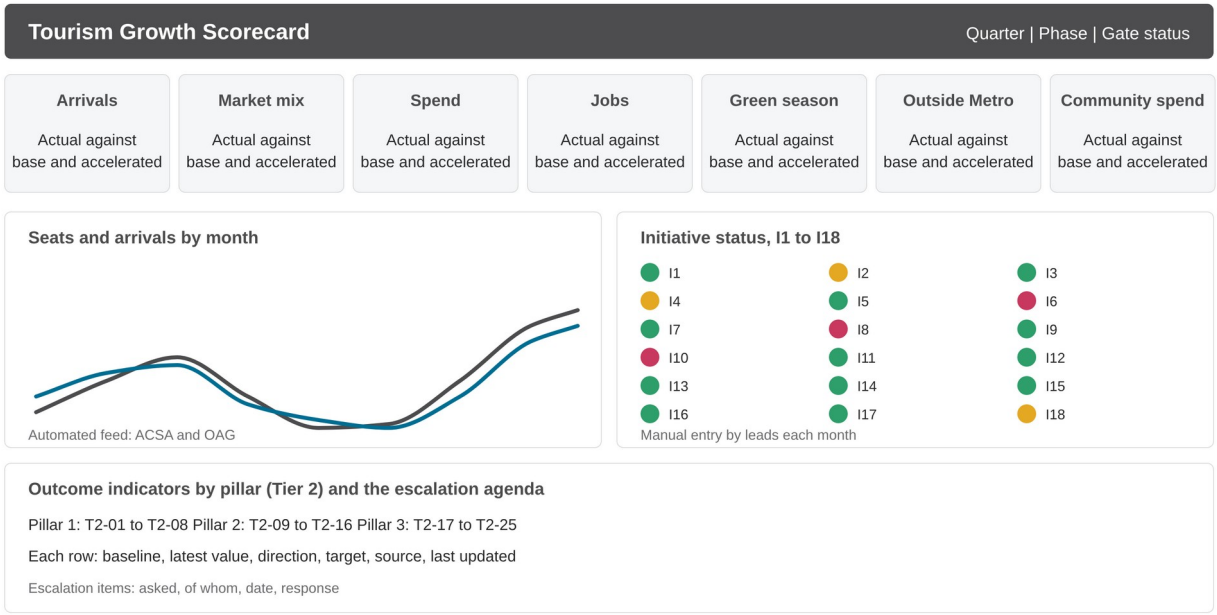


Figure 5.3. Quarterly scorecard layout

Source: Letsema, dashboard concept. Illustrative layout; no values shown.

Reporting runs on a fixed calendar tied to Steerco and the Board. Each month, the leads send Tier 3 outputs, initiative status and the seats and arrivals feeds to the programme office as a dashboard update. Each quarter, the programme office takes Tier 2 outcomes where available, the risks rated high and the escalation responses to Steerco in the scorecard. Each year, Steerco takes Tier 1 impact against both paths, the plan refresh and gate status to the Board in an outlook report, made public at the business outlook event. At each gate, Steerco sends the Board a gate paper on the tests in section 4.7.

5.6 Evaluation and learning

Two evaluations bracket the plan: a mid-term review in 2030, when the base case crosses the model's seat line, and a terminal evaluation in 2035.

The mid-term review tests whether the plan is on its path and whether the path still holds. It falls in 2030 because that is when the base case crosses the model's 1.8 million seat line,[747] before runway relief on the planning date.[748] The terminal evaluation in 2035 measures the result against both paths and sets up the next plan. Both should be run by a party independent of the programme office.

Each pillar carries two evaluation questions, one on results and one on the assumptions behind them. For Reshape demand: did arrivals, spend per visitor and the green-season share move with the activation, and in which markets and segments? Is conversion still the constraint, or has access overtaken it in the growth markets? For Transform supply: did seats, readiness and bookability rise outside the Metro, and did visitors follow? Did the airport relief arrive on time, and did the second gateways carry the load meanwhile? For Build enabling capability: did the pilots meet their thresholds, and did community spend rise? Did the national asks get answers, and did the data protocol deliver the baselines?

Pilots before capital. The inclusion pilots are evaluated before any capital is committed, on the Inclusion Plan's own measures: bookings, visitors and locally retained revenue.[749] A pilot scales only when it meets the thresholds agreed before launch.[750] The same rule applies to any product or asset investment under I9 and I14: test demand, then invest.

Learning into the plan. Findings from each review, gate and pilot go into the annual plan refresh under section 4.7, so the charters, targets and sequence change with the evidence rather than at the end of the plan.

5.7 Toolkit handover

The M&E toolkit turns this chapter into four working files that Wesgro Research owns from handover.

The four files are the indicator register, the baseline workbook, the scorecard template and the dashboard data model (SLA clauses 1.1.10.2 and 1.1.15.3) [clause wording to be checked against the signed Annexure B]. The indicator register holds all 68 indicators with their definition, unit, source, frequency, owner, baseline and target by year and path. The baseline workbook holds the baseline values with page references to the deliverables, and the computed values with their method. Wesgro Research owns both. The programme office owns the scorecard template, which carries the quarterly Steerco scorecard and the annual Board outlook. It also owns the dashboard data model: the feeds, refresh frequency and manual-entry forms for the dashboard in section 5.5.

Handover runs through knowledge-transfer sessions with Wesgro Research and the programme office, as the SLA requires (clause 1.1.15). The Excel toolkit itself is outside this report and is listed as an open item [M&E toolkit workbook: Letsema to deliver with the final report].

[747] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p21.
[748] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p103.
[749] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p33.
[750] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p32.

Appendices

A1 Hypothesis evaluation evidence

Every focus area traces back to the evidence behind it and forward to its initiative and indicators, with a rating for the strength of that evidence.

The first table sets out what the evidence supports for each focus area and rates its strength on a three-point scale: strong, adequate or thin. The second table traces each focus area back to its workstream and the sections that discuss it, and forward to its initiative and indicators.

Table A.1. Strength of evidence by focus area

Nine focus areas rest on strong evidence and ten on adequate evidence; only focus area 20 is thin, and several figures hold only with a qualifier.

Focus area	What the evidence supports	Strength
1 Respond to growth segment traveller preferences	Four segments confirmed against markets of high incidence; the segmentation is directional and leaves out the domestic and seven African markets	Strong
2 Create green-season demand with MICE and events	June holds 6.4% of 2025 international seat capacity; ICCA meetings 33 to 58 from 2022 to 2024	Strong
3 Make the whole province findable and bookable	CapeNature takes about 70% of reservations through its call centre, and community product sells by phone; no count of bookable products exists	Adequate
4 Convert India and China hub traffic	About 101,000 journeys a year via hubs, the sum of two printed estimates, 71,000 and 30,000; the hub tables sum to 97,579	Strong
5 Increase yield in mature markets	Five mature long-haul routes above 80% load; no fare or yield data	Adequate
6 Build a regional foundation (Africa)	Nigeria R31,000 and Ghana R27,700 a visit, read as spend per visitor; the printed averages do not reproduce from the totals	Strong
7 Win direct routes and add seats on full routes	Eleven of 27 routes run above 80% load and sixteen at 75% or more, and carriers are expected to raise fares before adding seats; no frequency, aircraft-size or peak-slot data shows where seats can be added	Adequate
8 Grow cruise calls and ports	79 vessels (Diagnostic) against 83 calls (Infrastructure Report) in 2024/25; a plan to 250 calls appears in no deliverable	Adequate
9 Accelerate tourism-enabling internal mobility	Accessibility falls from 4.7 to 1.0 on the attractions and services basis; the transport basis gives 5.0 to 1.0	Strong
10 Support diversified route and product development	Cold zones, the Infrastructure Report's term for areas with tourism assets but little or no tourism use; no count of idle assets	Strong
11 Align visitor experience in-destination	A mid-scale gap, stated in words; no room or bed count	Adequate
12 Balance impact on nature-based attractions	Stakeholder statements and queue times; no visitor counts or caps for any flagship	Adequate
13 Embed local destination bodies for community inclusion	Seller with a stake, 20 communities and R259m a year at 1% of FY2025 foreign direct spend; one page prints 18 shortlisted, and the spend-tracing method is not described	Strong
14 Manage climate risk and sustainable tourism	LTO funding disrupted and Meiringspoort closed, from two organisations' statements and the Inclusion Plan's De Rust profile	Adequate
15 Crowd in capital with targeted investment strategies	An inference: a large capital pipeline exists and almost none of it reaches regional product, SME bookability or township product	Adequate
16 Align institutional stakeholders across all three tiers	Air rights and visas sit nationally, as the Diagnostic's tier table shows; no decision-rights map exists	Adequate
17 Strengthen industry and government collaboration	Raised by 15 of 16 organisations, a reconstructed count of organisations, not insight rows	Strong

Focus area	What the evidence supports	Strength
18 Expedite tourism-enabling policy and data sharing	Platforms exist; no data-sharing protocol in progress is described	Adequate
19 Lead removal of infrastructure, visa and safety deficits	Levers sit nationally for visas and air rights; safety programmes are provincial and basic services local	Strong
20 Develop workforce and service skills	No provincial tourism employment baseline in any deliverable; the labour analysis is still to be commissioned	Thin

Source: Reading and strength from the evidence notes behind Chapter 3. Strong: the figure and finding are printed in two deliverables or in one with a full table. Adequate: supported, with a figure missing, different or from one source. Thin: side mentions only.

Table A.2. Traceability by focus area

Focus area	Workstream	Sections	Initiative	Indicators
1 Respond to growth segment traveller preferences	Skift segmentation (March 2026), carried into the Market Assessment and Demand-Side Analysis	2.2	I1	T1-01; T1-02; T2-01
2 Create green-season demand with MICE and events	MIDAS seasonality (June 6.4% of international seats) and the Demand-Side MICE section (ICCA, UIA)	2.2; 2.1; 2.3	I2	T1-05; T2-02; T2-03
3 Make the whole province findable and bookable	Inclusion plan (community product sold by phone), Stakeholder Insights (Cape Nature 70% through the call centre), Infrastructure Report (route bookability gaps, no OTA presence in rural stock)	2.2; 2.1; 2.3; 2.4	I3	T2-04; T2-05
4 Convert India and China hub traffic	Demand-Side route-to-market (71,000 India and 30,000 China via hubs) and MIDAS (same figures; no direct route before 2030)	2.2; 2.1; 2.3; 1.2	I4	T1-02; T2-06
5 Increase yield in mature markets	MIDAS (mature long-haul routes above 80% load; carriers raise fares before adding seats) with the Demand-Side mature-market projection	2.2; 2.1; 2.3	I1	T1-03; T2-07
6 Build a regional foundation (Africa)	Demand-Side African opportunity section and Skift African memo; MIDAS regional route loads	2.2; 2.3; 1.2	I5	T1-02; T2-08
7 Win direct routes and add seats on full routes	MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment; Infrastructure Report air-access section	2.3; 2.1	I6	T1-01; T2-09; T2-10
8 Grow cruise calls and ports	Diagnostic cruise table and Infrastructure Report cruise and ports section; Wesgro cruise reports (not in hand)	2.3; 1.2	I7	T2-11
9 Accelerate tourism-enabling internal mobility	Infrastructure Report comparative regional analysis; Stakeholder Insights (Department of Mobility)	2.3; 1.2	I8	T1-06; T2-12; T2-13
10 Support diversified route and product development	Infrastructure Report spatial maps and route scorecards; Stakeholder Insights (11 of 16 organisations)	2.3; 2.4	I9	T1-06; T2-14
11 Align visitor experience in-destination	Infrastructure Report accommodation mapping; Stakeholder Insights (service quality); Benchmarking (Valencia, Singapore)	2.3; 2.1	I10	T2-15

Focus area	Workstream	Sections	Initiative	Indicators
12 Balance impact on nature-based attractions	Stakeholder Insights (Boulders near capacity, Table Mountain queues); Infrastructure Report flagship congestion	2.3; 2.1; 1.2	I11	T2-16
13 Embed local destination bodies for community inclusion	SME and Community Inclusion Plan (September 2026)	2.4; 2.1	I12	T1-07; T2-17
14 Manage climate risk and sustainable tourism	Stakeholder Insights (MFMA Circular No. 131, LTO sustainability, climate losses); Inclusion plan De Rust profile (Meiringspoort closed 6 May 2026)	2.4; 2.1; 1.2	I13	T2-18; T2-19
15 Crowd in capital with targeted investment strategies	Infrastructure Report pipeline and gap-closure tables (gaps with no committed capital); Stakeholder Insights (funding below peers); Benchmarking (Chile concession, New Zealand route fund)	2.4; 2.1; 2.3	I14	T2-20
16 Align institutional stakeholders across all three tiers	Stakeholder Insights (bilateral air agreements, fragmented mandates); Diagnostic governance tiers; MIDAS (government-to-government route designation)	2.4; 2.1; 1.2; 1.1	I15	T2-21
17 Strengthen industry and government collaboration	Stakeholder Insights appendix tables, counted for this report (Appendix A6)	2.4; 2.1	I15	T2-22
18 Expedite tourism-enabling policy and data sharing	Stakeholder Insights (JAMS, statistics committees, Stats SA task team); Skift digital memo (tracking framework)	2.4; 2.1; 1.2	I16	T2-23
19 Lead removal of infrastructure, visa and safety deficits	Stakeholder Insights, Demand-Side barriers and MIDAS all place visas and air rights with national government	2.4; 1.2	I17	T2-24
20 Develop workforce and service skills	No workstream; prompted by the 300,000-jobs ambition (Inception p4) and skills mentions in the Stakeholder Insights and Inclusion plan	2.4; 1.1	I18	T1-04; T2-25

Source: Workstream attribution is this report's, from the deliverables that carry the figures; the sections named give the pages.

A2 Demand model

The demand model takes international arrivals from 1,498,829 in 2025 to 1,822,634, 2,175,778 or 2,516,282 in 2035, and its base case crosses the 1.8 million seat line the model draws, at the 2030 year point.

Method

The model sets a growth rate for each source market from four levers and projects arrivals from the base year to 2035.[751] The levers are source market growth, Western Cape penetration of source-market outbound, an airlift capacity ceiling and structural market conditions. Source-market growth sets the ceiling: "WC cannot sustainably grow faster than it's source market is generating travellers".[752] Projections are anchored on OAG aviation data and Skift global traveller data.[753]

Scenario definitions

The three scenarios vary intervention, not demand: "The difference between scenarios is not demand potential, but the extent to which structural barriers are removed and growth opportunities are actively pursued".[754]

Table A.3. Growth model scenario definitions

The scenarios step up from no new airlift or growth-market spend to direct India and China routes with dedicated activation in four markets.

Dimension	Conservative	Base	Accelerated
Descriptor	The floor. What happens if Wesgro does nothing new	The most likely outcome. Wesgro maintains current activity	The upside. What confirmed intervention unlocks
Air access	Existing air access maintained with no additional frequencies or routes	Emirates, Qatar, Ethiopian and Turkish Airlines continue adding frequency and capacity into Cape Town	Direct India and China routes secured, alongside additional frequency growth from Emirates, Qatar, Ethiopian and Turkish Airlines
Market activation	Continued trade and marketing activity, with no dedicated growth market investment	Existing Wesgro programmes expanded across mature, regional and hub markets	Dedicated in market activation in India, China, USA and the GCC to increase destination awareness and conversion
Market development	Growth concentrated in existing mature markets and current connectivity corridors	UK, USA and Germany continue to grow, while India, China and Regional Africa expand through existing hub connections	India, China and the Middle East grow ahead of source market averages through improved access and activation
May additions	WC holds share; India and China as hub flows; all CAGRs below outbound averages	Trade and marketing at 2025 intensity; selective frequency increases; share gains in mature markets	Japan and South Korea introduced; mature European markets above base, constrained by seat capacity
Step up from previous case	Not applicable	Protecting existing airlift, growing hub frequencies, retaining source-market share and continued trade presence	Confirmed direct airlift, above-baseline marketing and added hub capacity; without confirmed routes, volume reverts to base

Source: Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p19 (descriptor, air access, market activation and market development rows) and p20 (step-up row). Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p18 (working analysis; May additions row) and p19 (the same step-up wording). Wording as printed, shortened in the last two rows.

[751] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p18, p20.
[752] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p18.
[753] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p8.
[754] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p19.

The May working analysis lists Japan and South Korea as introduced under the Accelerated case, yet its base case already carries both as the strategic group at 8,410 arrivals in 2025.[755] Its Accelerated activation names India, China and the USA; the June matrix adds the GCC.[756]

Scenario end points

Table A.4. Model end points by base year

The two decks print the same 2035 end points from different bases, with the base case 676,949 arrivals above 2025.

Measure	Conservative	Base	Accelerated
2025 base (May)	1,498,829	1,498,829	1,498,829
2035 projection	1,822,634	2,175,778	2,516,282
Absolute growth from 2025	+323,805	+676,949	+1,017,453
Growth vs 2025	+22%	+45%	+68%
Implied 10-year CAGR	2.0%	3.8%	5.3%
Uplift vs Conservative	Not applicable	+353,144	+693,648
2024 base (June)	1,445,031	1,445,031	1,445,031
Absolute growth from 2024	+377,603	+730,747	+1,071,251
Growth vs 2024	+26%	+51%	+74%
Implied 11-year CAGR, printed	2.0%	3.7%	5.0%
11-year CAGR, computed	2.1%	3.8%	5.2%

Source: Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19 (working analysis; 2025 basis); Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p20 (2024 basis). The last row is computed from the printed 2024 base and 2035 end points.

The June deck prints 11-year CAGRs of 2.0%, 3.7% and 5.0%, while its own end points give 2.1%, 3.8% and 5.2% (computed). Both subtitles round the Conservative and Accelerated end points to 1.82M and 2.52M.[757]

Base case by market group

Table A.5. Base case by market group

Every market group grows at each printed year point, and the base-case total first sits above the 1.8M seat line at 2030.

Group	2025	2028	2030	2032	2034	2035
Mature markets	587,287	635,712	670,350	707,009	745,816	766,067
Regional markets	292,514	321,854	343,096	365,796	390,059	402,812
Hubs	427,803	483,407	523,523	566,081	611,038	634,387
Acceleration	182,815	223,110	255,159	292,138	334,846	358,633
Strategic growth	8,410	9,772	10,801	11,940	13,200	13,879
Total	1,498,829	1,673,855	1,802,929	1,942,964	2,094,959	2,175,778
Current seat capacity line (seats, as drawn)	1.8M	1.8M	1.8M	1.8M	1.8M	1.8M

Source: Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p20 (working analysis); Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p21 prints the same 2028 to 2035 values. Only these six year points are printed. Groups as printed: Mature (US, UK, Netherlands, Germany, France, Switzerland); Regional (Namibia, Zim, Zambia, Bots, Kenya, etc.); Hubs (UAE, Ethiopia, Qatar, Turkey); Acceleration (Gulf, China, India, Brazil); Strategic growth (Japan and South Korea). The five groups sum to the printed total in every year (computed).

[755] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p18, p20, p22.
[756] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p19.
[757] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19; Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p20.

Hubs add the most arrivals of any group, 206,584 from 2025 to 2035, while acceleration markets grow fastest at 7.0% a year (computed). The June deck reads the chart the same way: "Hub markets deliver the largest absolute volume uplift in the model".[758]

On the June 2024 basis the groups start at Mature 572,032, Regional 283,362, Hubs 410,467, Acceleration 171,170 and Strategic growth 8,000, which sum to 1,445,031.[759] The June deck prints no 2025 group values.

Base case by market

Table A.6. Acceleration and mature market paths

India and China + HK more than double by 2035 at 8% a year, while the six mature markets grow at 2% to 4% a year.

Market	2025	2035	Printed rate	CAGR	Model assumption
UK	182,398	233,485	+3% p.a.	2.5%	Outbound 2 to 3% p.a.; strong direct access
Germany	130,475	159,049	+2% p.a.	2.0%	Weaker economic outlook; Lufthansa connectivity
US	113,857	168,536	+4% p.a.	4.0%	Strong recent demand; favourable USD/ZAR
Netherlands	107,938	138,169	+2% p.a.	2.5%	KLM Amsterdam hub
France	21,495	28,888	+3% p.a.	3.0%	Low WC penetration; direct Air France
Switzerland	31,124	37,940	+2% p.a.	2.0%	European hubs; seasonal Swiss direct service
Mature total	587,287	766,067		2.7%	Sum matches the group line
India	76,547	165,260	+8% p.a.	8.0%	Outbound above 10% p.a.; low penetration
China + HK	43,412	92,598	+8% p.a.	7.9%	Outbound 8 to 10% p.a.; no direct route
Middle East	41,647	67,839	+5% p.a.	5.0%	GCC outbound about 5 to 6% p.a.
Brazil	21,209	32,937	+5% p.a.	4.5%	Outbound 5%; low penetration
Acceleration total	182,815	358,634		7.0%	Group line prints 358,633
Japan	5,275	9,010	+5% p.a.	5.5%	Strategic importance, not current size
South Korea	3,135	4,869	+5% p.a.	4.5%	Strategic importance, not current size
Strategic total	8,410	13,879		5.1%	Sum matches the group line
Hubs	427,803	634,387	Not printed	4.0%	UAE, Ethiopia, Qatar and Turkey; group line only

Source: Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p21 and p22 (working analysis); Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p22, p23 and p25 (values and assumptions). Hubs row: group values from Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p20. CAGR and group totals are computed from the printed bars; assumptions are shortened from the printed text.

Table A.7. Regional market paths

Regional lines grow at 2.0% to 5.0% a year with Kenya fastest, and the model carries no row for Nigeria or Ghana.

Market	2025	2035	Printed rate	Change
Namibia	72,750	102,621	3.5% p.a.	+29,871
Zimbabwe	69,005	92,737	3.0% p.a.	+23,732
Zambia	19,638	27,701	3.5% p.a.	+8,063
Botswana	20,237	27,197	3.0% p.a.	+6,960
Kenya	23,394	38,106	5.0% p.a.	+14,712
Mauritius	25,844	33,083	2.5% p.a.	+7,239

[758] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p21.
[759] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p21, sum computed.

Market	2025	2035	Printed rate	Change
Mozambique	12,642	16,183	2.5% p.a.	+3,541
Angola	43,609	58,507	3.0% p.a.	+14,898
Other Regional (Chad, St Helena, Eswatini)	5,394	6,575	2.0% p.a.	+1,181
Regional total	292,513	402,710		+110,197
Nigeria	No row	No row		
Ghana	No row	No row		

Source: Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p23 (working analysis); Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p24. Change and the regional total are computed from the printed bars; the group line prints 292,514 and 402,812 (Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p20). The Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p30 names Nigeria the largest modelled African opportunity and Ghana a high-spend market with an established base.

Printed rates are rounded labels: UK and Netherlands recompute to 2.5% a year, Brazil and South Korea to 4.5% and Japan to 5.5% (computed). Bar sums miss the regional and acceleration group lines by 1 to 102 arrivals (computed). Lesotho and Malawi, with 40,266 and 12,682 tourist arrivals in 2024, also have no row.[760]

Base-case spend

Table A.8. Base-case spend by group

At fixed average spend per group, base-case tourism spend rises from a modelled R27.12bn in 2024 to R40.59bn in 2035.

Group	Average spend per arrival	2024	2030	2035	Change 2024 to 2035
Mature markets	R24,500	14.01	16.42	18.77	+4.76
Regional markets	R8,500	2.41	2.92	3.42	+1.01
Hubs	R17,500	7.18	9.16	11.10	+3.92
Acceleration	R19,500	3.34	4.98	6.99	+3.65
Strategic growth	R22,000	0.18	0.24	0.31	+0.13
Total	Not printed	27.12	33.71	40.59	+13.47

Source: Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p24 (working analysis; comma decimals on the slide shown here as points). Values in R billion. Change is computed. The 2030 group cells sum to 33.72 against the printed 33.71 total, a rounding difference (computed).

The 2030 and 2035 values equal each group's arrivals times its average spend, so spend per arrival within a group stays fixed (computed). Dividing the 2024 values by the same assumptions implies 1,445,116 arrivals, close to the June base of 1,445,031 (computed). The slide calls the 2024 values modelled, and the same deck reports foreign direct spend of R22.7bn in FY2024.[761] The June deck prints no spend projection.

Seat line and model limits

Both decks state that "Current air access places a hard ceiling at 1.8 million inbound seats, meaning the projected growth cannot be realised without additional capacity or frequency".[762] Neither deck prints the seats behind the line or a load factor that converts seats into arrivals. At the international routes' 76.0% load factor, 1.8 million seats would carry about 1.37 million arrivals, below the 1.57 million recorded in FY25/26. This report therefore reads the line as the model's assumption, not a measured cap (section 1.3).

The model prints its seat line and six base-case year points but no seat table, annual series or group split for the other scenarios. The seat line is 1.8 million inbound seats, drawn as a line labelled 1.8M and called

[760] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p27.
[761] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p10, p24.
[762] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p20; Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p21.

current, with no year or seat definition.[763] Neither deck states the year the line is crossed: 2028 (1,673,855) sits below the line and 2030 (1,802,929) is the first point above it.[764]

No seat table is printed: there are no seats by route or year, no load factors and no frequencies.[765] Nor is an annual series: 2026, 2027, 2029, 2031 and 2033 are absent, and the June chart starts at 2024, not 2025.[766] The conservative and accelerated scenarios appear at 2035 only, with no group split, no year points and no per-market rates.[767]

The calendar or financial basis and the source series of the 1,498,829 base are not stated, and the 2025 bars are not marked as actuals or model values.[768] ACSA passenger arrivals (1.57m in FY25/26), SAT tourist arrivals, OAG air arrivals and model arrivals are not reconciled.[769]

Arrivals figures and their bases

Eight arrivals figures circulate around this study, and they count four things: ambitions, airport passengers, South African Tourism's tourist arrivals and the model's arrivals. The table below fixes each figure and states how the report uses it. It keeps an airport count apart from a provincial tourist count, and an ambition apart from a projection. Section 1.1 sets out the three rules behind the last column.

Table A.9. Arrivals figures in circulation

The report uses airport passenger arrivals for baselines, the demand model for targets and South African Tourism's provincial count only to read across to the Growth for Jobs target.

Figure	What it counts	Year	Source	How this report uses it
1.44m	International passenger arrivals at Cape Town International (ACSA), fiscal year	FY24/25	Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p25	Recovery baseline (1.2) and the baseline year for the M&E framework (Chapter 5)
1.57m	Same series	FY25/26	Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p10	Latest actual; shown against the model, not substituted for its base
1,498,829	Demand model base; the series and year basis are not labelled in the deck	2025	Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19	Base of the growth case; every 2035 figure in Chapters 3 to 5 is an increment on it
2,175,778 and 2,516,282	Model projections on the 2025 base: base case and accelerated case	2035	Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19	The report's two paths; growth to 2.5 million is the rounded accelerated case
1,538,142	International tourist arrivals to the Western Cape, South African Tourism basis	2025	Wesgro Research, Western Cape Tourism Performance: Annual 2025; public source	Reference point for the G4J basis only; not a baseline or a target
3 million	International tourist arrivals to the province, SAT basis, built as 2 million in 2019 plus 1 million	2035	Wesgro, presentation to the parliamentary committee, 1 Apr 2026 (public source), recording the G4J 2023 target	Alignment reference under clause 1.1.14.2; a different measure from the airport series
2.8m	"International visitors"; measure and base not stated	2035	Inception Report, Nov 2025, p4	Original ambition; quoted, not used

[763] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p20; Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p21.
[764] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p20; Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p21.
[765] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p17, p20; Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p18.
[766] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p20; Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p21.
[767] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19; Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p20.
[768] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19, p20; Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p22 to p25.
[769] Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p8, p11, p13, p20, p27.

Figure	What it counts	Year	Source	How this report uses it
5.7 million and R54.7 billion	International arrivals and tourism spend; base not stated	2035	Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p5	The Diagnostic's statement of the ambition; superseded and quoted for the record

Source: Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p5, p25; Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p10, p19; Inception Report, Nov 2025, p4; Wesgro, presentation to the parliamentary committee, 1 Apr 2026 (public source); Wesgro Research, Western Cape Tourism Performance: Annual 2025; public source.

The two ambitions do not reconcile with each other or with the measured baseline. Neither the 2.8 million ambition nor its later restatement as 5.7 million arrivals and R54.7 billion of spend names a series or a base year.[770] Twice the 1.44 million international passenger arrivals at Cape Town International in FY24/25 is 2.88 million, close to the first and far from the second.[771]

The model's 2025 base of 1,498,829 sits just below South African Tourism's count of 1,538,142 for 2025.[772] Yet each market group's 2025 value tracks its 2024 value grown at the model's own rate. The report therefore treats the base as a model value until its basis is confirmed.[773]

The airport count for FY25/26, 1.57 million, sits above the model's 2025 base and below its 2028 base-case point of 1,673,855.[774] Yet the two differ in measure and period, so the gap is no evidence that the model is cautious.

[770] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p4; Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p5; this report treats the second statement as superseded.
[771] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p25, computed.
[772] Wesgro Research, Western Cape Tourism Performance: Annual 2025.
[773] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p20; Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p21; the steps match the growth rates to within 0.2 points, computed from the market-group values in this appendix.
[774] Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p10, p20.

A3 Benchmark cases

Six comparators were drawn from a 30-destination screen on twelve criteria, and each case reduces to a system type, two levers and the changes they require of the Western Cape.

Evaluation criteria

Both the Inception Report and the Global Benchmarking Report screen destinations on twelve criteria in four groups.[775] Each destination received one average score across all criteria.[776]

Table A.10. Benchmark selection criteria

Group	Criterion	What it compares with the Western Cape
Market & Access Dynamics	Long-Haul Dependence & Connectivity	Reliance on long-haul aviation, hub relationships and seat-capacity volatility
	Source Market Portfolio	Fit with Wesgro's core and target markets (UK/EU, North America, China, India, Middle East, Africa)
	Ease of Access & Visa	Entry conditions, visa openness and visa-free access for Western Cape priority markets
Destination & Product Structure	City-Region Configuration	Fit with the "Cape Town gateway + multi-regional Western Cape" model
	Product & Experience Mix	Fit with the mix of coast, city, nature, wine and agri-tourism, food, culture and soft adventure
	Cost & Price Positioning	Accommodation, dining and excursion costs against a mid to upper-mid price tier
Growth, Inclusion & Sustainability	Growth Pattern & Tourism Development Stage	Lifecycle stage, demand pressures, seasonality and infrastructure strain
	Inclusivity, Community Participation & SMME Landscape	SMME structure, community tourism footprint and local participation
	Sustainability, Climate & Environmental Conditions	Climate risks, coastal vulnerability, water availability and resource pressure
Performance & Competitiveness	Tourism Volume & Seasonality	Total arrivals, international share and seasonal concentration
	Tourism Yield & Spend Levels	Average daily spend, trip length and value profile
	Airport & Tourism Infrastructure	Airport quality, airside and landside capacity, ground transport and tourism infrastructure

Source: Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p11 (groups, criteria and definitions, shortened); Inception Report, Nov 2025, p29, p30. Two criteria are defined differently in the two sources: the Inception Report has Cruise & Multi-Modal Access, covering cruise arrivals, self-drive touring and regional mobility, and Tourism Infrastructure & Capacity, covering hotel mix, transport, visitor services and attraction capacity (Inception Report, Nov 2025, p30).

How the six were chosen

The screen scored 30 destinations on the twelve criteria and ranked them on one average score.[777] Chile, Melbourne and Victoria, Valencia and Singapore came from the top of the ranking.[778] New Zealand, ranked seventh at 3.67, and Kenya, ranked eleventh at 3.50, joined for what the score could not weigh: a remote single-gateway case and an African case with community-based tourism.[779]

[775] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p29, p30; Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p11.
[776] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p29.
[777] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p29, p31; Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p12.
[778] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p31, p32; ranks 1 to 6 and their scores are not printed.
[779] Inception Report, Nov 2025, p31; Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p12, p51.

Table A.11. How the six comparators were chosen

Four comparators came from the top of the screen, and New Zealand and Kenya joined for the remote-gateway and African cases they bring.

Destination	Screen rank and score	Printed rationale	What the case is read for
Chile	Ranks 1 to 6; score not printed	High comparability in dispersal challenges, product mix and long-haul reliance	Long-haul access treated as infrastructure
Melbourne & Victoria	Ranks 1 to 6; score not printed	Strong long-haul dependence and multi-regional tourism footprint	Events that spread demand across the year
Valencia Region	Ranks 1 to 6; score not printed	Comparable climate, product mix and price point	Quality governed across the destination
Singapore	Ranks 1 to 6; score not printed	Integrated approach to air access, service quality, food culture and visitor segmentation	Hub transit turned into stays
Kenya	Rank 11, score 3.50	Strong alignment in long-haul reliance, regional dispersal and community-based tourism	Gateway access, dispersal and community inclusion
Auckland & North Island, New Zealand	Rank 7, score 3.67	Urban life closely intertwined with natural landscapes	A remote single gateway and marketing tied to routes

Source: Inception Report, Nov 2025, p31 (ranks and scores), p32; Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p12 (rationales), p51. The screen prints ranks 7 to 30 only, so the four leading comparators sit among ranks 1 to 6 with no printed score. Rationales as printed, shortened only by cutting; what each case is read for follows section 2.1.

Growth record and primary levers

The Global Benchmarking Report summarises the six cases in one table, reproduced here.[780] Its global norm is growth of 3% to 5% a year under stable conditions.[781]

Table A.12. Comparator growth, recovery and levers

Five of the six printed growth rates exceed the report's 3% to 5% norm, two clearly beat 2024's actual global growth of 11%, and four of the six cases pair structural demand creation with demand activation.

Destination	YoY growth % over 2023 to 2024	% change vs 2019 (recovery depth)	Primary levers	Primary demand impact
Chile	~+35%	~82% recovered	1) Gateway-led air concentration 2) Product diversification and immersive experience	1) Demand Activation 2) Structural Demand Creation
Kenya	~12.8% to 14.6%	~102% recovered	1) Conservation-led institutionalisation of wildlife 2) Nairobi Led Gateway Diversification	1) Structural Demand Creation 2) Demand Activation
Singapore	~19%	Slightly below, spend recovered	1) Integrated Aviation Hub Strategy and Stopover Demand Conversion 2) Institutional Quality uplift of Visitor Economy	1) Structural Demand Creation 2) Demand Activation and Acceleration
Australia, Victoria Melbourne	~4.3%	Near full recovery, differentiation from yield, value density	1) Event-led Demand 2) Knowledge Brand Strategy	1) Structural Demand Creation 2) Demand Activation and Acceleration
New Zealand	~12%	90% recovery, increased yield per visitor	1) Demand-Led Route Development Integration 2) Premiumisation	1) System and Product Yield Optimisation 2) Demand Activation and Acceleration

[780] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p9.
[781] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p7.

Destination	YoY growth % over 2023 to 2024	% change vs 2019 (recovery depth)	Primary levers	Primary demand impact
Spain, Valencia	13 to 14%	124% recovered	1) Institutionalised Quality Governance 2) Governance-led Demand Diversification	1) System and Product Yield Optimisation 2) Demand Activation and Acceleration

Source: Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p9, values and destination labels as printed. Ranges are written with 'to', decimal commas are shown as points and Valencia's second lever takes its p49 title in place of the p9 label. Melbourne's ~4.3% is a forecast average annual growth rate for short-term visitor arrivals to Australia, not a 2023 to 2024 actual (p17). New Zealand's ~12% matches holiday-arrivals growth of 12.1% for January to December 2025; total arrivals grew 5.9% over the same period (p53). Demand-impact classes (p8): structural demand creation expands total addressable demand; demand activation and acceleration converts latent or constrained demand; system and product yield optimisation raises value per traveller without increasing arrivals. Corrected 2024 figures: Chile 40.4% (116% of 2019), Singapore 21% (86% of 2019), Kenya 14.6% (section 2.1).

System type and its three components

The report treats sustained growth as the product of three reinforcing components: institutional coordination; strategic marketing and promotion; accessibility and connectivity.[782] Without competitive access, "latent demand does not convert".[783]

All six cases align coordination, marketing and access, but each builds its system around a different anchor.[784]

Melbourne and Victoria: events-led. Coordination institutionalises events and a knowledge-led brand as a cross-government economic development tool. Marketing integrates city branding, intellectual capital and events into a single demand proposition. The event calendar is used to de-risk and stimulate aviation demand.

Chile: connectivity-led. Coordination is anchored around a single strategic constraint, long-haul access. Marketing runs unified national branding with defined regional identities and multi-region itinerary packaging. Liberal aviation policy and major hub investment position Santiago as a single efficient long-haul hub.

Kenya: product-led. Coordination aligns tourism with national priorities in conservation, trade and diplomacy. Marketing is segment-specific and grounded in a designed product system. Access reduces entry friction, with Nairobi as a multipurpose regional and global hub.

Singapore: orchestrated experience. A centrally orchestrated system under STB works through structured public-private partnerships. Marketing packages experiences (events, precincts, lifestyle) into seamless high-value propositions. Aviation, infrastructure and visitor experience are integrated into a single seamless gateway.

Valencia: governance-led. Governance is decentralised and sector-led. Marketing expands the reasons to visit: gastronomy, culture, sport, wellness and business events. Connectivity supports a multi-product destination system and dispersal.

New Zealand: value-led. Tourism, aviation and policy are integrated around shared demand objectives. Marketing shifts from volume to value by selling scarce, high-quality experiences. Long-haul demand converts only when marketing, aviation and distribution are aligned.

[782] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p58.
[783] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p59.
[784] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p61 for the system types; p59 to p60 for the three components, condensed.

Levers and required changes

Each case closes on a transferable-levers slide that names two levers and the change each requires locally.[785] The table gives those bullets in the report's words, shortened only by cutting.

Table A.13. Transferable levers by case

The six cases yield twelve levers, and their required changes centre on air access, events, quality standards, regional product and governance.

Case	Lever 1 and required change for the Western Cape	Lever 2 and required change for the Western Cape
Melbourne & Victoria (p20)	**Event Led Demand Engine** Proactive international bidding pipeline anchored in priority markets and sectors; unified event acquisition and calendar strategy across Wesgro, Convention Bureau, City and Province; integrate city branding, intellectual capital and sector strengths into event positioning; hotel and precinct readiness planning; activate community participation and cultural engagement	**Knowledge-Led Brand Strategy** Strengthen coordination between Wesgro and Convention Bureau/Universities/Industry Bodies/Trade and Investment Teams; proactive international conference bidding pipeline aligned to sector strengths; sector aligned brand narrative link to priority industries; visibility and packaging across global distribution channels
Chile (p28)	**Gateway-Led Air Connectivity and Capacity Expansion** Treat air access as core economic infrastructure, not a tourism add-on; establish a permanent, well-funded Public-Private Air Access Fund; lobby for air service liberalisation and simplified visa regimes; develop a unified Gateway Narrative	**Product Diversification and Immersive Regional Positioning** Unify destination narrative across province, city and sectors; move from asset marketing to experience led packaging; enforce brand consistency and international quality standards
Kenya (p35)	**Wildlife-led Product Systematisation** Shift from asset-led to system-led tourism development; strengthen coordination across public & private sector and communities; position WC as a demand anchor; integrate MICE and business travel into broader tourism system; build conservation and community inclusion into the tourism value proposition	**Nairobi-Led Gateway Repositioning and Demand Diversification** Treat MICE as a system lever; align city, provincial and national actors around gateway strategy; infrastructure credibility and event-readiness must be protected; mitigate risk of MICE demand remaining disconnected
Singapore (p42)	**Integrated Aviation Hub Strategy and Stopover Demand Conversion** Align government, aviation, events and private sector stakeholders under a coordinated strategy with shared KPIs; linking air access, major events and co-op marketing to convert connectivity into high-value demand	**Institutional Quality Uplift of the Visitor Economy** Province-wide quality and standards framework led by Wesgro; targeted investment in service excellence, work-force capability and infrastructure; embed continuous performance measurement and public-private accountability
Valencia (p49)	**Integrated Quality & Sustainability Institutionalisation** Establish a provincial-level quality authority or charter; phase implementation by district but embed in provincial policy; reduce SMME burden via subsidies and capability support; make certification visible across booking platforms; move from 'encouraged compliance' to institutionalised compliance	**Governance-led Demand Diversification** Establish formal sector councils (Wine, MICE, Adventure, Culture etc.); embed tourism governance into permanent public-private structures; align infrastructure, promotion and policy by demand segment; integrate residents formally into planning forums
New Zealand (p56)	**Demand-Engineered Air Access** Ring-fence budgets around priority long-haul corridors; formalise an Aviation Partnership Framework; introduce structured early-stage route support mechanisms	**Regional Value Engineering through Strategic De-Commoditisation** Replace arrivals KPI with yield-based metrics; deliberate regional product curation frameworks; align conservation and premium access to protect pricing power; shape premium-ready regional circuits beyond Cape Town core; build partnerships with specialist distribution networks

Source: Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p20 (Melbourne and Victoria), p28 (Chile), p35 (Kenya), p42 (Singapore), p49 (Valencia), p56 (New Zealand). Lever titles and bullets as printed, shortened by cutting, with one verb paraphrased; initial capitals, dashes and list commas follow this report's style.

[785] Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p13.

A4 Readiness scores

The infrastructure assessment classifies 50,332 assets in six districts and scores each district on attractiveness, readiness and accessibility; overall ratings fall from 4.5 in the Cape Metro to 1.9 in the Central Karoo.

Method

The assessment models tourism supply in three layers (attractions, services and infrastructure) and holds that "destination performance is constrained by the weakest layer".[786] Its asset database sorts the layers into twelve categories with named subtypes.[787] It draws on Wesgro, SANParks, StatsSA and CapeNature data,[788] with Overpass, WikiQuery and tourism reports for 2023 to 2025 named as sources of geographical data points.[789]

Table A.14. Asset database structure

Layer	Category	Subtypes
Attraction	Natural	Beach; mountain; park & reserve; scenic routes
Attraction	Cultural & heritage	Museum; historical site; monument; cultural precinct
Attraction	Commercial and leisure	Wine estate; theme park
Attraction	Events	Festival; sporting event; cultural event; business events
Service	Accommodation	Hotel; guest house; lodge; self catering
Service	Food & beverage	Restaurant; café; bar
Service	Tourism services	Tour operator; travel agency; car rental
Service	Visitor amenities	Fuel station; retail centre; visitor information centres
Infrastructure	Air access	Airport; airstrip
Infrastructure	Road network	National route; regional road
Infrastructure	Transport nodes	Bus terminal; train station
Infrastructure	Public services	Hospital; police station

Source: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p10, as printed in sentence case.

The comparative tables score a different set of eleven categories in three groups,[790] and the district scorecards chart a similar set. Attractions cover activity, commercial & leisure, cultural & heritage, events and natural assets. Services cover accommodation, eatery and shopping. Transport and enabling structures cover transport, enabling structure and visitor amenities. The asset counts use five groups: accommodation, attractions, eateries, events and amenities.[791]

Attractiveness carries 40% of the stated weight and readiness and accessibility carry 30% each.[792] Attractiveness and quality asks how compelling the tourism offer is, through visitor ratings, uniqueness, price positioning and experience depth. Readiness and capacity asks whether the region can service and convert demand, through capacity and digital discovery. Accessibility asks whether visitors can reach and move through the destination, through airport proximity, gateway travel time and public transport availability. The scale runs from 1 'Very weak' and 2 'Weak' through 3 'Functional' and 4 'Strong' to 5

[786] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p9.
[787] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p10.
[788] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p2.
[789] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p4.
[790] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p88 to p90.
[791] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p23, p67.
[792] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p17.

'Leading'. The stated method is: "Average indicator scores within each dimension, then combine dimensions using the agreed weights".[793]

Each dimension is the average of its indicator scores, and the dimensions are then combined at 40/30/30.[794] All three use a common scale from 1 to 5, with Functional at 3 and Leading at 5.[795] The report states four assumptions.[796] Asset volume does not equal readiness, and one framework applies to all regions. Indicator scores are evidence informed rather than purely formula derived, and missing data is not treated as poor performance.

Overall rating. The overall ratings are the Infrastructure Report's evidence-informed judgement, not a weighted formula, so this report does not re-derive them.

Comparative regional scores

The comparative regional analysis scores every district on all three dimensions for each of the eleven categories.[797] Each cell gives attractiveness, readiness and accessibility in that order. Each district's accessibility score is constant within each group, except West Coast natural attractions at 2.0 against 1.7.[798] The Cape Metro scores 4.7 for accessibility on attractions and services and 5.0 on transport and enabling structures.

Table A.15. Dimension scores by district

Accessibility falls from 4.7 or 5.0 in the Cape Metro to 1.0 in the Central Karoo in every scored category, while natural attractiveness reaches 4.3 in three districts outside the Metro.

Category	Cape Metro	Garden Route	Cape Winelands	West Coast	Overberg	Central Karoo
Attractions						
Activity	4.8 / 4.7 / 4.7	4.3 / 3.7 / 3.0	3.3 / 3.0 / 3.3	2.8 / 2.0 / 1.7	3.5 / 3.0 / 2.0	2.5 / 1.7 / 1.0
Commercial & leisure	3.8 / 4.7 / 4.7	3.3 / 3.0 / 3.0	4.5 / 4.0 / 3.3	3.0 / 2.0 / 1.7	3.3 / 3.0 / 2.0	1.3 / 1.3 / 1.0
Cultural & heritage	4.5 / 4.3 / 4.7	3.8 / 4.0 / 3.0	4.0 / 3.7 / 3.3	3.8 / 3.0 / 1.7	3.5 / 3.0 / 2.0	3.5 / 2.3 / 1.0
Events	4.3 / 4.7 / 4.7	No score	4.0 / 4.0 / 3.3	3.8 / 3.0 / 1.7	3.8 / 3.3 / 2.0	No score
Natural	4.8 / 4.7 / 4.7	4.3 / 4.0 / 3.0	4.0 / 3.7 / 3.3	4.3 / 3.0 / 2.0	4.3 / 3.3 / 2.0	3.3 / 2.3 / 1.0
Services						
Accommodation	4.3 / 4.7 / 4.7	4.0 / 4.0 / 3.0	4.0 / 4.0 / 3.3	3.3 / 2.7 / 1.7	3.8 / 3.3 / 2.0	3.3 / 2.0 / 1.0
Eatery	4.5 / 5.0 / 4.7	4.0 / 3.7 / 3.0	4.0 / 4.0 / 3.3	3.3 / 2.3 / 1.7	3.3 / 3.0 / 2.0	2.8 / 2.0 / 1.0
Shopping	4.0 / 5.0 / 4.7	3.0 / 3.0 / 3.0	3.0 / 3.0 / 3.3	3.3 / 2.3 / 1.7	2.8 / 2.7 / 2.0	2.3 / 1.7 / 1.0
Transport and enabling						
Transport	3.8 / 4.7 / 5.0	3.3 / 3.2 / 3.0	3.3 / 3.7 / 3.3	2.3 / 2.7 / 1.7	2.5 / 2.7 / 2.0	2.0 / 2.3 / 1.0
Enabling structure	3.3 / 4.0 / 5.0	2.8 / 3.0 / 3.0	2.5 / 2.7 / 3.3	2.5 / 2.3 / 1.7	2.3 / 2.7 / 2.0	2.3 / 2.0 / 1.0
Visitor amenities	3.8 / 4.7 / 5.0	3.3 / 3.7 / 3.0	2.3 / 2.7 / 3.3	2.5 / 2.3 / 1.7	2.3 / 2.7 / 2.0	2.3 / 2.0 / 1.0

Source: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p88 (attractions), p89 (services), p90 (transport and enabling structures). Cells give attractiveness / readiness / accessibility as printed; 'No score' marks a printed dash.

[793] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p17.
[794] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p17.
[795] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p17.
[796] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p18.
[797] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p88 to p90.
[798] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p88.

District scorecards

Each district section includes a scorecard that prints an overall rating out of 5, the three dimension scores and a bar score for each category.[799] Three scorecards print all three dimension scores. The Cape Winelands prints no accessibility score, and the Overberg and Central Karoo print the dimension labels without numbers.

Table A.16. Overall readiness by district

Overall ratings fall from 4.5 in the Cape Metro to 1.9 in the Central Karoo, and only three of the six scorecards print all three dimension scores.

Score	Cape Metro	Garden Route	Cape Winelands	West Coast	Overberg	Central Karoo
Overall rating	4.5/5	3.4/5	3.4/5	2.5/5	2.7/5	1.9/5
Attractiveness	4.0	4.3	4.5	3.2	Not printed	Not printed
Readiness	3.0	3.8	4.0	2.7	Not printed	Not printed
Accessibility	2.5	3.5	Not printed	1.7	Not printed	Not printed
Activity	4.7	3.7	3.6	2.2	2.9	1.8
Commercial & leisure	4.3	3.1	4.0	2.3	2.8	1.2
Cultural & heritage	4.5	3.6	3.5	2.9	2.9	2.4
Events	4.5	No bar	No bar	2.9	3.1	No bar
Natural	4.7	3.8	3.5	3.2	3.3	2.3
Accommodation	4.5	3.8	3.7	2.6	3.1	2
Eatery	4.7	3.7	3.8	2.5	2.8	2
Shopping	4.5	3.2	3.5	2.5	2.5	2.1
Transport	4.4	3.1	2.8	2.2	2.4	1.8
Enabling structure	4	2.9	3.0	2.2	2.3	No bar
Visitor amenities	4.3	3.0	3.2	2.4	2.5	1.7
Visitor services	No bar	3.3	3.3	No bar	No bar	No bar
Mean of bars (computed)	4.464	3.382	3.445	2.536	2.782	1.922
Weighted 40/30/30 (computed)	3.25	3.91	Not computable	2.60	Not computable	Not computable

Source: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p28, p41, p52, p63, p74, p85 in column order. Bars as printed, decimal commas shown as points; bar labels vary by slide. 'Not printed': a dimension label without a number. 'No bar': a category absent from the chart. Computed: the mean of the printed bars (eleven, or nine for the Central Karoo) and the p17 weights applied to the printed dimension scores.

Accessibility. The scorecard dimension scores do not reconcile with the comparative tables. The Cape Metro scorecard prints accessibility of 2.5 and the Garden Route 3.5, while the comparative tables give them 4.7 to 5.0 and 3.0.[800] The West Coast's 1.7 matches its comparative scores apart from natural attractions.

Touring routes

Each of the six touring routes has a route card with four metrics and a scorecard that rates four readiness dimensions.[801] Ready means the route "meets international expectations now", Developing that it is "workable, with notable gaps" and Gap "a binding constraint to address".[802] The method slide announces five dimensions but lists four, numbered 1, 2, 4 and 5. The West Coast overall score of Emerging is not one of the three defined ratings.[803]

[799] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p28, p41, p52, p63, p74, p85.
[800] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p28, p41, p88 to p90.
[801] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p19.
[802] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p19.
[803] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p62.

Table A.17. Touring route scorecards

Only the Cape Peninsula route rates Ready overall; four routes rate Developing and the West Coast / Cederberg route rates Emerging.

Measure	Cape Peninsula	Garden Route	Cape Winelands	West Coast / Cederberg	Whale Coast / Overberg	Route 62 / Klein Karoo
From Cape Town	0 km	385 km	50 km	120 km	120 km	160 km
Route length	160 km	225 km	80 km	280 km	230 km	330 km
End-to-end drive	3.0 h	3.0 h	1.5 h	3.5 h	3.5 h	4.5 h
Suggested stay	2 to 3 days	5 to 7 days	2 to 4 days	2 to 4 days	3 to 5 days	3 to 5 days
Air & road access	Ready	Ready	Ready	Developing	Developing	Developing
Accommodation range	Ready	Ready	Ready	Gap	Developing	Developing
Safety & support	Developing	Developing	Developing	Ready	Developing	Developing
Digital & bookability	Ready	Ready	Ready	Gap	Developing	Gap
Overall	**Ready**	**Developing**	**Developing**	**Emerging**	**Developing**	**Developing**

Source: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026: cards p29, p39, p50, p72, p61, p83 and scorecards p30, p40, p51, p62, p73, p84, in column order. Distances are printed as approximate; stays are printed in days, although p19 defines them in nights. The Garden Route pipeline slide lists 'Route fragmented across 300km' as an existing gap (p43).

Tourism asset counts

The assessment counts 50,332 tourism assets across the six districts.[804] The six district totals sum to exactly that figure, and their shares sum to 100.0% with the Cape Winelands at 15.4% (computed). On every district slide the five category counts fall short of the stated total, leaving 592 assets not broken out (computed).

Table A.18. Asset counts by district

The Cape Metro holds 20,281 of the province's 50,332 assets and the Central Karoo holds 1,518; the six district totals sum to the provincial figure.

Count (share)	Cape Metro	Garden Route	Cape Winelands	West Coast	Overberg	Central Karoo
Total assets	20,281	9,875	7,730	4,752	6,176	1,518
Share of province	40.3%	19.6%	15.4% (gauge 40.3%)	9.4%	12.3%	3.0%
Accommodation	6,563 (32.2%)	4,996 (24.3%)	2,842 (13.8%)	2,294 (11.2%)	3,214 (11.2%)	622 (3.0%)
Attractions	5,544 (44.9%)	2,136 (17.3%)	2,298 (18.6%)	908 (7.4%)	1,183 (9.6%)	281 (2.3%)
Eateries	6,532 (50.2%)	2,012 (15.5%)	1,936 (14.5%)	992 (7.6%)	1,209 (9.4%)	325 (2.5%)
Events	638 (34.7%)	297 (16.2%)	276 (15.0%)	247 (13.5%)	254 (13.8%)	124 (6.8%)
Amenities	706 (34.7%)	349 (17.1%)	299 (14.7%)	267 (13.1%)	272 (13.4%)	124 (7.0%)
Sum of five (computed)	19,983	9,790	7,651	4,708	6,132	1,476
Not broken out (computed)	298	85	79	44	44	42

Source: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p23, p34, p45, p56, p67, p78 in column order; province total p2, p3. Counts and gauge percentages as printed; the Central Karoo amenities share is printed '%7.0'. Computed: the last two rows. Accommodation shares as printed sum to 95.7%, against 99.7% to 100.1% for the other categories; the Overberg and West Coast shares are both printed as 11.2%.

Cape Winelands share. This appendix uses 15.4%, computed from the count (7,730 of 50,332).

[804] Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p2, p3.

A5 Inclusion fact base

The Inclusion Plan scores 107 long-listed communities down to a shortlist of 20, rates their readiness, sizes the spend they could capture and takes its order of action from five benchmark cases.

Long-list rule and scoring weights

The long-list takes every Census 2011 sub-place cluster with 1,500 people or more and official unemployment of 25% or more, plus named mission, fishing and farm settlements.[805] The rule yields 107 township and rural communities with 2.81 million people in 2011 (48% of the province) and 3.79 million on the 2025 estimate.[806] Of the 107, 93 sit within 45 minutes of one of 35 supply-report nodes or three corridors.[807]

By region the long-list holds Cape Metro 26, Cape Winelands 16, Overberg 19, Garden Route 23, West Coast 13 and Central Karoo 10.[808] The shortlist takes five from Cape Metro and three from each other region.[809] Need rests on Census 2011 because Census 2022 is not published below municipality and ward and asked no income question.[810]

Table A.19. Community shortlist criteria

Need carries the largest weight of the five criteria, and each criterion scores a community from 3 to 1 against printed thresholds.

Criterion	Weight	Score 3	Score 2	Score 1
Need	0.25	Unemployment 32% or more (1.5 times the provincial rate)	22% to 32%	Below 22%
Tourism Potential	0.20	Three or more attractions inside, or any cultural or heritage asset	One or two inside, or ten or more within 5 km	None
Proximity	0.20	20 min or less to a node or corridor	21 to 45 min	Beyond 45 min
Readiness	0.20	Three or more of: LTO or community organisation; events; LED activity; corporate investment	One or two	None
Access	0.15	Rail station within 1.5 km	Bus stop or taxi rank within 500 m	Neither

Source: SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p14. Thresholds as printed; the weights sum to 1.00 (computed). Shortlist composite scores run from 1.80 (Prince Albert North) to 3.00 (Langa and Khayelitsha) (p18). Regional counts sum to the printed 107 and 20 (computed); the p14 panel prints 18 shortlisted, three per region, against 20 on p3, p16, p18 and p28. Drive times are OSRM free-flow estimates (p16, p17).

Archetypes and responses

Two tests set the archetype: a 45-minute drive time to the nearest node or corridor and whether any attraction sits inside the boundary.[811] Atlantis is held remote by Wesgro naming at 26 minutes from Darling.[812] For the largest group the plan's diagnosis is that "the product and the node's demand are there; the seller is missing".[813]

[805] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p14.
[806] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p16.
[807] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p16.
[808] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p16.
[809] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p16.
[810] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p15.
[811] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p4, p14.
[812] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p17.
[813] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p15.

Table A.20. Archetypes, responses and benchmarks

Proximate communities with underused assets are the largest group on both lists, and the plan pairs each archetype with a response, a first move and a benchmark.

Archetype	Long-list	Shortlist	Response type (p15)	First move (p31)	Benchmark (p15)
Proximate, assets underused	49	11	Integrate: itinerary slots, procurement, events; organise sellers	Package the existing product through the nearby tourism node and test demand before adding assets	Vilakazi Street; Rio
Proximate, no assets	43	6	Create one anchor asset with covenant, then integrate	Test a bookable route, experience or event before considering capital investment	Kliptown
Remote, assets underused	7	2	Open access and place asset on route product	Address the last-mile access constraint and connect the existing asset to a route already reaching the area	Comuna 13
Remote, no assets	8	1	Procurement and skills first; asset only with route product	Begin with procurement and skills linked to nearby tourism establishments; defer assets until demand is demonstrated	Costa Rica
Total	107	20			

Source: SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p15 and p17 (counts), p15 (response types and benchmarks) and p31 (first moves). The p4 slide prints long-list counts of 48 and 8 for the two assets-underused rows. Totals are computed.

The counts give 92 proximate communities against 93 within 45 minutes on p16 (computed). Doringbaai and Laingsburg (Bergsig) carry different archetypes on their profiles than on the shortlist.[814] Knysna northern townships and Kwa-Mandlenkosi are scored as having no community-based product but "assets underused on the evidence".[815]

Readiness of the shortlisted communities

The plan rates each shortlisted community Ready, Developing or Gap from the community side, with LTO confirmation outstanding.[816] Digital and bookability comes from the 19 profile pages; Gugulethu has no profile.[817]

Table A.21. Shortlist readiness ratings

Half the shortlist has no identified active tourism body, and no community is rated Ready on benefit visible to residents or on digital and bookability.

Community	Binding constraint	Organisation present	Benefit visible to residents	Assets protected	Safety perception	Digital and bookability
Cape Metro						
Langa	Organisation	Developing	Developing	Ready	Developing	Developing
Khayelitsha	Organisation	Developing	Developing	Gap	Gap	Developing
Atlantis	Organisation	Gap	Gap	Developing	Gap	Developing
Mitchells Plain	Organisation	Developing	Developing	Gap	Gap	Developing
Gugulethu	Attraction	Gap	Developing	Developing	Gap	No profile
Cape Winelands						
Kayamandi	Safety	Developing	Developing	Developing	Gap	Developing
Mbekweni	Attraction	Developing	Gap	Gap	Gap	Gap

[814] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p18, p25, p26.
[815] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p56, p58.
[816] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p27, p28.
[817] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p20 to p26, p40 to p51.

Community	Binding constraint	Organisation present	Benefit visible to residents	Assets protected	Safety perception	Digital and bookability
Nkqubela	Attraction	Gap	Gap	Developing	Gap	Gap
Overberg						
Zwelihle	Organisation	Gap	Developing	Gap	Developing	Gap
Kassiesbaai	Organisation	Developing	Developing	Ready	Developing	Gap
Genadendal	Organisation	Developing	Gap	Ready	Developing	Gap
Garden Route						
Thembalethu	Attraction	Gap	Developing	Developing	Gap	Gap
Knysna northern townships	Market link	Developing	Developing	Ready	Developing	Gap
De Rust	Infrastructure	Developing	Gap	Developing	Developing	Developing
West Coast						
Laingville	Organisation	Gap	Gap	Developing	Developing	Gap
Doringbaai	Organisation	Gap	Developing	Developing	Ready	Developing
Elands Bay	Organisation	Gap	Gap	Developing	Ready	Developing
Central Karoo						
Kwa-Mandlenkosi	Organisation	Gap	Gap	Gap	Gap	Gap
Prince Albert North	Attraction	Ready	Developing	Ready	Developing	Gap
Laingsburg (Bergsig)	Attraction	Gap	Gap	Developing	Developing	Gap
Ready (count)		1	0	5	2	0
Developing (count)		9	11	10	9	8
Gap (count)		10	9	5	9	11

Source: SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026: p53 to p58 for the binding constraint; p28 for organisation present, benefit visible to residents and assets protected or damaged; p27 for safety perception; p20 to p26 and p40 to p51 for digital and bookability. Rows follow the shortlist order on p18; section 2.4 prints each community's archetype, score and drive time. Counts are tallied from the printed cells (computed).

The remaining ratings are counted in the order Ready, Developing and Gap. On p27, extortion is 10, 5, 5; energy supply 6, 14, 0; water and sanitation 1, 14, 5; coach access 0, 20, 0; service delivery 1, 14, 5.[818] In the 19 profiles, air and road access is 2, 16, 1; accommodation range 0, 5, 14; safety and support 0, 11, 8.[819]

Extortion is a Gap in Khayelitsha, Atlantis, Mitchells Plain, Gugulethu and Kayamandi.[820] Binding constraints tally Organisation 11, Attraction 6, Safety 1, Market link 1 and Infrastructure 1.[821] The p28 headline counts six communities with asset damage against five Gap cells. The plan names no pilot community and assigns no owner; it tests two to three of six profiled exemplars and lists stakeholders for validation only.[822]

Spend capture scenarios

The 20 communities hold 18.4% of Western Cape residents but a documented floor of R4m to R10m a year in visitor spend, while 1% of FY2025 foreign direct spend would land R259m.[823] They also hold 15.4% of employed residents; both shares come from Census 2011. Foreign direct spend traced to businesses trading inside the communities is a floor of 0.02% to 0.04%, which the plan documents as R4m to R10m landing in the 20 communities a year.

[818] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p27, computed.
[819] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p20 to p26, p40 to p51, computed.
[820] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p27.
[821] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p53 to p58.
[822] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p32, p53 to p58.
[823] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p5; values as printed, with no tracing method or denominator printed.

At 1%, FY2025 foreign direct spend would land R259m in the communities, which implies R25.9 billion of FY2025 foreign direct spend (computed). At 1% of the 2035 spend ambition the figure is R547m, which implies R54.7 billion of spend in 2035 (computed). The plan cites the Demand-Side Analysis (16 Sep 2026) and Diagnostic Report v2 for that scenario.[824] The Diagnostic sets the ambition as 5.7 million international arrivals and R54.7 billion of tourism spend by 2035,[825] a different case from the 2.5 million this report carries. Appendix A2 sets out the demand model's own 2035 cases.

Benchmark cases and the order of action

The five cases point to one order of action: "a seller with a stake, a safe and workable visit, product that keeps spend in the community, then exposure".[826] The plan's six takeaways are that a sustainable local operator is essential, resident ownership matters, safety is a prerequisite, local spend should be captured, existing product should be sold and spending should be tracked.[827]

The plan finds that local selling mechanisms lasted while assets and training without a durable route to market did not, but Costa Rica's selling network did not survive donor exit.[828]

Rio de Janeiro, Santa Marta and Rocinha. The Rio Top Tour's first phase cost about R$230,000 (R$184,000 federal, R$46,000 state). The Cantagalo elevator cost about R$89 million and the Providência cable car R$75 million in a R$163 million package, and almost 10,000 officers were deployed at peak.[829] The tours drew about 4,500 visitors in their first month in 2010, and about 20 resident guides were working by 2015. In 2014, 81% of foreign visitors spent up to R$10 in Rocinha. The cable car stood idle for eight years and security collapsed in 2017, yet Rocinha drew 544,000 visitors in 2023. Access and safety were preconditions, not product, and resident guides continued after the programme that launched them.[830]

Medellín, Comuna 13. Metrocable Line J (2008) cost about 96.9 billion pesos and the escalators (2011) about 10 billion pesos, with maintenance above 260 million pesos a year; the integrated urban programme passed 100 billion pesos by 2020.[831] Comuna 13 drew 1.66 million visitors in 2022 and 1.98 million in 2025, 52% of them international, with more than 1,000 businesses and about 300 guides. A 2023 study put its capacity at 667 visitors a day. The lesson is to fund a mandate, a capacity ceiling and a community body alongside the escalator; residents developed the product first.[832]

Soweto, Vilakazi Street. The Hector Pieterson Museum cost R23.2 million, the Mandela House restoration about R9 million from corporate donors and Orlando Stadium about R280 million; the public-realm cost is not disclosed.[833] The street drew about 1,000 tourists a day by January 2010. Sakhumzi grew from four employees in 2001 to about 110 in 2019, and the ten restaurants provide more than 800 jobs, though the Mandela House company was liquidated. Upgrades amplified existing assets but benefits concentrated on street-front owners, so design governance and a resident precinct entity belong at the outset.

Costa Rica, ACTUAR. UNDP GEF small grants funded the network from the 1990s. Law 8724 (2009) gave ICT duties without a budget, and no state funding for the selling network has been identified.[834] ACTUAR, founded in 2001, turned over more than USD 800,000 in 2013 for more than 30 member communities and dissolved at the end of 2018; its benefits "stopped at association members". A management entity with its own selling channel was the engine, and it did not survive donor exit.

[824] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p5.
[825] Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p5.
[826] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p12.
[827] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p12.
[828] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p7 to p12, p30; the Rio, Medellín, Vilakazi Street and Kliptown cards print no source line, and the plan pools their sources on p12.
[829] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p7.
[830] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p30.
[831] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p8.
[832] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p30.
[833] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p9.
[834] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p10.

Soweto, Kliptown. Kliptown received R436 million in its first allocation. The JDA spent about R497 million from 2001 to 2010 plus R40 million to 2013, Walter Sisulu Square cost R160 million to R180 million and a 48-room hotel R24 million.[835] The business case projected almost 200,000 international visitors a year, but the museum drew about 4,000 a year by 2017 and the hotel traded above break-even only during the 2010 FIFA World Cup. Local small businesses took 5% of construction contract value, and the site was looted in 2021. Heritage converts to local income only when operator, trader and guide product, security and services are funded before the ribbon is cut.

[835] SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p11.

A6 Stakeholder inputs

Phase 1 engaged 16 organisations, whose 223 rated insight statements span all three pillars of the hypothesis tree and inform eight priority areas for deeper engagement.

Engagement record and method

Engagement runs in four phases: Intro & Framing from January to March 2026, sense-making and validation from April to May, socialisation of draft recommendations from June to July and mobilisation from August into October.[836] The March deck closes phase 1 and marks phase 2, a validation round with a select few stakeholders, as still to commence.[837] [Phase 2 to 4 records not in hand: Letsema to supply the organisations engaged, session dates and outcomes for each phase.]

The project team held structured sessions with key stakeholders, extracted insights, mapped each to the project hypothesis tree and aggregated them.[838] Each insight is a concise statement written by the team, not a verbatim quotation.[839] Every row carries a pillar, a category of the tree and one impact rating of High, Medium or Low.[840] The ratings are not defined, and no session dates, participants or roles are recorded, so this appendix attributes insights to organisations and does not quote them.

Organisations engaged in phase 1

Table A.22. Insights by organisation

Sixteen organisations carry 223 rated insight rows, and CapeNature (17 of 24) and the Department of Economic Development (15 of 19) carry the most High ratings.

Organisation	Type	Pages	Rows	High	Medium	Low
Mossel Bay	Local or district tourism body	p20, p21	18	9	9	0
Department of Mobility	Enabling environment	p22, p23	14	7	7	0
Dept of Economic Development	Enabling environment	p24, p25	19	15	4	0
Overberg District	Local or district tourism body	p26, p27	19	5	13	1
C-BRTA	Supply side	p28	7	2	5	0
Google	Enabling environment	p29	8	1	6	1
Stats SA	Enabling environment	p30	7	1	4	2
FEDHASA	Supply side	p31	9	2	6	1
Robben Island Museum	Supply side	p32, p33	14	8	6	0
SATVITO	Enabling environment	p34	11	9	2	0
Table Mountain Aerial Cableway	Supply side	p35, p36	19	10	8	1
Department of Tourism	National, not on p16	p37	7	4	3	0
West Coast District Municipality	Local or district tourism body	p38, p39	15	11	4	0
!Khwa ttu	Supply side	p40, p41	16	7	9	0
CapeNature	Supply side	p42 to p44	24	17	7	0
CTICC	Supply side	p45, p46	16	7	9	0
Total		p20 to p46	223	115	102	6

[836] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p4, p17.
[837] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p4, p15.
[838] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p5.
[839] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p5.
[840] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p20 to p46.

Source: Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p16 (type, where listed; the three local or district tourism bodies overlap the p16 supply-side entry Tourism offices of each District) and p20 to p46. Medium and Low are tallied from the transcribed rows (computed). The deck does not print the number 16.

Organisations listed for later phases

The deck lists 13 supply-side stakeholders, 6 proposed demand-side engagements and 11 enabling-environment stakeholders engaged or in progress.[841] No airline, online travel agency or tour operator is among the 16 phase 1 organisations.

The later-phase list names the demand-side voices that phase 1 lacks, but marks all six demand-side engagements as proposed.[842] The 13 supply-side stakeholders, seven of them with a phase 1 table, are: Tourism offices of each District; Table Mountain Aerial Cableway; Robben Island Museum; Hospitality Providers; Conference Venue Operators; CapeNature; SANParks; CBRTA; Ikhwa ttu; CCID; CTICC; FEDHASA; V&A Waterfront.

The 6 proposed demand-side engagements, none with a phase 1 table, are: Trip.com Group (China, ASEAN); Thomas Cook India (India, Middle East outbound); DNATA Travel (Middle East, India, ASEAN); China International Travel Service (China); Emirates (China, India, Middle East, ASEAN); SATSA. The 11 enabling-environment stakeholders engaged or in progress, five of them with a phase 1 table, are: Department of Economic Development and Tourism; Ministry of Mobility; South African Tourism; SouthAfrica.net; We Do Tourism; SATOvito; Statistics South Africa; Google (Government Affairs and Public Policy); Cape Town International Airport; Winelands Airport; George Airport. The appendix tables print SATVITO, C-BRTA, !Khwa ttu and Cape Nature.

SANParks, the V&A Waterfront, the CCID, hospitality providers, conference venue operators, South African Tourism, SouthAfrica.net, We Do Tourism and the three airports have no phase 1 table.[843] The entry for district tourism offices overlaps the Mossel Bay, Overberg District and West Coast District Municipality tables.

Tally by focus area

No tally is printed, so the table below is a reconstruction from the 16 appendix tables.[844]

Table A.23. Insights by focus area

Policy and data sharing and industry-government collaboration each draw insights from 15 of the 16 organisations, and policy and data sharing carries the most rows and the most High ratings.

Focus area (as coded)	Organisations	Rows	High	Medium	Low
Reshape demand (pillar, as coded)	12	64	23	40	1
1 Respond to growth segment traveller preferences	10	14	6	8	0
2 Create green-season demand with MICE and events	9	15	4	11	0
3 Make the whole province findable and bookable	11	15	6	9	0
4 Convert India and China hub traffic (coded as growth markets generally)	8	9	3	6	0
5 Increase yield in mature markets	4	7	2	4	1
6 Build a regional foundation (Africa)	3	4	2	2	0
Transform supply (pillar, as coded)	14	68	44	24	0
7 and 8 Routes, seats and cruise (coded together)	3	3	3	0	0
9 Accelerate tourism-enabling internal mobility	8	18	10	8	0

[841] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p16.
[842] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p16; entries, spellings and markets in brackets as printed.
[843] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p16.
[844] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p20 to p46.

Focus area (as coded)	Organisations	Rows	High	Medium	Low
19 Lead removal of infrastructure, visa and safety deficits (coded to supply)	10	14	9	5	0
10 Support diversified route and product development	11	18	11	7	0
11 Align visitor experience in-destination	8	11	7	4	0
12 Balance impact on nature-based attractions	3	4	4	0	0
Build enabling capability (pillar, as coded)	16	91	48	38	5
13 Embed local destination bodies for community inclusion	9	14	6	7	1
14 Manage climate risk and sustainable tourism	4	5	3	2	0
15 Crowd in capital with targeted investment strategies	6	8	6	2	0
16 Align institutional stakeholders across all three tiers	5	11	9	2	0
17 Strengthen industry and government collaboration	15	23	8	13	2
18 Expedite tourism-enabling policy and data sharing	15	30	16	12	2
Total	16	223	115	102	6

Source: Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p20 to p46. Reconstruction from the appendix tables, since the deck prints no tally (computed). Each coded category is shown against the focus area it bears on. The tables code routes and cruise as one category and visa, safety and infrastructure under the supply pillar. The Organisations column counts those of the 16 with at least one row under the category or pillar.

The coding has no skills category, so skills insights from CapeNature, the West Coast District Municipality and the Overberg District sit under other categories.[845]

Priority areas for deeper engagement

Table A.24. Lines of enquiry by area

Priority area	Lines of enquiry (p14)
Province-wide access, mobility and visitor movement	Highest-friction transport bottlenecks affecting visitor movement; last-mile access gaps across priority routes and attractions; most feasible mobility interventions by corridor and destination; how to measure mobility impact on spread, stay and satisfaction
International access friction: air access, visas and onward conversion	Priority market access barriers across air, visa and onward travel; where the province is losing international access conversion; highest-impact interventions to ease international access friction; evidence required to support route and facilitation prioritisation
Destination readiness, safety and resilience	Safety issues most damaging to demand and destination confidence; destination infrastructure and service-readiness gaps; climate and utility risks facing priority tourism assets; peak-period visitor-management challenges and operating responses
Product diversification and geographic spread beyond the Cape Town core	Regions and products with strongest potential for incremental growth; barriers preventing secondary destinations from scaling; most credible route-development and multi-stop travel opportunities; how to balance investment between core and emerging destinations
Inclusive tourism growth and SME/community participation	Capability gaps limiting SME and community participation; why current support mechanisms are not scaling market-ready operators; partnership and mentoring models that could improve market access; how inclusion can support both equity and tourism differentiation
Market prioritisation and demand development in mature and emerging source markets	Priority source markets by scale, yield and strategic fit; market-specific barriers to stronger demand conversion; how to balance mature-market yield with growth-market expansion; which segment propositions are strongest by market
Seasonality management, events and demand spread	Where seasonality is most severe by region and segment; event opportunities with strongest off-peak and regional potential; constraints limiting event-led demand growth; how to embed seasonality and spread objectives into activation

[845] Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p27, p39, p43, p44.

Priority area	Lines of enquiry (p14)
Digital conversion, packaging and tourism intelligence	Where the Western Cape is losing travellers along the path to purchase; digital and content gaps weakening conversion; minimum tourism-data architecture needed for better decisions; realistic data-sharing partnerships across the tourism syst (truncated on the slide)

Source: Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p14. Bullets as printed with initial capitals lowered, except the second bullet of the second area, reworded for this report's style; the last is truncated on the slide.

A7 Initiative charters and action register

The 112 actions in Chapter 3 are listed here by initiative, so each lead can see every action the plan asks of it and of its partners.

Section 4.3 carries the eighteen charters in full, so this appendix does not repeat them. It lists the actions from the Chapter 3 action tables in initiative order, with the tier that acts and the proposed lead and partners. The programme office loads this register into the toolkit as the Tier 3 work plan.

Table A.25. Chapter 3 action register

Initiative	FA	Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
I1	1	Wesgro	Set segment targets inside each priority market: Curious Explorers in the UK and USA, Reflective Adventurers in Germany, Creative Connectors in India, Discerning Connoisseurs in the UAE	Destination Marketing; Research
I1	1	Wesgro	Move spend from broad awareness to trade-led conversion through each segment's own channels, from luxury advisors to mobile-first OTAs	Destination Marketing; trade and OTA partners
I1	1	Wesgro	Commission destination-specific research to validate the segments, extend it to the domestic and African markets and build the segments into brand tracking	Research
I1	1	Partners	Develop segment-matched product: heritage and township experiences, creative districts, private-access wine and food and a certified network of wellness retreats and trails	Product owners; CapeNature; SANParks; LTOs
I1	1	National	Agree one segment frame with SA Tourism for long-haul campaigns, so provincial and national spend target the same travellers	SA Tourism
I1	5	Wesgro	Make the case to carriers on the five full routes for added frequency or larger aircraft, backed by green-season marketing	Air Access; airlines
I1	5	Wesgro	Sell Discerning Connoisseur product through luxury advisors and high-end operators in the UK, USA, Germany, France and Switzerland	Destination Marketing; trade
I1	5	Wesgro	Add a yield measure, spend per visitor by market with length of stay, beside arrivals in Wesgro's own targets	Research
I1	5	Partners	Invest in premium product outside the Metro and in the midscale branded accommodation the province lacks (focus areas 11 and 15)	Accommodation investors; hospitality bodies
I1	5	National	Escalate the cap on US carriers, the absence of an Open Skies agreement and the bilateral agreements that limit airlift	Department of Transport
I2	2	Wesgro	Publish a green-season events calendar and aim Convention Bureau bids at May to September in the province's strongest sectors	Convention Bureau; Destination Marketing
I2	2	Wesgro	Package green-season flight, stay and experiences with airlines and trade, and test cooler-season incentive packages with Indian and Gulf planners	Air Access; Destination Marketing; airlines
I2	2	Wesgro	Measure meetings, incentives and exhibitions, which provincial statistics do not cover today	Research; CTICC
I2	2	Partners	Programme lifestyle events in December and January and keep peak dates for international events; market flower, fynbos and whale events earlier	CTICC; Overberg and West Coast LTOs
I2	2	Partners	Agree one event acquisition and calendar strategy across Wesgro, the Convention Bureau, the City and the Province	City of Cape Town; DEDAT
I2	2	National	Ease visas for regional African delegates, whose event demand the venue operator rates as visa-constrained	Home Affairs; SA National Convention Bureau

Initiative	FA	Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
I3	3	Wesgro	Run a bookability census of provincial product by district and publish it as the baseline	Research; LTOs
I3	3	Wesgro	Run a digital onboarding drive for small operators and cellars on the West Coast, Route 62 and the Overberg	Tourism; district municipalities
I3	3	Wesgro	Deepen OTA partnerships with Trip.com, Almosafer and Booking.com, and list packaged regional itineraries on them	Destination Marketing; OTAs
I3	3	Partners	Give each pilot community one live booking route before any promotion (focus area 13)	LTOs; community sellers
I3	3	Partners	Move CapeNature reservations online and complete cashless payments at reserve level	CapeNature
I3	3	National	Extend rural broadband under SA Connect, so operators outside the core can take online bookings and card payments	National government
I4	4	Wesgro	Secure added frequency from Emirates, Qatar Airways and Ethiopian Airlines, with joint market support tied to Indian and Chinese sales	Air Access; hub carriers
I4	4	Wesgro	Activate inside Xiaohongshu, Douyin and MakeMyTrip with market-specific itineraries and Trip.com packages	Destination Marketing; OTAs; trade
I4	4	Wesgro	Build long-term route cases for the India and China corridors and keep a standing relationship with Indian carriers, China Southern and China Eastern	Air Access
I4	4	Partners	Ready the product for both markets: Mandarin and Indian-language guiding, Alipay and WeChat Pay, visible vegetarian options	Product owners; attractions; hospitality bodies
I4	4	National	Escalate visa processing for China and India, and the route designation for China that is decided government to government	Home Affairs; Department of Transport
I5	6	Wesgro	Make the capacity case on the five full regional routes with Airlink, Ethiopian Airlines, Kenya Airways and the other regional carriers	Air Access (focus area 7); airlines
I5	6	Wesgro	Run premium, trade-led activation in Nigeria and Kenya for leisure, weddings and conferences with leisure extensions	Destination Marketing; Convention Bureau; trade
I5	6	Wesgro	Add Nigeria and Ghana to the growth model and commission consumer research for Botswana, Zambia, Ghana and Rwanda	Research
I5	6	Partners	Convert rest-of-Africa travellers who stop in Johannesburg with onward packages, and give regional delegates leisure extensions	Cape Town Tourism; CTICC; tour operators; Cross-Border Road Transport Agency
I5	6	National	Escalate visas for African markets, building on the Ghana visa waiver of November 2023, and liberalisation of regional air routes	Home Affairs; Department of Transport
I6	7	Wesgro	Run a seat-retention and frequency programme on the full routes, with joint marketing tied to route performance	Air Access; Destination Marketing; airlines
I6	7	Wesgro	Scale and ring-fence Cape Town Air Access's route fund as a public-private fund for route support, with a set size and governance	Air Access; DEDAT; City of Cape Town; private sector
I6	7	Wesgro	Treat runway delivery as the first risk: track approvals and milestones quarterly and commission a capacity-against-demand model to 2035	Air Access; Research
I6	7	Partners	Deliver the runway, terminals and George upgrade on the published dates; close the funding and name a carrier at Cape Winelands	ACSA; Cape Winelands Airport
I6	7	National	Escalate bilateral air service agreements, the cap on US carriers and immigration processing at Cape Town International	Department of Transport; Home Affairs

Initiative	FA	Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
I7	8	Wesgro	Market Cape Town to lines whose ships fit the 300m berth and to expedition and home-porting operators, with pre- and post-cruise stays	Cruise Cape Town; Destination Marketing
I7	8	Wesgro	Back Mossel Bay now with packaged excursions and line marketing; keep Saldanha Bay on watch until demand is proven	Cruise Cape Town; Mossel Bay municipality
I7	8	Wesgro	Put community and regional product on cruise-operator channels, starting with a bookable walk in the Knysna townships	Cruise Cape Town; LTOs
I7	8	Partners	Manage berth scheduling and wind delays at Cape Town, plan for shore power and review the 300m limit	Transnet National Ports Authority; V&A Waterfront
I7	8	National	Put cruise into port planning, since current Western Cape port capital carries no cruise capacity	Transnet
I8	9	Wesgro	Package the Southern Line as a visitor product, with refreshed branding and day passes	Tourism; Destination Marketing; City of Cape Town; PRASA
I8	9	Wesgro	Aggregate demand and bookings for corridor shuttles, starting on the Garden Route and between Cape Town, Darling and the West Coast	Tourism; district municipalities; private operators
I8	9	Wesgro	Sell the transfer inside the itinerary on the N2 and R62 routes, so visitors without a car can buy the trip	Destination Marketing; operators
I8	9	Partners	Complete the Central Line recovery, MyCiTi Phase 2 and the unfunded last mile to Cape Point, with integrated ticketing	City of Cape Town; PRASA; Department of Mobility
I8	9	Partners	Take forward the Cape Town to George rapid rail assessment and extend the George public transport model	Department of Mobility
I8	9	National	Lift the national rule that blocks bank-card payments on the George bus, and fund passenger rail beyond the Metro	National government; PRASA
I9	10	Wesgro	Package bookable multi-day itineraries on each of the six touring routes, delivering first on the Garden Route, the Cape Winelands and the Overberg, then Route 62 and the West Coast	Tourism; Destination Marketing; LTOs
I9	10	Wesgro	Activate cold-zone assets with guided tours, interpretation and bookable product, beginning with the marine and wildflower assets	Tourism; CapeNature; SANParks; LTOs
I9	10	Wesgro	Build regional conference offers in Stellenbosch and George, with stays before and after Cape Town events	Convention Bureau
I9	10	Partners	Invest in accommodation and service depth beyond Hermanus, in Route 62's secondary towns and beyond Langebaan and Paternoster (focus area 15)	Accommodation investors; municipalities
I9	10	Partners	Refresh flagship product: Robben Island beyond the prison tour; the Cableway's lower station	Robben Island Museum; Table Mountain Aerial Cableway
I9	10	National	Complete SANParks precinct projects such as the R81.7m Agulhas lighthouse precinct	SANParks
I10	11	Wesgro	Prepare for growth markets: multilingual guiding, digital payments and culturally relevant product for Chinese, Indian and Gulf visitors	Tourism; Destination Marketing
I10	11	Wesgro	Make the investment case for mid-scale and conference-capable hotels in George and Mossel Bay, east of Hermanus and on Route 62 (focus area 15)	Tourism; private investors
I10	11	Partners	Set up a provincial quality charter, phased by district, with certification visible on booking platforms and support for SMMEs to comply	DEDAT, with Wesgro Tourism; industry bodies
I10	11	Partners	Close service and interpretation gaps at named sites: Robben Island interpretation, CapeNature service readiness, restaurant quality in Mossel Bay	Attraction operators; municipalities; CATHSSETA

Initiative	FA	Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
I10	11	National	Improve immigration processing and peak-hour throughput at Cape Town International, and deliver the terminal relief due about 2032	Home Affairs; ACSA
I11	12	Wesgro	Market Cape Point, the under-used reserves and the Southern Line to Muizenberg, Kalk Bay and Simon's Town as alternatives to peak-hour visits at the Cableway and Boulders	Destination Marketing; CapeNature; SANParks; PRASA
I11	12	Wesgro	Request visitor counts and capacity for the five flagship sites and publish them as the baseline	Research; site operators
I11	12	Wesgro	Report spend per visitor and length of stay for nature product alongside visitor numbers	Research
I11	12	Partners	Introduce digital visitor-flow management at the Cableway and Boulders, with tiered pricing where mandates allow	Table Mountain Aerial Cableway; SANParks; CapeNature
I11	12	Partners	Make reserve product climate-resilient by reassessing asset formats and siting	CapeNature
I11	12	National	Agree a visitor management plan for Table Mountain National Park and Boulders with the City and the operators	SANParks
I12	13	Wesgro	Put pilot community product into the itineraries, calendars and channels Wesgro already runs, such as the Langa and Kayamandi routes and the Mal'va festival listing	Tourism; Destination Marketing
I12	13	Wesgro	Choose the two or three pilots with partners on the plan's readiness criteria, and keep the record of bookings, visitors and locally retained revenue	Research; Tourism
I12	13	Partners	Form or fund a local selling body in each pilot community, with one live booking route, published dates and a named customer contact	Municipalities; LTOs; community sellers
I12	13	Partners	Attach maintenance and marketing covenants to public assets before any re-letting or upgrade	Municipalities
I12	13	National	Commit SAPS to the launch safety plans the pilots need, and open ACSA and other national procurement to businesses trading inside the communities	SAPS; ACSA
I13	14	Wesgro	Keep a climate and weather risk register for tourism sites and routes, starting with the Robben Island, Cableway and CapeNature losses and the Meiringspoort closure	Research; DEDAT; site operators
I13	14	Wesgro	Build sustainability checks into the provincial quality charter (focus area 11) on the Mossel Bay model	Tourism; LTOs
I13	14	Wesgro	Route itineraries and marketing around closures, starting with alternatives to Meiringspoort until the pass reopens	Destination Marketing; Garden Route and Klein Karoo LTOs
I13	14	Partners	Give LTOs a stable funding agreement with a development mandate, written into IDPs with reporting	Municipalities; district municipalities; DEDAT
I13	14	Partners	Make reserve and attraction assets climate-resilient, with off-grid power at remote sites	CapeNature; site operators
I13	14	National	Resolve the effect of MFMA Circular No. 131 on municipal funding of local tourism bodies, and complete the Meiringspoort rebuild	National Treasury; the road authority
I14	15	Wesgro	Build a tourism investment pipeline from the gap-closure tables, scored for return, jobs and inclusion, and take it to investors	Wesgro investment promotion; Tourism; DEDAT
I14	15	Wesgro	Prepare investment cases for mid-scale and conference-capable hotels in secondary nodes and for accommodation at De Hoop and on Route 62	Wesgro investment promotion; private investors
I14	15	Wesgro	Scale Cape Town Air Access's route fund into the public-private air access fund, with ring-fenced corridor budgets (focus area 7)	Air Access; DEDAT; City of Cape Town; private sector

Initiative	FA	Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
I14	15	Partners	Test a tourism levy and blended-finance vehicles for destination management and mobility	DEDAT; City of Cape Town
I14	15	Partners	Attach covenants to public assets before re-letting or upgrading them, and invest in community assets only after demand is proven	Municipalities
I14	15	National	Hold ACSA, PRASA and Transnet to their published capital dates, and add tourism use to the port plans	ACSA; PRASA; Transnet
I15	16	Wesgro	Constitute the Tourism Growth Steerco, co-chaired with DEDAT and with Cape Town Tourism as a standing member, and agree a decision-rights map by tier from the Diagnostic's tier table	Wesgro CEO's office; DEDAT; Cape Town Tourism
I15	16	Wesgro	Hold standing relationships with Indian carriers and authorities, with China Southern and China Eastern and with Riyadh Air	Air Access
I15	16	Wesgro	Track the national capital programmes that bind the plan (runway, ports and rail) and report on them each quarter	Air Access; Research
I15	16	Partners	Settle district, local and LTO mandates, restore a tourism development function where it has lapsed and revisit the Discover Garden Route partnership	District municipalities; municipalities; LTOs
I15	16	Partners	Test a dedicated transport authority model for tourism-enabling mobility	Department of Mobility
I15	16	National	Agree with the province how marketing and data roles divide between national and provincial bodies	SA Tourism; Department of Tourism
I15	17	Wesgro	Use JAMS as the single consultation channel to the associations, and add the Tour Guides Association	Wesgro CEO's office; FEDHASA
I15	17	Wesgro	Set up sector councils for wine, business events, adventure and culture inside Steerco's structure	Tourism; Convention Bureau; industry bodies
I15	17	Wesgro	Bring airlines, online travel agencies and tour operators into the joint plan, starting with Trip.com Group, Thomas Cook India, dnata Travel, China International Travel Service and Emirates	Destination Marketing; Air Access
I15	17	Partners	Supply academic and sector champions for international bids	CTICC; universities
I15	17	Partners	Give regional forums a development agenda and tailor provincial support to district needs	District municipalities; DEDAT; LTOs
I15	17	National	Include provincial assets in SA Tourism's campaigns for emerging source markets	SA Tourism
I16	18	Wesgro	Agree data-sharing terms with ACSA, SA Tourism, Stats SA, Cape Town Tourism, the site operators and the booking platforms	Research
I16	18	Wesgro	Run one indicator register and dashboard, with quarterly digital tracking and annual brand research	Research; programme office
I16	18	Wesgro	Measure meetings, incentives and exhibitions	Research; Convention Bureau
I16	18	Partners	Close the provincial tourism policy gap and embed tourism in IDPs and spatial plans, with reporting	DEDAT; municipalities
I16	18	Partners	Share visitor-level data from ticketing and reservation systems	Attraction operators; CapeNature
I16	18	National	Approve a provincial tourism GDP and jobs methodology and resource the tourism satellite account	Department of Tourism; Stats SA
I17	19	Wesgro	Table an escalation agenda at Steerco: visa categories and processing for China, India, the Middle East and Africa; air service agreements; immigration throughput at Cape Town International	Wesgro CEO's office; DEDAT
I17	19	Wesgro	Build the market-by-market evidence for each ask, from visa processing times to safety perception in source markets	Research; Destination Marketing

Initiative	FA	Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
I17	19	Wesgro	Carry a visitor-safety narrative in marketing, and apply the four launch gates set in focus area 13 to any community product Wesgro sells	Destination Marketing; Tourism
I17	19	Partners	Set up dedicated tourism safety units and programmes, with safety compacts in pilot communities	Western Cape Government; municipalities; SAPS
I17	19	Partners	Fix basic services, water and connectivity at remote reserves and in tourism towns	Municipalities; CapeNature
I17	19	National	Decide on visa processing, air service agreements and immigration counters, and make station security a rail line item	Home Affairs; Department of Transport; PRASA
I18	20	Wesgro	Commission the labour analysis with DEDAT: baseline, definition, occupations, skills gaps and the training pipeline	Research; DEDAT
I18	20	Wesgro	Extract the tourism employment table from the Pero 2025	Research
I18	20	Wesgro	Build a workforce strand into the provincial quality charter (focus area 11)	Tourism
I18	20	Partners	Run training partnerships around reserves and in pilot communities, building on the CATHSSETA guide certification and the Prince Albert academy	CapeNature; CATHSSETA; training providers; municipalities
I18	20	Partners	Help newly trained guides stay in the sector with bookings from existing itineraries	LTOs; tour operators
I18	20	National	Approve a provincial tourism jobs methodology and resource the tourism satellite account	Department of Tourism; Stats SA

Source: Chapter 3 action tables; initiative mapping from the traceability table. Leads and partners are proposals for Steerco to confirm.

A8 M&E toolkit

The toolkit register adds the source, frequency, owner and target to each Tier 2 indicator in section 5.2.

Targets come from the growth model where it prints them and from the Inclusion Plan where it sets a pilot count. Elsewhere the target is a direction or a milestone, marked proposed where it is this report's choice; Steerco fixes the levels at Gate 1 once the 2027 baselines exist. Tier 1 targets are in section 5.3 and Tier 3 outputs in the charters.

Table A.26. Tier 2 indicator register

Code	Indicator	Source	Frequency	Owner	Target or direction to 2035
T2-01	Arrivals from the UK, Germany, USA and India	SA Tourism; growth model	Annual	Research	726,330 (2035, base; computed from MA p21, p22)
T2-02	ICCA association meetings in Cape Town	ICCA	Annual	Convention Bureau	Rising; level set at Gate 1
T2-03	April to September share of international seats	ACSA; OAG	Quarterly	Air Access	Rising
T2-04	Share of operators bookable online	Bookability census	Every two years	Research	Baseline in 2027; rising
T2-05	CapeNature reservations made online	CapeNature	Annual	Research	Rising
T2-06	India and China arrivals via hubs	GDS bookings; growth model	Annual	Air Access	India 165,260; China and Hong Kong 92,598 (2035, base, model)
T2-07	Spend per visitor, mature markets	SA Tourism	Annual	Research	Rising in real terms
T2-08	African arrivals and spend	SA Tourism	Annual	Research	Regional group 402,812 (2035, base)
T2-09	International seats and routes	ACSA; OAG	Quarterly	Air Access	From the capacity-against-demand model (I6)
T2-10	Seats added on routes above 80% load	GDS bookings	Annual	Air Access	Seats added on each full route
T2-11	Cruise calls and passengers	Cruise Cape Town	Each season	Cruise Cape Town	Held open until the 250-call plan is sourced
T2-12	Accessibility score by district	Readiness re-score	2029 and 2032	Research	Rising outside the Metro
T2-13	Corridor transfer products on sale	I8 records	Annual	Tourism	One per corridor by 2031 (proposed)
T2-14	Overall readiness by district	Readiness re-score	2029 and 2032	Research	Rising at each re-score
T2-15	Touring routes rated Ready	Readiness re-score	2029 and 2032	Research	Three of six by 2031; none below Developing (proposed)
T2-16	Peak queue at the Cableway	Operator	Annual	Research	Falling
T2-17	Communities with a live booking route	Pilot records	Quarterly	Tourism	Two or three pilots (SCIP p32), by 2028 (proposed)
T2-18	LTOs with a funding agreement	LTO survey	Annual	DEDAT	Baseline in 2027; rising
T2-19	Weather losses at flagship sites	Site operators	Annual	Research	Tracked; no target

Code	Indicator	Source	Frequency	Owner	Target or direction to 2035
T2-20	Tourism projects at financial close	I14 records	Annual	Wesgro investment promotion	First projects by 2031
T2-21	Escalation items answered	Steerco records	Quarterly	Wesgro CEO's office	Each item answered within a year (proposed)
T2-22	Industry partners in the joint plan	Steerco records	Annual	Wesgro CEO's office	Plan agreed in 2027; partners rising
T2-23	Automated feeds in the dashboard	Programme office	Quarterly	Research	Arrivals, seats and cruise automated by 2028
T2-24	Visa processing time, priority markets	Home Affairs; SA Tourism	Annual	Wesgro CEO's office	Falling
T2-25	Tourism labour analysis published	Research	Once	DEDAT, with Wesgro Research	Published by the end of 2028

Source: Indicator register, section 5.2; Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p20 to p23 (model values, working analysis); SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p32. T2-01 is the sum of the four printed market values (computed).

Scorecard and dashboard templates

The quarterly scorecard carries one row per indicator: code, name, baseline and year, latest value and date, direction against the path, target, source and owner. The annual Board outlook adds the Tier 1 chart against both paths and the gate status. The dashboard data model lists each feed, its refresh frequency and the manual-entry form for indicators without a feed. The templates themselves are delivered with the Excel toolkit [M&E toolkit workbook: Letsema to deliver with the final report].

A9 Glossary and references

Ten terms carry a specific meaning in this report, and twenty-eight documents support it, cited by the date on their covers.

Abbreviations are listed in the front matter. Deliverables are cited with the date printed on the cover; where the file date differs, both are shown below. Working analyses rank below the deliverables, and public sources are used only where no deliverable carries the figure.

Table A.27. Glossary of terms

Term	Meaning in this report
Accelerated case	The growth model's upside path: direct India and China routes secured with dedicated activation; 2,516,282 arrivals in 2035
Base case	The growth model's most likely path: Wesgro's current activity continues and hub carriers add capacity; 2,175,778 arrivals in 2035
Cold zone	The Infrastructure Report's term for an area with tourism assets but little or no tourism use
Focus area	One of the twenty entries on the hypothesis tree, each with a Chapter 3 entry, an initiative and indicators
Green season	April to September, the months of lower overseas demand
International arrivals	On the growth model's basis, which Skift is to confirm; distinct from international passenger arrivals at Cape Town International, which ACSA reports
Readiness	The Infrastructure Report's score for how ready a district's assets are to receive visitors, beside attractiveness and accessibility
Seat line	The 1.8 million inbound seats the growth model draws as current air access, as drawn in the Demand-Side Analysis; a model assumption, not a measured cap (section 1.3)
Seller with a stake	The Inclusion Plan's term for a local body that sells community product and keeps the revenue in the community
Tier 1, 2 and 3	Impact, outcome and output indicators (section 5.2)

Source: Letsema, from Chapters 1 to 5.

Table A.28. Documents and sources cited

Document	Author	Date cited	Status	Version in hand and SLA clauses
Inception Report	Study team	Nov 2025 (27 November 2025)	Deliverable	37 slides; working session of 28 November 2025. SLA clauses: [to confirm against Annexure B]
Current State Diagnostic, version 2	Study team	Dec 2025	Deliverable	v2 in the file name. SLA clauses: [to confirm against Annexure B]
Skift Digital and Search Insights memo	Skift Advisory	10 Dec 2025	Working analysis	
Stakeholder Insights Report, phase 1	Study team	Mar 2026 (12 March 2026)	Deliverable	File dated 12 March 2026; sixteen organisation tables. SLA clauses: 1.1.6, 3.2.8
Skift Segmentation Analysis, version 2.0	Skift Advisory	Mar 2026 (12 March 2026)	Working analysis	
Skift African Market Analysis, version 1	Skift Advisory	16 Mar 2026	Working analysis	
Global Benchmarking Report	Study team	Mar 2026 (cover prints 2026 only; file 24 March 2026)	Deliverable	Cover prints 2026 only; file dated 24 March 2026. SLA clauses: 1.1.5, 1.1.11, 3.2.7

Document	Author	Date cited	Status	Version in hand and SLA clauses
MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, final draft	MIDAS	Mar 2026 (file 20 April 2026)	Deliverable	Word file marked final draft, dated 20 April 2026; no page numbers. SLA clauses: 1.1.1.2
Market Assessment Report	Study team	May 2026	Working analysis	Working analysis; predecessor of the Demand-Side Analysis; prints the 2025 model base. SLA clauses: Working analysis under 1.1.1 [to confirm]
Demand-Side Analysis, final	Study team	Jun 2026 (file 1 October 2026)	Deliverable	Final; file dated 1 October 2026. SLA clauses: 1.1.1, 1.1.7, 3.2.3
Infrastructure Report, final	Study team	Jul 2026 (file 22 September 2026)	Deliverable	Final of 114 slides, file dated 22 September 2026; June 2026 draft of 42 slides superseded. SLA clauses: 1.1.2, 1.1.8, 3.2.4
SME and Community Inclusion Plan	Study team	Sep 2026 (file 9 October 2026)	Deliverable	File dated 9 October 2026. SLA clauses: 1.1.3, 1.1.9, 3.2.5
Unlocking Tourism Summary of Findings, working session	Study team	14 Oct 2026 (not in this evidence base)	Deck	
Economic Value of Tourism in Cape Town for the 2024 year	City of Cape Town (Futureneer Advisors)	June 2025	Public source	
Tourism Satellite Account release, as reported	Statistics South Africa	2026, provisional	Public source	
Air access releases: jobs and spend per 100 international passengers	Wesgro and Cape Town Air Access	2023 to 2024	Public source	
Presentation to the parliamentary committee	Wesgro	1 April 2026	Public source	
Western Cape tourism is booming, but can locals afford to enjoy it?	Hypertext	April 2026	Public source	
Western Cape Tourism Performance: Annual 2025	Wesgro Research (SA Tourism data)	2026	Public source	
Q1 2026/27 performance presentation to the Portfolio Committee on Transport, as reported by Travel News	ACSA	August 2026	Public source	
Parliamentary reply on Cape Town International runway capacity	Minister of Transport	April 2025	Public source	
Anuario de Turismo 2024	Sernatur, Chile	December 2025	Public source	
Singapore achieves historical high in tourism receipts in 2024	Singapore Tourism Board	February 2025	Public source	
World Tourism Barometer	UN Tourism	January 2025 and January 2026	Public source	
George Airport expansion reporting	George Herald	July 2026	Public source	
Meiringspoort temporary reinstatement	Western Cape Government	July 2026	Public source	

Document	Author	Date cited	Status	Version in hand and SLA clauses
Kenya 2024 tourism performance, as reported	The Star (Kenya)	May 2025	Public source	
Service Level Agreement, Annexure B	Wesgro and Letsema	December 2025 (not in this evidence base)	Contract	

Source: Letsema, document register. Study team: Letsema in partnership with Skift Advisory. Versions in hand from the cover pages and file dates of each document; SLA Annexure B clause numbers [to be checked against the signed Annexure B].

The SLA clause numbers in the last column are those each document answers. [Clause wording to be checked against the signed Annexure B.]

WESGRO
cape town & western cape
tourism, trade & investment

Contact us

hello@wesgro.co.za

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